Befriending the Most Powerful Person
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Befriending the Most Powerful Person

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Summary

Phainon, an ordinary college student finds himself bound to a "Befriending the Most Powerful Person System" and transmigrated across various worlds. Just from the name you can tell this system would not bring you happiness. It switches capture targets in the blink of a hat, gives punishments through electrocution and the only buff it provides is making his face red enough when interacting with the capture target to to make him look gay. This time he's been thrust into an ABO world filled with mechas. Stuck in the body of a cannon fodder beta who has already offended the novel's protagonist, he must navigate a dangerous military academy while completing the system's questionable daily tasks. With a hidden identity and powerful enemies, he'll need more than luck to survive until the story's end and raise the protagonists favorability value to 100.

Notes

English is not my first language.

Chapter 1: Transmigrated as a Cannon Fodder

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

When Phainon started to gain consciousness he felt that his throat was parched and his hands and feet felt uncomfortable when he tried to move them. He opened his eyes to find himself in what could only be described as the ‘little black room’ from corny mafia novels.

“System, what grudge do you have against me?!” was Phainon’s first coherent thought. He lamented his shitty luck for being bound to such a system who didn’t care about its workers.

A few months ago, Phainon was just a homebody who could stay at home for months on end. But he was conned into bonding with the Befriending the Most Powerful Person System, who stuffed him right into a book called "The Most Powerful Person in the Apocalypse". That was his first world he had to endure.

As for this broken Befriending the Most Powerful Person System, it was really just a system that would cling to the powerful without any regard to their own reputation. You could tell just from the name! This kind of system wouldn't make you happy.

This system would automatically lock onto the most powerful person as the capture target. A daily task would be assigned based on the situation. If it wasn't completed, there would be a terrible punishment, namely electrocution.

Before, he only transmigrated into a world as someone who, despite having some problems, most people generally saw as a straight male (the important part). In any case, it seemed that there weren't any problems.

But now, the system actually had him transmigrate straight into a BL novel. Phainon was already being poisoned to death just looking at the original

novel... He didn't need to think about the system's sinister intentions to be clear about them, but he was resolute!

Even if he had slept with a guy in the previous world, even if he had kissed a guy, Phainon still felt that he was a straight... Forget it, he suddenly felt like he couldn't say anything.

There were three genders in this world. They were divided into alphas, betas, and omegas. The difference was roughly that alphas couldn't get pregnant, and betas and omegas both could (._.) and omegas had a heat that was even scarier than a Zerg's.

Although there were males and females in these three genders, from Phainon's understanding, it seemed that there were girls with peepees who were together, and there was no difference from being gay... Female omegas and such were simply the clear springs in this world!

And this was a novel where the main gong had a harem. The protagonist, Khaslana, was an alpha. He was born in the slums, only knowing that his mother died because of the difficult birth. He didn't know who his father was, and grew up in a welfare agency. Naturally, in this kind of novel with an unknown father, the protagonist's background was terrifying. Khaslana's biological father was actually the empire's emperor.

Although he was just an orphan, Khaslana was extremely gifted, and his face was quite attractive. Using schemes and tricks, he made his way up step by step, using countless people and discovering his own background. Finally, he succeeded in the struggle for the throne and became emperor, becoming a winner in life.

As for the harem, in any case it was already a harem. It was totally normal for a male protagonist to be a bit more douchey. Besides, the people he played were all guys (thankfully, they were all male alphas. According to this novel's settings, AA love was gay).

The protagonist would seek revenge for anything. He was a deep schemer. When someone displeased him, he wouldn't say anything, but in secret he

would get revenge with ruthless methods.

Who knew how many boys had gone through this. Phainon didn't feel too much about it at first. He wouldn't care at all if it wasn't for the fact that he had actually transmigrated into a cannon fodder, and it was even a male beta cannon fodder who would often sneer with a tone that was just looking for a beating.

Anyone would know that a character who offended so many people couldn't keep going in this kind of novel, okay!! Out of the people who taunted Khaslana, if their reputations weren't utterly ruined, then they were furiously eating their lunchboxes. And Phainon, who had transmigrated into this cannon fodder, was even more miserable.

After this cannon fodder had been wrongly named a peeping tom (and it was a peeping tom who was looking into the men's bathroom), because the situation was too embarrassing, he had been ruthlessly expelled from the school... And when he was on the way home, the protagonist's worshippers had people tie him up and take him away.

Phainon transmigrated right into that moment. He was bound in ropes, laying on the ground, and his clothes were already torn up. At the side, there was someone holding a whip, constantly lashing him. The system suppressed most of the pain, but it was inhumane to feel the pain that came time and time again.

"What the fuck?!" Phainon simply didn't understand why it was such a heavy start. It was whatever to transmigrate into a BL ABO world. Now that he had come somewhere where he was being whipped, could it still be better?

At the side, there was a young man wearing black. He was extremely attractive, so that he could even be called beautiful, but he wasn't feminine. But his handsome face was filled with disgust. He looked down at Phainon, having his lackeys continue to brandish the whips.

[Beep beep beep... Detected a powerful character... Beginning to select capture targets in accordance with the system's regulations... Selection complete. The current capture target is Caelus.]

Caelus was the son of a duke with an honorable status. He was a naturally gifted alpha, and he was one of the original protagonist Khaslana's fanboys... In the future, he would also give Khaslana a lot of help.

Although Khaslana had just entered the military academy, he was already an influential figure in the school. The first time he participated in the mecha tournament on the virtual net, he fought his way into the top hundred. Caelus was one of the fanboys that became a fan of Khaslana after the tournament.

Besides, Caelus's personality was completely that of an arrogant, spoiled young master. After finding out that the person he worshipped had actually been taunted -and by a laze-about beta too- he was extremely unhappy. He grabbed Phainon, who had dared to sneer at Khaslana.

"You actually had the guts to mock Senior Khaslana." Caelus laughed coldly. "But you're just a useless beta. Where did this courage come from?"

Phainon: "!" Hey, this is gender discrimination!! Don't think you're so amazing just because you're an alpha, how is being a gender with pain-in-the-ass heats any better than the convenience of being a beta?

"It seems you're pretty strong-willed." When he saw that Phainon wanted to retort, Caelus snorted. "Whip a bit harder. We'll see how long you can take it."

Wait, he wasn't strong-willed! Stop quickly!

"I..." can't endure any more... Before he finished begging for mercy, because he was hungry and tired and had been whipped for so long, he finally fainted.

Phainon didn't wake up until an unknown amount of time later.

He was, of course, still laying in a little black room. How could someone like Caelus prepare a place to live for someone he dragged here to beat!!

The little black room was clearly used for illegal punishment, but because the duke was rich enough to use his money to shut people up, the floor even had a rug spread over it. It was at least better than sleeping on normal floorboards.

There wasn't even a window on the wall. The door was also shut tightly. There was no way for Phainon, who felt weak all over, to escape.

Normally, what Caelus was doing was illegal, but with his status, even if he beat Phainon to death, nobody would have the courage to set things straight with him.

"This is basically murder." Phainon used his ability to heal his wounds before he was able to recover some energy. But he was still hungry and thirsty and tired, and his clothes were still torn up. There was even some crusted blood on his clothes. He was ready to collapse.

He must have the most rotten luck to have made an enemy of the original protagonist and an entire group of people right after transmigrating!! This was beginning right at hell level. What in the world was he going to do?

As soon as he thought about the capture target Caelus, Phainon felt that the future was dim. But if the capture target was the original protagonist, the situation would be impossible to look at... He knew what the original protagonist would never be good to someone who had cursed him out just by thinking about it!

The one thing that he was able to rejoice in was that he had transmigrated into a beta. How nice was it to be a beta! Phainon felt very emotional. He had already had enough of things like heats from the last worlds!

[Actually, host, you're an omega pretending to be a beta.]

Phainon: "...Huh?!"

Phainon thought back to the members in the body he had transmigrated into. The original owner's father was a downtrodden noble, and his mother, who had squeezed her way into the upper class, was the daughter of a rich merchant. They sent their only child into the military academy with the help of their family's connections.

Although it wasn't mentioned in the original novel, it was obvious after a bit of thought. The original owner who had offended the original protagonist had definitely caused his entire family to fall into a sorry state.

"Wait, I don't have a reason that makes me have to pretend to be a beta, right?!" Phainon said. "Why not think about how strange it is for a cannon fodder that was here for faceslapping to have such a background!"

[These are all settings patched in by the world consciousness. It's probably because the original host's mother can't have any more children, and omegas can't inherit titles. Being afraid the title would fall into other hands, the original host was forced into pretending to be a beta.]

Phainon: "...Th-then it's already been concealed for ten-some years. There won't be any problems if I keep concealing it, right?"

[The inhibitors on the host have a strong effect. As long as no alphas mark the host, there won't be any problems.]

"System, why do I feel like your words are always some flags." Phainon's face was green. But when he thought about how most of the alphas in this world were gays who liked other alphas (deduced from the original protagonist's harem), he felt he wouldn't have any problems.

Phainon struggled in the little black room for a long time, continuously using his healing ability the system had given him when he first bound to it to replenish his blood before he was able to recover half of his strength and stop laying prone on the ground. Today, Phainon discovered this healing ability really was convenient.

Soon, the sound of footsteps came from outside. Phainon's heart tensed, and he quickly laid back on the ground, pretending to be unconscious. If Caelus

saw that he was as lively as a golden retriever and decided to whip him a few more times, it would be no good.

This time, there was only the sound of one person. The door opened, and a voice full of loathing came. "Hmph, you really are trash. Wasn't it just a few whippings? But you're still not awake."

Phainon: "..." You try not eating or drinking after getting beaten up and laying here for an entire day!!

[Daily task refreshed. The current task is [Kiss the capture target once]. Host, please do your best.]

Phainon: "???" System, you... Hey, do all systems have such an immoral setting as soon as it's a BL world??

Well, forget it. He's had sex before, what was a kiss?

After the depressing situation from the last world, Phainon had become very adaptable.

As Caelus looked at the pallid youth laying on the ground, he actually felt that Phainon was a little bit pitiful. Immediately, he was disgusted by his own thoughts.

He remembered his goal in coming. Using hands covered by gloves, Caelus grabbed Phainon by the collar, his eyes flashing with disgust and thinking about how he would throw away the gloves that had touched Phainon when he went out later. He said coldly, "Trash, wake up!"

As an outstanding alpha, Caelus had innate disdain for betas. He even looked down on betas who were the same noble rank as he was. There was no need to talk about Phainon, whose father came from a tiny noble family. As long as Caelus wanted to, he could have Phainon's entire family driven away from the planet the very next day.

Phainon finally pretended to be waking up slowly. He said weakly, "W-what are you doing?"

"You got lucky. I wouldn't let you go so easily if it wasn't for the fact it'd be a bother to clean up after a death." Caelus remembered what his older brother had told him that morning and snorted coldly. "Hmph. Hurry up, get up and get things together. You're going with me to apologize to Senior Khaslana today. Don't think you can get out of it by playing dead. I won't let you go as long as Senior Khaslana doesn't accept your apology."

But Phainon didn't absorb any of the later words that Caelus said. He was thinking about something even more serious.

Did he fail to complete his daily task and get the system's abuse, or did he complete the daily task and get beaten by Caelus? These two situations swirled around in Phainon's head.

It was obvious which one was scarier. Compared to the soul-crushing torture from the system, Caelus wouldn't hurt him much even if he was whipping him for an entire afternoon.
After he made his decision, Phainon heartlessly, firmly grabbed Caelus's hand.

Caelus didn't expect that Phainon actually had the guts to resist. He also didn't expect that Phainon still had the energy to grab him. He was stunned, then furious. He, someone with such a high status, was actually given a sneak attack by a useless beta. This was simply the most embarrassing thing to happen to him in his entire life.

Without waiting for Caelus to move, Phainon suddenly leaned in.

Because he was too rushed, rather than saying Phainon leaned in, it was more accurate to say that he knocked his head towards Caelus. With strength that came out of nowhere, he managed to press Caelus directly to the ground. His teeth even scraped Caelus's lip. The scent of blood dissipated from between them.

Caelus laid on the soft grass in a trance, seeming like he could see a faint fragrance coming from Phainon's body. His lips were unimaginably soft. He was clearly just a beta, so why could he actually...

Phainon was simply acting as though he was about to die. When he heard the system's prompt that the task was completed, he slowly sat back.

"..." Alright, now he could wait for Caelus's temper to erupt.

The room sank into an unusual silence.

"You... B-brazen! Shameless! That was my fir-first..." When Caelus finally reacted, he immediately sat up, wiping off the blood at his mouth quickly. He gritted his teeth. "So you're going to offend me. You're just an insignificant waste beta, but you actually did something like this... I absolutely won't let you off!"

Phainon had already prepared to get whipped. He lowered his head, closing his eyes, but after a long time, nothing happened. He opened his eyes in confusion.

And he was pressed down by Caelus, who kissed him abruptly.

Phainon's heart flew into a panic. "...Mmmm?!" Wait, the revenge Caelus was talking about was this kind?!

Caelus seemed like he was competing with Phainon. He gripped Phainon's jaw stubbornly, opening his mouth and using his tongue to invade his mouth. Although he had never kissed anyone before and his actions were a little unfamiliar, Phainon almost couldn't breathe.

When Phainon was kissed until he was about to faint, Caelus finally leaned back proudly. He reached out to lift Phainon's chin. "Hmph. You're just a waste and you want to compete with me."

Phainon looked at Caelus in shock. "..." Was this something normal people would do?!

Or was this perfectly normal in an ABO world... After all, men could even get pregnant and women could have pee-pees. What was impossible?

"Still, since you made an enemy of me, I won't let you go so randomly." Caelus snorted again. "I have to lock you up. I'll make you understand how

things will end when you offend me."

Immediately, Caelus rushed out.

Phainon stayed in the room, trembling in wait of the end Caelus was waiting for. Of course, when he was waiting, he switched rooms.

This was a room in quite decent condition. There was a bed, a bathroom, and a desk. There was even a helmet that could surf the net!

Hey, did Caelus really have the intentions to illegally imprison him?! He even had things that could connect to the outside world set out openly in the room.

But even if he could connect to the outside world, Phainon despairingly discovered that he still had no way to leave... Even his parents had no way to take him away.

It seemed that Caelus didn't have a big heart. He just had absolute faith that Phainon wouldn't escape.

Phainon couldn't understand what Caelus was trying to do either. In any case, it was boring to stay here, so he put on the helmet.

The virtual world was no different from the real world. In the future, there were many people who stayed engrossed in the virtual world all day, because in the virtual world, they didn't need to worry about heats or anything like that. The omegas who could only stay in school and or at a home especially liked to stay in the virtual world. There were even game cabins with nutrient fluids made for these people, which could let them stay in the virtual world for two to three days.

If they were like Phainon and used the helmet to connect to the net, they were forced to disconnect every five or six hours to eat.

After Phainon put on the helmet, his consciousness went straight to a lively street. It was full of people. Nobody noticed Phainon. They were all looking at the fight on the virtual screen at the side in excitement.

Phainon's attention was also drawn by the fight. When he read the novel's introduction, he understood that other than ABO, this world also had a mecha setting, but it was his first time seeing them for real.

On the virtual screen, there were two mechas fighting fiercely. One of them was gorgeous and even had a high-tech weapon, but its opponent was an old, worn-out mecha that looked like it was about to fall apart.

The victor seemed obvious, but in reality the gorgeous mecha was suffering defeat after defeat, and the worn-out mecha was growing more and more valiant. It had an overwhelming advantage.

Everyone was excited. They kept cheering. It was obvious that they were fans of the worn-out mecha.

"How awesome..." Phainon couldn't stop himself from crying out.

Someone next to him said in excitement, "After all, that's the amazing Time! Although he's a newcomer to the competition this time, he's this strong! Even if he's using an outdated mecha, nobody can compete with him! I think he'll definitely get to the finals this time!"

Phainon: "...!"

Wasn't the guy named Time Khaslana from the original novel?!

Chapter End Notes

> I am a big lover of reading trashy Chinese QT novels and i also am a lover of all things Phainon and so this combination has formed. The original novel is also called Befriending the Most Powerful Person and you can read its translation online if you'd like. This is just my take on it with my favorite characters. This is also my first time writing on ao3 so hopefully this goes well. Feel free to give me constructive criticism in the comments.

Chapter 2: In Mydei's mind, the word "surrender" emerged

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

According to the rules of the competition, the competitors could choose not to expose their faces or their real names. Khaslana had entered concealing his face and name. But while his identity was hidden from the common people, he couldn't hide it from Caelus and people with a background. In minutes, they guessed who he was.

In the original novel, this competition was also Khaslana's first step on the path of glory. After Caelus saw the competition, he became a fanboy of his technique. Besides Caelus, he also met several friends who were talented and of strong backgrounds. They became the base that he used to seize the throne in the future.

In the end, Khaslana took first place and became famous throughout the entire empire, and he defeated the Zerg spy that had been planted in the capital planet (all kinds of interstellar novels had these overused villains). After that, his reputation spread far and wide. Overnight, the number of have fans he had broke through to several billion. They retaliated against the people who had humiliated him in the past, and they couldn't stay in the capital any longer.

As a cannon fodder who had been expelled from his school not long ago because of such a shameful reason, Phainon's mood was complicated. He just had to think to know that Khaslana's revenge wasn't over. When he gained more power in the future, who knew if Phainon would even be able to continue living.

And he had to capture Khaslana before he could leave!! The favorability score was absolutely in the high negatives already.

Phainon felt a huge mental burden just thinking about it. It would be good if he could follow the original protagonist's path and participate in a mecha competition like this. He wouldn't be shut in a room and beaten because his strength was so trash.

[Host, you can go participate in a virtual mecha competition if you want. Also, because everyone is a projection in the virtual world, you won't bind to a new capture target.]

"The important thing isn't whatever about the capture target. Although that's also very important... If someone who has the strength of a radish like this body goes participate in a mecha competition, I'll get wiped out in the first first round," Phainon instinctively retorted, but his heart was wavering.

Although the original relied on inhibitors to act as a beta for over ten years, his physique was about the same level as other omegas. He was just a little stronger than other omegas, so his grades in school were also at the bottom of the rankings and he would just bully commoner students like the original protagonist.

The reason the original host had taunted Khaslana was probably really because he was secretly jealous that he was an alpha. Although he didn't want to admit it, alphas were just naturally superior in terms of strength.

But as long as it was a boy, who wouldn't be excited by a mecha? When Phainon first became a homebody nerd, he really liked watching mecha war movies. Every time he saw the protagonist start the mecha, he wanted to try it himself. Now, the opportunity was right before his eyes. If he didn't give it a try, he wouldn't be able to explain himself.

Phainon turned to look at the rules screen at the side. As long as he paid sixty empire coins, he could participate. Of course, sixty empire coins only provided the lowest training mecha. If he wanted a better one, he had to pay more.

In some sense, it was possible to net good results from these competitions buy throwing money at it. For the most part, anyone else who broke into the rankings was skilled. Still, someone like Khaslana, who could crush other

people using a high-grade mecha that cost several billion empire coins with just practiced ease of an outdated mecha, was someone who came once in a hundred years. That was why he attracted so many fans.

Now, as long as they wanted to, anyone could join the competitions. The competition adopted a point system. The top one hundred people by the end of the competition could rise to the finals. If they won, they would get 2 points. If they lost, they would lose 2 points. A draw was 0 points.

Although it was just a battle in the virtual world, it would use up spiritual energy. When there was less spiritual energy, it would affect their performance, so most people would only fight two or three battles.

"Well, it's just sixty empire coins. It's about the same cost to go see a movie. Besides, I can be anonymous." Phainon walked to the side where he could register automatically, without the slightest burden, swiping his personal terminal. Immediately, his surroundings faded to black, and several virtual screens appeared in front of him.

[Please select the mecha you would like to use.] An emotionless, robotic voice sounded.

Phainon looked at the screen in front of him. There were all kinds of mechas in all kinds of colors and all kinds of weapons. Several were kinds that common people in the outside world had no way to even touch, but in the virtual world, they just needed to pay some empire coins to use it.

Of course, Phainon selected the free older generation mecha without hesitation. As if he would spend a single extra empire coin on a competition he had no chance to win!

Next was whether he wanted to conceal his face, and the name he would use to compete.

Phainon naturally picked to conceal his face, and he barely thought about the name. He typed in the words Prince Latiao (means spicy stick, a type of popular chines snack like jerky) ... Actually, this was the nickname he used to use when he was surfing the internet.

People from the future definitely didn't know what latiao were. This way, he could maintain a sense of mystery as well as allowing him to remember the latiao he liked to eat before he transmigrated... After he thought about it, he suddenly felt this name was simply perfect.

After he finished his selections, the screen glowing in front of Phainon's eyes dimmed completely.

[Selected the old style mecha... Succeeded in registering for the competition... You currently have 0 points... Matching with an opponent...]

After a series of mechanical noises, Phainon's vision turned bright. He discovered that he was currently sitting in an old mecha, and the exterior was the field. It felt unnaturally genuine. There wasn't the slightest difference reality. Phainon felt around the mecha with excitement.

This round of the mecha competition had already been running for several months. It would end in just half a month, and most of the people at the top of the rankings had fans already. Every time they competed, countless people would fight to spend money and buy tickets to watch up close. People like Khaslana had already reached the level where their competitions would be broadcasted outside.

Generally speaking, people wouldn't come to watch the matches of people who were low in the points rankings, and the competition system would match people with similar points, so Phainon's opponent should be someone who was at the end of the ranks.

But the field was full of people, and across from Phainon was a top-grade mecha. The crowd around him was cheering unceasingly.

Phainon had a bad feeling. He looked to see who his opponent was, and he was stunned. "...What the fuck?!"

The opponent that the competition system had matched Phainon with was actually a contestant in the top hundred players whose name was Mydeimos. He was a nouveau riche who had gained fame with the help of a huge sum of money and his extreme skills. He wouldn't hesitate to use

several of the weapons that needed several million empire coins to use once. On top of that, Mydei was quite attractive, so his fans were naturally numerous.

Phainon was different from other people, because he understood who this was. Mydeimos's real identity was actually the crown prince's younger cousin. His family was a superpower that could influence the entire empire's trade, and his mother was the descendant of a family with a strong reputation.

In addition to this, he was also Khaslana's close friend. Later, he even betrayed his older cousin, the crown prince, to support Khaslana. This was why the crown prince, the villain boss, lost so quickly.

Phainon didn't expect that as soon as he came out he would meet an opponent like this. He felt like he had been abandoned by the world.

Phainon wasn't the only one who was shocked. When Mydei and the crowd saw the enemy was actually a hopeless lose with 0 points and using an outdated mecha, they were also shocked.

"Did the system run into an error?"

"You can tell right away that someone like this just came to join in on the fun, but he can actually be with Mydeimos?"

"In the case, I can also participate in the competition, right?!"

"And Prince Latiao is a weird name. It just sounds funny."

These people thought the name Prince Latiao was already so far from down-to-earth it was at the level of a punk edgelord.

Mydei, sitting in a high-level mecha, pondered earnestly. He had brilliant blonde and auburn hair, amber eyes eyes, and a handsome face often sporting a calm and determined expression. Just a single smile from him was intoxicating. He hadn't announced his identity, otherwise his fans would be ten times as numerous.

"I heard that even if it's your first time competing, if the system detects a strong spiritual strength, it will still match you up with an opponent with a corresponding strength... Maybe it's that kind of situation." When Mydei thought of it, he immediately turned serious, fixing his gaze on the enemy opposite him.

The match hadn't officially started yet. Using a technique gained from the host's school memories, Phainon began to operate the mecha with difficulty. He fumbled around for the controls, trying to move.

To the crowd outside, this outdated mecha suddenly began to shake like a drunkard. It couldn't even walk properly. Several times, it even fell to the ground for real, then crawling back up with difficulty.

Jeers immediately exploded from the stands. "My god, this is totally a mecha newbie, isn't it? Even my little brother in elementary school can move better than him."

"Where did this kind of guy get the courage to join a mecha competition? What a joke."

"I'm going to record this match and put it on the forum so everyone can have a laugh."

Even Mydei was a bit hesitant. No matter how he looked at it, it was obvious his opponent was a beginner. Was the system matching really wrong?

After a moving his limbs a flurry for a long time, Phainon suddenly remembered that they had also been taught how to use spiritual energy to connect directly to the mecha. Because this method needed formidable spiritual energy, most people couldn't do it.

But if they succeeded in connecting to the mecha, they would feel as though they were the mecha themselves. It was many times better than operating it by hand. If the mecha was injured, the operator would also be wounded, and it was also a more dangerous method.

[Count down. 10, 9, 8, 7... 4, 3, 2, 1-begin!]

Phainon gritted his teeth, closing his eyes and trying to use his spiritual energy to connect to the mecha. In moments, it was as though a blue ocean appeared before his eyes, and he was a tiny speck of light in the sea.

"Is this my spiritual world?" Phainon was frozen.

The original novel said that normal people had spiritual world that was just the size of a well. Even the peerlessly talented main character Khaslana had a spiritual world just the size of a lake.

But the host, as a cannon fodder, didn't even register as a B-grade spiritual energy... In other words, the sea in front of him wasn't the original host's spiritual energy. It was his own spiritual energy.

“…..”

“…”

When the countdown ended, the barrier between the two mechas immediately disappeared.

The crowd in the stands began to shout. "Knock down this newbie who doesn't know the limits of the sky!"

"We bought tickets to see experts, not to a rookie like this."

"A weak chicken has the guts to use an outdated mecha? Do they think they're God Time?"

Mydei just manipulated his mecha to charge in front of his enemy. His mecha was the newest model that had been developed, and it was much faster than a normal mecha. The power of its weapons were also extremely strong. He could cut open his opponent's cockpit with ease.

Unexpectedly the other party's mecha still hadn't begun to move. It was obvious the person in the cockpit had already gave up on opposition.

It seemed as though the system really had an error during matching. Somebody who gave out without even a fight was simply a disgrace on the competition.

Disappointment flashed through Mydei's eyes. He had come to the competition to cross swords with even more strong people, inexperienced trash like this was really not worth his time.

Mydei manipulated the laser scalpel directly to point directly at his opponent's cockpit. At this point, this enemy wasn't worth his serious attention. He just wanted to use the quickest method to deal with him.

The stands rose with cheers. Almost everyone could imagine how the outdated mecha's cockpit would be skewered by the laser scalpel in the next moment.

But Phainon's eyes suddenly snapped open.

In that moment, it was as though he had become the mecha... No, his powerful spiritual energy had nearly encompassed the entire space. He saw everything. He could even see the expressions of the crowd in the stands as clear as day.

And in Phainon's eyes, Mydeimos's nimble laser scalpel was as slow as if it was in a slow motion film. He could avoid it with ease.

Phainon avoided the surprise attack without thinking.

When the anticipated result of slicing open the cockpit didn't happen, Mydei was stunned. He realized that his opponent had actually evaded him at a rapid speed.

The people on the stands were stupefied. Several people thought their vision had gone blurry, reaching up to rub their eyes.

"What just happened?"

"Is it a coincidence...? Just now he couldn't even control his mecha properly, how could he suddenly avoid it?"

"It must be a coincidence. Even a genius couldn't learn how the controls in a second... Unless he connected with his spiritual energy just now. But how could that be?"

Someone unwittingly spoke the truth.

Mydei furrowed his brows, lunging for Phainon with the laser scalpel in his hand. But it was just like it was seconds ago. The opponent easily dodged. Even the mecha's speed was no slower than his own modern mecha.

Generally speaking, if it wasn't superb technique, it was only possible to reach such a level by connecting to the mecha with spiritual energy.

Mydei was also using his spiritual energy to control the mecha, but he hadn't achieved such a complete, seamless connection. Among the people he knew, people who could achieve such a level of connection with an outdated mecha...

In that moment, Mydei unexpectedly thought of the friend he thought of in high esteem, Khaslana.

"How could it be, this guy is just trash." When he realized that he had actually put this newbie and Khaslana on the same level, Mydei felt a wave of fury. Comparing Khaslana with this person was an insult.

Mydei looked up at the outdated mecha, chopping at his opponent. At the same time, he prepared to fire ammunition at the opposing mecha's four limbs to destroy it. "Aren't you good at hiding? You don't have luck on your side this time."

But this time his opponent didn't dodge. He pulled out a worn-out laser weapon to block Mydei's attack.

Naturally, the outdated mecha's weapons couldn't be compared with the latest laser scalpel. In a few breaths, it was destroyed, but in those few breaths, the old mecha had already charged in front of Mydei. It grabbed Mydei's mecha's arms.

In the next moment, Mydei could see several different ways to struggle free, but no matter how he tried to move his body, he couldn't move. The places his mecha was touching his opponent's made him feel very clearly the other party's spiritual strength.

It was a terrifyingly strong spiritual energy. In that moment, Mydei felt as though he was drowning in the sea. He couldn't breathe. His spiritual strength was S-rank, the cream of the crop, but compared to his opponent he had no way to resist. He couldn't even struggle. He just wanted to surrender himself to this powerful person.

Exactly... At that moment, in Mydei's mind, the word "surrender" emerged.

Mydei didn't know how long it took before he returned to his senses. By then, his opponent's weapons were already resting against his cockpit. As long as the mecha used a little bit more strength, it would be able to cut through his cockpit and skewer through him.

[Number 09364 is victorious.]

A mechanical voice like the competition system's rang along with the sound of the crowd sucking in a cold breath. Nobody had expected that a beginner that nobody thought highly of could actually defeat Mydeimos so easily.

The people who had been mocking Phainon now felt that they couldn't face the situation. If it wasn't for the rule that someone could only compete with one identity, they would even suspect if this Prince Latiao was a side entry for the terrifying Time.

There were even people who turned into Phainon's fans on the spot. They completely forgot about Mydeimos, cheering Phainon's name continuously from the side.

"Ahh... I-lost." Mydei finally reacted. He had actually lost to a newbie with 0 points.

If this was spread around, it would be absolutely humiliating, but Mydei didn't feel humiliated at all. Instead, a strange feeling began to bubble in his

heart.

"No, if there's someone as strong as this, how could he be a newbie." When he thought about how he had been totally steamrollered by this other peron's strength, his complete inability to fight back, the feeling of being almost suffocated, a red glow appeared on Mydei's pale, handsome face. He was ecstatic.

That was the feeling he was chasing after. Before, Mydei thought that the person who fit these requirements was Khaslana, but now...

"Exactly. This is the person I've always been looking for." Mydei looked at the opposing mecha with shining eyes, but instead discovered that the mecha had already left.

After he won, Phainon rapidly left the competition. He was stupefied.

"What just happened? Why is my spiritual energy so strong?" Phainon felt like he had just been dreaming. After he connected to the mecha with his spiritual energy, it was as though he had been given a cheat. He had defeated his opponent as easily as if he was fighting an elementary schooler.

And that wasn't a normal opponent. It was the most important male character in the original novel, Mydeimos!

Even now, the rush of victory was still left in Phainon's blood, and he couldn't calm himself down. It was as though he could still see everything in the blink of an eye, as though he could still behead his opponent easily.

[Host, it's because after you experienced so many worlds and underwent all different kinds of transmigrations, your soul's strength is already much stronger than the average person's. When you participate in this kind of competition, you naturally would have no problem. Of course, if this was reality, the strong spiritual energy would make host's body fall apart.]

"...Since it's already like this, can't you give me a body that's a bit better?! Something like my original body." Phainon's impassioned heart quickly cooled. He had even thought that he could finally become one of the strong

and wouldn't need to get thrown about by a nutjob. He didn't expect that he could only be strong in the virtual world.

[If host is too strong, it will draw the world consciousness's attention. Host's identity was already hidden in the competition this time, otherwise if you're found out by others it will cause unnecessary trouble.]

"Well, that's true." Phainon thought that he wasn't a Gary Stu protagonist anyway, and he didn't have a protagonist halo. If there actually was someone with such incredible strength, he might get his lunchbox in minutes. But it didn’t stop his heart which would still sometimes miss his carefully maintained body from his original world when he was now forced into these bottom roles.

But after resting for a bit, Phainon's mind filled with high aspirations. "Since I can only be strong in the virtual world, I won't let this opportunity get away. I'm going to get into the finals." If he changed worlds in the future, where would he get this kind of chance?

After making his decision, Phainon immediately continued into the competition site.

Meanwhile, the people who had just watched Mydeimos and Phainon's match had put a video up on the forums.

The people of the empire worshipped the strong and often had mecha competitions around the country. Almost everyone paid attention to virtual mecha competitions. There were also always countless people visiting the forums every day.

And a post titled "A newbie with zero points using an outdated mecha actually killed one of the top hundred in seconds, could it be that a second God Time has come up into the clouds?" attracted countless people's eyes. After the people who thought it was some fake rumors and disdained to click in saw the video, they were stunned.

In just a day, the post had countless replies. Several people questioned it simultaneously, all in shock, asking whether Mydei had made a mistake, or

if Mydeimos and that Prince Latiao had some dirty transactions between them.

But Mydei's fans jumped on them like a pack of rabid dogs. Everyone knew Mydeimos was a nouveau riche who had all the money he wanted. How could he ruin his own name for something like this? It was even less likely he would take any bribes.

As the people in the post were fighting endlessly, someone suddenly tossed out a video, saying they had happened to see Prince Latiao at the competition by chance. Because they were too shocked, they had recorded it, and they would also let the people in the post see what the circumstances were really like.

Chapter End Notes

> Gary Stu: (male version of Mary Sue) protagonist is an unrealistically perfect, overpowered male lead who is incredibly skilled, universally admired (or feared), faces no real challenges, and often bends the story's logic for wish fulfillment.
>
> Getting Lunchbox: The phrase "getting a lunchbox" or receiving a lunchbox means that a character is going to die or be killed off. In earlier productions, an actor who had finished all their scenes in a show (often because their character was about to die) would receive their final "box lunch" from the catering crew on set. Once an actor received their final lunchbox, it was an informal signal that their work was done because their character's story had concluded with their death.
> ---
>
> The character that i am basing Mydei on is very very very different from our aloof king but i am trying to reach a middle ground because Mydei in this fic serves the role of devoted protector and fanboy who ends up being Phainon's biggest supporter and comrade (and more ofc-). Lmao thats like my biggest grip with this whole story, i feel like

im making Mydei's character too strange but alas we must persist. I've already edited it two times.

Chapter 3: Meeting the Original Protagonist

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

The contents of the video that was put online was a scene between Prince Latiao and a more well-known contestant in the top ninety.

On the battlefield, Prince Latiao was the same as before. He easily steamrollered his opponent. Even the people on the sidelines could see his skillful maneuvering, while his seasoned opponent seemed like he had gone stupid. He lost without the slightest resistance. He didn't even realize his loss for a long time.

And there were several videos appearing. As long as they had been watching outside, they could see the videos. This person named Prince Latiao participated in tens of matches without stopping, and nearly none of the opponents he met could make it past ten minutes in the battlefield.

Generally speaking, it was already impressive for a participant to compete three or four times, but this Prince Latiao seemed not to know how to get tired. What terrifying level had his spiritual energy reached?

All the recordings were spread around. In moments, most of the people who had been cursing in the forums disappeared. Everyone had a sense of disbelief. Was it possible that there were actually two incredible competitors that appeared this year? Other than God Time, there was actually another person who could use an outdated mecha and reach a level of an immortal.

With such incredible power, it was impossible that this was someone unknown to the public. Was it some influential family's young master who came to participate in secret?

On the side, Mydei expressed in his social accounts that what had happened was absolutely genuine. There wasn't a single bit that was fake. Moreover,

he deeply respected Prince Latiao's strength, and he hoped he could get to know him.

Mydei's fervent tone gave his fans a shock. Everyone knew that Mydei didn't have any interest in things outside of the battlefield, and he rarely spoke. They didn't expect that as soon as he opened his mouth today, he would sound just like a devoted fanboy of Prince Latiao.

Mydeimos had several million fans. After they saw his messages, several who didn't know what had happened went to look up this person named Prince Latiao. Immediately, they were stunned by the video of their match.

Overnight, Prince Latiao gained an unknown number of fans. Everyone was on the forums guessing who he was. All of the disbelievers had disappeared without a trace, and the people replacing them were countless worshippers.

"Ahhh, why is he so hot, he's just like my idol God Time! I think I'm falling in love again!"

"Me too, me too. It's obviously just an old, outdated mecha, but why is it so hot? I've licked the videos online tens of times already! It's not nearly enough!"

"Who knows when God Latiao will come back to compete again. I want to see what it'd be like if he competes with the top fifty."

"We'll definitely see it. An expert like this entering the semifinals is certain!"

But Khaslana's fans were considerably unhappy. They felt that this new person was imitating Khaslana, and they sent all kinds of jeers on the forum, saying that the newbie was just trash that couldn't even get in the top fifty. If he met with God Time, he would be beaten down.

But most people were strongly anticipating the clash of the two people using old-style mechas.

During the same time period, there were countless people who wanted to investigate who was behind Prince Latiao, but they had no results no matter how they looked. In the end, they could only drop it.

In a dormitory in the empire's advanced military school, a teenager with off white hair walked out of the bathroom in a bathrobe. He was handsome with a few hints of devilish seduction, a constant, kind smile always on his face. He could make other people trust him unconsciously.

This white-haired teenager was the protagonist of this interstellar ABO mecha novel, Khaslana. Khaslana toweled off his hair and put on his helmet. As soon as he entered the virtual world, he saw several emails.

These emails were basically all about how a competitor like Khaslana who used an outdated mecha had appeared recently. They were asking him if there was any connection between the two of them.

Khaslana's lip curled in a disdainful smile. Immediately, without the slightest hesitation, he cleared all of the emails.

"It's just someone not worth mentioning. He wasn't worth my time from the start."

Khaslana had absolute confidence in his own strength. It was impossible for someone to have spiritual energy stronger than his.

His spiritual energy was SSS grade, and he had maneuvering technique honed from years of diligent practice. How could a random guy who even had such a disgusting name pop up and compete with him so easily?

After tens of matches, even someone with spiritual energy as strong as Phainon couldn't take it anymore. He watched himself climb up to the first couple hundred in exhaustion, then exhaustedly logged out of the virtual world.

When he took off the helmet, Phainon discovered that he was covered in sweat. Since omegas were too physically weak, when they stayed a little too long in the virtual world, it was a huge strain on their bodies.

So Phainon went to the bathroom to shower. He even discovered that there were new clothes in his size in the drawer that he could change into.

The sky outside had already turned dark, but there was actually a meal on the table. It even seemed like it was one of those top-quality meals. Phainon felt a bit emotional, but immediately remembered that even the food that the dogs in Caelus's house ate was better than the meals Phainon normally had... This was probably the worst food they had at his house.

"But what in the world is Caelus thinking?" Phainon sat at the table eating, still puzzled after thinking for a long time. "He beat me up so badly before, but now he's not hitting me, and he even locked me up somewhere with such good conditions... Is he afraid that after I leave I'll destroy his image, so he wants to bribe me...?"

When he remembered Caelus's arrogance, Phainon quickly wiped the unrealistic thoughts from his mind.

Still, Phainon wasn't sure about anything else, but he knew that if Caelus still didn't come, then his daily task [Greet the capture target] couldn't be completed.

Phainon began to think. If Caelus still didn't come by nighttime, he would have to brave the dangers and make some trouble to draw Caelus over... Getting beaten up wasn't nearly as scary as the system's punishment.

Luckily, Caelus didn't forget that there was someone locked inside. When Phainon finished eating, Caelus pushed open the door with a haughty expression and walked inside.

Phainon hurriedly said, "Young Master Caelus, hi." It was wonderful to have the task completed.

"I don't have the leisure to be greeting trash like you. Don't think that if you're a bit more enthusiastic I'll consider you important," Caelus said angrily. "And don't think you can stay here comfortably just because you changed rooms. I won't let you mooch off of me."

He wasn't even the one who wanted to come mooch!!

"T-then can I go home?" Phainon hadn't forgotten that he had a mother and father in this world. Still, he had sent a message home while he was in the virtual world, so they wouldn't worry even if he didn't go home for now.

Of course, their son getting expelled because he peeped in the male bathrooms was extremely embarrassing... Phainon felt that the host's parents really weren't simple.

"No." Caelus crossed his arms across his chest, smiling coldly. "You think you can go as you please after offending me like you did yesterday? Don't joke around."

Didn't you offend me right back yesterday?!

Phainon thought, but of course he couldn't say that out loud, otherwise Caelus would definitely beat him half to death. He could only say, "Then what do you want me to do, Young Master Caelus?"

"To make up for what you did to me, I want you to be my servant," Caelus said arrogantly. "Of course, there are other servants to do those specialized things. You just need to be in charge of waiting on me at school. You know, you're just a beta, and you managed to become my servant. If your parents knew, they would be proud of you."

Although Phainon really wanted to curse Caelus for being too proud, it really was fact. For a family in dire straits like his, a family had the name of a noble but didn't have any true power, they would be honored if even the son of a duke greeted them.

Phainon: "But I was already expelled..." This was so cruel.

"So what? You can keep going to school tomorrow. I already had people settle it with the dean," Caelus said. "Of course, if you don't serve me well, the institute will expel you just as before. So you'd better do it properly. Don't think that you can slack because you're a beta. My expectations are very high."

After sarcastically making things clear, Caelus turned to leave.

Phainon: "!!" Hey, that's so careless. You think you're amazing just because you have power and influence?!... He really was amazing. Phainon could finally go back to school!!

It was lucky Caelus didn't mention the thing from yesterday about apologizing to Khaslana. For the time being, Phainon didn't have the guts to go see Khaslana. He was afraid that as soon as such a disreputable and tormenting thing was publicized, Khaslana's name would be ruined.

Khaslana would seek revenge if someone just glanced at him the wrong way. To reach his goal, even his friends were calculated. It would be better to say that, in his eyes, nobody was his friend. They were just chess pieces that he could use. In the original novel, he had used Mydeimos thoroughly. In the end, his family had been thrown into bankruptcy, and he committed suicide in his guilt over causing his cousin's death.

Although there were plenty of gay alphas who liked Khaslana in the original novel, all of the people who succeeded in joining his harem were omegas. After all, the protagonist's interests were still normal... What kind of danmei novel was this?!

Anyway, even Mydeimos, the crown prince's younger cousin, the young master of a financial magnate, was so miserable. Phainon didn't think he, as a cannon fodder, could protect his life!!

The one thing he could rely on was charging out to suck up when the original protagonist became successful and famous. Then he could have his lunchbox and leave the world immediately. It was fine as long as he avoided seeing Khaslana.

The more he thought, the more Phainon felt that his method was absolutely perfect. He slept peacefully.

-

The next day, Phainon dragged himself out of bed early in the morning and changed into his school uniform. After yesterday's experience, he was full of interest for mechas. He wanted to hurry up and go to school to learn... If

he could, it would be best to train his body to be a bit more sturdy. This way, there might be a day where he could succeed in piloting a mecha in the real world.

Although he could surpass most people relying on his spiritual energy alone, if he was matched with someone extremely strong, he probably wouldn't be able to defeat them, particularly because the original host didn't study properly before, and Phainon didn't know a bunch of different things about mechas. How was he supposed to fight like this, huh!

He went downstairs to eat. It was just like yesterday. When Caelus was eating, there were several different people waiting on him. There was no need for Phainon to lift a finger.

Phainon wondered what Caelus was thinking when he made him a servant for no good reason, but it was fine as long as he could benefit.

After finishing breakfast, Phainon got onto the aircar with Caelus.

Phainon sat solemnly, thinking about how he could study well, when he heard Caelus suddenly speak. "By the way, you were on the virtual net yesterday, weren't you? Did you see the virtual mecha competition or not?"

Phainon didn't realize Caelus was actually talking to him for a long time. He immediately let out a noise of surprise, then when he saw Caelus's expression turn much darker, he immediately said, "Of course I did. Is something wrong?"

"Hmph. You really are a useless beta. You don't even know when someone is talking." Caelus continued with his ad hominem. Phainon felt that if Caelus wasn't the son of a duke, the surrounding betas would have jumped him and started beating him up.

"Then you should know about that Prince Latiao who made a huge splash at the competition yesterday." Caelus's gaze filled with disdain. He sneered, "What a horrible name. He even copied Senior Khaslana, using an old mecha. He's just a joke. He just beat a couple of weak chickens and he thinks he's so great."

Phainon didn't expect that he would hear his virtual world's nickname from Caelus. He began to cough violently.

"When someone else is talking, you listen properly." Caelus glared at Phainon with extreme unhappiness, then continued to vent his fury with Prince Latiao.

Although Caelus had the character design of an arrogant young master, he truly admired the strong, which was why he looked up to Khaslana and even became his fanboy.

When he saw a ton of people bringing up Prince Latiao and Khaslana in the same breath, Caelus was extremely unhappy, but he couldn't find anyone to talk to. When he thought about it, Phainon still had some use, but he was embarrassed to have a proper conversation with him. He hesitated for a long time before he finally spoke.

"Ahh, yeah." When Phainon heard Caelus's words, he nodded again and again. Once in a while, he would even say indignantly, "You're exactly right. This Prince Latiao is absolute garbage."

Hearing Phainon speak, Caelus felt that he was getting easier and easier on the eyes. He even nodded amiably at Phainon. "Not bad. Although you're trash, you've still got some taste."

Phainon: "..." Was raising the favorability score ever easy! He even needed to curse himself out this time. It was lucky that after Caelus heard the first bit, his favorability score seemed to skyrocket. When the favorability rises up, he wouldn't need to worry that his future would be so crappy!

"Hmph. I don't know why I can't find Prince Latiao's identity, either. Otherwise, I would grab him and take him for some torture," Caelus said, annoyed.

Phainon: "..." Actually, you already tortured him.

Soon, they arrived at the empire's military school. It was a pretty famous school. Many noble families studied here, and even some underage princes

were here.

As a special student, Caelus's aircar could drive straight into the school into the parking lot before stopping. He didn't have to weave through the huge garden before he could get to the school like the normal students.

Although they both made it into the school with their connections, there was a big difference between someone from a rundown family like Phainon and Caelus, the son of a duke. The places they learned were also different. Even the teachers and the study materials were as different as night and day.

Phainon got ready to leave, wanting to go to the other area he remembered from the host's memory to study, but Caelus stopped him. "Hold still. Where are you trying to go?"

"Huh? I-I'm going to the classroom," Phainon said.

"Are you an idiot?" Caelus snorted. "Since you're my servant, you have to stay by my side. You're trying to go somewhere else? Hurry up, come here."

"But won't there be a problem? I'm not a student here..." If he could go somewhere better, Phainon would naturally be happy, but would he really be able to avoid getting kicked out by the teacher?

Caelus shot him an arrogant glance. "There's nobody with the guts to touch my people. Just come here."

Phainon: "!" Ah, he suddenly thought that Caelus was super cool.

Thus, Phainon was forced along with Caelus to go to the higher ranking classrooms.

Who would expect that because he offended the male protagonist he falsely accused of being a pervert who peeped into the male showers, and then after the protagonist's fan brought him home for a whipping... things would actually turn out for the good. He succeeded in coming back to school, and even came straight to a higher ranking area. Was this called profiting from disaster?

Feeling complicated but excited, Phainon and Caelus walked into the classroom. All of the students in this class were alphas. There were probably betas before, but Caelus must have crowded them out.

At first, everyone was sitting at their desks, silently reading. When they saw Phainon had come in with Caelus, their expressions changed immediately.

Actually, based on Phainon's status as a cannon fodder, there was no way these people would remember him. But what had happened was too shocking. Nobody had expected that someone would actually peep in the men's bathroom. He was a pervert among perverts! When everyone in the school thought about how they might have been seen while they were in the bathroom, their entire bodies filled with goosebumps.

It nearly made the news. If it wasn't for the fact that the dean was afraid it would ruin their reputation and he suppressed the news, Phainon might be a well-known pervert throughout the entire empire.

It was easy to tell how terrifying of a person Khaslana was. Because of his framing, the original host had no way to continue living.

Phainon: "..." Although it's not my first time being seen as a gay, I don't know why but this seems especially humiliating.

The thing that was even more surprising was that Phainon actually came with Caelus. Was Caelus possessed?! This guy was a beta, and he was also a pervert who peeped on the men's bathroom!

Even if other people didn't know, they were very clear how much Caelus despised betas. He was even arrogant to his alpha classmates. How the heck did this guy manage to suck up to Caelus?!

Under everyone's peculiar stares, Phainon sat down stiffly.

But Caelus was completely at ease, not feeling like there was any problem at all. He called Phainon to open his books for him.

Class started soon. The teacher just glanced at Phainon for a moment before naturally beginning to lecture.

Phainon could understand most of what was going on. He could even relate the circumstances from when he was connected to the mecha. What he couldn't really figure out were the few more profound topics. Whenever they got to those topics, he would unconsciously begin to take notes.

When Caelus was in class, he was also completely focused. His attitude was completely different from his normal arrogance. After all, he was chasing stubbornly after this goal.

While he was listening earnestly to the lessons, time passed quickly. Soon, it was the end of class. Phainon felt a bit like he hadn't heard enough, but when he saw the notebook full of questions, he didn't have the guts to go and ask.

Because he was just a student who was stuck in as a transfer. How could he go and ask the teacher questions.

The original host just came to school to pass time. His test scores were just okay, and during mecha battle classes, it was painful to watch.

But it was also because of his family. After all, the original host was actually an omega, and his natural physique had its drawbacks. His parents felt some remorse for him, but they didn't ask that he became someone amazing.

"I'll go on the virtual net to look it up later." Phainon sighed, then realized Caelus was looking at the notebook in his hands.

"Hmph, you don't even know something so simple." Caelus jeered at him with disdain first, then leaned over. "Look, it's not like this... You have to do this part like this. You don't even know something like this? Did you even listen properly?"

Like such, Caelus explained all of the questions Phainon had. Although he had an extremely impatient attitude, and he would often add in a few barbs,

he explained in great detail. Even Phainon understood in moments.

When Phainon was done listening, he suddenly realized, wasn't Caelus just like the tsunderes in rumors?

Wait, he didn't want to keep thinking about something scary like this!

The next class was about the same. Caelus explained the things Phainon didn't understand. Finally, his expression turned much warmer. "It seems like you're not completely trash. You've got a bit of drive."

Phainon: "..." It seemed that Caelus liked people who loved studying.

Next, it was time to eat lunch. There were several restaurants in the school. There were restaurants with low prices that even the commoners could afford, restaurants with sky-high prices, and restaurants that only allowed noble students to eat there. Although Phainon was technically from a downtrodden noble family, he was broke. He just ate the food from the noble restaurant.

Of course, the restaurant Caelus picked was the most expensive kind. When Phainon thought about how he could eat all kinds of delicacies later, he was incredibly moved.

But what happened next extinguished Phainon's belly of fire.

Weren't the people over there Khaslana and Mydeimos? What the fuck!? Hey, all of the beautiful plans he thought of last night were destroyed!

Chapter End Notes

> Yay! New Chapter. The only slang in this chapter was lunchbox but i explained it already in the previous chapters end notes but if there's anything else that is unclear just let me know, I'll explain it in the endnotes! Thanks for reading.

Chapter 4: "Your actually....an Omega?"

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

It was Phainon's first time seeing their faces. He had to admit that they were extremely attractive, and they both had their own uniqueness.

Although Mydeimos had an illustrious background, he didn't like other people nagging him. When he dealt with things, he was very lowkey, even hiding his own status. Most of the people in the school didn't know about it.

And right now, Khaslana was also a new student who had talent and popularity. Nobody knew he was the renowned God Time in the online mecha competitions.

So both of them looked like normal students strolling around the school. There weren't any crazy fans following after them, either.

Thus they strolled straight into Phainon.

In the next moment, the system began to sound.

[Beep beep beep... Detected a more powerful character... Beginning to change capture targets in accordance with the system's regulations... Change complete. The current capture target is Mydeimos.]

Phainon: "???" Hey, wait, why was it Mydeimos?! He thought it would be Khaslana.

[It's because the capture target Mydeimos's strength is higher, of course.]

Phainon: "..." Well, that was true. Khaslana was technically still in the first stages of his development. It was normal if his power couldn't compare to Mydei's.

When Khaslana saw the two of them, he was different from Phainon, who had been scared out of his wits. Instead, he smiled slightly, greeting them, as though he was seeing a friend. He didn't treat Phainon with the slightest bit of strangeness.

Just seeing Khaslana's attitude, anyone could tell he was the one who had unjustly accused the original host of peeping on the men's bathroom!

The more Khaslana acted like this, the colder Phainon's heart got. He would rather Khaslana come over and whip him a few times to work out the problem. He didn't want Khaslana to keep plotting against him secretly. Still, there was nothing he could do if his character was just like this.

When Caelus saw his adored idol, he became excited and opened his mouth, but because of his nerves he couldn't say anything. After struggling for a long time, in the end he only gave a casual nod, not even saying anything. His attitude was obviously icy... If it wasn't for the fact that he was always praising Khaslana at home, even Phainon couldn't guess that he was Khaslana's fanboy.

No wonder the original novel's Khaslana thought Caelus was his enemy for a long time. He even thought of killing Caelus several times.

When Phainon thought of this, he felt that Caelus was absolutely miserable. He was actually fanboying after someone like this. Sincerity really was difficult.

Mydei was just indifferent. He gave a careless greeting to Caelus, completely ignoring Phainon.

To Mydei, giving a second glance to someone like this was an insult on his own eyes. He was still thinking constantly of the dozens of mails he had sent to Prince Latiao in his excitement yesterday, and whether Prince Latiao would disdain him for being annoying after seeing them. He couldn't help feeling regretful.

But Caelus looked at Mydei coldly. After all, he was just some guy who lost to Prince Latiao and let things progress so far. If he was a little more useful,

the circumstances would be different.

Phainon, staying self-aware, said nothing. He wouldn't make things hard for himself.

It was just some greetings, but things actually got so awkward.

Since both parties had things to do, they dispersed quickly. When Khaslana passed by Phainon, he threw out a sentence casually. "I didn't think you still knew some schemes. But you won't be so lucky next time. Just wait and see."

His voice was very quiet. Only Phainon could hear him. His heart tightened, and he whipped his head back, seeing a friendly smile appearing on Khaslana's devilishly handsome face.

Then Khaslana turned away, leaving together with Mydei.

To be honest, when Phainon saw Khaslana's smile, he was so shocked he nearly fell to his knees.

Could things still be okay when the original protagonist set his eyes on him! With his schemes, he could cause Phainon to lose his reputation easily... Although his reputation was already gone. Forget it, why think about him so much? Even if the entire empire thought he was a pervert who peeped on the men's bathroom, so what! He would still live on.

Phainon was simply giving up on a hopeless situation.

Caelus, who had already walked ahead by several steps, turned to glance at Phainon. "What're you looking at? Stop looking, hurry up."

Phainon hurried after him.

Caelus went straight to selecting a private room in the restaurant, then ordered a bunch of expensive food. When the food came, he looked straight at Phainon and said unhappily, "What are you still sitting there for? Hurry up and come to serve me. Don't you have the sense of a servant?"

...Phainon was wondering if Caelus didn't even eat when he was by himself and didn't have someone to serve him.

Well, the capture target had changed. Similarly, Phainon was a lot lazier. He hesitantly said, "Huh? But I'm just a beta. It's not very good if I come in contact with you, right?"

Caelus said haughtily, "Although you're just a beta, you're doing alright, you're much better than other betas. I'll permit you to serve my meal more closely."

Phainon really wanted to say, "So what if you die of starvation", but he had to lower his head under this roof, and he still went over to feed Caelus.

Phainon was very curious about Caelus's favorability score, so he asked the system, even though this laze-about system could only check if the score was negative, zero, or positive.

[The previous capture target's favorability score is zero.]

Phainon: "..." Hey, then why did Caelus even make him feed him.

[It's because the previous capture target's favorability score towards most betas is negative, so the host's 0 is more acceptable.]

Phainon: "..." He actually had no way to retort.

Now that he thought about it, Caelus probably felt very annoyed when he was eating by himself normally. so after he seized Phainon, he made him a butler along the way...

Growing alphas had especially large appetites. Caelus didn't finish eating until Phainon's arms were already numb, then he started to drink tea with the utmost elegance. Phainon had no idea how Caelus, someone who could be called thin could eat so much.

Phainon didn't start eating until he finished feeding Caelus. He quickly sank into the blissful taste of the food, flinging all the unhappy things into the back of his mind.

Was there anyone on the planet as easily satisfied as him.

After Caelus finished eating, his mood improved significantly. He watched Phainon and said, "There's a mecha battle lesson in two days. You'd better practice properly when you go back. I don't want to see you humiliating me."

Phainon immediately remembered how terrible the original host's mecha battle grades were. Immediately, his face turned pale. The reason he could be so amazing on the virtual net was all reliant on his spiritual energy. But in reality, where his body would collapse as long as he used spiritual energy, he could only operate manually.

And his manual mecha operation experience was only from the warm-up during the battle with Mydeimos yesterday. He even fell down several times.

That was even on the virtual net. Falling down didn't hurt much. But in reality, with an omega's frail body, it would probably break his bones, and he would have to lay in bed for several months...

The original host's mother and father had already talked it out with the teachers. Every time they had mecha battle lessons, he just wouldn't attend. But it was obvious that Caelus wasn't someone who could be reasoned with.

...It looked like he would have to go into the virtual net and practice his manual operations properly.

Most of Phainon's good mood dispersed in moments. He picked up the tea on the side, taking a sip.

"There's still that damn Prince Latiao," Caelus snorted. "I'm going to go teach him a lesson today. I'll let him know how high the heavens are."

Phainon nearly spat out the tea he just drank. He began coughing.

"What's wrong?" Caelus immediately frowned. "You don't think I can win?"

"No, no..." Phainon hurriedly said. "How could Prince Latiao win against you? I believe you will definitely succeed!"

"That's just about right," Caelus said. "You did pretty well today. Keep working hard in the future. I'll think about increasing your salary."

Phainon was shocked: "!" He actually had a salary! He even thought he was just working for nothing.

In fact, Caelus was a good person, huh... But when he thought of how he was given a beating as soon as he came, Phainon decided to forget it.

-

Physical education was in the afternoon. Phainon worked hard to toughen himself before he realized exactly how bad omegas' physical strength was.

He only ran for a bit, but he was already panting for breath, while the surrounding alphas were full of energy.

But Phainon felt he was doing pretty good for transmigrating into an omega pretending to be a beta.

Although he would occasionally feel jealous of alphas, he wouldn't go around cursing that life was unfair or anything like that... After all, most omegas were locked up at home, otherwise they went to all-omega schools, and once they came of age they waited to be married off.

If he had transmigrated into that kind of omega, Phainon would just choose death.

When school was over, he returned to the residence. Caelus went fiercely back to his own room.

Phainon went back to his room too, putting on the helmet and entering the virtual world. As soon as he went in, he was stunned by the amount of mail. Before this, the original host only had ten-some letters cursing him out for being a pervert...

These letters were all from people who sent them through the competition, and the competition's system forwarded it to him. There wasn't any problem with keeping his identity secret. Nobody would know Phainon's mailing address.

Yesterday, Phainon just fought a couple dozen rounds and left. He didn't think of going to take a look at other places like the forum. He didn't expect that he would actually become a small celebrity in the competition.

Phainon poked open a few letters to take a look. Shockingly enough, there were a significant number of love letters filled with all kinds of selfies. There were even some from male and female omegas. It really gave Phainon a shock.

And even Mydeimos sent him several dozen letters. When he picked them out, he discovered that they were written in the same tone as a fanboy's. Phainon really couldn't imagine the cold Mydeimos from earlier in the day actually writing something like this... If he knew Phainon was Prince Latiao, who knew how he would react.

And this Mydei guy was actually ecstatic after being beaten. In fact, he was a total masochist, wasn't he! ...But living like this, he wouldn't have any problems doing his daily task. Phainon thought about contacting Mydei to meet up online after this stuff was dealt with.

He could do his daily task in dreams in one of his previous worlds, so it should be possible online too.

Another portion of the letters were related to a collaboration. There were also several strong people who wanted to pull him over onto their side. When Phainon saw the huge number of empire coins, he got emotional, but in reality he was a potato. What use was an expert that could only live in the virtual net? He could only reluctantly ignore these letters.

As for the ones saying how much money he could get by doing a couple random commercials during the competition, Phainon was very interested. It was just doing a few ads, how wonderful it was to earn money so carelessly.

Thus, after Phainon got the system to thoroughly conceal his location, he went to ask the other party about the fees. Finally, he asked around several places and earned a good amount of honest money. In moments, he had tens of thousand of empire coins.

Although the original host's family were nobles, they lived about the same as commoners. A year of their expenses was only a few tens of thousand empires coins.

When Phainon finished settling those things, he arrived at the square with the most people. Shockingly, the most conspicuous advertisement had a declaration of war.

It invited Prince Latiao to go to a certain virtual mecha training site to exchange pointers. If Prince Latiao won, then he could get a million interstellar coins. If he lost, then he would have to withdraw from the virtual mecha competition, and never participate again.

There were a huge number of people competing in the virtual world every day, but there were only a few people who were so arrogant. It quickly drew many people's attention.

People could see the ad as soon as they walked into the district. It cost dozens of thousands of interstellar coins per day.

Phainon understood immediately. No wonder so many advertising companies were looking for him just now. It seemed it was because of this ad's positioning.

Phainon: "..." The damn person who put up this declaration of war was definitely Caelus. Should he go or not... Although Caelus wasn't participating in the competition this time, he was very strong. He had avoided death from Khaslana's schemes several times. After the plot in the original novel finished, he even became a general and Khaslana's capable assistant... So should he go or not?

Wasn't this nonsense? Of course he should go! Phainon had confidence in his spiritual energy. If Caelus was giving away money, why wouldn't he go

collect it? That was a million interstellar coins!

Phainon went to an individual-use competition terminal at the side without a sliver of hesitation. These one-on-one matches were also held through the virtual mecha competition's system.

After he entered, a screen to select his mecha appeared just like it did yesterday.

Generally speaking, a contestant would use the mecha he was most familiar with. They usually wouldn't change at will. They were also more personalized, where they would put a special symbol on the mecha. For example, it was easy to identify who it was just by looking at the mecha for the experts in the top fifty.

But Prince Latiao's appearance made Khaslana's outdated mecha look less unique, which was why Khaslana's fans fans were so unhappy.

Yesterday, Phainon only picked randomly because he was poor. Now, he had so much money from down payments that he had become rich in moments. Why would he pick the worn outdated mecha? He immediately picked the latest, most popular mecha. It only cost a few hundred empire coins.

In the real world, he couldn't pilot any of these amazing mechas, so of course he would give it a try online. He wasn't trying to play cool like the original protagonist or anything. And if he was going to shoot ads, then he had to pick a custom appearance and spend a few thousand more empire coins. Still, compared to his ad appearance fee, it was nothing.

Phainon went straight to initiate the new functions, copying the lines the ad companies gave him onto his mecha. The plain white mecha quickly became colorful. It looked absolutely stuck-up. It was obvious the owner's sense of beauty was trash.

Still, Phainon didn't care about these things. Compared to getting cursed out for his sense of beauty, empire coins were obviously more important.

Phainon opened the screen. As expected, he saw Caelus sending out a challenge. There was an attached agreement explaining clearly what would happen if he lost and what would happen if he won. It had been approved by the competition and was legally binding. As long as he signed, he couldn't back out.

It even had Caelus's signature at the bottom.

In the virtual world, Caelus was also hiding his true identity. Here, his name was Stay Away From Me. It really matched his personality...

Phainon signed the agreement at once, then clicked accept. His sight filled with color, and he was sent directly to the battlefield.

It was already filled with spectators. They were people who had just heard the news and quickly bought tickets to come in. These unofficial battle rooms all had to be paid out of pocket, but one percent of the ticket revenue would be split between the two participants.

So when Phainon saw all these people, it was like he was looking at empire coins. He felt very emotional.

Most people had come to see Prince Latiao. They also wanted to know who had challenged him, even wasting his money to buy the ad space in the square. When they saw Phainon's mecha, they were stupefied.

Didn't Prince Latiao use an outdated mecha? Why did he suddenly change now? And it was whatever if he changed, but why did this mecha look so tacky? And it was full of a mess of words... Wait, these were ads!

A perfectly good mecha had been tormented into such a ghastly state. Just how many ads did Prince Latiao take?!

This completely shattered the showiness of Prince Latiao in their hearts!! Although this name was showy to begin with, they really wanted to ask exactly how poor Prince Latiao was...

And Mydei, who had people paying attention to news about Prince Latiao at any moment, was the first person to have bought a ticket. He looked at the battlefield, both anxious and excited. He couldn't calm himself down ever since what happened yesterday. His mind was full of Prince Latiao.

Through the filter of his brain, Mydei thought that even such an ugly mecha had personality. He even thought of making his own mecha similar when he went back.

"Hmph." Caelus sneered when he saw the mecha. "As expected, you're just trash. You're doing something like this to get strong for a moment, and even wanted to be compared with Senior Khaslana. Today, I'm going to make you lose and never think about competing in mecha competitions again."

But Phainon didn't care too much. He just looked at the various buttons inside the mecha, remembering what he had learned in school that day, and excitedly realizing he had remembered them. Now, he pretty much knew the things he hadn't known yesterday.

Anyway, there was still a bit of time before the warm-up time ended. He would use this time to practice a bit.

Phainon began to attempt to operate the mecha manually. After his experience yesterday, his maneuvering was much better today. Although it couldn't compare to the feeling that he and the mecha were one when he was using spiritual energy, at least he could walk without falling over.

The surrounding spectators watched the mecha take extremely stiff steps, just a tiny bit better than a beginner, and their expressions turned shocked. They had only seen videos of Prince Latiao's heroic displays. They had no idea that at the beginning of the first match, Prince Latiao had gotten plenty of ridicule because of his terrible operations.

"Maybe he's not used to the new mecha?"

"Gosh, he should be using a mecha he's used to for a match as important as this. Why did he have to change?"

"Will he really lose because of this? Then I bought this ticket for nothing."

Only Mydei was excited. His gaze fixed on the field, remembering the first time he met Prince Latiao. Through his mental filter, even if Phainon fell over, Mydei would probably still think it was a skillful, beautiful fall...

Soon, the warm-up time ended. Caelus also got serious, despite how he hadn't considered his opponent a true threat before. Caelus had seen all of Prince Latiao's videos before, and even he had to admit that his opponent had some skills. But if he wanted to be compared with Khaslana, he still fell short.

Although he was very strong, Prince Latiao's techniques were very unpracticed, and he didn't seem to have any understanding of strategy. He often seemed like a mecha operating beginner.

"Based on the video from yesterday, this Prince Latiao is going to try and sneak attack me as quickly as possible. For many people, their cockpits will be skewered before they can react," Caelus thought. "As long as I block this first strike, then take the opportunity to attack, I can defeat him easily."

Caelus sat calmly in the same spot, connecting to the mecha with his spiritual energy, waiting for his opponent to move.

People on his level typically use spiritual energy to maneuver the mecha. Otherwise, their hand speed wasn't fast enough.

In this world, spiritual energy was decided at birth, but their physiques could be improved. Many things were set at the beginning. Even if Khaslana was the original protagonist who climbed up from the slums, his biggest cheat was his powerful spiritual energy.

In the moment the match began, Prince Latiao's clumsy bearing disappeared. His mecha began to move quickly, attacking immediately.

"Just as I expected. If I hadn't prepared, I might really have lost." Caelus caught the blow as he had planned, his mind at ease but moving quickly. He seized the opportunity to attack his opponent in return.

It was reasonable to think that at such a high speed, according to his plans, Prince Latiao couldn't possibly avoid him, but in that moment, his opponent disappeared in a flash, quicker than he had in the video.

"How could it be." Caelus's eyes widened, then he realized that yesterday Prince Latiao was using the most worn, outdated mecha, but today he had changed into a new mecha. It was normal for him to be faster.

So Caelus missed his best opportunity. Prince Latiao had already flashed away to a safe place.

"Shit, I actually made this kind a mistake. Forget it, I'll use Plan B." Caelus's expression turned ugly. He pulled out a laser scalpel, rushing towards his opponent.

After watching the videos, Caelus deduced that his opponent wasn't very good in combat. Since his first plan failed, then he would go with the normal method. In any case, he was confident in his strength.

Caelus's guess was correct. Phainon really wasn't good in combat. He hadn't learned many skills to begin with. Yesterday, he had relied on his speed and the element of surprise to win. Now that he was faced with Caelus, who had investigated him thoroughly, it quickly exposed his shortcomings.

But with his powerful spiritual energy controlling the entire arena, Phainon could practically see anything Caelus was trying to do. He could avoid any blow. He could even avoid sneak attacks like he had eyes on the back of his head. If he wanted to lose, it was hard, but it wouldn't be easy if he wanted to win, either.

As they exchanged blows, Phainon's spiritual energy recorded all of Caelus's movements in his memory. In the next exchange, it unconsciously exerted itself.
Phainon didn't even realize it himself, but when he unconsciously used such a movement to attack, Caelus was stunned.

"He actually learned my moves. He learned so quickly. It's even a move that not many people in the school learned," Caelus thought back to the strange

movements from the warm-up, and a terrifying thought surfaced in his mind.

"Could it be that this guy is a mecha piloting beginner? So when he wasn't connected to the system, he was like that... In this case, then how terrifying is his spiritual energy?

"If this is the case, then he wasn't purposefully imitating Senior Khaslana yesterday. It was because it was his first time, and he didn't know what mecha to use, so he used the outdated mecha. But he won so easily..."

After thinking of this, Caelus couldn't stay calm. He looked towards Prince Latiao's mecha, his original disdain gone. Instead, it was filled with strong curiosity.

He wanted to know exactly how strong this person's spiritual energy was.

Before that, the person with the strongest spiritual energy that he had seen was Khaslana. He could tell at a glance that even though Khaslana was much stronger because of his experience and all kinds of reasons, if it was just based on spiritual energy, this person would, without a doubt, be the strongest person in the future.

Besides, Khaslana still had terrifying skill, and he had an aura of infinite possibilities. It was exactly because of this that Caelus became Khaslana's fanboy without the slightest hesitation.

But now, it seemed that he had found someone even more amazing.

In fact, from a certain viewpoint, Caelus and Mydei very alike. Both of them sought the strong, and their attitudes were close to being twisted. It was related to the original protagonist's setting, to make it easy for him to collect followers, but now it had made it easy for Phainon.

Caelus's eyes flashed with fanaticism. Without the slightest hesitation, he approached his opponent, even using the most dangerous method, reaching out with his spiritual energy to probe the other mecha.

It was an extremely dangerous method. Only people who were very confident in their spiritual energy would do it. When they had the upper hand, they could make their opponent fall into a trance so they had no way to operate their mecha, seizing victory for themselves.

If their opponent's spiritual energy was stronger, as long as they were careless, the initiator could even fall into a coma. It was also likely for them to lose themselves in their opponent's spiritual world due to the disparity in energy. It was a gamble.

It wasn't that Caelus didn't know the risks. But in that moment, all he wanted was to know was exactly how strong this person's spiritual energy was, so much that his own safety was secondary.

The people in the stands thought they were about to see an intense battle. Nobody expected that Stay Away From Me would actually fling himself over to embrace Prince Latiao's mecha. What the heck Weren't they fighting perfectly well before?!

When Mydei saw what was happening, he nearly crushed the arm of the chair he was sitting on. His expression turned ugly. "What the heck is this guy doing? Is he trying to use tricks because he can't beat Prince Latiao?"

The noise of the outside was distant. As his spiritual energy touched his opponent's spiritual energy, Caelus sank into the middle.

In moments, this powerful spiritual energy dispersed most of his willpower. It was as though he was soaking in an ocean spiritual energy. There was a faint fragrance in the air.

No, this fragrance... Caelus jolted suddenly from his stupor, waking up from his daze.

Although Caelus felt like a long time had passed, it had only been a moment in the outside world.

Phainon felt awful. Someone invading his spiritual energy was just like someone peeling off his clothes. Since Caelus had sent himself to his door,

then Phainon would move directly.

Just as Phainon picked up his weapon and aimed at his opponent's cockpit, Caelus opened his eyes. His pale cheeks were flushed a faint red, and he looked towards the opposing mecha in shock. In the moment before he lost, his voice tore from his throat.

"You're actually... an omega?"

Chapter End Notes

Oop- The drama.

The author has something to say:
I feel like an interstellar universe is filled with even more dog blood with an ABO setting.

Chapter 5: That's My Destined Companion

Chapter Notes

> I edited this chapter while i was writing but i didnt reread it today so let me know if anything is amiss. Thx <3

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Of course, Phainon couldn't hear what Caelus was saying. After his victory, he simply exited.

After he left the competition venue, Phainon received a notification of a million empire coin deposit into his account. He still felt like it was a little unreal, but he didn't think... in just a moment, he had become a millionaire.

Suddenly, he really wanted to have a few more dumb rich people like Caelus come challenge him.

When the competition ended, the video also went up on several forums and social media sites. It quickly caused everyone to gasp in shock.

Although everyone had wondered about Prince Latiao's sense of artistry when they watched the first video, now that they were watching the second video they automatically overlooked it.

In the empire, as long as you were strong, nothing else was important. Even if Phainon's mecha was filled with advertisements and looked ridiculously flashy, in that moment there were several people copying him and spray-painting a mess of things on their own mechas.

But Phainon just received even more letters about advertisements. Now that he wasn't poor, he set them aside, beginning to think about his daily task.

Thus Mydei, who had become incredibly excited after watching the match, received Prince Latiao's letter of reply.

There were all kinds of facilities in the virtual world. Whether someone wanted to enjoy delicious foods or go on a leisure tour, they could do anything. Moreover, these experiences were almost the same as reality, but the prices were significantly lower, and it was also safer.

For example, in the past, to see the beautiful sunrise on the legendary and extremely dangerous Planet A, they would have to brave fatal dangers in order to see it. Now, they could experience it in the simulation facilities, and the price was only a few hundred empire coins.

Because there was heavy human traffic, there were also many people who did their everyday work in the virtual world. The virtual world and the real world didn't have that much of a difference. It could almost be called a second world.

But simulation facilities were still pretty expensive. For example, if the richest magnate in the empire constructed a high-end restaurant in the virtual world, though the food was simulated, it had a considerably high price. If a commoner went in to eat once, they could keep showing off for a long time after.

And at that moment Mydei was sitting at a table in the highest balcony garden, restlessly staring out at the scenery outside the glass.

Today, he was wearing an expensive custom suit. In the real world, it would cost at least a million empire coins to buy. He had went specially to get his blonde and auburn hair styled and make him look more lively. He was even more handsome than he was normally.

Like this, Mydei could make people shriek just by sitting there. Of course, there wasn't anyone else there at the moment. He had booked the entire balcony. In any case, it was his family's business.

There was a simulated aurora from Planet Mofei, said to be the most beautiful and most romantic view in the universe, outside the window. Numerous light pink flowers were in full bloom in the garden, their faint fragrance dispersing into the air.

To couples, this was the holy land for a date and the best place to propose, but when Mydei was making his choice, he didn't think of it. He just thought that only such a nice place would match his male god.

"I wonder if he'll be dissatisfied with this place?" Mydei was very anxious. After he got Prince Latiao's letter, he hesitated for a long time before he finally settled on meeting at this restaurant. Still, he worried that Prince Latiao would dislike it.

The door opened. Someone with a mosaic over their face walked in, waving over at him.

That's right. This person with a mosaic over their face was Phainon. He had to give a big thank you to the virtual world's privacy protection. As long as he didn't want others to see his real appearance, he could adjust his privacy settings... After that, people wouldn't be able to make out your face no matter what happened.

Otherwise, Phainon wouldn't come out to meet Mydei so casually. If his identity was exposed, it would be a bother.

At the moment, only Prince Latiao, who had received his invitation, could come in. Mydei immediately stood up in excitement.

Even though Phainon's face was covered with a mosaic, and he was wearing a very casual outfit, Mydei didn't have any complaints. He even felt that his male god managed to be good-looking even with a mosaic over his face. He awkwardly cleared his throat as he got up “Ah..Greetings, I..” Mydei tried to contain regulate his emotions in accordance with his regal bearing.

Because he was too excited, Mydei nearly stumbled. You could tell he was out of his element. Luckily, Phainon was close, and he hurried to catch him. "Are you okay?"

Of course, Phainon's voice was also being processed by the privacy protections. It sounded very distorted, but in Mydei's ears it was just like a sound of nature. His typically icy face immediately turned red. "I-I'm fine. I-it's truly an honor to have you here."

Phainon: "..." Hey, was this the same Mydei he met yesterday? How come his aura was totally different!

They sat down at the table. Mydei despite being very nevous managed to hide it well, the only tell being the slight bobbing of his leg under the table. "What would you like to eat? You can order anything you'd like. Please, don't be polite."

Phainon knew this restaurant was owned by Mydei's family, so wasn't polite and ordered several dishes. Mydei also ordered a few dishes.

Because it was just simulated food, they could only experience the food's taste, but they wouldn't feel full. As a result, many people who wanted to keep their figures but also wanted to taste fine food were interested.

After the simulated foods were selected, they automatically appeared on the table, and the two of them began to eat. In fact, only Phainon was eating. Mydei was just staring at him with adoration. Fine food or whatever else was nothing to him.

Mydei summoned his courage to speak. “I- I have come to respect your prowess immensely… In the moment that you defeated me, I was already deeply interested by your bearing. Since you possess a strength that I have been looking for please allow me to follow at your side. If I ever have the luck to meet you in reality…”

At his words, Phainon's entire body erupted with goosebumps. "!" Hey! There's too many things you can pick apart in these words! And why is it so boastful? People out of the loop might even think he was reading prose or something.

In fact, these words were something that Mydei had paid a good sum of money to have someone write for him before he met Phainon. He had spent a long time memorizing them before Phainon arrived.

Phainon sighed. "Sorry. Right now, I can't reveal my identity, so I can't meet you."

"I see... I've been rude." Mydei was a bit disappointed, then he hurriedly added, "It doesn't matter. It'll be good as long as you can think of me when you have time. If you don't dislike it, I would like to compete once more and have you instruct me on how to pilot a mecha. No, there's no need to instruct me, it's fine as long as you defeat me ruthlessly... I will, of course, pay for the expenses. The price doesn't matter."

If someone could get paid to fight, who wouldn't agree! But Mydeimos really was a super masochist, huh!

Phainon said, "... Of course we can do that."

Since he was just getting some money in exchange for beating up Mydeimos, it wasn't good for Phainon to take too much money so he went by the price of the mecha trainers online, about five hundred thousand empire coins per session. When Mydei heard the number, he felt it was a little low, and doubled it.

Phainon: "..." Sure enough, he was being too polite, wasn't he? He was actually thinking of helping the son of the richest person in the empire save some money...

After they finished eating, Mydei took Phainon directly to his residence in the virtual world. Inside, there was even a designated mecha training field. The average person wouldn't specially purchase a residence in the virtual world. Only Mydei was so leisurely.

The facilities were incredibly luxurious. It could even compare with the mecha competition's facilities... Even though it was just simulated, he had to spend a lot of money to get things to such a level.

"If we battle each other, isn't it even better to do it outside?" Phainon said. Furthermore, competing outside would have an extra entrance fee. He might even earn a profit after giving a beating.

"But you came especially for me. I don't want other people to see." Mydei's voice was low, a dissatisfied tone in it. "Only I need to see this. I'll fully enjoy my time alone with you."

Phainon: "...As long as you're happy."

Although he could pick anything he wanted for free, Phainon naturally picked the best, most gorgeous mecha, while Mydei only selected the one he used the most often, the newest model.

Mydei had already anticipated today's match for a long time. He had dreamed of that day's events so many times. In the daytime, other than when he was practicing, he was always absentminded. Several times, Khaslana even asked what was going on with him.

But Mydei was embarrassed to tell this to his friend, so he just found a random excuse to cover it up.

Today, just sitting in the cockpit, Mydei's heart was already beating in anticipation. He looked at the opposite mecha, his energy in a stage of high excitement, looking very fierce... If Phainon saw what he looked like, he would be given a shock and think that Mydei was about to kill him or something.

On the other side, Phainon quickly realized the benefit of these high-level mechas. When he was using the old mecha or regular mechas, there was a pause before he could completely connect with his spiritual energy. For these high-level mechas, he only needed the blink of an eye before he was connected.

When he was using other mechas before, he couldn't tell. Now that he was using a high-level mecha, he discovered exactly how awkward it was to pilot the lower-grade mechas from before.

Phainon suddenly realized something bad. "..." Crap, now that he had used such a high-level mecha, how was he supposed to go back to those lousy mechas?

But he was a millionaire now. Even in the real world, he would be able to buy a mecha. In the insignificant virtual net, those several hundred thousand empire coins were nothing.

After warming up with the mecha controls for a bit, Phainon nodded. The two of them began to fight.

In these few days, because Mydei had trained properly when he wasn't daydreaming, his skills were a decent amount better than they were before. And because he had watched Prince Latiao's videos an uncountable number of times, he had ways to counter most of Phainon's moves.

But he didn't want to beat Phainon. He just wanted to elevate himself to a position where he could overtake his opponent naturally. Besides, he thought that as long as he was stronger, the excitement he would feel after being defeated would also feel stronger.

Although he had lost several times before, only the utterly crushing feeling when he lost to Prince Latiao had made him so excited. When he lost to other people, he would only feel uncomfortable.

Mydei's combat ability had been strong to begin with. The reason he had lost to Phainon so quickly was because he hadn't been prepared.

But Phainon was no longer the same old Phainon who didn't even know how to maneuver a mecha. After his fight with Caelus, he had learned several cunning moves.

In a rapid exchange of a dozen blows, Phainon found an opportunity to press Mydeimos into a corner. He ruthlessly pushed down on the ground. The match should have ended in that moment. Yet simultaneously, Phainon suddenly remembered what Caelus had done.

The current Phainon was full of curiosity towards spiritual energy. Now that he knew this method, how could he not want to try it out?

"Only people with strong spiritual energy can do it. If I'm doing it, it shouldn't be a problem," Phainon thought, sending his spiritual energy probing outwards and enveloping Mydei's mecha directly.

The sensation of spiritual energy touching spiritual energy was very unique. It was just like the deepest part of two people's consciousness crashing into

each other until they were one and the same.

Apparently, if he could adjust properly, sometimes the intersection of spiritual energy could actually produce a pleasure even stronger than horizontal tango.

Because the people in the virtual world had all sent their consciousness inside, their reactions regarding spiritual energy were exponentially stronger than in the real life.

In the moment Phainon's spiritual energy touched Mydei's, a sharp spike of excitement passed through to him. In moments, it infected Phainon. He felt his body heat up in moments. He wanted to do something to drain away this feeling.

If Phainon's spiritual energy and Mydei's spiritual energy were about the same level, he might momentarily have no way to control himself. Luckily, Phainon's spiritual energy was much stronger than Mydei's. He quickly suppressed the emotion.

"Haaa..." Phainon let out a breath, wiping the sweat on his forehead. Sure enough, he couldn't try these things so randomly.

And at that moment, Mydei had completely given up on fighting back. After a long time, his voice finally sounded. "...I lost."

Phainon couldn't tell if he was mistaking it, but he felt that Mydei's voice was a little strange.

After Phainon got down from the mecha, a few moments passed. Just as Phainon was thinking whether he should go up and take a look, Mydei finally climbed out. His clothes were soaked in sweat, his amber eyes shining. He was panting lowly. His cheeks and even his ears and neck were all red.

Phainon: "...!" Fuck, you're really a super masochist! Didn't you just lose a match? Is that enough to become like this!!

Mydei looked at Phainon, his face completely flushed, then walked over. Phainon was nearly shocked into retreating a step.

It was too scary. Although he knew there were an especially large number of gays in this world, someone like Mydeimos was even scarier than a normal gay, okay.

Shockingly enough, when Mydei walked in front of Phainon, he kneeled down, taking Phainon's hand devoutly. With a warrior’s respect, he said, "Although you aren't willing to let me follow at your side, if there's anything you need to deal with in the future, you must think of me first. I’ll help with most anything."

Phainon was already shocked silly. "Oh, yeah, okay. Don't be like this... Quick, get up..."

How was he supposed to look straight at Mydei in reality! Well, in any case he probably wasn't going to see Mydeimos often... This shouldn't be too much of a problem.

Today's random task was to praise the capture target once. Although Phainon felt that this was a very inopportune moment, if he didn't say it soon he'd be late. He accepted Mydei's hands. "Yeah, you're really good too. Today, being with you, I was also really happy..."

Although he was scared by Mydei's super masochism, in the future he could complete his task and even get some empire coins. How wonderful! So what about those little things.

Mydei had barely calmed down. Hearing Phainon, his felt immensely satisfied and a handsome smirk made it’s way onto his face. "I will hold you to that, ….Deliverer.”

Phainon had no idea how Mydei could stay so excited with the entire face before him mosaiced.

Phainon hoped Mydei could keep his calm when he found out exactly who Prince Latiao was.

-

Soon, it was the next day.

Phainon was a little tired after all the fighting from yesterday. In the morning, he almost couldn't get himself out of bed. He went downstairs still bleary, but when he saw Caelus he was scared into full consciousness.

Today, Caelus, who had been full of pride, was unexpectedly absentminded. He ate the breakfast that the servants brought over sluggishly, occasionally thinking of something and flushing pink.

Normally, if the servants did something a little bit wrong, Caelus would lecture them. Today, however, he was completely unlike himself. When someone made a mistake, he acted just like he hadn't seen it. Occasionally, he would look stunned, then smile a little.

What the heck was going on? Was this the same arrogant, headstrong Caelus who always looked angry no matter the time of day? Why did he look just like a young maiden in love?

Phainon's own imagination gave him a huge shock. Who was so unlucky to have Caelus fall in love with them?

When they got on the aircar, Caelus captured Phainon in conversation again. After all, with Caelus's lousy temper, he didn't have any friends. He could only chat with Phainon.

"Listen to me properly. In the past, I always thought of omegas as annoying living beings." As soon as he opened his mouth, Caelus began to discriminate. "They're fragile and delicate and start crying if you just say some stuff. They make me annoyed just looking at them. I was prepared to never get married in my lifetime."

Phainon: "..." Dang, this Caelus didn't just look down on betas, he even looked down on omegas. Still, this was normal! After all, in the original novel he was a gay who liked alphas. With him like this, he could probably only like gays...

"But yesterday, my thinking changed." Caelus said, "I met an omega, and I finally understood. He's my destined companion..."

Phainon: "...Ah, this is great news."

Still, thinking about it, who did Caelus meet yesterday? Wasn't he always in school? There were only alphas and omegas. Or could it be in the virtual net? Did he meet someone after he lost?

Just as Phainon was racking his brains, Caelus said, "If I say it, you'll probably laugh at me. You can't laugh. The person I'm talking about is that Prince Latiao."

Phainon choked. "...!?"

What the heck?!

Phainon wanted to grab Caelus by the collar and make things clear. How the fuck did he know Phainon was an omega! This was just unscientific! Or did something happen to his inhibitors?!

"But," Phainon said, organizing his thoughts with difficulty, "That Prince Latiao is an alpha, isn't he? How can an omega have such strength? Besides, it's not likely for omegas or whatever to join virtual mecha competitions, right? Haha hahaha..."

Because of the restraints of their constitutions, omegas typically wouldn't study mechas. Even if they had high-grade spiritual energy, they wouldn't consider it.

"No, he's definitely an omega," Caelus said confidently. "When I was in his spiritual energy, I sensed the scent of an omega's pheromones. I didn't expect that there were actually omegas who could make it so far. It seems that I've been too narrow-minded. It's not just alphas who are strong."

You know it yourself, too?!

Although Caelus began self-introspection from this, Phainon couldn't get happy at all.

That poor soul that Caelus had fucking fallen for was actually himself.

Why were these inhibitors so garbage?! He had been seen through in seconds, but maybe this was a problem with spiritual energy... Damn it, Phainon felt that he should be more careful about using his spiritual energy.

Now, the only thing that was worth celebrating was that he had chosen to be anonymous when he first entered the competition. Phainon was even more afraid to expose his identity. If it was exposed, Caelus and Mydeimos might rip him thoroughly into shreds.

"Thank goodness I didn't show my real appearance during the fight yesterday. I just need change to a new name and he probably won't know who I am." Caelus looked as though he was letting out a breath of relief.

Phainon: "..." In fact, the other party knows everything.

"By the way, how do you think I should pursue him." Caelus looked towards Phainon, his attitude much better than before and completely sincere. "After all, I don't have any experience with courting someone. It'll be no good if I do it badly and scare him off."

Phainon': "...About that." You think I've got experience with courting someone?!

If Caelus was interested in someone else, Phainon would say some random things, but the someone was him. He couldn't go through the motions casually. If he did one thing wrong, it would get annoying. Not responding was even worse. Who would Caelus go ask next?

Phainon just blabbered, "Most omegas should like gentle and soft alphas, especially these kinds of awesome omegas. They definitely hate forceful alphas, so you just have to show him your gentle side and be more soft. Don't do anything too fierce. If you do things like this, he'll probably think more highly of you."

Exactly, don't do anything too fierce! As long as you do this, nothing will happen!!

"Yeah, you're right." Caelus nodded pensively, then returning to his normal appearance. He looked towards Phainon loftily. "If I succeed in courting him, you'll be my best advisor. I won't treat you unfairly."

Phainon faked happiness, but inside his emotions didn't fluctuate in the slightest. Anyway, he knew that Caelus would never succeed in this life.

After he got off the aircar, the two of them unexpectedly met Mydeimos, who was alone. Caelus didn't want to greet him at all. Phainon remembered what happened yesterday and was afraid of being recognized, so he didn't want to speak.

Mydei glanced at them coldly, sweeping over Phainon like he was looking at trash, and left even more icily.

Phainon: "..." Looks like he had thought too much. With Mydei's attitude, it would be weirder if he could recognize Phainon was Prince Latiao.

Caelus sneered. "...Being so arrogant all the time as if he's so amazing, but he couldn't even defeat my companion."

When Phainon heard Caelus's term of address, he was shocked enough that he started hacking.

"By the way, did you catch a cold recently? You're coughing a lot." Caelus turned to look over.

"No, no," Phainon said quickly. "My throat just hurt a bit from the air conditioning just now."

Caelus said calmly, "If you're sick, just go straight to the doctor. You can find me for reimbursements for the cost."

The news about Prince Latiao drew even more attention from the powerful. After all, he wasn't just strong. At a glance, it was obvious that he needed money... It was obvious that he was easy to win over.

If it wasn't for the fact that Phainon was more lazy, he might really agree, but now he was ruthless.

At that moment, in the most expensive sky-suspended restaurant in the capital planet, it was rumored that His Highness the Crown Prince Nanook was sitting inside, looking at the scenery outside. From there, he could see most of the capital, and the scenery was beautiful.

As the final boss in the original novel, Nanook was extremely cunning. He had silver hair like the moon and eyes that resembled molten gold. He was incredibly beautiful. After all, compared to His Majesty the Emperor, who looked steadfast, he resembled the empress, once the most beautiful face in the empire, more.

This empress was most well-known for her beauty. Most people had even forgotten that she had married into the imperial family thanks to her illustrious family background.

Along with her beauty, the empress had a very extreme personality. She was terrifyingly possessive of her companions, and had thusly killed an innumerable number of maids who had tried to seduce the emperor. She couldn't even stand a few concubines.

Just as he had inherited the empress's beauty, Nanook had also inherited her bigotry. He was scarily possessive of the things he liked. In his youth, he wouldn't let anyone else even touch his toys.

The most dramatic part of the novel was that the person His Majesty the Emperor really loved was Khaslana's mother. She was an innocent sweetheart who was born into low status, but because of the empress's possessiveness, he didn't have the nerve to bring her back. This was why Khaslana was born in the slums...

And later, when the empress found out about what had happened, she poisoned drinks right in front of the emperor, wanting to drag him down with her. In the end the emperor was saved. If it wasn't for the fact that he needed the help of the empress's family, he would have gone directly for the empress's corpse to vent his anger.

It was exactly for this reason that the emperor didn't like Nanook, who looked just like the empress. He felt guilt towards the son of his lover,

Khaslana, and did his utmost to pave the way for him to move forward. He didn't spare the slightest thought for the eldest son from his political marriage. It was why Nanook had withered so thoroughly.

But at that moment, Nanook was still His Highness the Crown Prince with boundless paths in his future, and Khaslana's past as an illegitimate child was still a secret.

"By the way, I saw someone interesting on the virtual net yesterday," Nanook said with a slight smile.

"Oh? What kind of person managed to draw Your Highness's attention?" The young man at Nanook's side was extremely handsome. If Phainon was there, he would notice that he looked around seventy percent similar to Caelus, but he looked much more mature.

He was Caelus's elder brother, the heir to the dukedom, Anaxagoras.

In the original novel, Anaxa had always stood on Nanook's side. Later, because he couldn't steel his heart and kill his younger brother, he let Caelus go. Consequently, he had indirectly caused Khaslana's victory. Finally, thanks to Caelus's reputation, he was able to survive, but the rest of his life was spent in suffering.

As Anaxa spoke, he silently said a prayer for that person. He couldn't say whether that person was fortunate or unfortunate to have drawn His Highness's attention.

"Look at this." Nanook brought his smart computer in front of Anaxa, his voice calm. "The most interesting thing is that I actually can't find out his identity. In the recording I got, his face is still blurry. How did he do it?"

For competitions like this, although they said it was anonymous, in fact those with influence could easily discover who it was. For example, plenty of people had discovered who Khaslana was.

But to have someone that even the crown prince Nanook couldn't find was a shock.

Anaxa looked at the screen. It was a contestant fighting with an old-fashioned mecha, but he still beat Mydeimos easily.

After all, Mydeimos was the crown prince's younger cousin. Anaxa had some understanding of his strength. He immediately gained some interest towards the person on the screen. "There's actually someone who can be as good as that time. He even defeated Mydeimos. I'll have people go investigate..."

When it first happened, Anaxa had also been excited by the commotion and had interest in drawing that person in, but the other party tactfully rejected him. Anaxa only felt it was a pity, and didn't think too much about it. He hadn't thought that he was actually someone who could overturn the empire.

"By the way, I heard your younger brother brought an impoverished young noble home to torture recently?" Nanook looked over with a raised eyebrow, his golden eyes cold.

Anaxagoras's heart tensed, but his expression was calm as if nothing had happened. He sighed helplessly. "Caelus was spoiled by our entire family ever since he was young, and now it turns out that he's grown unafraid of anything. I already told him many times. He should have let that person go already. Although those impoverished nobles aren't anything much, it wouldn't be very good if someone insisted on investigating."

"Yes," Nanook said calmly. "After all, things are more bothersome these day. It's best not to let anyone else get any information that could be used against you."

"Right." Anaxa relaxed. As His Highness the Crown Prince's right-hand man, he understood what Nanook's true personality was like very well.

The perfect, gentle person everyone else saw was an act. His Highness the Crown Prince's real personality was extreme and distrustful.

When he thought about how the empress was so extreme that she had tried to bring the emperor to death with her, Anaxa thought that the person His Highness the Crown Prince would like in the future was a bit miserable.

After they finished discussing the topic, Nanook looked at the mecha on his screen again, his eyes filled with interest. He said, his voice low, "It really is interesting... After so many years, it's the first time that someone has drawn my interest. Who in the world are you?"

-

At that moment, Phainon had no idea he had drawn the attention of the main villain in the original novel. He was looking at the old-fashioned practice mecha in front of his eyes with trepidation.

The scary mecha combat class wasn't until tomorrow, so Phainon came to school without any worries. He didn't expect that there would be a mecha training class today.

Although Phainon enjoyed the feeling of operating mechas in the virtual world, it was his first time touching a mecha in the real world. He was very worried about what might happen.

At his side, Caelus said calmly, "You'd better practice properly today. If you lose tomorrow, it won't be as simple as getting humiliated. You might even be putting your life on your line. Everyone has to participate in the combat class tomorrow, don't put blame on me for not reminding you."

Caelus walked towards his mecha. During the mecha training lesson, most people were practicing their movements. Some people had arranged to learn from each other.

Out of the entire training field, only Phainon was still standing in place and idling his time away.

The sound of jeers began to erupt around him.

"Isn't this that pervert beta who peeped in the men's bathrooms? I heard he got expelled ages ago. Why is he still staying here so brazenly?"

"Didn't he manage to come back to study by clinging onto Caelus? Or which school would want this student, huh?"

"Look at him. Even if he came back thanks to sucking up, he doesn't even know how to turn on the mecha. What a joke."

How were these chatting alphas so bored? If they had time to gossip, they could go and practice properly!

Though Phainon didn't care about what they said, it wasn't good of him to keep standing here either. He had to face the things he had to face, so be gritted his teeth and climbed onto the mecha.

Phainon had touched mechas who-knows-how-many times in the virtual net, but feeling them in the real world was a completely novel experience. There was even a wonderful feeling where his fingers were touching the buttons.

"It would be all good if I could connect to the mecha with my spiritual energy in the real world." Phainon sighed, thinking about his lousy body again. He could only throw this way of thinking to the back of his mind, beginning to maneuver the mecha.

Because he had practice from the virtual net, he didn't have any problems making the mecha walk. He could also do a few simple moves. Phainon let out a breath of relief. "Still, this is really far from a real fight. Tomorrow, I'll just surrender and end it quickly."

But on the other side of the training field, three people had gathered sneakily. "That's right, isn't it? That guy's the useless beta, right?"

"Exactly, I saw him." Another person nodded. "He's just a beta, but he's actually so arrogant. He even has the guts to come back to class. Let's teach him a lesson."

"Still, it'll be bad if the teachers catch us," someone said with worry.

"Don't worry. I checked, the teachers are busy right now. It'll be at least half an hour before they come back. There's enough time for us to teach that guy a lesson."

After they finished discussing, they got into their mechas and moved secretly towards Phainon.

Phainon was in the middle of practicing his movements. Suddenly, something banged next to him, and his mecha immediately unbalanced. After flailing for a long time, he managed to return to his center of gravity. He looked to his side with irritation.

But he found that there wasn't just one mecha next to him. There were three. They were surrounding him on all sides.

"Fuck." Phainon had a bad feeling. "They've come to pick a fight." After all, the original host's foul mouth had offended many people. Besides, Khaslana had so many friends. It was normal for them to come to pick a fight.

Against three mechas' attacks, Phainon's response was all over the place. His mecha operation technique was simply unpracticed, and he was forced to keep retreating. He couldn't even fight back.

When he had retreated until he couldn't keep retreating, the three of them shockingly began to attack his mecha's limbs. It was obvious they wanted to destroy the mecha to humiliate Phainon.

Phainon: "!!" Humiliation was just some bullying, but if they destroyed the training mecha he would have to pay for the damages, okay!!

Even Phainon's anger was building. He questioned the system gloomily, "Will my body collapse as soon as I use my spiritual energy? There's not any buffer time? Can I heal my body with my healing ability?"

[There is indeed a process to your body's collapse after you use your spiritual energy. Based on the current circumstances of the host's body, it can probably endure for three minutes. After three minutes, your body will quickly deteriorate, and even your healing ability won't be able to save you.]

"To face these people, three minutes is enough." Phainon's expression turned cold. He began to connect his spiritual energy to the mecha.

Khaslana was standing in a tall building at the side, observing the training field with calm amidst the chaos. When he saw Phainon being cornered, his voice was indifferent. "If you need to blame something, blame yourself for not practicing well normally. That's why people are bullying you now."

"What? Is there something interesting down there?" Mydei walked out, looking downwards with interest.

"Nothing. I was just taking a look. I'm going back first," Khaslana said as if nothing had happened. He turned back towards the classroom. Things were about done with. He had no interest in continuing to watch and see how a good-for-nothing was getting taught a lesson.

Mydei was about to go back, but suddenly something flashed in the corner of his eye.

"That's...."

Chapter End Notes

> The Author has something to say:
> Uh oh...Looks like Phainon's not very good at keeping secrets lmao.
>
> Also yay new chapter!! This is an extra long one so only one chapter this week. This is also my last reserve chapter so from here on out it will most likely be one chapter per week but who knows if im feeling it i might do two. Haha let me know your thoughts i love reading your comments, it makes my day! <3.

Chapter 6: A fight with the original protagonist

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

In a remote area of the training field, there were several mechas in battle. It was very normal for fights in the training field, but what was unusual was the mecha in the center being attacked.

It was obviously just a normal, outdated mecha, but it fought back against the other three mechas easily, as though it saw their every move. When blocking blows, it could simultaneously attack with skill. Moreover, each of its attacks landed directly on the other mecha's vitals.

After all, the outdated mechas in the training field were mechas that had fallen out of use for many years. Their weak points were obvious. With a few blows at the weak connections between the limbs, they would fall apart. Still, it was clear that these students couldn't do it.

Mydei stared fixedly at the scene, not even daring to blink, afraid of missing even the smallest detail of the fight. His hands began to tremble in excitement. "Yes, exactly, that's... That has to be... I wouldn't make a mistake!"

The person down there was Prince Latiao!

The fight ended quickly. It didn't even last three minutes in total. The other three mechas had been attacked until they had no ability to fight back. The mechas were even falling apart. The cockpit had protective installations, so the people inside should be okay.

And the mecha Mydei thought was being piloted by Prince Latiao unexpectedly rushed to a hidden corner.

"...Crap." Mydei jolted awake from his battle-induced daze. He gritted his teeth, spinning around and moving to rush down the stairs. He didn't even

hear when Khaslana called for him to come back.

Seeing Mydei hurry away, Khaslana's gaze darkened slightly.

Recently, Mydei's behavior was a bit strange. Khaslana hated being unable to control everything in the palm of his hands.

"It looks like I need to investigate a bit."

After his momentary explosion of power just now, Phainon quickly left the scene.

In fact, he had been a little panicky. In his agitation, he had actually broken the three mechas facing him. If he had to pay it back, even a million empire coins wasn't enough! Though it was those three provoking him to begin with, anyway.

...Even if the school rules said that if a mecha was damaged, the pilot would have to pay for the expenses, Phainon started worrying whether his sudden explosive strength would draw anyone's attention.

Luckily, the area was relatively hidden. According to the system, the security cameras didn't record that area, and the system also blurred Phainon's appearance when he was leaving.

Everything started quickly and ended quickly. Nobody had noticed anything. Even if the three people said what had happened, nobody would believe a beta was actually able to attain such a level.

When Phainon thought about it, he finally let out a breath of relief.

During the period of Phainon's explosive power, his body was slowly beginning to collapse. At first, when he used his healing ability to heal himself, he felt significantly better. Now, the effect had passed, and he felt weak and limp all over. He had no energy left in his limbs, and his head was spinning.

Phainon climbed out of the cockpit with difficulty, and met Mydeimos, who was walking over quickly, head-on.

Mydei glanced at Phainon coldly, then walked rapidly ahead.

"Huh? Isn't that where I just came from?" Phainon felt a little suspicious, but he really had no energy and he felt exhausted. He didn't feel like thinking about what Mydeimos was doing.

Mydei rushed to where the fight had been happening, but only saw the three fallen mechas. "As expected, he already left... I was too slow."

Disappointment settled into Mydei's heart, but he clung to a tiny sliver of hope, stepping forward to open the cockpit of the mecha on the ground, hoping to interrogate the person inside and ask if he knew who his opponent was.

But Mydei's hopes were dashed. The person inside the cockpit seemed to have been given a huge shock. He huddled in his mecha, trembling. It was obvious that being defeated in just three minute had been too much of a blow. Mydei couldn't get the slightest bit of information out from them.

"Useless guy." Mydei gave up on the interrogation, looking at the person inside the mecha coldly. "You don't have enough strength yourself, but you went to provoke someone else in vain. You were asking to sink this low..."

Mydei went off to investigate the security cameras.

But out of some kind of coincidence, there were no security cameras aimed at that area, and for some reason the image of the outside area was blurry. It was impossible to tell who it was.

He could only give up on it.

"Still, in this case, the scope of my search can be narrowed down." Mydei thought of something, his face beginning to faintly flush red.

"I didn't expect us to be so close. I can't believe I never realized there was someone so skilled at the institute. Could there be some reason that he has to stay lowkey?"

Phainon waited for class to end in the lounge, completely exhausted, then went home with Caelus. Caelus seemed to be thinking something, and didn't notice Phainon's weary appearance at all.

Well, Phainon didn't really want to hear his romance worries anyway. Instead, he was able to relax.

But before long he would regret it and ask himself why he didn't ask. In the end, it led to something terrifying.

When he returned to his room, although he was tired, Phainon still had to log on to the virtual world. After all, he didn't finish his daily task yet... Besides, it was almost the last day of the competition. If he didn't hurry to participate in some matches, he wouldn't have enough points to enter the finals.

As soon as he logged online, Phainon's inbox was stuffed full again.

Phainon skimmed them. They were all about the same as the emails from yesterday, with a dozen more from Caelus. He didn't even need to think to guess what was inside. Phainon didn't look at them at all, deleting them immediately (._.)

As for the ads, Phainon was famous now. He picked a few with higher prices, then wrote an email to Mydeimos, asking him to reply when he had landed. It would make it easy for Phainon to do his daily task.

And then Phainon strode out of the room, appearing at the virtual square. As soon as he arrived, he was stunned by the sight.

Every possible location for ad placement, whether it was big or small, had been bought. The same picture was in all of them, and the picture was a video from when Prince Latiao was fighting.

Rather than calling it a video, it was more accurate to call it a montage. It spliced pretty much every cool movement from Prince Latiao's fights. It looked extremely exciting. Even Phainon was feeling affected. He didn't think that he was actually so heroic.

The montage finished quickly, then a youth with black hair appeared on the screen, holding a bouquet of roses in one hand. It was Caelus.

The memory of what Caelus had said in the morning suddenly surfaced in Phainon's mind. A bolt of lightning jolted through his mind. Fuck, Caelus wasn't getting up to some crap again, was he?

To be honest, although Caelus's personality and brains were a little off, he was extremely handsome. When he appeared, the people in the virtual square began to shriek. Several of them began to ask other people if he was some new celebrity.

Phainon felt very complicated, but people were always face-cons. He was too. He didn't have any right to judge someone else.

The Caelus on the screen wasn't as vexing as he usually was. Instead, he looked out of the screen with a serious expression, beginning to introduce himself. He started from his family background, then to his height and his body measurements, the food he liked to eat, the color he liked... He also recited his grades from elementary school.

It was just like a dating app bio. No, a normal person's bio wouldn't have so much unnecessary information!

Still, as long as he had that face and the status of a duke's son, as long as he said he was looking for romance, the people interested would probably break down the duke's doors.

Phainon had a bad feeling. It was as though something bad was about to happen.

As expected, in the next moment, Caelus began to speak adoringly. "Prince Latiao, when I saw you, I knew that you were my destined partner. I really wish to understand you well... In fact, I'm not someone with a forceful personality. I just wanted your attention, which is why I did those things..."

Phainon: "..." Hey! Do you think you're not forceful as long as you say you're not forceful?! Like this you might as well never have a wife in your

fucking life, okay!

Everyone watching the advertisements was shocked. Although they didn't know Prince Latiao's gender, if he was so amazing, he had to be an alpha. The son of the duke had actually come out of the closet in front of a whole crowd! This was breaking news!!

But the omegas that had been full of excitement immediately turned cold. In any case, a gay alpha who was interested in alphas didn't have anything to do with them.

Phainon could pretty much imagine how the breaking news would spread through the entire empire by tomorrow. He didn't even want to become famous like this, okay.

Now, the only thing worth celebrating was that now this brainless guy Caelus didn't announce Phainon's gender. Otherwise, even if Phainon had to put his life on the line, he would have charged over to have them die together.

Even if Phainon was completely unwilling, because of Caelus, talks about the name Prince Latiao went crazy again. His popularity was competing with the top fifty competitors... Although this popularity was super weird too.

To vent some of his anger, Phainon went straight to compete in the virtual mecha competition.

This time, Phainon used the mecha full of advertisements just like last time, and started to begin the selections.

The opponent that the system randomly selected for System this time was a competitor in the top fifty. Those in the top fifty were all incredible people. To keep them with the competition, the competition organizers would even give them one percent of the ticket prices.

In other words, every time someone in the top fifty competed, there were heaps of empire coins to collect. Phainon envied it a lot. He also wanted to

be in the top fifty and make money.

The current Prince Latiao wasn't the same as the confused, nameless newbie he was a few days ago. There were many of his fans in the stands, calling his name continuously.

Phainon's heart burst in pride, but when he looked towards the stands, he immediately noticed that all of the screens in the stands were playing Caelus's image.

Is having money so great, huh?! Just how much money did Caelus spend?! Did he think the other person had accepted him after a bombardment of brainwashing?!

Phainon's heart filled with grief and indignation. He attacked the other person with an almost furious blow. Before they could react, Phainon's momentum bowled them over. Luckily, they had experience, and wouldn't lose immediately like other people. After they dodged the blow, they began to fight back, but in the end they still couldn't resist Phainon.

At the other side.

In a dormitory that was almost like a small mansion in the Empire Military Institute, Mydei took a deep breath, then sank into his nutrient cabinet impatiently.

In order to attain the best conditions, Mydei had bought the most expensive nutrient cabin in the beginning. He wouldn't even think about using a helmet.

In the past, Mydei had logged into the virtual net only for mecha competitions, but now he had a new goal. He wanted to see the person he thought almost…. longingly about, Prince Latiao.

As soon as he logged on, he received Prince Latiao's email. Mydei's heart skipped a beat. It was just a few dozen words, just asking him to respond

when he went online, but Mydei felt like every word was precious. This was the email that his male god had taken the initiative to send! He couldn't stop himself from reading it a few more times

before he calmed down to write a reply. His hands were shaking. He thought over every word for a long time before he finally hit send.

Mydei couldn't calm himself from his excitement. When he looked up, he spotted Caelus's ridiculously expensive ads. When he saw Prince Latiao's familiar bearing, he paused, unable to move.

After seeing half of the advertisement, Mydei's joy immediately turned to fury.

This Caelus was nothing. Other than his background and his face, he didn't have the slightest redeeming quality. He even had some beta clinging onto him for influence. He must be confessing just to play around... Damn it, he used such an attitude to Mydei's male god? He couldn't be forgiven!

What would he do if his male god was seduced by Caelus? Mydei couldn't help beginning to worry. "No, it won't happen. He wouldn't be so easily seduced."

And where did Mydei get the right to interfere with his decision?

Mydei couldn't stop himself from beginning to ponder. If someday Prince Latiao really wanted to be with someone else, then what would he do... Just thinking about it made Mydei's chest ache like it was about to split apart. He felt strangely uncomfortable.

He was too greedy, wasn't he? Before, he could easily watch from afar, but now he wanted to take another step forward even if they were close together.

Mydei began to feel perturbed. He could only cheer himself up when he saw Prince Latiao.

Phainon also noticed that Mydeimos seemed a little off today. After he finished his daily task, he blurted, "You seem a little gloomy today? What's wrong?"

"It's nothing, I'm fine. You don't need to worry about someone like me," Mydei said gruffly, feeling a bit shy from the sudden attention. "But... if you don't find it offensive, I have something I'd like to ask you. If you would rather not hear it, don't need to say it."

Phainon was curious about what Mydeimos wanted to ask him. "Go ahead."

"You must have seen the advertisements today, right?" Mydei said carefully.

Phainon nearly vomited a mouthful of old blood. He began to choke. "Yeah, I saw them."

Phainon began to feel embarrassed now that someone had actually brought it up.

"What do you think about it, then..." After he finished speaking, Mydei hurried to explain, "I don't mean to interrogate you, I just think... well, someone like that doesn't seem very reliable..."

He was absolutely right! Phainon practically wanted to shake Mydeimos's hand.

"I don't have any particular thoughts about that video," Phainon said calmly, trying to revive his awesomeness. "To me, the most important thing is the competition. I won't think about anything else. Besides, those kinds of people are just talk. They'll probably forget it quickly."

"That's true..." Mydei let out a breath of relief. He said, "After all, you're an alpha. You naturally don't have any interest to other alphas like you, right?"

When he finished speaking, Mydei, who realized he was also an alpha, felt his chest begin to ache.

"I don't have any interest in alphas," Phainon said absently. "I like omegas... But right now I won't think about those kinds of things anyways."

Something like two omegas being together was simply impossible, but Phainon had only come to do a daily task. He didn't think anything about romance.

"By the way, it's not that convenient to send emails every time we want to meet. How about we exchange contacts?" Phainon said without thinking.

Mydei was stunned. His depression instantly dissipated. Excited, he said, "Of course we can. That would be my honor."

Mecha combat classes were that night.

It was a ten minute class that they only had once a month. All the first and second years would participate. Nobody could ask for leave.

Generally, they would draw two random students to fight. Because they were using armed mechas, they were much more dangerous than the outdated mechas. Thus, this time of year was also the time that students had the most injuries.

Phainon was incredibly anxious. He looked up at the people on the podium, completely unable to calm himself down.

Although he could use his spiritual energy for three minutes, if he suddenly became skilled, it wouldn't be easy for him to end things. If someone overestimated his skills in the future and assigned him to some more difficult classes or duties, Phainon would have no way to complete them.

Actually, it didn't matter if his opponent was someone else, but Phainon was most worried that he would be unlucky enough to draw Khaslana as his opponent. What would he do then?

Compared to this, even all of the news he saw this morning about Caelus coming out was nothing.

Like Phainon, Caelus was extremely anxious, but he wasn't worried about the mecha combat class. Instead, he was worried about what he had done

yesterday. "Was I too much yesterday? I didn't want to go so far, but if I didn't do that, then how would I express my sincerity? Should I apologize?"

Phainon didn't have the guts to believe that the apology Caelus was talking about would be a normal apology. He said hurriedly, "He definitely understood you already. He probably didn't reply yet because he was too shocked."

...Although he really didn't want to answer Caelus, with things like this he didn't have a choice.

"I hope you're right," Caelus sighed.

Phainon wondered why the duke and duchess didn't care a bit more about their son. Don't ignore your younger son just because you have an outstanding eldest son as the heir! Was coming out so openly really not a problem... Would the dukedom really stay unaffected!

After he finished spitting curses in his head, Phainon forgot about his nerves. Anyway, he'd just do his worst. It was fine.

At the same time, in the luxurious private box at the other side, Mydei was staring fixedly at the image on the broadcasting screen that filled up the entire wall. It was displaying the fifth or sixth match that was currently ongoing.

After Mydei investigated, he found that there were only first and second year students in the training field yesterday. They were certain to appear in the combat class, and Prince Latiao was certain to be in their midst.

Prince Latiao had such strength. If he wanted to appear to the public, he could, but instead he was quiet and unknown. He must have been hiding his true strength all this time.

So in the combat class, he would definitely behave very discreetly. He might even lose on purpose. Mydei was prepared to survey the details. He watched Prince Latiao's videos countless times, and he had already engraved the subtleties of his movements in his mind.

Mydei was both excited and nervous.

Khaslana sat at the side, looking at the screen expressionlessly. He had already cleared up the investigation. Mydei's abnormal behavior was actually because of that Prince Latiao.

"He's just someone who failed at imitating me, and he can only pick such a sensationalist name to capture people's attention," Khaslana thought. "Even if there's someone even stronger, so what? I'll let him be proud for a few days."

Khaslana's favorite thing to do was letting his enemies crawl upwards, then, right when they were at the height of their pride, knocking them off of their throne and enjoying their grief.

By that time, Mydei would understand that the real person deserving of his loyalty was Khaslana, not that lowly copycat.

"Ah, it's my turn." Khaslana stood up, smiling slightly at Mydei. "I'll be back soon."

Match after match passed. Soon, it was Phainon's turn.

Phainon gritted his teeth, getting up from his seat, his steps heavy.

He had already decided. He would use his normal ability to fight. The competition rules dictated that he couldn't surrender until five minutes had passed. It would be fine as long as he managed to endure five minutes and then surrender. In any case, he wouldn't get expelled if he surrendered... Normal people should stop fighting after the other party surrender.

But Phainon saw his opponent-Khaslana.

Phainon was so shocked he nearly buckled and fell to his knees. "...???" Wait? What kind of luck was this? Out of all the people in the school, he really ended up matching with Khaslana? Holy fuck.

Khaslana gave Phainon a friendly smile. "What a coincidence. I didn't expect that my opponent would actually be you."

Phainon: "Ah, hello..." No, this had to be one of Khaslana's plots. How else could it be so coincidental?

"I still remember the circumstances when we first met," Khaslana chuckled. "In the blink of an eye, so much time has passed. I really miss it."

If someone out of the loop heard Khaslana, they would think he and Phainon were friends or something.

But Phainon knew that the first time they met was when Khaslana had just started school, but he had been utterly humiliated by the original soul of the body Phainon was currently inhabiting... Khaslana's words were totally a threat!

Phainon gritted his teeth. "Um, Khaslana, don't you think classmates should exchange our views... There's no need to be too serious? It should be okay as long as we don't overdo it."

"Oh?" Khaslana raised an eyebrow. "I'm very sorry. I'm very serious about everything relating to mechas. Still, I'm confident in your strength. It'll be fine as long as we both do our best. I think it's certain that no accidents will happen. Right?"

Right your foot! This is already a complete threat!

Phainon already knew that it would be no use if he surrendered. For someone like Khaslana, even if his opponent surrendered, he would definitely pretend he didn't hear it and continue beating his opponent even more fiercely.

Feeling a huge amount of pressure, Phainon climbed into the cockpit of the mecha.

It was his first time using a standard mecha in the real life. If he wasn't facing Khaslana, everything would be wonderful.

Soon, the competition began. Khaslana was calm despite the situation, maneuvering the mecha to attack with ease.

Like a cat playing with a mouse, Khaslana didn't prepare to take Phainon out in one blow. Instead, he wanted to thoroughly play around with him, waiting until he didn't have anymore patience before he acted.

Phainon continuously evaded Khaslana's attacks, only feeling that every second was taking longer than the last. He didn't know when Khaslana began to move, and he didn't know what he would do in the next second. Sweat trickled down his face.

If he could use his spiritual energy, he could observe his opponent's movements, and he wouldn't be in such a miserable situation. Dammit.

At the side, Mydei sat in the private box, examining for a long time. He hadn't found anyone who moved like Prince Latiao. He looked towards his friend's match, feeling disappointed.

He knew very clearly that there was probably nobody in their grade that could compete with Khaslana. The opponent today looked especially weak. Even with Khaslana deliberately going easy on him, he was barely able to evade.

"How could someone like this be him." Mydei sighed. He didn't know whether he would be able to find Prince Latiao today.

--

Fierce attacks flew towards Phainon. He swayed in place, discovering that one of the mecha's legs was no longer stable.

When Khaslana had attacked just now, the mecha's left leg had been disconnected.

"Crap." Phainon bit his lip, understanding immediately. Khaslana was preparing to use the method he had used on the three guys from yesterday to deal with him.

And with Khaslana's personality, he might pretend that he had accidentally hit the cockpit. If he got Phainon injured, Phainon wouldn't let him off.

"If things keep going like this, I'll be a sitting duck." Phainon's gaze turned cold. "Even if my opponent is the original protagonist, there's nothing I can do. If I don't fight back..."

Since the beginning, Phainon never wanted to fight the protagonist head-on. After all, the other party was the blessed son of the world consciousness. If he fought back, it would always be him on the short end of the stick.

But he understood now. There were some things he couldn't avoid no matter how much he wanted to. If he didn't face them, the other person would just get more intense.

Phainon closed his eyes, connecting his spiritual energy with the mecha.

On the other side of the field, Khaslana was leisurely operating the mecha. With his SSS-grade spiritual energy, his mecha was just like part of his body. Sometimes, it could even react faster than his own body. Nobody was his opponent, no matter who it was.

Khaslana thought of himself as a natural mecha operating genius. It was the gift the heavens had bestowed on him. Nobody could defeat him. Even if he was born in the slums, he had incredible luck. He had anything he wanted, and he had barely met any setbacks.

Because of this, Khaslana had grown into a warped personality. For example, he could easily kill off this beta, someone who didn't understand his own limits. But what he enjoyed the most was a weakling's last struggle before death.

The weakling was obviously destined to defeat, but because he had the slightest hope of succeeding, he continued to endure. Finally, in his despair, he discovered that there was only one road forward to defeat.

Every time he saw the painful despair in his opponent's eyes, Khaslana would feel joy. When he attacked, he specially left his opponent an opportunity to escape. Sometimes, he would let them escape. Sometimes, he would shoot them in their vitals.

When he thought about what expression this beta had on at that moment, Khaslana couldn't hold back his glee.

In the next moment, Khaslana suddenly froze.

His opponent suddenly evaded the blow that should have landed.

No. According to his plans, he would certainly land his blow. With the strength of a beta, how could he avoid it? And the left leg of his opponent's mecha was malfunctioning.

Again, Khaslana felt the anxiety of the situation slipping out of his hands. His eyes turned cold. "I'm done playing... Now, you should get ready to lose."

Chapter End Notes

> The Author has something to say:
> Hey Hey! Happy New Year! And sorry for not posting for so long. I went on vacation and then i got sick and school's started up again, so it wasnt the greatest start to the year ever but oh well! We persevere. Hope you like this new chapter. I feel like this one is a bit boring but i assure you its building up to some good scenes next chapter or two! Also i have most of the next chapter done so expect a double update this week to make up for the two week hiatus!
>
> TMI but am i the only one who likes to jump into the new year? Like jumping at 11:59 so that when you land its in the new year. Does anyone else do that too or is it just me? Because my mom thinks its pretty stupid.
>
> Also Also, last thing i promise! But you know how characters just run away from you once you start writing? Because lowkey why was i shipping Khaslana and Mydei this chapter??? Like it was giving 'Only look at me' and jealousy trope even though that's definitely not what's happening here. lmao.

Chapter 7: Fallen Sockpuppet

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Phainon could feel very clearly that Khaslana's attacks were no longer as sluggish as before, but swift and fierce. Each blow was aimed at his vitals.

If he was still operating manually, Phainon would definitely have lost already. But with his spiritual energy connected to his mecha, his sense of his surroundings was incomparably clear, and he could see everything on the field. No matter how cunning Khaslana's attacks were, he could dodge them all.

Of course, in order to avoid exposing his true strength, when Phainon dodged, he purposely faked panic, making it look like he was able to dodge thanks to luck. He was successful at looking like a useless potato.

"But this is no good..." Phainon racked his brains. "There's not much time less. I have to finish things in three minutes, but I can't just win against Khaslana... If that happens, it'll draw people's attention."

And Mydei, watching the scene from the private room, was nearly standing up.

To an outsider watching the two people fighting, it looked like Phainon was dodging blindly, as though he didn't have the slightest ability to resist, and even like he was in a sorry state. But Mydei could sense the peculiarity clearly.

Based on his understanding of Khaslana, Khaslana was already using all of his strength. This was no longer a level that normal people could compare with. After all, Khaslana was someone at the top in the virtual world.

But if that Phainon was really useless, then he wouldn't get lucky enough to dodge so many times. Moreover, Mydei saw each and every one of the

details in the movements Phainon made when he was dodging.

He was very familiar with the particulars of those movements. They were just like the movements he saw countless of times in videos. They were the same as Prince Latiao's movements in the arena. They were the movements that Mydei had been searching for in the arena all morning.

Mydei couldn't believe his eyes. "How? It couldn't be..." A completely implausible theory began to take shape in his mind. "...No. No, it's too early to come to a conclusion." Mydei stood up. "I have to go see it personally."

Mydei rushed out the door without hesitation, running to the region Khaslana and Phainon were fighting in.

He was fairly close to the arena, and he was in a position high above. It was easy to see everything in the arena.

Mydei looked straight at the mecha that seemed like it was being piloted with an unpracticed hand, his molten amber eyes filled with struggle.

"Come on, let me see... Are you truly that person?"

On the other hand, Khaslana was getting more and more annoyed. Now, the opponent that he should have been able to handle with ease was actually able to avoid his blows again and again and wearing his little bit of patience down to nothing.

Khaslana liked toying with the weak, but if these weaklings began acting out of his control, he would fall into hysteria.

"It looks like I've only got one choice." Khaslana's gaze turned cold. He aimed at Phainon's weak point and thrust forward.

As long as he hit that spot, Phainon's mecha would immediately get out of control. Even the mecha's safety mechanisms would be affected. Even if he suffered injuries, it wouldn't be unusual. Every year, students would get hurt because of that spot.

But Phainon maneuvered his mecha into a twist just enough to dodge that blow.

"It's just as I thought... What should I do then?" Things played out just as Khaslana had anticipated. His attack from just now had been to test the waters. When Phainon dodged, Khaslana controlled the other arm of his mecha to pull out its weapon, aiming a blow at the place Phainon had dodged towards.

"Can you still dodge this?"

Khaslana had never shown this trump card. In fact, he could fight with weapons in both hands, and he could bring out the highest level of power from each of them.

In the original novel, Khaslana didn't reveal himself until later. At first, he hadn't wanted to reveal his hand in the combat lessons, but faced with a situation no longer in his control, he finally made up his mind.

But what Khaslana didn't know was that his opponent knew his each and every move even more clearly then he himself did.

Khaslana's mecha was completely blocking off Phainon's escape route with one weapon in each hand. There was nowhere Phainon could run. If he dodged, he would be skewered by one of the weapons.

Khaslana was sure that as long as Phainon's mecha was skewered, then he could seize the chance to batter his opponent's mecha into scrap metal.

Phainon's mecha stayed stiffly in place, as though he was at a loss because he had nowhere to run.

The crowd cried out in shock. "He's incredible, he can actually fight at such a level!"

"I know Khaslana's pretty good with mechas, but I didn't expect that he was actually so skilled."

Khaslana didn't hear any of their amazed gasps. He was thinking only of Phainon's mecha broken into pieces. He couldn't control his glee, maneuvering his mecha to attack. "It's time. Where will you run now? There's already nowhere to run, hmm?"

Then, as if Phainon was too nervous and couldn't control his mecha, his mecha slid backwards drunkenly, just in time to avoid Khaslana's blow.

"How..." Khaslana was stunned.

But it wasn't done yet. Before Khaslana's disbelieving eyes, Phainon's mecha just happened to crash towards him, even sending his weapons crashing straight towards Khaslana's cockpit, causing it to sway. The connection between Khaslana's spiritual energy and the mecha snapped.

The cockpit was the most critical region of the mecha. As long as his opponent touched his mecha, the victory was practically set in stone.

The combat lessons didn't require their students to really go into close combat, so when Phainon's mecha crashed into Khaslana's cockpit, an earsplitting bell rang into the air. It meant the victor had been decided.

All the surrounding students were stunned. "Fuck, you can even win like this?"

"Isn't this guy's luck crazy? I expected him to get taught a lesson. I didn't expect..."

"Poor Khaslana. He was sure to win, but he lost because of something like this."

The fragments of the conversations around Khaslana drifted into his ears.

He... had lost?

He, who had never lost since he started school, had lost to a beta?!

When Khaslana realized what had happened, his alluringly handsome face sank. He looked towards the opposing mecha with a death stare.

"At first, I was thinking of having you back out and leave the school after getting some heavy injuries. Now it looks like I was being too kind," Khaslana said lowly, his spiritual energy sinking into the air in the blink of an eye.

He knew his spiritual energy was stronger than most people's. As long as he wanted to, he could even use his spiritual energy to make anyone under A-grade go crazy.

When he was in a low-level school, he would have anyone who got on his bad side take spiritual damage in the battlefield. They couldn't even stay in school. They would be forced to stay in the sanatorium for life, not knowing what had happened to their own spiritual energy.

Khaslana was planning to use the same tactic to counter Phainon. After all, spiritual problems were difficult to detect. Even the best military institute in the empire had no way to find out what was wrong.

But in the next moment, Khaslana felt an indescribable dread from his spiritual energy. Other than his luck, the reason Khaslana could climb so high was because of his occasional, strong intuition that allowed him to evade danger at a critical moment several times.

It was his first time sensing this fear. Khaslana unconsciously stopped diffusing spiritual energy.

Just as Khaslana stopped, Phainon maneuvered his mecha into a standing position, retreating from the training field rapidly, unwilling to stay near Khaslana for even a second longer.

Khaslana looked over coldly, hammering his mecha with both fists. "Phainon... I'll remember you."

It was his second time moving against Phainon, but he hadn't succeeded. He wouldn't let himself face defeat a third time.

Everyone watching the fight to the death was thoroughly shocked. In their ten-odd years of life, it was their first time seeing someone win from sheer

dumb luck. None of them realized anything strange.

But Mydei stood at the side, his hands balled tightly into fists, staring fixedly at the replays on the screen. His eyes were filled with disbelief.

When he hurried over, he had examined Phainon's every move closely. The more he looked, the more he felt that Phainon's movements were exactly like Prince Latiao's.

"Still, he could be imitating Prince Latiao..." Mydei thought, "If he's really imitating, it's not impossible to copy the details."

But when Phainon dodged Khaslana's attack and crashed into him, a sliver of spiritual energy unconsciously dissipated into the air.

Because Phainon was focused on Khaslana, he couldn't keep hold on his spiritual energy. He reasoned that there was nobody above who had their spiritual energy saturating the air, but he didn't expect that his energy would run into Mydei upstairs.

When he felt the strong, familiar spiritual energy, Mydei's handsome but always cold face flushed red. He clutched onto the wall to keep his cool, almost causing It to crack from the force.

"That's right... Everything can be faked except for this spiritual energy... This strong spiritual energy..." Mydei mumbled. "It must be him. Ah... I managed to find out now..."

Mydei thought of when he had rushed to the mecha training field and ran into Phainon. Back then, he thought he was just a useless beta hiding there to slack off, and hadn't bothered to spare him a single glance.

But things seemed different now. Phainon must have rushed to leave as soon as the action ended, and ran into him. Mydei clenched his fists. He should have noticed something was off back then, but because of his innate prejudice he hadn't even though about it.

No wonder he hadn't been able to find Prince Latiao in the school by looking for an alpha. It was because the person he looked up to the most was actually a beta.

Mydei's opinion didn't change because Prince Latiao wasn’t an alpha. Instead, his admiration deepened.

His idol was really worth his title. He could even attain such a level as a beta.

Phainon's victory absolutely wasn't just luck. Mydei thought back to the scene from just now. It was clear that it was a result that had been carefully planned and crafted for the outsider. He had the skill to defeat Khaslana as he wished, but he went for a roundabout way to achieve his goal.

Now that he thought about it, Phainon's uselessness in the past was an act he had put up. In fact, to cover up his true power, Phainon had always kept himself hidden. Even if others insulted him, he didn't care.

That's right. Mydei thought of what Prince Latiao had said to him in the virtual net. Phainon doesn't care about this at all. He thinks wholeheartedly of mechas and becoming stronger.

Mydei sat back at his seat, disappointed. The things that had happened to Phainon flashed through his mind one by one. Now, the things that he had practically forgotten were as clear as day.

Before, every time they met, he would always pretend not to see him. He had even thought that looking at Phainon was an offense to his eyes... But the other person hadn't said anything when they met in the virtual net. He had even been so friendly.

But even if Phainon didn't care, Mydei couldn't forgive himself for looking down on him in the past. He wished he could turn back time and give himself a slap across the face.

Back when people accused Phainon of being a pervert peeping on the men's bathrooms, Mydei had known very clearly that he was an innocent, but he

had thought that such a person was getting his just desserts, so he didn't come out to say anything. It had even forced Phainon to leave the school.

After that, Phainon only came back with the help of Caelus's power. Otherwise... wait.

Mydei was suddenly shocked. He thought back to when Caelus had confessed to Prince Latiao in broad daylight on the virtual net yesterday.

He had thought it was weird. Caelus and Prince Latiao didn't have many chances to meet, so why would Caelus start wooing him so quickly? It was as though they already knew each other for a long time.

Now he understood. So they had already gotten acquainted with each other then... In the end, it was all his, the cold bystander's, fault.

When he thought about how he had caused Phainon to get to know Caelus, Mydei felt incredibly bitter. He didn't come back to his senses for a long time.

The second Phainon entered the mecha prep station, he disconnected his spiritual energy from the mecha, wiping off the sweat on his forehead. His entire body was soaked with sweat.

After all, he wasn't just using his spiritual energy to control the mecha. He also had to face Khaslana, who had a protagonist halo, and pretend to be weak, then gain victory by chance...

Still, Phainon hadn't expected to win so easily. It seemed that Khaslana took him too lightly and was too relaxed.

Another factor was that it was only a combat lesson, and it couldn't influence the real story. Otherwise, even if the world consciousness had to give Phainon a heart attack and give him a lunch box, it wouldn't let Khaslana lose. It wasn't so easy to face the original protagonist.

"Even Khaslana won't realize anything is wrong. He'll just think I won by chance." Phainon was ready to admire his own resourcefulness.

Phainon didn't know what would happen when he met Khaslana in the future either... Anyway, things had already gotten to this state.

After being sprawled out in the cockpit for a while, Phainon finally clambered up, feeling absolutely exhausted. He felt like he was walking on air, completely unlike he was on real ground, but like he was walking on clouds.

"As I thought, I should work on doing some more exercise." Phainon began panting after a few steps, supporting himself on the wall. He couldn't help beginning to complain, "This omega body's just too garbage. I'm so tired after just a bit of spiritual energy. I won't be able to find a job once I graduate, will I?"

As soon as he walked out of the mecha prep station, everyone's attention focused on Phainon. Their gazes were filled with awe. After all, it was rare to see someone as lucky as Phainon. It made them want to come and touch Phainon and let some of his luck rub off on them, but they weren't close enough for that.

If someone put this online, Phainon would most certainly become one of those "repost for luck" posts that had been reposted several hundred thousand times.

Then the main entrance opened. Mydei stood in the doorway. He looked as though he was in a rush. His blonde hair was a mess, but it made him look more approachable and not as though he was a thousand miles away.

After seeing Mydei, everyone's expressions changed.

Someone had spread the word about how Mydeimos had requested surveillance footage yesterday. Most people in the school were aware that someone who could get the footage couldn't have an ordinary background. A few people discovered Mydei's true background through their own means.

Thus, overnight, Mydeimos's true identity had had spread through the entire school, and he didn't have any intention to cover it up either.

Only someone who didn't pay attention to the school sites like Phainon wouldn't know.

Now, everyone wanted to get close to Mydeimos. They hated themselves for not noticing someone so amazing in their school and envied Khaslana's luck.

But Mydeimos was so hard to approach that nobody was daring enough to talk to him. In the past, there were people who wanted to get close to him because of his looks, but he didn't even spare them a glance.

When Mydei saw Phainon, his expression changed. He walked over quickly.

Phainon unconsciously stopped in his footsteps, looking at him alertly. "...!" What did Mydeimos want to do?! Did he come get revenge because he was upset with the method Phainon used to win over Khaslana?!

When the crowd thought about Mydeimos and Khaslana's relationship, they thought of the same thing as Phainon and thought Mydei came to settle the score with him... Fuck, this must be the best chance for them to get on Mydeimos's good side.

Because Phainon usually stuck to Caelus, nobody had the guts to say anything. Now that Caelus was gone, each of them began to rack their brains to jeer at Phainon and curry favor with Mydeimos.

"Is this the guy who just beat Khaslana? Why does he look like a weak chicken? He doesn't look like he can beat Khaslana at all. I think there's something fishy about him."

"Heh, look, that guy just won by luck. How else would a pervert who got expelled then came back with no shame win against Khaslana? Everyone knows how amazing Khaslana is."

To curry favor with Mydeimos, these people began praising Khaslana shamelessly.

"Poor Khaslana, I bet this will even affect his grades for the year... This kind of trash shouldn't have been at our school in the first place. If he can't stand it, that's whatever, but he even affected someone else. He's absolutely shameless."

"Exactly. Someone as amazing as Khaslana actually lost to a beta. If this gets around, even his reputation will get affected."

"And he's so tired after just getting on a mecha. If he really goes and participates in some mecha competition, won't he just be vomiting blood? If you're as weak as an omega, don't come to study at our military institute. If I was him, I would have left school ages ago."

…….

…

Phainon didn't know how to react. "..." Hey, do you guys have to act like this just to suck up! These jeers are so awkward, okay, and that last one accidentally came a bit too close to home...

But Mydei's expression turned uglier and uglier. Everyone thought they had gotten the main point and got even more excited, beginning to let out curse after curse.

Although their personalities looked bad, as long as they could get the favor of the crown prince's younger cousin, the heir of the richest tycoon in the empire, so what if they had bad personalities? Wouldn't their futures be limitless?! Everyone had the same thing in mind.

Phainon was pretty sure that Mydeimos wouldn't hit him in front of so many people, so he kept walking forward, pretending it had nothing to do with him.

He didn't expect that because he had been standing for so long, Phainon's legs suddenly went numb. He lost control and fell forward.

When he saw that Phainon was about to fall, Mydei flew over, grabbing ahold of Phainon. He asked anxiously, "Are you alright? Do you feel any discomfort?"

Phainon was given a huge shock. "??!" So polite?!

The surrounding crowd: "...???!!" The fuck?!

The people who were talking cheerfully shut up immediately.

Hey, why were things going different from what was agreed on! Where was the "picking a fight for my good friend" that they were promised? Why were things suddenly going like this? How were they supposed to bear it!

"I-I'm fine..." Phainon couldn't figure out if Mydeimos had recognized him. He could only ask, "Do you need me for something?"

"I truly apologize. I came too late, I couldn't bring you away before those people started talking." Mydei's eyes were filled with guilt. He got on one knee in front of Phainon, putting himself in a most humble position.

Mydei's behavior shocked Phainon. He began to panic. "T-t-th... Wait, don't be like this..."

How did Mydeimos have the mental strength to kneel down in front of so many people!

The crowd was also so shocked they nearly peed their pants. Was this still the always-cold Mydei who looked like everyone owed him money?! And the person he was facing was just a beta with no strength, was someone impersonating him?! Or did they have a collective hallucination? Or did Phainon actually have a deeply hidden history?!

Because it was too shocking, everybody was beginning to doubt their eyes.

But Mydei didn't care about them at all. His sunset-like eyes drilled into Phainon, his voice steely.

"I apologize for the things I did in the past. I hope you would be wiling to forgive me... I understand that my actions cannot be brushed over in a few sentences. I can accept any punishment you give me, but I ask that you do not push me away."

Phainon: "...!" Fuck, such grand lines, Mydeimos must know his identity, right? Although he had no idea where he got this information... In any case, the most important thing right now was to keep it from anyone else.

The crowd: "???" What kind of development was this! Did something happen that they didn't know about? They obviously came to school every day, but it seemed like they had missed out on some shocking news.

The people who had been mocking Phainon earlier wished they could rip their own mouths off. They wanted to run away, but they were afraid of being to obvious and being noticed by Mydeimos. They could only stay in the crowd, suffering.

What exactly was up with this Phainon guy? He was just a beta, and he was even expelled from the school. A normal person couldn't make a comeback, but he actually befriended two amazing people in one go. How the heck did he do it?!

Their stares were about to poke through Phainon. He hurriedly grabbed Mydei's hand. "Okay, I forgive you. You should stand up quickly... There's some stuff that isn't good to say here, let's find somewhere more private."

When Phainon grabbed Mydei's hand, his eyes glimmered. He immediately stood up, nodding. "Alright, I'll leave all the decisions to you."

Then he turned his head, giving the crowd a cold stare. He said coldly, "I won't pretend I didn't hear what you said earlier. By the end of the day, you'd better make a public apology on the school's website, or you can prepare to face the Kremnoan family's fury."

Mydei's words showed he had no intention of keeping his background a secret any longer. The crowd was stunned. Bringing out the Kremnoan

name so directly meant that Mydei had decided to stand against those people.

The people who had cursed at Phainon before had no choice but to start thinking about how they would apologize to Phainon online no matter how bitter they felt. Although it was humiliating, compared to the consequences of facing the Kremnoan family's suppression, humiliation was just humiliation.

They hadn't forgotten when a celebrity from a noble family mocked the head of the Kremnoan family. In the end, they were blocked and suppressed, and their entire family was pressured into bankruptcy. The emperor even took away their title of nobility.

Immediately, Mydei pulled Phainon's hand, rushing to a lounge nearby. When he noticed how hard Phainon was panting, he questioned in concern, "What's wrong? You seem to be in poor condition."

"It's nothing, I'm fine." Phainon waved a hand, looking at him seriously. "You figured out my identity?"

Mydei blurted, "I truly apologize, I didn't do it intentionally. I just happened to notice."

"As I thought, you found out..." Phainon could feel the terrifying power of a fanboy acutely. He even found out something kept so secret. "I'm begging you, please never say anything about this, especially to Khaslana. Please?"

Mydei was shocked. He nearly got back on his knees. He gritted his teeth. "Of course I will do as you say, but there's no need to use 'please' with me..."

Although Khaslana was his friend, he was nothing compared to Phainon. If Mydei had to choose between the two, he would abandon Khaslana without hesitation.

In the original novel, Mydei could betray his own cousin for Khaslana. He could betray anyone for Phainon.

"Alright." Phainon let out a breath of relief. He continued, "You saw it too. Although I'm really strong online, I'm just a normal student in real life. If you can't accept it, just pretend like nothing happened at all."

"You're truly too kind. You're still so kind to someone like me." Mydei was ready to cry. His voice hoarse, he said, "Even if you are different in reality, I already decided that I would follow after you for a lifetime. I absolutely won't change because of such a reason."

Fuck, Mydeimos's basically already been possessed by the devil.

Phainon: "...As long as you're happy." If Mydeimos wanted to stick to him for no reward, he couldn't do anything about it.

"Then, when we're in school in the future, you don't have to talk to me like this. You can just say my name normally." Phainon felt this was a very serious matter. "Okay?"

"Of course, it's no problem," Mydei said. "Then in the future, I'll address you... address you as Ph-Phainon..." His face was turning more impassive by the second but there was an almost happy glow emanating from him and Phainon swears he could see a lion’s tail swishing behind him.

Phainon felt embarrassed by Mydeimos's reaction. "..." Isn't it just a name? There's absolutely no need to be so excited!!

"Oh, right, it's getting late. I'll leave first," Phainon said. If Caelus couldn't find him and ran over it would be annoying.

Mydei suddenly remembered, and probed, "Right, your relationship with Caelus..."

But before Phainon could leave, the door burst open.

Caelus's silhouette appeared in the doorway. His impatient voice rang out. "You're just a servant, don't always make trouble for me. When you're done fighting, just go and sit back down properly. Now you even had me come find you personally."

Phainon: "!" Hey, coming as soon as he finished talking makes it just seem like it was on purpose, okay?

Chapter End Notes

The Author has something to say:
Yay! Two Chapters in one week! And I feel like this is one that you all have been waiting for for a while. I hope it lives up to your expectations hehe. From here on out I have a lot of fun things planned. I'm very excited and I hope you'll enjoy them too. See you next week!

Chapter 8: As long as I’m at his side, it’s enough

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

When he saw that there were unexpectedly two people inside, and one of them was Mydeimos, Caelus paused and frowned, but he promptly ignored Mydeimos, looking towards Phainon. He said coldly, "What are you standing there for? Hurry up or you might as well just sleep here tonight."

Without the slightest hesitation, he turned and left.

When Mydei saw Caelus's attitude towards Phainon, he wanted to say something, but Phainon stopped him.

After Phainon rested for a bit, his energy was pretty much recovered to normal levels. He gave Mydei an apologetic glance. "Let's talk another time." He scurried out the door.

Mydei swallowed his half-asked question, watching their fading silhouettes. His gaze was several times colder than usual, and his hands were clenched tightly.

"Someone like this... How is someone like this good enough to stay by his side..."

In the aircar, Phainon suddenly remembered Caelus was Khaslana's fanboy. He didn't make Caelus angry by accidentally winning, did he? He felt a bit panicked.

"Congratulations on your victory." Caelus glanced at him and said, "Although I was hoping Senior Khaslana would win, I wouldn't do anything to you because of something like this. After all, your victory was genuine too."

Phainon: "....!" Liar, you're obviously the kind of guy that could even lay a trap for your biological brother! You even secretly plotted against a few of Khaslana's enemies.

Still, when he thought about it, in the original novel Caelus was already head over heels for Khaslana, so it was normal that he was so lovesick. Now, he just worshipped Khaslana... so it was understandable that he wasn't so crazy.

Phainon immediately let out a breath of relief. He decided to completely ignore that the person Caelus currently liked was Prince Latiao.

"By the way, how come you and that Mydeimos guy were together?" Caelus said casually. "He was always scowling at you until just a while ago, wasn't he?"

You talk like you're not always scowling yourself.

Phainon's heart skipped a beat. "Oh, yeah, we just happened to met in the lounge..." Though the news about how Mydeimos got down on one knee would be spreading by tomorrow... Phainon guessed that with Caelus being how he was, he had probably never listened to gossip around the school, so he didn't bother to explain (._.)

"Oh? I see." Caelus snorted. "In any case, it doesn't have anything to do with me. Still, that Mydeimos guy really doesn't know his own limits. He actually went and confessed to my companion online. It's just wishful thinking. If I'm wooing ahead of time, nobody will fall in love with someone like him."

Phainon: "..." Hey, you and him are two of a kind, okay! And who was your companion, huh? Don't be so confident.

"By the way, tonight, you don't have to stay in that little room upstairs anymore. Just come down to eat," Caelus said calmly. "With your performance these days, I think I should give you a bit of a promotion."

Phainon: "..." Did Caelus's favorability score rise a bit because they talked a bit about love problems?

He hoped Caelus would never find out the truth.

Dinner in the dining room was, as he expected, more delicious than the meals he had in his room. Phainon ate so happily that he was ready to cry. As he ate, he began to think about how to reply to Caelus on the virtual net.

After logging in, Phainon went to the school site to take a look first. Contrary to his expectations, there wasn't a single thread about what Mydeimos did that day. There weren't even any threads about Phainon. There were only a few threads about how unlucky Khaslana was.

After searching a bit, Phainon discovered that the keywords had actually been blocked.

Phainon: "..." He nearly forgot that Mydeimos was the crown prince's younger cousin. Blocking out news like this was no problem at all.

After letting go of the burden in his heart, Phainon scurried over to fight a few rounds in the competition before going to find Mydei. This was pretty much his everyday activity by now.

After accumulating points over the last period of time, Prince Latiao's points had climbed up to the top two hundred. With another hundred-some points, he could squeeze his way into the top hundred.

Other people could fight two or three rounds a day. They would need at least two months before they could collect a hundred-some points. But to Phainon, who wanted to fight in the arena every day, a hundred-some points was about what he could accumulate in a day. There were many people who both envied and admired him.

Because Mydeimos knew Phainon's true identity now, he didn't bother distorting his face and voice. He went directly to look for Mydei with his real face.

After he saw Phainon, Mydei just about sank into his happy place. He felt like he was a step closer to Phainon. Now, they could meet in both the real world and the virtual world every day. It was another step closer to his dreams.

If that damned hindrance Caelus didn't exist, things would be perfect.

After they finished practicing together, Mydei and Phainon sat in the room together drinking tea, resting leisurely and taking the chance to chat.

"Why do you conceal your strength?" Mydei asked uncertainly. "With your strength, it's clear that even at school you could be one of the strongest people, but why do you hide your identity? Those ignorant people even shame you for it."

As soon as Mydei remembered how those people had jeered at Phainon, gloom began to swirl in his heart again. He wished he could get all of those people expelled. In truth, Mydei searched up news about Prince Latiao every day. Every time he saw something bad, he would find the person who posted it and bring them out for a beating.

"Oh, that." Phainon sighed, putting on a desolate expression of a worldly gentleman. "I don't want those people to know my identity... Because I just want to live my school life peacefully without any disturbances as a normal person, not as a prodigy."

If someone else was saying something so pompous to Phainon, Phainon would definitely slap them, but when Mydei heard these words, his eyes sparkled. He sighed with emotion. "Indeed, someone like you naturally has different goals than someone as lowly as us."

Phainon thought about what he had turned his entire mecha into for the sake of advertisement fees. It was totally super lowly, but Mydei was still lavishing praise in a frenzy... Phainon suddenly felt a little embarrassed. Even if he was more shameless he would feel embarrassed, okay.

"Um, I also hoped to ask, what kind of relationship do you have with Caelus?" Mydei asked carefully. "I apologize; I must be terribly annoying. I

already asked yesterday... but I still don't understand why someone as beautiful and strong as you would stay by someone like him."

Fuck, what was up with that sentence! The word "strong" was obviously enough! Mydei's words nearly made Phainon spit out a mouthful of blood... It was his first time hearing someone use the word "beautiful" to describe him in all his years of living. The power of a fan's rose-tinted glasses was simply terrifying.

"It's nothing." Phainon had just managed to get over the shock of those words. He absolutely wouldn't say anything about how he was acting as a servant at the moment, so he explained, "You know too. Back then, I was expelled because of that thing. Caelus was the one who saved me, so to repay him, I stayed by his side to help him out."

"Then you don't have any way to leave?" Mydei said quickly. "If it's about money, I can provide assistance, no matter how much money, it's..."

"That's not necessary, Phainon said. "Life is pretty good like this. There's no need for a change at the moment."

The important thing was that if he didn't stay and keep an eye on Caelus, who knew if he might go crazy and expose the truth that he was an omega.

"I see..." Mydei's face fell.

Sure enough, he hadn't done well enough. If he did enough, why wouldn't Phainon pick him, and instead pick that Caelus guy?

It must be because that Caelus found out Phainon's online identity and used it to force Phainon to stay with him. He was even shameless enough to put up ads to express his love. He obviously wanted to use it to pressure Phainon.

As Mydei went on an imagining spree, Phainon took the rest time to send Caelus a letter under Prince Latiao's name.

In the letter, Phainon said that he liked people who were lowkey and strong. If Caelus could make it to the finals of the empire's real-life mecha competition held every few years, then Phainon would consider dating him.

If Phainon remembered correctly, the real-life mecha competition would begin soon. It could also draw Caelus's attention.

As for the stuff about the finals, Phainon knew very clearly that while Caelus was pretty strong, he wasn't fully grown yet. It was impossible for him to make it to the finals.

After pressing the key to send the letter, Phainon couldn't help feeling very clever.

He had spent enough time online. Phainon said a quick good-bye to Mydei and logged off.

Mydei stayed in his seat, looking at the cup Phainon had drank from. Unconsciously, he picked up the cup, pressing his lips to the edge of the cup gently.

Like this, it was as though he could touch the other person just as closely.

After some time, Mydei returned suddenly to his senses. The hand holding the cup trembled. "What did I just do..."

Everything that happened later went without a hitch.

The next day, when Phainon was still asleep in bed, Caelus dragged him up.

Phainon, still bleary, was pulled to the garden of the duke's residence and began to train with Caelus.

"What's with this?" Phainon yawned, looking dazedly at Caelus.

"I need to make it into the finals of the mecha tournament. To achieve that goal, I have to start training now." Caelus gritted his teeth. "I'll become an

alpha worthy of him."

Phainon: "!" Fuck, Caelus was really going all out for the sake of a letter. It looked like he was really serious...

Although Phainon felt complicated, things progressed smoothly. As expected, Caelus forgot about those lousy online confessions and switched his focus to training for the real-life mecha competition. He even took any time he could get during break time at school to practice with mechas.

Because Phainon had told Mydei not to look for him and be a little more lowkey, Mydei had no choice but to keep himself hidden upstairs.

Seeing Phainon pressed to close to Caelus, Mydei's heart filled with envy, but he couldn't tell Phainon how he felt. He could only use his terminal to take pictures of Phainon training.

Though nobody could talk about how Mydei got down on one knee online, everyone pretty much understood what had happened, and their attitudes towards Phainon changed greatly. Instead of their previous disdain, they would avoid him if they saw him from a distance, like he was a landmine that would explode with the slightest touch.

Although Phainon found it a bit weird, it was fine as long as it was convenient for him. In any case, their attitudes wouldn't affect him at all.

Phainon attended classes in the morning and trained in his free time. At night, he fought in the virtual mecha competition. A dozen days passed as such, and his body was finally much stronger than before... Still, "much stronger" was only relative to his previous strength. After all, omegas were born with limited physical strength. Even if he was impressive, he couldn't train himself up to an alpha's level.

Phainon's goal was to achieve the strength of a beta.

And in the virtual world, Prince Latiao had finally succeeded in making it to the top hundred in the virtual mecha competition. It was enough to enter the finals that would be beginning soon.

Phainon didn't know how many matches he had fought. He encountered terrifying opponents several times.

But they were only terrifying to other people. To Phainon, they weren't very strong, and after several days of combat, Phainon's strength increased rapidly. He was solidly undefeated.

Unwittingly, the number of Prince Latiao's fans skyrocketed. There were many crazy fanboys and fangirls who would praise Prince Latiao madly at all kinds of different places. There were even people who claimed that Prince Latiao's strength was already in the top ten, and that as long as he was given time, he would certainly be able to take first prize.

Because of his fans' words, fans of other competitors were indignant. They would begin to argue time and time again. But even if they slandered Prince Latiao, they could only attack his name and the ads on his mecha. They didn't have the nerve to slander Prince Latiao's strength. After all, Prince Latiao's strength was obvious to anyone with eyes.

Everyone asked Prince Latiao to get a social account for publicity, but Phainon felt that it would expose his identity, so he didn't show any signs of making one.

During this period of time, Prince Latiao's ad-filled mecha actually became a new trend. Many young people stamped a mess of words on their own mechas, feeling very stylish.

The first person to imitate him was actually Mydeimos.

Once, Phainon went to watch one of Mydei's matches. When he sat into the stands and saw Mydei's mecha, he nearly spat out a mouthful of blood.

The kinds of mechas that Mydei piloted were all stylish and bougie. They all made him seem extremely rich and cool.

But now, although he was still using expensive mechas, his coolness was completely gone. There were a bunch of words printed on his mecha, and

looking carefully they were all, shockingly enough, Prince Latiao's name... Mydei even had a design of Phainon's mecha stamped on his mecha...

This was no longer at the level of someone without a sense of beauty. It was simply offending the eye. It was terrible to look at. It was as hair-raising as a brainless fan's work.

No... Mydeimos was a crazy fanboy to begin with.

It was the first time, Phainon, as the person printed on Mydei's mecha, felt so ashamed of his nickname...

And he finally realized how hideous his own mecha was when he piloted it out. Even so, Phainon wouldn't change!

The surrounding crowd was actually used to the terrible style of Mydei's mecha. Phainon had to ask around a bit before he found out that Mydeimos was actually the president of Prince Latiao's fanclub. He was the one who started many trends.

Phainon: "..." In some ways, Mydei was really terrifying.

Because Mydei didn't choose to hide his identity, the view of the inside of his cockpit was projected directly onto the screen in the middle of the arena.

Everyone could see clearly that Mydei was wearing a school uniform. His handsome face was cold and he looked at his opponent carelessly, as though he didn't take his opponent seriously at all.

His opponent was infuriated by Mydei's gaze instantly. He pulled out his weapon, rushing him furiously.

"Too weak." Mydei shook his head, but he thought of Phainon. "If it was that person, his movements wouldn't be so slow." After fighting with Phainon, these people's strength was nothing to him. "If it was that person, he would already be in front of me..."

Mydei's mind was filled with the scene of Phainon teaching him. He didn't have any patience for the fight before his eyes and stabbed through his

opponent's cockpit without the slightest hesitation.

"Fighting with people like this is simply a waste of my time," Mydei thought coldly.

Phainon almost felt like he couldn't recognize that this was the same Mydei that had been following him recently. After all, the way Mydei acted with him was too different from the way he acted with other people.

When the match ended, the two of them met up in front of Mydei's house.

"I saw your match just now," Phainon said.

Mydei was stunned. His turned his face shyly. He said gruffly, "I... Just now I didn't even perform very well. You actually saw such a failure..."

"It's okay, I think you're great," Phainon said. "You were really cool when you were fighting, your opponent couldn't match up to you at all."

Phainon really felt that way. Besides, in the original novel, Mydei was truly strong. Moreover, he was currently even more powerful than Khaslana... He rescued Phainon who nearly had to go have Khaslana as his capture target.

Mydei froze. He felt like something had struck him right in the heart.

He had been praised by Phainon. Mydei felt like there would never be another moment so happy again. He didn't react for a long time, his deep green eyes filled with joy. He looked at Phainon earnestly. "Thank you very much. That you approve of me... I'm incredibly happy."

He was so happy that he would rather this moment never ended.

After he logged off, Mydei opened his eyes within the nutrient cabin.

The room that was once bare and plain, now had pictures pasted all over the walls. The person in every one of the pictures was, naturally, Phainon.

The pictures were all pictures that Mydei had taken of Phainon behind his back recently. He had taken so many, but he couldn't bear to delete any of

them.

Mydei crawled out of the nutrient cabin and walked over to the wall. There was a live-size picture of Phainon. It was as though he was really there.

Mydei reached out and pressed his hand to where Phainon's hand was. He rested his forehead against the wall, his eyes full of infatuation.

In the next moment, he caught sight of Caelus in the corner of the picture.

"There's always some people in the way who shouldn't exist..." His eyes turned as cold as ice. "It's obvious that having me alone at his side is enough. There's no need for anyone extra."

A few days later, the finals of the virtual mecha competition began.

The finals were different from the preliminary competitions. It was no longer a point system. Instead, everyone was divided into ten groups, and within the groups everyone would fight with each other to select the best results. In the end, the ten remaining people would enter the real finals.

At this point, every contestant would earn five percent of the earnings from ticket to their matches. Though the people at this ranking typically didn't value that little bit of money, it was still a symbol of glory.

Phainon felt great emotion for the officials' sense. Although he was already a wealthy man with a million empire coins, this little bit of money was nothing on the capital planet.

If he didn't have this many opponents, Phainon would wish that he could fight a dozen matches every day.

But Mydei gave up on the chance to participate in the finals. Recently, he had less and less interest in fighting with these people. He might as well say that other than fighting with Phainon, everything was dull.

Mydei felt that rather than wasting his time on the competition, he should just take the time to watch Phainon compete and let himself get a bit more excited.

Of course, it would be worth celebrating if he got to fight Phainon in the finals, but Mydei didn't want to become an obstacle in Phainon's path forward. Even if it was unlikely to be in the same group was small, he wasn't willing to take that chance.

All contestants were required to attend the opening ceremony of the finals. Normally, many contestants who never appeared in public would show their true faces. After all, this was something honorable.

Of course, if they didn't want to reveal themselves they could put on a mosaic.

Phainon really, really wanted to show off in front of so many people, but he absolutely couldn't reveal his identity, so he had to reluctantly put on a mosaic, feeling like the entire world had turned gloomy.

Everyone was disappointed. They had thought that they could see Prince Latiao's real face. They started guessing why Prince Latiao was hiding his identity.

What the people of the empire prized the most was strength. Even if someone was ugly, everyone would accept it. Out of the people who entered the finals, there were several unattractive contestants, but they still had plenty of fans.

So there weren't many people who guessed that Prince Latiao had a mosaic to hide his face. Most people thought that he had an identity that he couldn't publicize, like being a noble or a member of the imperial family or something.

But Khaslana felt that it was about time, and revealed his own face at the finals.

Immediately, the crowd began to stir. Nobody had expected God Time to be such a handsome man. His every smile had an effect on their hearts.

If he was strong, fine, but being strong and being so attractive, and being so attractive while still being so young, this was hard to come by! Khaslana quickly gained a sizable number of fans.

At the empire's military institute, the students were also stupefied. The people at the school would naturally pay attention to the virtual mecha competition, and they all had their own favored contestants. Because of his broken techniques, God Time had naturally gained many of them as fans.

Now that everyone knew Khaslana was actually the legendary God Time, they were completely and utterly stunned.

Those who didn't get how Khaslana became close friends with Mydeimos suddenly understood. They must have met at a match... Damn it! They wanted to be God Time's bro too!

When Phainon went to school the next day, he spotted Khaslana in the middle of a crowd. Everyone was staring at him with admiration, asking for autographs one after another and lavishing praise on him.

But Khaslana's expression was as calm as always. He looked at everyone with a slight smile. "Guys, there's no need to hurry. Let's take it slow. I'll sign an autograph for everyone. I just got lucky, I'm not that strong. There's no need to care so much about me either."

His gentle manner allowed many of them to sink into the trap. With the addition of Khaslana's protagonist halo, he gained several people who were willing to act as his underlings in seconds.

But when Phainon walked over, everyone's gazes turned strange. Everyone knew that after Phainon first jeered at Khaslana there was no way for him to come back out with his head held high, but Phainon went straight to give them a slap in their faces.

But in the few days before at the combat training lesson, Phainon won over Khaslana with sheer dumb luck. Although the process was amusing, it wouldn't change the result of the victory.

When they thought about how this useless beta had managed to use such a reason to be victorious over their amazing God Time, everyone's mood turned complicated.

Someone who could enter the finals of the virtual mecha competition wasn't a normal person. There were numerous strong people vying for a spot. Moreover, Khaslana was just a student. It was easy to imagine his bright future.

After a short internal struggle, nobody could be bothered to pay attention to Phainon. They continued to praise Khaslana. Who had the time to care about a passerby? It was more important to build a good relationship with Khaslana, who seemed easy to talk to.

But Mydei was hidden away, watching them ignore Phainon as such. His fingers were practically digging into the post. When the surroundings cleared of people, he finally rushed down to Phainon. "Don't bother with those people. They don't have an eye for talent. To me, you're the most amazing."

"I don't care, but shouldn't you go congratulate Khaslana a little?" Phainon said. "Recently I think you and Khaslana haven't been spending as much time together."

Mydei looked as though he had just realized something. "Oh, I've always been paying attention to you recently. I forgot about communicating with him for a while."

Mydei spent most of his time salivating over Phainon's videos and pictures. Where would he find the time to go talk with Khaslana?

Phainon was stunned. "!" Hey, is this really no big deal?

In the most central region of the capital planet, Anaxagoras was sitting next to the window, his head lowered and his eyes focused on the papers on Prince Latiao that he was holding.

After an investigation by his subordinates, while the materials on Prince Latiao were significantly greater than before, there was still nothing on his true identity. They could only get reports about his mecha piloting habits, what kind of ads he liked (...), and all kinds of completely useless things.

When he thought about how his little brother had actually come out of the closet on the virtual net a few days ago, and that the person he had come out of the closet for was Prince Latiao, Anaxa felt his head ache.

The duke and duchess were both travelling on other planets, but Anaxa couldn't go back home because of business. He didn't expect that just leaving his little brother alone for a month would give him the chance to make such a big mess. Anaxagoras had no idea how he would face his parents.

Why would his little brother, who didn't take a second glance at anyone lower than him, suddenly fall in love with an alpha of unknown identity? What in the world happened when Anaxa was gone?

Even His Highness the Crown Prince was focused on news about that person... Anaxas suddenly had a thought. His own little brother wouldn't become His Highness the Crown Prince's enemy by accident, would he?

No, it was impossible. Even if His Highness the Crown Prince paid more attention to Prince Latiao recently, how could anyone like someone who didn't even show his face? He must be thinking too much.

After he finished thinking, Anaxa furrowed his eyebrows and looked down at his hands. "You can only find this much? Who in the world is this Prince Latiao? There are even such open permissions. It can't be that even the central computer can't find him?"

"We have no way to search the central computer or find the details of his location," the subordinate bent on one knee at the side said hurriedly. "But

we finally did everything possible and locked onto his approximate location. This shouldn't be wrong."

"Oh? Go ahead and say it." Anaxa raised an eyebrow, looking over.

"Prince Latiao's location is exactly in the direction of the capital planet's academic district. But we couldn't find any more details," the subordinate said.

"Very good, he's actually over there... That Prince Latiao must be a student here." Anaxagoras glanced in the direction of the academic district. "There are only a few schools there. Finding one person is still so difficult?"

When he thought about his little brother, who was still in the academic district, Anaxagoras suddenly realized that Prince Latiao might have connections with his little brother in reality.

"It looks like I need to make a trip personally."

Chapter End Notes

> The Author has something to say:
> Yay! New update! This was supposed to come out yesterday but i have an exam coming up so i forgot about it. Wish me luck!

Chapter 9: The Omega Inhibitors Failed

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

After Khaslana's identity was revealed, the way he was treated at school changed immediately. He had many more followers and there were even several retired teachers who came looking for Khaslana to give him extra lessons.

Back in the day, these teachers were heroes of the battlefield. They would treat even princes with cool attitudes, but the way Khaslana made his way into the finals using an outdated mecha spurred them into action. And when the school learned of Khaslana's family circumstances, they immediately exempted him from the high tuition fees and even gave Khaslana the highest scholarship... Although Khaslana wasn't impoverished anymore.

Though Phainon changed the plot quite a bit after arriving and caused two of the important people in the original novel to be less fervent around Khaslana compared to the original plotline, the story still continued to develop along its original path.

On website in the virtual world, the hottest topic was how the real face behind God Time was a shockingly handsome man. Khaslana was basically the man of the hour in both reality and in the virtual world.

Under these circumstances, as someone who had never been close to Khaslana, Phainon's situation was getting dangerous.

Phainon even thought that Khaslana would target him on purpose. He didn't expect that Khaslana would act as though he had forgotten the enmity between them. When they met, he would say a proper hello. He didn't mock Phainon for what had happened in the past, either.

Thus everyone applauded Khaslana for his benevolence. He could even forgive someone who had mocked him so easily.

In contrast, Phainon felt even more uneasy. "..." Khaslana just wasn't the kind of guy who could forget grievances so easily, okay? He was definitely brewing up some big move.

And there was another thing that made Phainon feel a bit conflicted. Recently, whenever he was training, he would suddenly get dizzy. Several times, he had nearly fallen down because of his vertigo. The nape of his neck would often start feeling hot.

Phainon hadn't thought much about it at first. But once when Mydei sat at his side, he leaned in unconsciously, his voice casual and low. "Your scent smells so fragrant..." Phainon was suddenly shocked to his senses. He was so shocked that he shot to his feet.

With what he remembered of this scary ABO novel's setting, the nape was where an omega's scent gland was, fuck! And Mydeimos was an alpha. This was very bad, very very bad.

Mydei realized what was happening. He immediately apologized. "I truly apologize; I've been offensive to you."

"It's nothing." Phainon waved a hand, but he felt a bit uncomfortable Could it be that his omega inhibitors were starting to lose effect...

Although he hadn't been bitten by an alpha or anything, pushing his limits with training every day might have affected his inhibitors...

[Host is exactly right. The omega inhibitors you've been using have indeed been slowly losing efficacy. At most, after a week, the effect will completely disappear.]

This time the problem is terrible, okay!!

As soon as he imagined what it would be like if his status as an omega was revealed to the school, Phainon felt uncomfortable all over. Being expelled from school was just a small thing. Being discovered by Caelus was the scariest thing. Caelus would definitely feel like he got cheated and retaliate against him in fury.

Phainon immediately got ready to ask for leave and go home for a few days to ask the original host's mother and father how he should fix it.

Meanwhile, Anaxagoras pretty much understood what his little brother had been doing these last few days.

"The teenager he captured has been staying at our house as a servant? Anaxa said disbelievingly. He really couldn't understand what Caelus was thinking. Based on his understanding of Caelus, it was already pretty good if he didn't beat someone he didn't like half to death. He had actually let the other person stay at home for days?

Although he was called a servant, with the other party's background, it was something good, not a punishment.

"No... I have to investigate this person." Anaxa felt there must be something he hadn't noticed.

His subordinate quickly sent Phainon's information over.

The first half of the files were very standard. In summary, he was a beta from an impoverished noble family and managed to get in the institute with the help of some connections. He drifted through his school days, and even taunted Khaslana.

But in the second half, things suddenly began to change. This male beta had shockingly been expelled because he peeped in the male baths (in all his years of life, it was Anaxa's first time hearing of such a reason for being expelled), but he later returned to school with the help of Caelus. After that, he sucked up to the crown prince's younger cousin Mydeimos, and even defeated Khaslana in the mecha battlefield.

"He was able to defeat the Khaslana? He's just a beta. How in the world did he do it?" Anaxa was stunned. He immediately began to think about whether Phainon might be Prince Latiao in the virtual world.

Anaxa pulled up the video from the mecha combat lesson to take a look.

Back then, all of the people in the crowd were just students. They didn't notice the details of the battle. On top of that, they didn't have much of an eye for things, so naturally they couldn't see the truth. But Anaxa saw the issue acutely.

"In the first half, his performance was absolutely disappointing, but in the middle he suddenly changed. Even his dodging became smoother, and he managed to win like this... Could it be that this Phainon person and Prince Latiao have some relation?"

After he returned home, Caelus and Phainon spotted Anaxagoras sitting in the living room. Caelus's expression changed immediately. When he thought about the dumb shit he had been doing recently, he obediently called, "Gege."

Anaxa clearly looked like he wanted to teach his brother a lesson. "So you still remember I'm your brother?"

Phainon was shocked. He didn't expect he would be able to see Anaxa. He thought that this house was just Caelus's. Phainon started thinking about how to explain being a manservant to Anaxa. Finally, he decided it was too much of a hassle. He stood behind Caelus, playing dead.

"You must be Phainon?" Anaxa turned to look at him.

Phainon was given a shock. He nodded quickly. "Yes, I'm Phainon."

In the original novel, although Anaxagoras was good-tempered and didn't have as much attack power as the other characters, for better or worse he was still the heir of the duke's title, and he absolutely wasn't as easy to get along with as he seemed on the surface. In fact, he was incredibly two-faced.

In comparison, while Caelus was a bit more cocky and would curse someone out at the drop of a hat or capture someone to give them a whipping over a disagreement, for better or worse he was easy to understand. Phainon could feel more at ease with him.

"It's really been hard on you to take care of our family’s Caelus so far," Anaxa said. "I'll have to trouble you to continue taking care of him in the future."

"I don't need anyone to take care of me," Caelus said.

Phainon hurriedly nodded. He saw that they both looked like they wanted to say something. "If there's nothing else, I'll leave first."

Caelus snorted. "If you're going, go quickly. Don't forget to come back down for dinner."

Phainon rushed upstairs. The two brothers went to the study to converse.

"Ge, how come you came back so quickly?" Caelus said uncertainly. "Didn't you say you'd be gone for a year?"

"I came back because something happened. It's lucky I came back, or who knows what kind of mess you'd kick up." Anaxa said coolly. "What's between you and Phainon? Why did you decide to let him stay?"

Caelus's expression didn't change. He said, "He offended me, so to compensate I had him stay for a bit as a servant."

Anaxa said, "Then how long will he work?"

"I haven't decided," Caelus said very calmly.

"..." Anaxa rested his forehead in his hands. He said, "Don't you hate betas? What is it about this beta that makes you see him in a different light?"

Caelus thought for a long time, then said, "Maybe it's because he's got more sense. I feel like he's better than other betas."

Anaxa was also wondering why his little brother didn't get beaten to death. "...Why did you confess to Prince Latiao online? Do you know how much of a hassle this brought our family?"

Because of it, there weren't many people who would get close to Anaxagoras recently. After all, everyone thought that since the younger brother was a gay who liked alphas, the older brother might just have the same problem. It made things indescribably difficult for Anaxa.

"Because I like him," Caelus said without the slightest hesitation. Although he secretly knew Prince Latiao was an omega, he wouldn't say it.

"Alright. In fact, I don't want to bother with managing you." Anaxa's head was beginning to ache. "But do you know what he really looks like? Does it matter if he's a big, tall, muscular man or if he's an old man?"

"Of course he won't look like that!" Caelus said huffily. "My future partner's very normal!"

"Are you saying you've already met him in reality?" Anaxa's voice suddenly turned cold. "Like Phainon from just now. What's his relationship with Prince Latiao?"

"Impossible." Caelus was stunned for a moment. "Ge, don't joke around. How could Phainon have any relationship with Prince Latiao? They probably haven't even met."

"Then how did he win against Khaslana? You're Khaslana's fan, you should be very clear about his strength, right?" Anaxa looked straight at Caelus. He said, "Are you hiding something from me?"

"No, of course not," Caelus said. "Phainon just got lucky. Normally, he isn't that strong..."

Despite what he said, Caelus felt a bit strange. Things really were like that. Even if Phainon got even luckier, it was too much of a coincidence...

"You've realized yourself that there's something strange, haven't you?" Anaxa studied Caelus's expression. He said slowly, "In that case, use your own eyes and take a look. I'm not saying that Phainon and Prince Latiao definitely have some relationship, but he definitely isn't as useless as he seems. Don't have too much faith in other people."

Caelus couldn't even retort. He thought back to the things that he had discovered, and it seemed that he really had overlooked some things. And the thing that confused him the most was that stuff with Mydeimos. Something he didn't know about must have happened between them.

Caelus gritted his teeth. "I'll look over it carefully. I'll see what exactly he's hiding from me."

Phainon took leave easily. After all, he was just a manservant, not selling his body. Of course there would be no problem going back home to see his parents. And Phainon didn't even need to pack his luggage. He went straight to the port to take an airship back home.

As an impoverished noble family, Phainon's family naturally didn't live in the capital planet. They lived in another planet in the same galaxy. There was an airship that left for that planet at the same time every day. It only took a few hours there and back, and it was incredibly convenient.

When he arrived at the gate, Phainon ran into Mydei, who had been waiting inside for a long time.

"Why would you be here?" Phainon was given a shock. How did Mydei know he was leaving? He didn't say a thing.

"I was worried about letting you leave alone," Mydei said, "so I bought my own ticket and came. I truly apologize."

Phainon said, "But don't you still need to go to class?"

"There's no need for something like that. I already took leave," Mydei said calmly. "Compared to being in class, I would rather go with you. If something happens, I'll be able to help immediately."

Phainon didn't feel any need to turn him down, so he said, "Okay then. You can just come along..." It was nice for Mydei to be with him. If something happened and he couldn't go online, he could still accomplish his daily task."

Before Mydei arrived, he bought a ticket for the best room in the highest grade airship. Phainon was originally planning to squeeze into some random airship. Now that he saw there was such a good seat, he went straight to get his original ticket refunded.

After getting on the airship, the two of them waited in the room. After all, Mydei had spent a good sum of money. It was incredibly comfortable and there was even a view out the window and a meal provided.

When the flight was half over, Phainon needed to use the bathroom. When he walked out and opened the door to the hallway, he crashed straight into a teenager.

The teenager had blonde hair pale enough to be white and a delicate, pretty face. His looks could put anyone at ease, but his current expression was horrible. When he ran into Phainon, he fell straight down.

Phainon: "!" He just wanted to use the bathroom, why did he encounter this kind of situation?

And he didn't look like a normal person either. Of course... how could someone who could afford a VIP seat in an airship be a normal person. If he was some amazing noble, if something happened he wouldn't be able to pay for it even if he sold himself.

Phainon panicked. He bent over to see how he was doing.

But he saw the teenager frown. His forehead was full of cold sweat. He looked like he in a rough state.

"Crap, his situation looks really serious." Phainon didn't think he was doing very well, and remembered the ability he hadn't used for a long time. He gritted his teeth. "Well, we're all humans here. Nothing will happen if I use it."

The Zerg from the last world had really set him up.

Phainon grabbed the teenager's hand, sending his ability into his body.

The teenager who had been frowning immediately relaxed. His bloodless face slowly regained its color-but it didn't stop there. His cheeks gradually flushed red, and his body began to grow hot. He unconsciously nuzzled Phainon from inside his arms.

Phainon: "...?!" The fuck, why did this person get so excited after a little bit of healing?!

[The answer is simple. It's because the other person isn't human, or rather he isn't fully human.]

It was just a moment, but Phainon remembered that this novel still had Zerg as the villains in the middle.

The Zerg in this novel were much more dangerous than the Zerg in the previous world. There were many Zerg who pretended to be humans and mixed into society, and they had masked themselves for several years already. There were many who even married humans and had children. Plenty of Zerg hid even on the capital planet.

In the original novel, these Zerg were the same people who began to attack humans madly. Khaslana fought his hardest and was finally able to rescue everyone. His reputation rose another level. But the crown prince Nanook did nothing, so he lost much of the people's support.

It was totally unrealistic. Even if Nanooks really didn't do anything, he would find a couple of people to come and praise himself, alright? In any case, there wouldn't be anyone who would go investigate whether the crown prince really didn't do anything.

At first, Phainon felt that the villain was very far from him, but now he had discovered that the Zerg was right at his side.

But Phainon couldn't say anything about the Zerg, because with the progression of the original novel, humans hadn't discovered anything about it. If he said it aloud, it would be a spoiler. The world consciousness would obliterate him.

He spotted the Zerg teenager stirring on the ground. Phainon propped him right against the wall, running back to his room.

Anyway, he would just pretend nothing had happened.

As for what the Zerg in heat would do, Phainon wouldn't bother with it.

After a few hours on the airship, they finally arrived.

Now that Phainon thought about it, it was his first time going home after transmigrating into this world for so long.

Although his family was already poor, for better or worse they were a noble family. They still had their ancestral home located in a planet in the outskirts of the capital. Housing was much cheaper too.

Mydei had no idea what had happened during the flight. He followed after Phainon like an obedient daughter-in-law, looking shy.

When Phainon pushed open the door, he finally saw his body's parents.

People of the future had long lifespans, and they aged slowly. The original host's parents looked quite young. It actually felt very strange. These two people looked very different from Phainon's real parents, but when he first saw them he felt very close to them.

It was probably the original body's pre-installed feelings.

Hieronymus and Audata were both people who doted on their child. Since their child had been away for so long, when they saw Phainon they pulled him over to look over him carefully, insisting that Phainon had gotten too thin. In fact, after eating well and drinking well and training for several days, Phainon's body was in much better condition than before.

Then Hieronymus saw Mydeimos behind him. "And this is...?"

Because he was meeting Phainon's parents today, Mydei was wearing extremely formal clothes. Combined with his bearing and his incredibly attractive face, it was obvious at a glance that he wasn't a normal person.

"Hello, Aunt, Uncle, I-I'm..." Mydei was extremely nervous. When he was facing His Majesty the Emperor he was completely calm, but in front of Phainon's parents, he couldn't even speak.

"This is my friend Mydeimos. He goes to the same school as me. Since he was worried about me traveling by myself, he came along." Phainon didn't mention Mydei's status at all, feeling it would be bothersome to mention.

"Oh, our child has such a good friend! It's such a surprise." Audata looked at Mydei with great emotion. She had a maidservant bring him to put his things down in the guest room. Although they weren't wealthy, there were still several maidservants. For the most part, they were beta girls from some poor families in the area.

At night, the four of them ate together at a restaurant.

Audata asked Mydei about how Phainon was doing at school. As soon as they started talking about Phainon, the shy Mydei turned fervent. Although his face was calm, anyone could tell how excited he was almost as if there was a glow surrounding him. He kept praising Phainon, making Phainon seem like the most amazing student in the school.

Phainon listened to their conversation, feeling embarrassed. He didn't know what exactly Mydei was saying.

But which parent didn't like hearing their child being praised? They liked Mydei more and more, so much that Phainon suspected they were looking at their daughter-in-law... Phainon quickly banished the thought from his mind.

Soon, Audata asked Phainon about what had happened recently. She had been horrified to find out that he had been expelled, then he had gone back. What exactly had happened?

Phainon remembered how awkward the situation was when he had been expelled and avoided the topic, turning the subject onto a better direction and completely skipping over how Caelus had him whipped. He said that he had been rescued by the kind-hearted Caelus.

Mydei's mood sank as he listened.

"Oh, that's the child of the duke. He has so much compassion." Audata was moved. "We have to make sure to go thank him."

Phainon said hastily, "There's no need, I'm still at Caelus's house as a servant..."

Normally being a servant was embarrassing, but it was being a duke's servant. Someone could even brag about it. Audata and Hieronymus looked honored. Mydei felt even more uncomfortable. A scumbag like Caelus was able to make Phainon's parents regard him so highly. Mydei had to work hard too. But he had already promised Phainon not to reveal his identity. Mydei prepared to fight from a different front.

Late at night, after Mydei went to sleep, Audata and Hieronymus called Phainon in and they began to discuss serious matters in another room. Phainon went straight to the main topic, his expression ugly. The omega inhibitors he was using seemed like they were about to be ineffective.

Hieronymus's expression sank. "God, these inhibitors are technically banned. When we bought them, they told us they weren't stable. It's already lucky that you could use them for so many years."

Audata sighed, wiping her tears. "If I wasn't so useless, you wouldn't have to endure such hardships. You could be just like other omegas, growing up well at home and marrying and having children. It wouldn't be like this, acting like a beta all the time."

Phainon said quickly, "You guys don't need to be sad. I think it's great this way." If he really married and had children like a normal omega he would be peeing his pants in fear, okay?

"We were too paranoid in the past. Thinking about it now, the title of duke isn't worth anything much. Why don't you quit school and come back?" Hieronymus muttered to himself. "Other omegas around your age are already starting to look at partners. It's not too late for you. It just so happens that I've been paying attention to unmarried alphas."

"Right, and that Mydeimos who came with you this time is pretty good. He looks like he cares about our little Phainon a lot."

Wait, the reason he came back was to continue suppressing it, not to get hurried into a marriage! It absolutely wasn't to let his parents take a look at Mydei!

If they really had Phainon go on arranged blind dates, he might as well kill himself.

"I've grown up as a beta, I don't want to be an omega anymore either." Phainon gritted his teeth. "And I always helped out at the duke's house as a beta. If Caelus discovers that I was deceiving him, he definitely won't spare me."

If the first part could be considered a child not seeing eye-to-eye with his parents and ignoring their words, the second half was a critical blow. After all, that was the duke.

Hieronymus and Audata were confronted with reality. They quickly abandoned the idea of having Phainon come home for blind dates and went to inquire about how they could continue using the inhibitors.

Phainon let out a breath of relief. He didn't expect that he would use Caelus as an excuse one day.

After he returned to his room, Phainon got in bed and went to sleep. There was only one match a day in the virtual mecha competition. There were still several days before it was his turn to fight, so he would just take the chance to rest up and recharge.

When he woke up the next day, Phainon crawled out of bed lazily, yawning as he went downstairs. He spotted Mydei wearing an apron, a plate in his hands. His face was impassive but the faint blush on his ear gave away his embarrassment.

Phainon was so shocked his jaw nearly fell off. "....?!"

Audata beamed, coming to Phainon to say, "What a good kid. He woke up early to help out and even asked about what you like to eat and made a big breakfast... This is my very first time seeing an alpha that knows how to cook."

Mydei looked embarrassment. "This isn't anything much, I made too little."

"Oh, child, you're too modest. Our Little Phainon's only ever known how to play around. I don't even know if he studied properly at school."

As soon as she mentioned Phainon, Mydei turned serious. Unexpectedly, he began to explain to Audata how Phainon hadn't been playing around and just how serious and inspiring he was. All the praises he sang yesterday were being repeated.

The more Audata listened, the happier she got. If it wasn't for what Phainon had said yesterday, she would have promised Phainon to Mydei then and there.

Phainon sank into a sea of fear. "..." Fuck, how did he not know that Mydei was so good at sucking up to people's parents.

The way Audata and Hieronymus looked at Mydei was already like the gaze they would use to look at a son-in-law. Luckily Mydei didn't know that Phainon was an omega, so he didn't notice there was anything wrong. He just thought that Phainon's parents were very kind.

After they finished eating, Mydei dashed to the kitchen to deliberate what to make for lunch... Such kindness was terrifying.

Besides, based on what was in the original novel, Mydei was still a young master who had never even touched impure water, these skills came late in life. Could it be that he had practiced these skills out of his own will, wanting to be Phainon's follower? ...Phainon suddenly felt a bit confused, still feeling that there was something weird about how Mydei was working hard.

Phainon simply came back to his room. The three of them continued to discuss yesterday's topic, their expressions serious.

Hieronymus sighed. "I went and asked. The inhibitors we bought back then can only be used once. If they're used a second time, it will cause severe harm to the body. It might cause you to be infertile for the rest of your life, so we can't use it a second time."

Phainon: "..." Fuck, that's awesome, that harm is great!

But Phainon thought it over some more and realized that it might cause his physical ability to be even worse. If he took it, he might not be able to pilot a mecha for even three minutes. He quickly tossed this method aside.

"And if we want to buy it, we might not even be able to get it." As he spoke, Hieronymus pulled out a bottle. "Luckily, in the beginning I thought there might be an accident, so I bought a bottle of medicine. This medicine can temporarily suppress an omega's scent. One pill can probably last for a week..."

Phainon took the bottle, relaxing. It would be enough to last for a few months. If the plot went ahead as it should, his identity wouldn't be revealed before he left this world.

Immediately, Audata sighed, putting a hand on Phainon's shoulder. "When you finish this medicine, why don't you come home like a good child? We'll just leave this galaxy. Even a duke won't know anything's wrong... Let's start anew."

"Okay..." Phainon nodded, feeling a bit sorrowful. They didn't know that the original host had already died a long time ago, and when he finished his task he would leave this world.

Luckily Phainon still had his healing ability. He planned to use it to heal Audata and let them have another child. In the future, they would slowly forget the pain of their first child.

At that moment, there was a sudden noise from the door.

Phainon's heart turned to ice. He rushed forward to push open the door, but he crashed into Mydei, who was in a trance. The tray he was holding fell to the ground, the snacks on it flying everywhere. He must have been about to bring in the snacks, but by coincidence he heard what they were saying.

While he was in side, Phainon had thought of plenty of dramatic soap opera plotlines that were always burst to pieces by other people, he didn't expect that something like this would really happen to him.

"Did you hear everything we just said?"

Chapter End Notes

> The Author has something to say:
> Things are getting thrilling! Hello! Hello! Another reveal I'm sure you all have been waiting for, I hope it lived up to your expectation. I had a lot of fun with house wife Mydei and his idol Phainon XD. We also got to meet the parents! I haven't played Amphoreus as I had to delete the game due to storage issues so I haven't met them personally so I apologize for any ooc behavior.
>
> Also i am currently working on another fic on the side and wanted your opinion. Which do you prefer?
> Sadistic and Seductive Predator Ratio x Pretending to be Stoic Aventurine or Sadistic, Cruel and Seductive Aventurine x Stoic but Internally Rake Ratio Who’s Bordering on Sociopathy

Chapter 10: I’ve Found You

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

If he didn't still have his task to do, Phainon would have gone straight for the throat to silence him.

Mydei said, "Yes, I heard everything."

After his shock, Mydei went calm. He finally understood why Phainon had always hidden his identity. It was because Phainon was actually an omega. He couldn't be too flamboyant or he would draw all kinds of troubles.

After he understood, Mydei admired Phainon even more. As an omega, he could actually make it so far. He was even more amazing than an alpha.

Only someone like his idol could achieve a level that even alphas couldn't attain as an omega.

As a fanboy, he had to be biased towards his idol no matter what.

Mydei immediately said, "No matter what happens, my way of thinking won't change. I absolutely won't say anything about this."

Phainon sighed. He said, "The reason I never told you this isn't because I didn't trust you. It's just that if this gets out it'll be big trouble... Do you really not care? An alpha being the one to woo an omega... It's just ridiculous, isn't it?"

In this world, there were a ton of alphas who looked down on omegas. They thought omegas could only stay at home, taking care of children... For some people, as soon as they knew their genders, even if they were close before, their attitudes would change.

Of course, Phainon didn't have any prior experience with something like that. Everything he said was just based on his impression of the original novel. After all, in the original novel, omegas were really just pretty, useless flower vases.

"No, you are you. Even if you're an omega, my desire to woo you hasn't changed at all." As though he was afraid Phainon wouldn't believe him, he got down on one knee, looking into Phainon's eyes. "Gender or anything like that wouldn't affect anything. My intentions will never change."

The first time Phainon saw Mydei get on one knee, he was scared silly, but now he felt a bit used to it. But the previous two times were both when Mydei didn't know his gender. Now that he knew his real gender, it was obvious what Mydei thought about the situation.

When he saw Phainon hesitate, Mydei bit his lip. Internally, he knew that if he answered wrong, Phainon might not have the same faith in him anymore. His mind flew into a panic. He grabbed Phainon's hand.

"I'm willing to sign a contract. If I say anything about this, I'll never fight with a mecha again... If I do this, might you be able to believe me?"

Phainon was stunned. After all, Mydei had such a high status. Phainon himself had suspected that he had simply been humiliating Mydei... But Mydei was even willing to make such a concession. If Phainon was Mydei, he would have walked away without looking back.

He knew very clearly what mechas meant to Mydei. Being, shockingly enough, willing to write such a contract... It was enough to see how resolute Mydei was.

In that moment, Phainon felt a bit emotional, though his emotion was worth absolutely nothing.

Mydei was perfectly happy to do it. Ever since he met Phainon, he felt more and more like he had found the goal he was chasing after. If he couldn't stay at Phainon's side anymore, he would feel terror in the depths of his heart.

Compared to Phainon, even if he used to like mechas, they were incredibly boring now... If his opponent wasn't Phainon, even if he could continue piloting mechas, he couldn't feel happy at all.

"I believe you." Phainon inhaled deeply. "Let's pretend nothing happened at all and just go about our lives normally when we go back to school."

In any case, even if Phainon was still a bit skeptical, he couldn't really beat Mydei to death... It was really a hopeless situation.

"Alright." Mydei's eyes gleamed. He said, "Then I'll continue preparing snacks for you."

Phainon: "...!" Hey, is it really okay to have such wifely virtue!

And so things were resolved as such. After all, education was very important. That afternoon, the two of them got on the airship, returning to the capital planet. On their trip, there weren't any accidents like what had happened on the way out of the capital.

Phainon felt he had been a bit mean. He just tossed a Zerg in heat outside. If that person was really crazy in heat, he might have even been seized by police.

Still, Phainon hadn't heard anything about a youth assaulting someone on an airship. It should be all fine.

Soon, Phainon and Mydei separated. Mydei's worry was obvious, but he didn't say anything.

When Phainon went back to Caelus's house, he discovered that Anaxagoras had already left. Phainon let out a breath of relief. He wasn't really used to a character like Anaxagoras. He always felt like he was being seen through.

Although he hadn't done anything to feel guilty about, either.

Caelus was reclining on the sofa, his ash gray hair like a Grey Catbird's feathers, his almond-shaped eyes fixed on Phainon. His elegant facial features were full of arrogance.

Phainon sighed emotionally. Despite his terrible temper, Caelus was extremely attractive.

"You were gone for a long time. Weren't you just going home for a bit? There was nothing big happening." Caelus was fuming. "Do you know how much trouble you caused me being away these days?"

Wasn't the only thing missing someone to feed you at lunch! Can't you get used to eating by yourself!

"It was all my fault, I'm truly sorry." Phainon knew how to deal with Caelus. Anyway, he could think about whether it was really his fault after he apologized... And with the system's plug-in, Phainon's apology sounded extremely sincere.

"Hmph." As expected, Caelus didn't spit out anymore venom. He just said, "I've been training hard recently, I think I've gotten much stronger. Do you think if I participate in the upcoming mecha competition I can make it to the finals?"

The mecha competition in reality was much more of a hassle than the mecha competition in the virtual world. Registering alone had many procedures, and it was impossible to completely hide identities like on the virtual net.

Similarly, getting hurt in the competition was a real injury. Of course, these competitions were more prestigious than competitions on the virtual net.

Obviously, Caelus wasn't asking to hear Phainon's opinion. He was looking to hear praise first.

Even more falsely, Phainon praised, "I'm sure that with your abilities you'll definitely be able to make it to the finals. Nobody else can compete with you!"

"Well, of course." Caelus looked satisfied. Suddenly, he added, "Say, aren't you curious about why I'm participating in the mecha competition?"

"Huh?" Phainon was confused. "You need some other reason to participate?"

Though he was very clear about why Caelus wanted to participate, he definitely wouldn't act like he knew

"It's got nothing to do with you. Go away." Caelus looked annoyed.

Phainon: "..." Why the heck did Caelus seem even more bothersome to deal with? Was it because he had fallen in love... Well, it didn't have anything to do with him.

Phainon turned away, making to head up the stairs. Tonight was Prince Latiao's first match in the finals. He still had to get ready properly.

"Wait." Caelus suddenly spoke again. "I'm going to go train today, so don't do anything, just go with me. You look too weak to stand a gust of wind. If you don't train properly, I'll be embarrassed to take you to school."

Phainon: "Oh, um..." Wait, he had an important competition tonight! And Caelus wasn't watching, but was instead going to train? Phainon had the feeling that he might be scheming something bad.

"Don't tell me that you have something tonight and you can't come?" Caelus looked casual.

"Oh, um, I want to watch the mecha competition finals. Isn't Prince Latiao fighting tonight?" Phainon didn't think there was anything worth covering up, so he didn't beat around the bush. "Isn't he the contestant you're cheering for? Aren't you going to watch tonight?"

"Now that I think about it, is there something about Prince Latiao that you know and I don't know?" Caelus said. "After all, I don't really like interacting with people. I'm not very clear about what happens on the virtual net."

I already know you don't have friends...

Phainon bolstered his shamelessness and boasted, "Oh, if it's about that, I'm not too clear about it either, I just think he's amazing. He must be a formidable alpha in reality."

"Mm, exactly. You're right." Caelus thought back to what his brother had said, feeling like he had read into it too much.

Prince Latiao was an omega, and he could tell that Phainon was someone who hadn't met very many omegas before... As for Mydeimos, after he confessed online and became the president of Prince Latiao's fanclub, he must have met Phainon in the fanclub.

Caelus relaxed completely, waving a hand casually. "Then we won't train tonight. Go ahead and leave."

Phainon: "!" Although he didn't know why, he felt like he had missed a very big problem by a hair.

The arena for the finals was different than the previous ones. It was several times larger, and the entirety of the match would be broadcasted live. They even had people to commentate.

The seats were filled with onlookers, and there was a clear demarcation between the two sides' fans, seeming diametrically opposed.

Phainon's opponent this time was a contestant who ranked in the top forty. He was a middle-aged man named Rex.

"The contestant on this side is Rex. He's only thirty-seven this year," the host introduced. "This is already his fifth time participating in the mecha competition. I'm sure everyone feels like he's very familiar. In the past, he was only able to advance a single round. Will he achieve victory this time?"

The camera changed to Phainon's side. A big, bulky mecha plastered with all kinds of ads appeared on the screen.

Exactly-in order to get more ads, Phainon had changed to the biggest mecha.

The people who had heard only about Prince Latiao and never seen him in real life were shocked, but Prince Latiao's fans were proud. In their words, "An ordinary person couldn't get so many ads even if they wanted to. This is the symbol of our idol's strength."

"Um..." The hosts had never seen such an impoverished contestant. They were stunned for a moment before they explained, "This is the newcomer, Prince Latiao. Although it's his first time competing, he's shockingly strong. In a short timespan, he fought his way into the finals. Who knows how he'll perform?"

The host had another bout of boasting about the contestants' performances before starting the competition.

Rex looked towards Phainon with disdain. "Though this Prince Latiao's pretty strong, he's just too young. He doesn't have much combat experience, and his movements are choppy... He's far from my level."

Because he didn't have the privacy protection up, his words made it straight onto the screen. In seconds, Prince Latiao's fans were unhappy.

"Hmph." Rex continued, "And who knows what kind of person has so little confidence in their appearance. If you're still hiding your face at this point, I bet you've got some kind of problem."

Of course, he wasn't suddenly taunting him for no reason. He just wanted to rile up his opponent. If his opponent lost his reason, it would be easy to get at his weak points.

Phainon was thinking along the same lines as Rex. As soon as the match started, he maneuvered his mecha to charge forward.

"You can't keep your cool now, huh?" Rex moved to fight back gleefully, but reality was different from what he expected. Although Prince Latiao's

movements were choppy, he was faster than he expected. Before his every attack, Prince Latiao had already disappeared.

Forget about aiming for a weak point to seize victory. If it wasn't for Rex's rich experience, he might have been humiliated in a loss right off the bat.

"Dammit, you're just a little brat." Rex gritted his teeth.

They engaged in combat a few more minutes. From Rex's perspective, their strength was about equal, and they were in in a deadlock. For the moment, there was no way to seize victory.

"I didn't expect this brat to be so strong..." Rex was a bit shocked, but he felt even more unhappy. He had worked so hard for years to climb up to his spot. How could he give in to this brat so easily? "But you just got unlucky facing me. You should just come back next year."

Rex had been hiding his true strength from the beginning just so he could erupt now. He attacked fiercely, but Phainon dodged it stubbornly. It looked like Phainon was completely disadvantaged.

But Phainon had done pretty much the same thing. Exactly-he had also hidden his strength from the beginning.

Although Phainon had always stuck to fighting a quick battle, this time there was something unexpected.

When an advertising company was negotiating with Phainon, they said that as long as his match lasted for longer than ten minutes, the compensation would be tripled.

Under the seduction of money, Phainon had been going easy in the beginning without any moral integrity... If Rex knew he might choke on his anger.

To outsiders, their match looked like a thrilling struggle. In fact, Phainon was only using a portion of his spirit to face Rex. He hadn't brought out most of his strength.

Still, it was more strenuous than how he normally fought as he pleased. If it wasn't for the fact that he wanted to maximize the time the audience saw the ads on him in order to get even more ads in the future, Phainon wouldn't do such a thankless job.

If this was the real world, it would be hard to say, but in the virtual world, it wouldn't be an exaggeration to say that there were few people who could be Phainon's match... After all, based on spiritual strength, these people were who-knows-how-many leagues away from Phainon. The opponent he feared the most was the person with the protagonist halo, Khaslana.

Prince Latiao's fans looked towards the battlefield anxiously. Ever since they had become Prince Latiao's fans, there had never been a battle that took more than ten minutes.

"Why is today's match dragging on for so long? I guess the opponents in the finals really are different," someone said nervously.

"Hmph, I think your Prince Latiao's done for," one of Rex's fans jeered rudely. "That Prince Latiao of yours has just been crushing weaklings. When he's facing an expert as skilled and experienced as Rex, he certainly won't last long before he fails. Hmph."

Many people at the match thought the same. After all, it was more realistic. Some of Prince Latiao's fans were losing hope. They liked the Prince Latiao who could sweep his enemies in one go, but now they had to face with the harsh reality that their idol wasn't the strongest."

Mydei was also watching, but he worried even more. He was afraid that Phainon wasn't at his normal standards because the omega inhibitors had lost their effect.

"It looks like Prince Latiao has really met his match this time," one of the commentators narrated, watching Phainon continuing to dodge. "Although Prince Latiao's strong, Rex has experience with five years of competitors. I don't think Prince Latiao's situation is looking too good."

Just as everyone thought the winner was pretty much decided, the situation suddenly changed.

"Time's up." When Phainon thought of the huge sum of money that would be entering his bank account later, a smile appeared on his face, and he looked up at his opponent. "I'm really sorry, but let's end this now."

Just as Rex was attacking in glee, he discovered Prince Latiao had begun to fight back.

"It's too late. If you fight back now, all you'll do is work yourself up into a frenzy," Rex sneered, thinking that his attacks had upset Prince Latiao's rhythm. He seized the opportunity, raising his weapon to stab at Phainon's vitals and getting ready to finish their match then and there.

But in the next moment, Prince Latiao's mecha avoided the blow in an incredibly difficult maneuver. From a tricky angle, he thrust forward.

Before Rex could react, the cockpit of his mecha had been skewered cleanly. If this was reality, the pilot would be dead, but in this virtual world, the contestant was just forcibly ejected from the competition.

At the same time, Rex and his mecha both faded away from the battlefield.

Everyone looked on in shock. It had only been a few dozen seconds since they thought Prince Latiao was sure to lose. In those few dozen seconds, Prince Latiao had suddenly triumphed, just as if the heavens were on his side.

Prince Latiao's fans began to shout in excitement, and the people who had said Prince Latiao was going to lose wished they could bury themselves in a hole.

The commentators were also stunned, then hurried to explain, "It looks like this was Prince Latiao's tactic. First, he fakes weakness to confuse his enemy, then he seizes the opportunity to fight back. Based on his counterattacks, we can see how amazing his operation skills are."

After Phainon finished his task, he planned to ignore the ruckus and leave the field.

Just as he was checking whether the money had been deposited into his bank account, Phainon suddenly received a message.

The message was pretty much the same as the letter of challenge that Caelus had sent in the beginning. The letter expressed a desire to battle Phainon one-on-one, and there was no worry of being seen by other people. He had purposely chosen somewhere without a crowd. Moreover, regardless of whether Phainon won or not, he would receive two million empire coins.

Phainon: "!" If it wasn't for the fact that the letter's tone was totally different from Caelus's, he would have thought Caelus had come to pick a fight again. But this person was even richer than Caelus!

The empire's so big, so there are so many rich tyrants_(:3」∠)_

Although Phainon felt there might be something wrong, under the seduction of money, his soul was stirred and completely unsteady. He agreed without another thought.

When Phainon arrived at the arena the other party had mentioned, it was just like it was described in the mail, empty without a single spectator... For a moment, Phainon felt a little unaccustomed to it.

A mecha was standing in the opposite corner. His opponent had also screened their personal information, and it was impossible to tell who it was. Similarly, the mecha was extremely ordinary. It was the most widely used mecha, and it didn't have any individuality at all.

Was another opponent doing this to test his strength? Despite his thoughts, Phainon didn't care about these things. In any case, it was fine as long as he had money. If every one of his opponents came this way, he would make a fortune instantly.

Of course, not everyone was as much of a spendthrift as Caelus...

The competition system beeped, and the match began.

Phainon focused his attention, but the opposing mecha suddenly rushed at him.

Phainon was stunned. His opponent was lightning quick, and they reacted speedily when they dodged. They were completely unlike any opponents he had faced before.

If it wasn't for the fact that Phainon's spiritual energy could keep track of the entire field, he might have lost already. Yet it was also precisely because of his spiritual energy that he could pay attention to all kinds of details, and it was how Phainon noticed exactly how terrifying his opponent was.

"Who the heck is this?" Phainon's mind flew through thousands of possibilities. He kept feeling that the most likely person was Khaslana, but Khaslana wouldn't bring out two million empire coins to give to his enemy.

After a flurried exchange of blows, the two of them fell into an impasse.

Phainon could use his spiritual energy to crush his enemy, but he typically didn't want to do it. Just as he was hesitating, his opponent's spiritual energy suddenly reached over.

Because spiritual energy was a very mysterious thing, it was practically impossible to prevent someone else from coming into contact with him while he was operating a mecha. Still, everyone would pay more attention to their own spiritual energy. After all, if something happened, they would be left in a vegetative state.

But, shockingly enough, he had met someone who was so careless. The last time he met someone like this, it was that arrogant, bold, carefree guy, Caelus.

In the next moment, their spiritual energies touched.

Phainon froze. He felt that his opponent's spiritual energy was a somewhat different from an ordinary person's. Still, he had only felt Mydei's and

Caelus's spiritual energy before. He might be feeling it wrong.

A typical person's spiritual energy was bright like the sun, but this person's felt gloomy and clammy. Being squeezed close to a spiritual energy like this made Phainon feel incredibly uncomfortable.

Soon, the spiritual energy began to probe deeper. Last time, when Caelus did the same thing, he had discovered Phainon was actually an omega. This time, Phainon wouldn't let this person do the same thing. He immediately hardened his heart, banishing the other person's spiritual energy and abruptly crashing into their spiritual world.

Phainon felt like he had arrived in a sinister world. His limbs were slowly going cold. He was starting to feel like he shouldn't have used his spiritual energy so rashly.

"Ahh, this is exactly the feeling... I finally found you." A low voice rang out, sounding like it was right by Phainon's side. The voice chuckled slightly.

"?!" Phainon jumped in shock, withdrawing his spiritual energy almost unconsciously. He maneuvered his mecha to retreat rapidly.

What was up with this person? Why were they so scary... He felt like he had transmigrated into a horror movie.

His opponent's mecha didn't look like it would chase after him. It was as though this fight was just to feel him out. In the next moment, it faded away from where it was standing. His opponent had actually withdrawn.

"Wait, system, what was that just now? How come he could talk?" Even if he was going to get two million empire coins, Phainon couldn't forget what had just happened. He had been scared to death.

[When spiritual energy is high enough to be at a certain level, it's possible to use spiritual energy for interrogation. It's a similar principle with the spiritual transmission in cultivation novels.]

"I see... Well, as long as it's not some mysterious magic." Phainon let out a breath of relief.

But what the heck did that person mean? "Found you"? Who was it? Who was looking for him? He just felt really uncomfortable hearing it.

Forget it... The other person was completely anonymous. Even if Phainon wanted to find him, he would be able to. Rather than getting tangled up in something he didn't know about, he might as well be realistic about it.

So Phainon left this alone temporarily and logged off.

After coming out, Phainon felt a sudden wave of vertigo. His body was beginning to feel hot, and he felt incredibly ill. His limbs were weak, and he fell over immediately.

"Crap, i-is this an oncoming heat like I've heard about?" In the dry heat of his body, Phainon was dumbfounded. He attempted to reach for his bag to get the medicine inside.

Based on this ABO novel's settings, a typical omega would start heats after they finished maturing. Phainon had been fully matured for a long time, but he had been constrained because of the inhibitors.

He had heard that heats would be even more strong like this. If he didn't roll around in the sheets for a few days and nights, he wouldn't be able to calm it down.

If Phainon was a gay, he would die of happiness, but he thought of himself as a straight guy! He had no choice but to reach for his medicine with difficulty, hating his past self for not keeping it on him.

There was a knock on the door. Caelus's voice came from behind it. "Have you slept yet? I want to talk with you a bit."

"Fuck!" Caelus's sudden visit made Phainon break out in cold sweat. He had barely managed to prop himself up, but he nearly fell back down.

When he thought about it, shouldn't someone like Caelus just kick open the door and burst in? He had become so polite. It was really unscientific.

No, this wasn't the time to be thinking about how Caelus became so polite.

Perhaps because Caelus had shocked him into his senses, Phainon suddenly regained a bit of energy. He scrambled to grab the inhibitor in his bag, managing to twist it open with trembling hands. He grabbed a pill and swallowed it.

The medicine was extremely effective. Within a minute, the heat in Phainon's body settled, and his heat was pushed back down. He was now clearheaded, as if what had just happened was a dream. He didn't feel so weak anymore either.

Phainon quickly put away the medicine and aired out the room, getting rid of the omega pheromones that might have overflowed into the room.

Although Phainon couldn't feel it himself, alphas were extremely sensitive to omega scents. If he was discovered, he would be done for, so he pulled out a bottle of perfume that he had never used before, spraying it all around the room. The fragrances intermingled. Even an alpha with the keenest senses couldn't smell any omega scent anymore.

When he finished, Phainon went to the bathroom to take a quick shower, putting his sweat-soaked clothes to the side and changing into a new set of clothes.

When he finished, Phainon went to open the door, freshly showered.

Phainon said uncertainly, "What happened? What do you need me for?"

"You let me wait so long? You've really got some guts." Caelus looked over, arms crossed across his chest and looking unhappy. "My time is precious, you know."

Who's fault was it for coming over to look for someone so late!

"I truly apologize." Phainon was already well-practiced. Even if he was roasting Caelus silently, he kept a remorseful expression up on his face. He said quietly, "I was just taking a shower, so I didn't hear you... So, what did you need?"

"Nothing much. I just wanted to ask how you're feeling recently. After all, as the master I need to pay some more attention to our servants' situations." Caelus looked haughty. These kinds of action were the ones that made people want to give him a beating the most.

"It's great," Phainon said. "The room and board are both great." And all he had to do was keep Caelus company. It was super relaxed. At least it was better than keeping Anaxagoras company.

Although he had only exchanged a few sentences with Anaxagoras, Phainon felt guarded against him.

"Well, of course. Nobody would dare to look down on the dukedom. Still," Caelus said, frowning, "why does your room smell so weird? It's disgusting. Your sense of smell's got some problem..."

In order to cover it up, Phainon had no choice but to make himself look bad. "...Well, actually I like it like this. I can't sleep well unless it smells like this."

"I really don't know what to do with you. Don't do something like this outside. Alright, go and rest." Caelus humphed and left quickly.

Phainon guessed that Caelus hadn't noticed anything and let out a breath of relief. When he closed the door, he realized he had broken out into cold sweat, but he didn't have the energy to go shower again. He gave up and got in bed.

The day had been full of too much excitement. He had nearly been discovered by Caelus. Still, he couldn't keep going like this. He might be able to fudge it once, but next time might not be so easy.

It looked like he needed to find a way to move out.

And in the hallway, Caelus, who had turned to leave, had a somber expression on his face, and his hands were clenched tightly.

In the heart of the capital planet.

Anaxa looked uncertainly at the inhumanly beautiful teenager on the screen. "Your Highness, why did you suddenly call me back again?"

Recently, he had found many interesting things in the empire's military institute, though he hadn't found Prince Latiao's true identity. But Anaxa had looked into Khaslana's matters.

"You don't need to keep looking." Nanook had a slight smile on his face. "I've already found part of it on my own... In comparison, there are other things that need you more. Having you investigate is really a waste of your talent."

"It's as you say. I'll defer to your instructions." Anaxa knew that even if they had grown up together, Nanook had never believed in him. Chances were that this was also a decision made based on other factors.

In any case, he would stop looking into this.

"By the way, I've been a bit tired lately. Arrange a few rest days for me next month. I'm going to take a vacation," Nanook said.

Anaxa was stunned. In all his years of knowing Nanook, it was his first time hearing him say he wanted to take a vacation... Before this, he thought His Highness the Crown Prince was a working machine.

"Understood. I'll arrange it for you."

The next day, Phainon discovered that Caelus had practically become a new person.

Although Caelus was hard-working before, now he was training like he had no other purpose in life. He was using up almost all of his free time. Every night, he would be exhausted to the point that he could barely move.

Phainon didn't expect he would work so hard just for the mecha competition. He felt a bit surprised.

Though Phainon thought about leaving, he could never find a time to tell Caelus. He could only put it on hold for the time being.

In any case, with Caelus so exhausted, he wouldn't be able to see anything wrong.

And during that time, the inhibitors that had already been losing efficacy finally stopped working completely.

Phainon finally understood how great it was to have an inhibitor that could work for ten-odd years in one go. Now, he had to take an inhibitor every day in order to control himself, or his omega pheromones would start to diffuse.

Mydei seemed like he didn't know that Phainon was an omega. He acted exactly the same as he did before, and didn't change because Phainon's gender changed.

If it wasn't for what had happened before and how exciting it was, Phainon would wonder if he was dreaming...

Phainon thought that being a fan on the level of Mydei was amazing. Still, thinking about how much the novel's Mydei liked Khaslana, even if he didn’t get to be with Khaslana. Phainon probably didn't need to worry about it.

The next few competitors in the mecha competition couldn't match up to Phainon at all. He rose directly to first place of their group. By this stage, even more people Prince Latiao's strength.

Before, there were people who said that he was just a low-grade Khaslana copycat. If anyone said that now, his fans would rip into them. Besides, it was obvious that Prince Latiao's strength wasn't that much different from Khaslana's. Slowly, there was nobody who would say it anymore.

Khaslana had also succeeded in becoming number one. Of course, his success was more of a journey. There were several times that he had nearly lost, but in the end he was victorious.

As Khaslana watched videos of Prince Latiao, who he expected to be his opponent, his expression turned unhappy.

In the beginning, he thought Prince Latiao was just trash copying him. He didn't expect that the other person would climb step by step up to this level and even be equally matched with him.

Khaslana had always been the one above everyone else. There had never been anyone who stepped into his position.

Still, for now, Khaslana just didn't like Prince Latiao. The person he hated the most was still the evil, ever-present person who had taunted him several times and managed to win over him somehow, Phainon.

"For some reason, whenever I see Prince Latiao, I think of that guy." Despite his thoughts, Khaslana didn't think too much of it.

Although Prince Latiao had always kept his identity hidden, everyone knew he had to be an alpha. On the other hand, Phainon was just a weak, potato-level beta. Even if Khaslana didn't like Prince Latiao, he wouldn't bring Phainon into the conversation.

"Even like this, won't he become my subordinate anyways?" Khaslana smirked.

After the small group competition ended, the last ten people were basically the strongest people in the competition. Of course, there was an element of

luck involved.

By now, their popularity had pretty much reached the peak. The person who received the most attention was the undefeated Prince Latiao, but it was different from the beginning. Now, most people thought that Prince Latiao must be a seasoned veteran who had dozens of years of experience.

Compared to a middle-aged person, a student like Khaslana had more future prospects.

Phainon wasn't happy about being stuffed into the box of a middle-aged person at all.

Besides, there was still half a month before the ultimate finals would take place. During that time, there would be all kinds of publicity and even merch of the competitors (when Phainon saw it, he was really shocked).

Still, even if this was happening, Phainon didn't know why exactly it had been dragged out for so long... When he thought about the original novel's plotline, Phainon felt that everything was secondary. The most important thing was to let Khaslana be promoted.

Exactly. The next thing that would happen was the most important event in original novel.

And in this plotline, Khaslana's strength would surpass Mydei's.

Chapter End Notes

> The Author Has Something to Say:
> This was supposed to be two chapters but I'm really excited for the next couple of chapters so I decided to just get this one out in one go. Everything from next chapter onwards is very exciting! Some more flags were planted in this chapter with Khas, Caelus and Nanook. Hope you enjoy! <3

Chapter 11: Battlefield (Pt.1)

Chapter Notes

CW: Non-Con Kissing (One of them is asleep)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

In the original novel, the five major military institutes of the empire would soon join to hold a competition on a remote planet.

In the original novel, Khaslana had, of course, also gone.

The planet was quite dangerous. The surface was filled by an ancient, towering forest, and within the forest, there were all kinds of alien beasts and poisonous plants.

These alien beasts were unintelligent, and they couldn't leave the planet. They couldn't compare to the danger level of a Zerg, but it was difficult for these students, who only had weapons and couldn't use mechas to face them.

But with the help of his strength and his physique, Khaslana took to the situation like a duck to water. Later, he found an ore in a hidden cavern that could strengthen his physique, and his strength rose up another level. It even stimulated the imperial blood in his body, and thus he discovered that his father was actually the emperor.

Basically, this plot point was an important turning point in the original novel.

Generally speaking, someone couldn't go and snatch the original protagonist's opportunities. If it went poorly, the world consciousness would lock onto them and kill them straightaway. But when Phainon remembered how the ore could increase his strength, he was intrigued.

Still, these were all things that happened later. Right now, what he had to worry about was how he would complete his daily task after binding to Khaslana!

Phainon felt that compared to Khaslana, all of his previous capture targets were angels (._.)

Regardless of how much Phainon was dreading it, that day was coming up soon.

Every new student had to go to the competition, even if they were the kind that just came over to the academy hang out. Phainon didn't know whether or not the original host had thought about the competition when he came to hang out. After all, in the original novel, he had been expelled.

Everyone got on the airship with excitement. The empire's military institute was the wealthiest of all the five major institutes, and it had the most students from noble and imperial families. Naturally, the airship was very comfortable. It could compare with a luxury tour airship. Even the rooms were double rooms.

Then problems began to occur.

Phainon and Caelus were assigned into one room.

When Phainon found out, he was ready to curse up a storm. The more he didn't want something to happen, the more likely it would happen. He was getting more and more unlucky these days... But it was no big deal as long as he didn't get put in a room with Khaslana.

A spoiled rich kid like Caelus would naturally prepare a ton of luggage when he traveled. After all, how could someone of his status make do in the wilderness?

Phainon grabbed a few clothes at random and some things that he thought he might need in the wilderness, then went to help Caelus with carrying his luggage.

"There's no need." Caelus turned to look at him and said, "With the way you look like a gust of wind would blow you over, if you help me with my luggage people will think I'm treating you poorly. Besides, I have a space button that I can put them in."

Phainon let out a breath of relief. If he had to carry the luggage for such a long time, he really wouldn't be able to last... He had also forgotten that there was something like a space button. Still, in the future, a space button was extremely expensive. It was usually used to store a mecha. Only someone like Caelus would use it to store luggage.

Phainon carried his own luggage and got ready to leave, but Caelus stopped him in his footsteps, looking cold. "Give your luggage here too."

"Huh???" Phainon was stupefied.

How could someone who disdained betas as much as Caelus be willing to put someone else's things with his own things? And this "someone else" was even his family's servant. Caelus's favorability score for Phainon was still at zero, too.

Still, people changed. Phainon didn't read into it too deeply and handed his luggage to Caelus.

After the students gathered, they began to board the airship one by one, and the people everyone paid attention to the most, Khaslana and Mydeimos, were assigned to the same room.

After the airship took off, nobody could calm down. They assembled in the airship's training room and began to temper themselves.

Caelus was, of course, not an exception, but when he was preparing to go train, he received a message. He frowned, heading towards a hallway in the airship that was relatively more isolated.

Mydei had already been waiting there for a long time. In front of outsiders, he looked aloof and like he kept people at a distance. Even if he was

standing in the most bustling place on earth, nobody would have the courage to approach him.

"What did you want me for?" Caelus said impatiently, looking over with a frown. "My time is precious, you know."

"Let's change rooms," Mydei said coolly, looking like he was disgusted but had no choice to speak.

Caelus snorted. "And what if I don't want to? If I change rooms just because you said to change rooms, what should I do with my reputation?"

"Don't you admire Khaslana a lot?" Mydei was about to lose his patience. "You're still not happy when you've been given a chance to get in close contact with him?"

When Mydei mentioned Khaslana, Caelus froze.

For a while, ever since he had fought with Prince Latiao, he had unconsciously pushed Khaslana to the back of his mind. Even during the finals of the virtual mecha competition, he hadn't paid attention to Khaslana's matches.

Now, the overflowing admiration he had held for Khaslana had disappeared completely. When he thought of Khaslana, he didn't even think of him more than he would of a passerby.

Yes, because he had found someone even better now. Khaslana was no longer important.

"That's in the past. Now, I already..." Caelus looked like he had thought of someone. His expression was complicated. Immediately, he continued, "Anyway, I don't have any interest in Khaslana anymore. Isn't he your close friend? You want to avoid living with him that much?"

If Khaslana knew that he had been shunned by these two people, and was even being thrown around like a hot potato, he would be furious.

"You know what my goal is," Mydei said frankly. "If you have any conditions, name them."

"Hmph. I really don't know what it is about a beta that has drawn your attention," Caelus said. "No matter what else happens, don't think about changing rooms. I absolutely won't agree... I've got stuff to do, so I won't keep wasting my time with a guy like you."

When he finished speaking, Caelus turned to leave without the slightest hesitation.

Mydei watched Caelus leave. His deep green eyes iced over, killing intent seething in his gaze.

Meanwhile, Phainon laid down to rest in his room as soon as he finished his meal. How could he have the heart to go train when he thought of the situation he was faced with? He should take the chance to enjoy himself a bit while he still had the chance.

And now he was staying in the same room as Caelus. If his inhibitors expired, he was done for. As Phainon thought, he took out a bottle of medicine and swallowed a pill, finally feeling more at ease.

Dammit, who thought of a terrifying ABO setting? He felt like he really couldn't endure until the end, alright!

Although Phainon didn't want Khaslana to level up, he also wanted him to level up. This way, he could leave the world quickly.

After he finished his medicine, Phainon felt himself getting sleepy. He laid down in bed and fell asleep.

At some point, the door opened. Caelus's silhouette appeared in the doorway.

When he saw that Phainon was sleeping, Caelus kept even more quiet. He closed the door tightly, walking slowly to the side of his bed.

Phainon was sleeping fitfully. His brow was slightly furrowed, as though he was dreaming of something bad.

Caelus extended a hand, caressing Phainon's forehead. His movements were a little stiff. He had never tried to touch someone so gently.

Phainon's eyelashes suddenly quivered. Caelus froze, but he didn't pull his hand back.

After a moment, Phainon didn't show any signs of waking. He continued to sleep soundly.

"...Rest well," Caelus said in a low voice. He lowered his head, planting a soft kiss on Phainon's cheeks.

"Mm..." Phainon mumbled.

Caelus's pale cheeks flushed completely red instantly and he raised his head in alarm. He looked back at Phainon, who didn't stir, feeling a sense of defeat.

"Dammit, you cheat, being so cunning... You clearly knew all along, but you never said a word to me. Do think of me as a joke?"

As Caelus spoke, he thought back to how he had people whip Phainon the night they first met. His mood sank.

"So what exactly do you think about me..."

Caelus looked at Phainon, lowering his head helplessly. He kissed Phainon on the lips. He could only feel how soft those lips were, becoming intoxicated in moments. He used his tongue to probe between Phainon's teeth.

A sticky, liquid noise sounded in the room.

After a long time, Caelus finally lifted his head, his face scarlet, and wiped his mouth of silvery threads of saliva. He unconsciously moving to undo

Phainon's buttons, reaching out to press Phainon down and lowering his head to nip at Phainon's fair, slender neck.

Though it was already weak, he could smell the faint fragrance at such a close distance. It made him recall the day that he had fought with Prince Latiao, as well as that night.

He had never told Phainon that even with all kinds of fragrances around the room, that faint omega scent was so clear that there wasn't any smell that could cover it up. Even a slight sniff would make someone sink into an inescapable trance.

And now, if he bit down, Phainon would be marked by him. Phainon could be his.

But Caelus let out a breath, looking at Phainon who was sleeping calmly. As though he was venting, he reached out to pinch Phainon's cheek. "You dummy."

The airship arrived at its destination by the second day. It was a planet that looked beautiful from a distance. From its appearance, it was impossible to tell what kind of dangers were hiding within.

Normally, there was nobody who would come to this planet. After all, it was dangerous and had no resources worth mining. There was simply nobody who would come besides for thrill seekers.

Phainon yawned, disembarking from the airship. He had slept so early yesterday, so why was he so tired today?

And he didn't know why, but his neck hurt a bit. Maybe he had slept wrong... Phainon had no idea what had happened yesterday. He even felt that yesterday had been peaceful.

The only problem was Caelus's temper early that morning. Of course, Phainon was already used to this.

The planet's air quality was excellent, and just smelling it made him feel refreshed. When he tilted his head back, there was a never-ending forest before his eyes.

It was pretty good to look at it from a distance, but as soon as he thought about how his future days would be spent inside, he wasn't happy anymore.

Most of the students from other had already arrived. Everyone gathered at a simple and crude base. Despite the short time, there were already several students disputing with students from other institutes.

Phainon noticed that there was a group of students from the neighboring military institute clustered around a youth. He looked familiar, and Phainon unconsciously looked back at him several times.

Next to him, Caelus became unhappy. "What's there to look at?" He followed Phainon's gaze and discovered a beautiful teenager. He immediately snorted. "That guy's not even as handsome as I am."

Phainon: "..." Hey, why are you competing over something like this!

The teenager noticed Phainon. He turned towards him, smiling slightly.

Caelus's fury washed over him again. He stepped in front of Phainon. "You can't look."

Phainon had no idea how looking at the students from the neighboring institute had got on Caelus's nerves, but he finally remembered. Wasn't this teenager the Zerg he had met on the airship the other time?!

Fuck, he didn't expect to meet him again somewhere like this. He didn't expect a planted Zerg agent would actually sneak into one of the five major military institutes... Still, this was pretty normal, huh.

The Zerg in this world were fairly different from the Zerg in the previous world. Most importantly, the lower class Zerg in this world couldn't change into human form, but higher class Zerg could change their form at will. Moreover, their spiritual energy and strength was innately strong.

It was perfectly normal that a higher class Zerg coming over to act as a sleeper agent could simply join one of the five major military institutes... It was under such grave circumstances that Khaslana could drive these Zerg away. It was all thanks to his plot armor.

In any case, he was walking fast last time and the other person hadn't seen his face. Phainon turned away like nothing had happened. He didn't want this Zerg villain to drag him in.

Although the empire's military institute was famous and had the support of the imperial family, it wasn't the most impressive academy. The other academies had their own strengths.

Students didn't get along with those at other academies. Every few years, they would compete, and the victorious academy would become the number one institute for those few years.

This competition would be based on the students' wilderness survival skills. They would have to make it through the primeval forest to their destination, and they couldn't use their mechas or weapons with high destructive power. They could only use cold weapons.

When the competition was mentioned outside, everyone said the purpose was to train their unity and cooperation, but everyone secretly knew that if they could take the lead in this competition, they could say they were winning glory for their school and get even more opportunities in the future. Thus, everyone fought like their lives depended on it.

Of course, they were ensured safety in such a dangerous place. Every student received an emergency alarm. If anything that was serious enough to threaten their life and safety, they could press the alarm, and a teacher would come to their rescue immediately.

But pressing the alarm was an automatic forfeit. It was a more embarrassing method of action.

Phainon didn't care about being embarrassed. Going through the forest with his trash omega body? It was obviously impossible. He might as well just

forfeit. The only thing was that forfeiting right at the start was a bit embarrassing, so he would endure for two or three days and then forfeit.

The teachers told everyone a few things to take note of, then divided everyone into groups by drawing lots. There were two people per group, and they would have to stay together for these few days. If one party forfeited, the other person would also lose their opportunity.

Khaslana's student ID was earlier in the numbers. He walked directly up on stage and tapped on the screen casually. The numbers stopped immediately.

Everyone in the audience was worked up. They all knew how strong Khaslana was. How wonderful would it be if they could be paired up with Khaslana! They might be able to achieve a grade they had never obtained before.

Phainon completely ignored the scene. According to the original plot, Khaslana would be paired up with Caelus. It had nothing to do with him.

Khaslana spoke. "Number 154."

Wait, why did this number sound familiar?

Afraid to face reality, Phainon lowered his head to look at his student ID. Number 154.

"Classmate Phainon, what a coincidence! It's truly a blessing." Khaslana walked over, a slight curve on his lips. He stood before Phainon, extending a hand. "I'll be in your care."

Blessing? This is just a curse, okay!!

Why was he the one who got Caelus's chance from the original novel... Phainon had thought that the competition would be a bit more difficult. Now, he felt like he was sending himself to his death.

Though competition had as many safety measures as possible, there had been several students who had died in accidents in the past since it was hard to predict what situations might arise in the forest. In the original novel,

Khaslana had offed several of students from other academies who had come to provoke him. It was easy to imagine what was in his future!

The surrounding crowd had complicated expressions. Phainon reached out a hand, almost completely stiff, and shook hands with Khaslana. He could only feel his cold sweat. "I'll be in your care..."

Meanwhile, Mydei and Caelus had been paired together. It was obvious they hadn't expected this situation.

Taking the circumstances into consideration, Mydei walked over, suggesting that his and Khaslana's group advance together. He reasoned, "Two people is too few, and we have better chances with four people. At night, we can take turns keeping watch. It'll be much safer."

Mydei sounded very reasonable. Plenty of people moved as a group of four because of their relationships. There even some who proceeded as groups of six or eight.

Khaslana naturally had no objections. If people as strong as Mydei and Caelus joined his team, it would benefit him.

As for Phainon... Khaslana chuckled. Ever since they had come to this planet, he had no plans to let Phainon leave alive.

Caelus just sneered, giving Phainon a sidelong glance. "I'm only agreeing to come and take on this task because of how weak you are."

Phainon grabbed Caelus's hand in excitement. He said, moved, "Thank you so much, you're amazing!"

Caelus had basically saved his life! Although he knew Caelus probably came for Khaslana, and his words just now were just acting cool to hide his soft spot for Khaslana, Phainon was very emotional.

Caelus froze. His face immediately turned red. He blurted, "What are you doing? Who gave you the right to hold my hand?"

Despite his words, he didn't make any move to throw him off.

Mydei noticed his movements. His eyes focused on where their hands were touching, his gaze turning cold.

The four of them headed towards the forest as planned. Though they didn't meet any other academy students, everyone had silently agreed to separate. Nobody would take the same road as someone they saw as their opponent. They were too afraid of being plotted against.

Although their group was strong, Phainon didn't have high hopes... He felt that it was already pretty good as long as these guys didn't mess around. Khaslana in particular had to seize the opportunity. It would be good if everyone could reach the end point.

The beginning of their journey went smoothly. As they went on, the road got more and more difficult to travel. There were all kinds of shrubs all over. While the other three alphas were still full of energy, Phainon couldn't keep going. He was panting in exhaustion.

It was lucky that the other three people were all alphas. Phainon could muddle through with the excuse that he was a beta. If their squad had another beta to compare Phainon to, then he wouldn't have any self-respect left.

"I knew you'd be like this." Caelus turned to look at him, looking disdainful. "As soon as I saw you, I knew you'd drag down our squad. If you really can't keep going, it's not impossible for me to piggyback you."

Phainon was given a huge shock. The first half of Caelus's words were fine, he was used to it anyway... but what was with the second half?!

Was Caelus always such a good person? He was even willing to carry a beta classmate from his team during a competition. Phainon had even expected that he would sarcastically suggest their two teams go their separate ways.

Even if Caelus was affected by what happened with Prince Latiao and no longer discriminated against betas, he wouldn't be so intimate, right? This

was already OOC, okay!

"Or do you not want it?" Caelus narrowed his eyes. "Even *I* don't mind, but you mind?"

"N-no, I just..." Phainon hurried to explain, "I think I can keep going for a bit, I won't impose on you."

Rather than letting Caelus piggyback him, he would be better off gritting his teeth and enduring a bit longer.

"Hmph," Caelus said. "Then let's keep going. If you can't keep up, don't come running to me for help."

Phainon gritted his teeth and endured for part of the way, but he really couldn't manage any longer. He nearly tripped over a tree root. Just as he was about to fall to the ground, Mydei, who had been silently paying attention to him, caught him.

Because of Phainon's instructions, Mydei still kept a delicate distance between them. Now that there were only four of them, he didn't care so much. He said, "It won't work if you keep going like this. I'm stronger than Caelus. I can defend myself better. Let me carry you on my back."

While putting himself forward, Mydei casually stepped on Caelus's reputation.

Phainon approved greatly, because Mydei's words were too true. It was easy to tell based on the system's choice of the capture target who was the stronger one.

"What do you mean by that?" Caelus immediately got into a bad mood. He glared at Mydei. "You're saying I'm not as good as you?"

"That's not what I mean," Mydei said calmly. "I'm just telling the truth."

Caelus's expression turned ugly, but most importantly, he had no way to retort. He just grabbed Phainon's hand. "Say it, who do you want to carry you?"

Phainon: "???" Fuck, why would something like this happen now?! Khaslana is still on the sidelines watching, okay!

Forget about Mydei, but what the heck was Caelus getting in on the action for? But if Phainon didn't let Caelus piggyback him this time, he would definitely kick up a big fuss. After all, he was that kind of person.

One the other hand, Phainon wasn't worried about Mydei. After all, he had always been very reliable, and his personality was much better than Caelus's. He should be able to understand his choice this time.

So Phainon gave Mydei an apologetic look and chose Caelus.

"See? As expected, he chose me." Caelus gave Mydei a smug glance, then put Phainon onto his back. He said, "You'd better hold on tight. I won't be paying attention to you while I walk."

Despite his words, Caelus was very attentive, afraid that Phainon would get scratched by any branches.

Mydei froze. For a long time, he didn't move, and he quickly fell behind the two of them.

Khaslana walked over. Calmly, he said, "Although you want to be kind to someone, they don't seem to want to accept your feelings."

"This has nothing to do with you," Mydei said. "I'm very clear about what he's thinking, and I can understand his actions." He did understand what Phainon was thinking, but he still couldn't really accept it.

But Mydei blamed himself. How could he think Phainon was doing the wrong thing? Phainon couldn't do anything wrong. Everything was Caelus's fault... Exactly, everything was because of Caelus.

"Oh?" Khaslana's lips curled up. "But you don't look very happy... Is it so hard to accept what you think? Do you think you'll be repaid what you have been given? Sometimes, even if you give, you won't get what you want."

Although Khaslana wasn't completely clear on what had happened between Mydeimos and Phainon, he was happy to drive a wedge between them. It would be best to make that damn Phainon learn what it was like to be completely isolated and alone.

"No, I've never thought that way. I'll be happy as long as I can stay by his side..." Mydei suddenly gritted his teeth, looking at the people ahead of him. But he had no choice but to admit that in that moment his heart was filled with a raging fire of envy that almost consumed half of his rationale.

He had never felt such envy since he was born, but ever since he began to stay at Phainon's side, he had almost always felt these kinds of feelings. It was insufferable agony, but he endured it as he had before.

At the beginning, he had just wanted to stay at Phainon's side, but human desires were without an end. As long as they got one thing, they would want even more.

If he was the only one at Phainon's side... it would be wonderful.

Mydei had thought the same thing many times, but now he couldn't restrain himself anymore.

Mydei's expression iced over. He stared at the people up ahead, but he felt relaxed in a way that he hadn't felt in a long time. He finally understood what he had to do.

Extraneous people like this shouldn't have existed in the first place.

Khaslana watched Mydei's expression change and left, smiling.

But he didn't know that Mydei wasn't thinking about betraying Phainon because of his words. Instead, he was filled with killing intent for Caelus.

After entering the forest, a few alien beasts began to appear. These beasts looked similar to normal animals, but they were even more horrible.

When he first saw an alien beast scurry out into the open, Phainon was given a terrible shock. He was able to relax after he saw Khaslana kill it easily using a pocket knife.

Even though they looked so terrifying, since they could be killed with an ordinary weapon like that, it seemed that they weren't so hard to deal with. In comparison, those Zerg who could shift into human shape and blend into society were even more scary.

The sky was turning dark. They decided to find a place in the forest to rest.

Caelus had brought a tent specially designed for leisure. It was very convenient, and could pitch itself with the press of a button. He also took out some delicacies and water out of his space button. Who knew if he had come to compete or to vacation.

The tent that Caelus had prepared was quite large. It could fit two people.

Although Caelus wasn't exactly willing, they collectively decided to let two people keep watch and the other two rest. They would switch every two hours.

When they drew lots, Phainon and Mydei were paired up, and Caelus and Khaslana were paired up.

Although Caelus wasn't happy, when he thought of his victory from earlier and how he had carried Phainon the entire way, it was no big deal if he just stepped back for the night watch. This way, he wouldn't make trouble.

Khaslana laid in the tent soundlessly. Even though they were so close, Caelus had completely forgotten his admiration for Khaslana. His mind was full of Phainon, and he couldn't sleep at all.

Though something like that had happened the first time they met, Phainon forced a kiss on him the second day, and he even stayed after that. Phainon always stayed by Caelus's side, and this time he had chosen him over Mydeimos... Could he believe that Phainon had some feelings for him?

When he thought back to the first kiss, Caelus felt a bit embarrassed, but his heart filled with sweetness.

Outside the tent, Phainon was resting against a tree listlessly, looking at the bonfire. He nearly fell asleep several times. He couldn't stop himself from yawning, and his eyelids were closing involuntarily.

Mydei watched him, his heart pained, and said, "If you're truly to tired, go rest first. There will be no problem with me here."

Phainon shook his head, struggling to speak. "No, I can't sleep right now..." If he slept at this kind of time, he had a feeling that something bad would happen.

At some point, the time ticked past midnight. The system's voice suddenly rang in Phainon's mind.

[Daily task refreshed. The current task is [*Force a kiss on the capture target once*]. Host, please do your best.]

Phainon was immediately jolted awake.

Chapter End Notes

> The Author Has Something To Say:
> AHHH System are you trying to be a wingman or not??? Your gonna be a problem later but while we are bound to Mydei its all good. I hope you all enjoy this arc its going to be my favorite with many squeal worthy moments <3!
>
> Happy Reading!

Chapter 12: Battlefield (Pt.2)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Phainon had thought that the system had gotten more restrained recently. He didn't expect that it had been brewing up a big move! It even issued a task like this at such a time. Phainon suspected that it had an ulterior motive... No, there was no need to suspect. This system had dedicated itself to fostering gays.

If he didn't finish up this damn task now, it would be even harder to do it tomorrow when everyone was moving together. Phainon absolutely couldn't imagine what it would be like if he forced a kiss on one of the three men.

But it wouldn't be very good if he forced a kiss on Mydei now. Mydei would certainly think of him as gay, and with his personality, there was an 80 or 90 percent chance that he would give himself over to Phainon... The scene was too stunning for Phainon to have the nerve to keep imagining it.

The only method was to take the chance to complete his task when Mydei was sleeping. That way, nobody could see him, and Phainon would be fine, Mydei would be fine, and everybody would be fine.

Phainon relaxed, sitting back to wait at the fireside.

Soon, it was time. Caelus came out from the tent with dark undereye circles, fixing his eyes straight on Phainon and Mydei. He didn't relax until he saw that they weren't even sitting very close to each other.

Caelus didn't sleep at all in the last two hours. Instead, he had been thinking up all kinds of possibilities, worrying that Mydeimos would take the chance to seduce Phainon outside... Exactly. At that moment, in Caelus's mind, Mydei had already become the mistress trying to wedge between him and Phainon.

On the other hand, Khaslana had a good sleep and woke up well-rested, as though he didn't care about whatever problems there were between the other three people.

"Well, we'll go and rest now." Phainon stumbled towards the tent, practically falling asleep on his feet. He could barely keep his eyes open.

Phainon had to admit that Caelus knew how to treat himself well. The tent was well-soundproofed, and as soon as he walked inside, all the noise outside was silenced. There was a mat on the ground made of some kind of unknown material, and it was extremely comfortable. It was almost like he had gone back to his own room... No, his own room wasn't even as comfortable.

But Mydei sat down at a spot closest to the outside. He was extremely vigilant, looking as though he wasn't planning to sleep.

If Mydei didn't sleep, how was he supposed to complete his task! Phainon hurriedly said, "It's already so late, you should come rest too. We'll still have to keep watch in another two hours."

"How could I sleep by your side?" Mydei said quickly. "I'm alright just sitting here. I don't trust the others. At a dangerous time like this, I should be here to protect you."

Phainon said, "...You don't need to think so much, at least for now. You should come and rest."

Mydei: "But I..."

"You already worked hard during the daytime, didn't you? If you don't sleep at night, how will you manage to keep going?" Phainon racked his brains for an excuse. "If you don't rest now, you'll have even less energy tomorrow. Even if you're an alpha, you're not made of stone, right?"

Mydei thought the same. "I suppose you're right. Please excuse the offense." With a little embarrassment, he sat down by Phainon's side, laying down.

They were close to each other, so close that Mydei unconsciously slowed his breathing and pressed his hands unconsciously to his chest, afraid that Phainon would hear his rapid heartbeat.

If Phainon didn't have a task to do, he would have fallen asleep in ten seconds. Now, in order to complete his task, he had no choice but to keep himself lively and keep a constant eye on Mydei.

When he noticed that Mydei was pretty much asleep, Phainon sat up, soundlessly inching towards Mydei's side.

Mydei was sleeping peacefully, his soft blonde hair mussed. In his sleep, his expression was cool and his features looked as though they had been carved by a master sculptor.

When Phainon first met him, he couldn't imagine that there would ever be a day that Mydei would stay by his side with such an attitude.

"Sorry... I..." Phainon felt a hint of guilt. He sighed, reaching out to brush Mydei's hair away. He bent over, aiming his pale lips for a kiss.

In his nervousness, Phainon didn't notice that Mydei, who should have been in deep sleep, had his hands clenched, and his ears had turned unnaturally flushed.

Exactly. Mydei wasn't asleep. How could he fall peacefully into slumber when he was next to his Deliverer? When Phainon leaned in sneakily, he thought that Phainon was about to do something and he got nervous. He didn't expect that Phainon would actually kiss him.

Mydei's heart pounded. He had never thought he would get so close to Phainon. He was happy as long as he was by Phainon's side. Although he would occasionally have thoughts about getting closer to Phainon, he had never thought of something like this.

Rather than saying that he didn't want to think about it, he didn't have the nerve to think about it. Mydei had placed Phainon on a pedestal in his mind. It would only blaspheme Phainon if he was together with Mydei.

Just as their lips touched, the system's task completion notification went off. At the same time, the tent was suddenly flung open.

Caelus, who had found an excuse to come because he wasn't at ease, saw the kiss as soon as he looked in.

The tent tore with a sharp sound. Caelus almost couldn't believe his eyes. He clutched a piece of the ripped tent in a death grip.

Phainon whipped his head up to look over in shock. "?!"

Fuck, what kind of drama was this, huh! Why did this storyline, where he got caught trying to steal a kiss, feature the three of them, who didn't have any feelings above friendship?

He might as well just say that they didn't even have friendship.

Luckily, Caelus didn't have any romantic intentions towards him. Phainon thought for a moment. He could only use gay methods to muddle his way through (besides, it was very normal for betas to like alphas in this world!). Although it was humiliating, it was better than being a pervert who attacked in secret.

"...I didn't expect you to spot me." Phainon was alarmed, then said, "Um, actually- actually, the person I've always liked is..."

"Stop." Caelus cut Phainon off.

Phainon: "Huh?" Was there some reason he couldn't say it?

"How could you... How could you be like this?" Caelus's expression was incredibly ugly. He strode over, grabbing Phainon's hand. "Aren't I the one you like? How could you do something like this with someone else? You even want to try and confess to someone else right in front of me."

Phainon: "Huh???"

Wait, at some point in time Caelus had dreamt up something crazy?

"No... Have you made some mistake...?" Phainon fumbled with his words.

"A mistake?" Caelus was nearly exploding in anger. He gritted his teeth. "Fine then, tell me, if it's a mistake, if you don't like me, then why would you kiss me?”

Phainon: "Huh? T-that was actually because..." Why was something that should have already passed soundlessly coming back out for interrogation?

He had already forgotten this dark past. He didn't expect that Caelus would still remember.

"Actually, I lost my sense of reason after being whipped, so that's why I did something like that." Phainon finally thought of an excuse. "I'm really sorry..." Still, Caelus had already retaliated, though it was with that kind of method.

"What do you mean? You want to deny the things you did yourself? You just seduced me to throw me away... Yes, you just want to toy with me, don't you?" Caelus gritted his teeth. "You want to retaliate against me because of how I treated you at first."

He was just getting a few lashings at the beginning, it didn't have anything to do with seduction! Did he not understand ABO worldviews or something?!

Phainon felt that his and Caelus's understanding had deviated at some point. "No, I don't mean anything like that, if I wanted to get revenge against you, I would have done it ages ago. Besides, don't you like Prince La-ahem..."

Caelus looked furious. He pressed Phainon down under him, lowering his head, and pressing towards Phainon's lips.

Phainon: "!!?"

At that moment, Phainon was stupefied. How in the world did things turn out like this? These shocking lines were something that would only appear in an overdramatic soap opera. Why did someone who had zero favorability

towards him do something so absolutely terrifying after catching him kissing another person?!

He must be dreaming... If Caelus was like this when he didn't look down on betas, why didn't he just go and pretend that he was a gay who liked alphas!

Caelus raised his head, looking much calmer, but his eyes were unusually serene. He reached out to cup Phainon's face. He spoke as though he was asking Phainon, but in fact it was to comfort himself. "I know that you actually like me. In the past, we were just at odds with each other. The things you did with Mydeimos were also just to provoke me. It's fine... I can understand it all."

Phainon: "...You know my real identity?" This was the only possibility.

"Yes. I've known for a long time," Caelus said. "Nothing you said to me before was random, right? When you said you wanted me to enter the mecha competition, it was just to encourage me, am I right?"

Caelus's tone didn't sound like he was asking a question. It sounded like a forceful statement.

Phainon: "...Y-yes." If Phainon said that he was actually fooling him, Caelus would definitely beat him to death.

Still, it was hard to figure out how exactly Caelus thought. It was simply unrealistic that he had known about this and kept it hidden for so long.

"I knew it... You did it all for me. It's fine. I won't be mad," Caelus smiled slightly, leaning down to hug Phainon.

But Phainon was nearly shocked out of his skin by the way Caelus treated him so well.

Caelus look at the space at the side, his voice cold. "Alright, now a certain someone can stop faking sleep, can't they?"

Next to them, Mydei jerked into a sitting position, his sunset eyes cold enough to freeze over. He gazed back at Caelus with a death stare.

Phainon: "You're awake?" Wait, faking sleep? Was Mydei not asleep just now? Phainon suddenly felt like he couldn't live to the next day.

"Yes," Mydei said, "I'm awake, and I know what you have done."

"..." Phainon was ready to choke on his blood. "Nonono, it's not what you think... Actually, it's..."

"I don't mind," Mydei said. "I just want to know why exactly you acted like this... I can accept it regardless of your reason."

"What reason do you still need?" Caelus snorted. "Wasn't he just toying with you a bit?"

"You..." Mydei looked at Caelus, gritting his teeth. He couldn't control the gloom he was feeling, and he aimed at Caelus's face with a swing of his fist.

Caelus didn't expect him to lash out. The attack sent him crashing to the ground. He coughed, covering the swelling red mark on his cheek. He looked towards Mydei with a smirk. "I hit the nail on the head, didn't I? It looks like you know a bit about yourself. In this case, why don't you just take the chance to step out early?"

"Watch your mouth." Mydei looked at Caelus coldly. "Everything was said under threat. I really have no idea where you're getting the courage to gloat."

"Hmph. So what if I gloat?" Caelus looked at Mydei with fury. "You bastard. You act so lofty on the surface, but behind you shamelessly seduce someone else's partner in secret? Do you think that you're so great because you're the crown prince's cousin?"

"What did you say?" Mydei sneered. "You know for yourself what exactly happened. I'm sure you're also very clear about who's the shameless person using threats."

Phainon, who was still laying on the ground: "???" Huh, wait, why were these people suddenly catfighting? And Caelus's lines were really too awful.

Forget it. With these kind of circumstances, saving himself was probably more important.

Phainon scurried towards a safe spot. When he was hiding behind the trees, he saw that the two of them had already got their weapons ready to begin to fight. Each and every blow was aimed to kill.

It was lucky that the competition had said they couldn't bring mechas. Otherwise, if they had brought out their mechas to fight... then this would stir up the entire institute-no, even more than the entire institute. It would stir up the five major military institutes.

Just as the fight was growing intense, a hand suddenly set itself on Phainon's shoulder, and a voice rang out. "Don't you think that rather than paying attention to other people right now, you should pay a bit more attention to your surroundings?"

Phainon whipped his head back around and saw Khaslana with a face full of a smile. His heart stuttered.

Khaslana said, "I really didn't expect that a beta would manage to get those two to reach this stage. Still, everything is going to end now."

Phainon said hastily, "Wait, if I die, won't you fail the assignment?! Didn't you want to get first place in the competition?"

"You're right. In this case, I'm in a bit of a tight spot," Khaslana said. "Still, the rules said that if one party forfeits, then the other person loses their opportunity, but they don't say anything about what happens when one party dies, hmm?"

Fuck, this goes too?!

Phainon unconsciously stepped back, but suddenly he stepped into the air, and his body fell backwards.

Was there a slope here before? Phainon couldn't remember. After all, Caelus had carried him the entire way. He didn't notice any of the surrounding

terrain at all.

In his moment of peril, Phainon suddenly grabbed onto Khaslana's clothing, but he didn't expect that Khaslana didn't have a steady stance either, and both of them fell.

The slope was incredibly steep, and the two of them went tumbling down. Phainon only felt that his entire body ached, he was sprawled completely on the ground and unable to move.

On the other hand, Khaslana was alright. After he dusted himself off, he looked perfectly normal. After all, he was an alpha, and his physique was significantly better than Phainon's.

"I didn't expect that you would be so calculating, but I underestimated you. This is a great place to kill someone, and there's no need to worry about being found out, don't you think?" Khaslana looked at Phainon with an eyebrow raised, He had a smile on his face, like he was certain that Phainon had no way to escape. He strolled over at an extremely relaxed pace.

Phainon, sprawled out on the ground, quickly used his healing ability to heal himself. Luckily the system's cheat really was strong. In moments, it healed the injuries in moments. At the same time, he played dead so Khaslana wouldn't notice anything.

"You really are an eyesore." Khaslana walked in front of Phainon, taking out a dagger and using the other to prop up his cheek. He said softly, "I can still remember your arrogant expression from the first time I met you in the institute as clear as day. Back then, you spoke like I couldn't hold my head high in public because I came from the slums. I really miss it."

Phainon: "..." Actually, he wasn't the one who did that, ahhh!

"The people who mocked me back then already learned their place and left the school. You're the only one who's been hobbling around in front of me." Khaslana sneered. "The ghost truly does linger. If it wasn't for the fact that I wasn't able to kill you, I wouldn't let you live until now."

Phainon: "!" He didn't want to stay in the institute and keep bumping into Khaslana! The fright was wrecking his emotions, okay!

But with the current circumstances, he had no choice. Phainon gritted his teeth. "Do you still not know my feelings? In fact, when I first taunted you, it wasn't because I looked down on you. It was to attract your attention!"

He was basically powerwashing himself clean. Phainon was just throwing words out. The chance of success should be close to zero.

"Shut up." Khaslana's expression sank. He thrust the dagger into Phainon's wrist, pinning his hands to the ground.

Phainon's forehead beaded with cold sweat, but with the system's pain blocker, the pain was about the same level as being bitten by a kitten or a puppy, and didn't hurt too much.

"Are you joking? Do you think I'll believe you?" Khaslana said. "Ever since you won against me, there was no chance I would let you live in this world."

Dammit, if you have the guts then go kill everyone who wins against you!

Phainon was ready to die from his anger, but he thought about how the original Khaslana seemed to have really killed the brats who had won against him when he was young and in the welfare institution... He really was a cruel person you couldn't cross, but what could Phainon do if he had already crossed him!

"Where should I go for?" Khaslana wrenched the dagger back out, looking at Phainon with a slight smile. "If I kill you so easily, it would be too easy, wouldn't it?"

Phainon's hand shrank back, afraid that Khaslana would go crazy and stab him a few more times.

"Since we're already at this point, then I'll cripple your limbs first, then give you half an hour to run for your life. What do you think?" Khaslana said

uncaringly. "If you can escape, then I'll let you live."

Phainon's expression turned ugly. "No..."

This was just a damn villain in a horror movie! He had actually thought of something so disgusting. Phainon knew that Khaslana was a male lead who would seek revenge for a single look, but he didn't expect him to be so twisted.

"Yes, that's good. I bet that you're happy to die this way, aren't you?" Khaslana said, grabbing Phainon's other hand with even more strength and stabbing down at Phainon's wrist.

That was the right moment!

Phainon took a deep breath, letting his spiritual energy surge towards Khaslana.

After being attacked by the spiritual energy, Khaslana fell into a daze.

That was his chance! Phainon suddenly sat up, pushing Khaslana down and wresting away the dagger in his hand.

When Khaslana reacted, he looked at Phainon in shock. "You have such strong spiritual energy?"

Ever since he was born, Khaslana had never met someone with stronger spiritual energy than him. After he achieved SSS-rank spiritual energy on the assessment, he finally realized that his spiritual energy might be the strongest in the empire. But now there was someone stronger than him... And that someone was Phainon, who had always performed poorly.

"Right, so what? You should be worrying about yourself." Phainon threw Khaslana's own words back at him.

Just now, Phainon's spiritual energy had rushed over Khaslana's spiritual energy, stifling it in moments and making him unable to move. He was as pathetic as he had been arrogant, but Khaslana still chuckled and said, "Since I wasn't skilled enough, then you can deal with me however you

want. Don't use something useless like a fist. Why don't you use the knife you're holding?"

"..." Phainon sank into silence.

"You can't do it, can you?" Khaslana spoke as though he knew Phainon wouldn't do anything to him. "After all, you're just an ordinary person, so ordinary it's sickening. There are enough people like you on this planet. It doesn't matter how many of you die."

"How do you know I won't do anything?" Phainon lifted his wrist. In moments, the cut that Khaslana's dagger had dug in his arm healed, but the mental trauma Khaslana caused wouldn't heal so easily.

Although he wouldn't be able to complete his task if he killed Khaslana, would it be fine as long as Phainon injured him?

Phainon looked at Khaslana's long fingers, his mind unnaturally calm. Coolly, he said, "Your hands are quite elegant." Then, without the slightest hesitation, he stabbed the dagger deep into Khaslana's hand, splattering blood everywhere.

Phainon didn't expect anything too scary. He just wanted to do as Khaslana said, that's all. Khaslana could experience what he said for himself. He should be quite happy.

"Ngh...!" Khaslana had to grit his teeth before he could endure the pain. He didn't have the same pain blocker cheat as Phainon, but he forced a mocking smile onto his face. "Just this little bit? This isn't nearly enough for me."

"It's just what you said. There's still your other hand, or..." Despite his hesitance in the beginning, when Phainon saw Khaslana's face, his hesitance mostly disappeared.

Again, he stabbed deeply into the other wrist. Khaslana immediately groaned, cold sweat dripping from his face. He panted heavily, but he still provoked Phainon. "You want to torture me with something like this?"

Phainon would see things through to the end. Khaslana was ready to kill him anyways. It was no use no matter how he tried to suck up. He might as well take the chance to vent his anger... Although he would be trading his future peace.

But he had already caused Mydei and Caelus to fight. Phainon felt that he probably had no destiny with the word "peace".

After a few rounds of suffering, Khaslana's clothes looked like he had been scooped out of the water. There were bloodstains all over, and he was almost passed out where he was laying.

Phainon could get tired out from just using spiritual energy alone. Now that he had tortured Khaslana, he was even more exhausted. He wished he could crawl into bed, but if he went to sleep in front of Khaslana he would definitely wake up to something terrifying.

What was scarier was that Phainon's body was suddenly turning hot... Fuck, he suddenly realized that the terrifying heat had come again!

But his heat suppressant medication was still in the tent. He didn't know if Mydei and Caelus's fight had destroyed the medicine at the tent either... But even if it wasn't destroyed, there was nothing he could do. With his condition, there was no way he could go back and get it.

Why did all the messes come in together? This was indeed the fate of a cannon fodder.

Phainon lowered his head to look at the unconscious Khaslana. He gritted his teeth, searching for somewhere close by. He knew not to stay close by an alpha during his heat. He would just let this Khaslana fellow off this time. As for heat or whatever, it should pass if he endured a bit. He would go back at dawn.

Phainon staggered to his feet, struggling towards a more concealed location. The better locations were all full of all kinds of trees. He thought to himself, If I meet some kind of alien beast, I'm done for.

Then, as if the world had abandoned him after he beat up the original protagonist, an alien beast suddenly scurried out from the side.

It was a giant insect that was the height of a man. It looked terrifying enough that it could act as a villain in a horror movie without the slightest photoshop. Of course, it still fell a bit short of being the final boss.

Phainon: "!" Fuck, did you have to come so quickly? Didn't he just beat up the original protagonist! Fine, beating up the original protagonist was pretty serious.

Some time had already passed since he used his spiritual energy... But if he used it now, his body might not be able to hold on.

Phainon gritted his teeth, wanting to use his spiritual energy as the only weapon he had, but because his energy had been exhausted, he collapsed toe the ground. Naturally, his spiritual energy didn't exert itself either.

At that moment, the large insect walked closer again. Phainon could practically see the insect's pincers. His heart pounded. Was he going to get his lunchbox like this!

Just as his life was hanging by a thread, the large insect hesitated, then quickly retreated several steps. Finally, as though it had encountered its natural enemy, it fled speedily.

Phainon let out a breath of relief. Wait, this wasn't the time to sigh in relief! He did his utmost to sit upright and look over, and he spotted a head with pale blonde hair and golden eyes in the distance. It was a teenager with a friendly smile.

"What a coincidence... We meet again." The youth greeted him cheerily.

Phainon was stunned. "Thank you so much for this... I-it really is a coincidence. I didn't expect that you would remember me." Wasn't this guy the Zerg! No wonder this large insect was scared off! It had probably scented the Zerg's pheromones. Still, why did it happen right at such a time...

"Of course I remember you." The teenager walked over to him slowly, extending a hand to lift his chin. "After all, you were the one who saved me on the airship. I could never forget my savior."

Phainon was way more than a savior. He was also the guy who worked him up into a heat and ran away.

Phainon felt like the way he managed to avoid getting beaten up was lucky enough to win the lottery. "..."

He had completely miscalculated. Sure enough, if they weren't noticed, Zerg could blend into other living beings. They could distinguish other people by scent alone.

It seemed like meeting this youth here wasn't an accident. The other party had followed his scent to seek him out.

Phainon couldn't expose that he knew the other person was a Zerg, or he would be silenced.

"Your body is so hot. It looks like you're not doing too well," the youth said, noticing the other parts of Phainon. "Your clothes are all torn, and your skin is exposed... By the way, you came alone, too. Something must have happened, right?"

Phainon hurriedly said, "It's nothing, I'm fine. I just lost contact with my teammate when I ran into that alien beast just now. I just need to rest for a moment and I'll be fine."

He shouldn't mention the enmity between him and Khaslana. Besides, he didn't need anyone else to help him right now. What would he do if they discovered he was an omega?

"Also, I was wondering about this ever since earlier. *Why do you smell like an omega's pheromones?*"

Chapter End Notes

The Author has Something to Say:
Oh~ Mysterious zerg kid. He's surely not gonna play a major role soon.....

Yay! New Chapter and I think this one is my favorite so far! The kiss with Mydei! Khas and Phai lowkey giving enemies to lovers. Like I cant be the only one imagining them looking hot injured, sweating and still trying to gloat XD. See you all next week!

Chapter 13: Zerg Kid

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Phainon was given a huge shock by the teenager's words, but because of his heat, he was too dizzy to think clearly. He couldn't explain himself even after a long time.

"Are you alright?" The teenager helped Phainon up, letting Phainon lean against him. "It looks like you're having a hard time, hmm?"

Phainon plastered himself onto the teenager's body unconsciously. The cool touch made him feel better, but the fever burning him from the inside out was impossible to bear. The worst part was the part below the neck that couldn't be described. If Phainon was clear-headed, he would wish he could die.

"I... I'm fine..." Phainon murmured over and over again with his last bit of awareness. His body went completely weak, and he could only lay weakly on the other person.

The color of teenager's laughing gold eyes deepened slightly. If he was just a normal, human alpha, the thick omega pheromones would probably have made him lose his sense.

"Yes, you're fine... Don't be scared." The teenager touched Phainon's back tenderly, his other hand cupping Phainon's cheek.

An omega in heat was incredibly sensitive. The teenager's slight touch was enough to make him shiver. If he was given more stimulation, like pressing their bodies together, or touching that most sensitive and most fragile place, it would be enough to make him orgasm.

The teenager leaned close to Phainon's ear, his voice low. "Because you're just in heat."

His words exploded into Phainon's ear like a clap of thunder. Phainon used the last ounce of his energy to begin to struggle, but of course his strength, even weaker than a kitten's, wasn't enough to throw off anyone. He had no choice but to pant, "No... I'm not an omega."

"Mm?" The teenager nuzzled his cheek, chuckling. "If you say you're not, then you're not. But you can't keep going like this either, am I right?"

The situation was clearly dangerous, but Phainon couldn't think. When he heard the teenager's tender voice, it was as though there really was no problem. His body even relaxed unconsciously, and he slowly calmed down.

If he had a little bit of reason left, he would know there was a serious problem.

"Good boy. Although it hurts a little, it'll pass quickly." The teenager arranged Phainon in a new position and picked him up, brushing over his nape gently.

"Nn...?" Phainon had a feeling that something bad was going to happen, but he couldn't get himself to react either.

The gland on the back of his neck was much more sensitive than other parts of his body. The touch made Phainon even more compliant. A mixture of feelings intermingled in his mind, making him sink into a daze.

The teenager lowered his head, gently taking hold of his neck in his mouth and nipping softly. He moved slowly until he was at the back of Phainon's neck, feeling the omega pheromones even more strongly.

Even though he wasn't human, he was about to go crazy.

He closed his eyes gently, and bit down.

The only thing Phainon felt was a wave of pain bursting from the back of his neck. It came with a strong pleasure that he couldn't ignore. His blood

was boiling, and he couldn't stop gasping for breath, but he had exhausted his energy while struggling and was too weak to even lift a finger.

His last shred of reason realized... This seemed to be a mark!?

Then Phainon's vision blurred, and he fell completely unconscious.

The teenager opened his eyes, letting go of his nape and planting several kisses on the back of Phainon's neck. "...As I thought, it's not possible... This body is incapable of forming a complete mark."

The teenager looking down at Phainon, who was completely unconscious in his arms, cupping his cheek.

"We'll see each other again..."

When he finished speaking, he stood up. In just a few steps, he sank into the river, and his eyes lost their spirit.

At the same time, far away in the palace on the capital planet, an ashy silver haired gold-eyed teenager laying inside a nutrient cabin opened his eyes.

He sat up, beads of water dripping from his dazzling white hair and sliding onto a cheek that was renowned to be even more beautiful than the Rose of the Empire, the prince.

"As I thought, it's not possible... After all, that body was too weak. It's simply incapable of bearing my power. A few days was already the limit. I'll need to have someone go and retrieve that body."

He spoke softly, as though he disliked the annoyance that was about to happen. His brow furrowed slightly.

"...Still, next time it won't be such a bother."

Because he was already completely certain of that person's identity.

He suddenly fell into a daze, thinking of what kind of reaction that person would have when he discovered his true identity.

After some time had passed, Khaslana woke up, his limbs still aching.

If an ordinary person was injured like this, they would already be dead. Yet Khaslana was incredibly clearheaded, and he could feel acutely how serious his injuries were. It was the first time in his life that he had been so injured.

"Exactly... It's this feeling..." Khaslana reached up to press his wound, which was no longer bleeding. He pressed slightly, feeling the pain coming from the injury. Unexpectedly, he felt a faint sense of excitement.

His life had always gone smoothly, and he had practically never faced failure. But time and time again, he had failed against the same person.

He should be feeling fury, but he was getting more and more excited.

Compared to successes that he had gained too easily, failures like this were extremely scarce. Rather than someone that he could deal with easily, Phainon was like a rarity who burst into his world halfway through, shaking his always smooth-sailing life into uncertainty.

Khaslana seemed to have thought of something. "Hahaha... Hahahahaha..." He began to chuckle, but it was followed by hacking coughs.

Even though he was Khaslana, he had lost so much blood, and his emotions were high. For a moment, his head spun and his vision went fuzzy.

And when the necklace around his neck, his last remaining piece of his mother, dipped into the puddle of blood, it began to glow with a dazzling light.

With difficulty, he reached up to grasp the necklace. Khaslana's wounds healed at lightning speed. Although he looked like he was in dire straits, he didn't have a single injury.

Precisely. Khaslana's last reminder of his mother was a precious necklace that the emperor gifted to her. It was an ore that could strengthen this

wearer's physique. When it touched Khaslana's blood, its remaining strength dissipated, healing his wounds completely.

"What is...?" It was Khaslana's first time analyzing this plain, ordinary necklace so carefully. After its display of power just now, the jewel of the necklace turned gray and shattered.

And there was a design engraved in the metal the jewel was set into.

It was the emblem that represented the imperial family. Nearly every member of the empire knew that the emblem practically represented the imperial family themselves. If anyone had the nerve to use the emblem without permission, they would get the death penalty.

Then why would the imperial family's emblem appear on the necklace his mother left behind for him?

Khaslana suddenly had a completely unrealistic guess about his background.

Meanwhile, Phainon woke up blearily. He could only remember that the Zerg bit his nape yesterday, and because he couldn't bear the mix of pain and pleasure he had passed out.

"Fuck..." Phainon's mind suddenly cleared up. He hurriedly touched the back of his neck, turning pale. "...I was marked??"

The original ABO setting had plenty of extra characteristics. For example, to maintain the protagonist's coolness, Khaslana had the innate ability to resist omega pheromones. Even if he smelled them, he wouldn't lose his reason. Later, when people sent omegas in heat over to him, hoping to befuddle Khaslana, they all failed... Still, wouldn't this make people think that Khaslana had a problem in that regard?

As for the matter of marking, if they were more pressed for time, it could only be a temporary mark, and the marked omega could only calm down.

Of course, completely getting rid of the problem of heats would still require a furious tumble in the sheets...

When Phainon realized this, he was shocked. He looked down at his clothes, which were still properly on his body, before he could let out a breath of relief. As for the mark on his neck, as if he'd go and think about it...

Now that he thought about it, that Zerg was pretty good. Other than biting him, he didn't do anything in particular.

To an omega native to this world, getting bitten on the nape was a terrible thing, but to Phainon, who had transmigrated into this world not even half a year ago, the back of his neck was no different than any other part of his body. He therefore even felt a bit grateful to the Zerg.

But if Phainon knew this Zerg's real identity, he certainly wouldn't think the same way.

If it was a human alpha who ran into him back then, something terrifying would definitely have happened.

"I'd better hurry back and get my inhibitors to prevent something like this from happening again." Phainon struggled to get up, but he discovered that his body was still achy and weak. Even lifting an arm was exhausting. He was so tired he felt like he had been run over.

Well, that wasn't wrong. Yesterday, Khaslana had caused him to go tumbling down the mountain, then he had an intense fight with Khaslana, and even stabbed Khaslana several times... And after that he went right into heat and a Zerg nearly put him to death.

And it all started because he forced a kiss on Mydei.

When he thought about it, Phainon felt incredibly unlucky. Although his secret identity wasn't exposed, the person most important to hide from, Caelus, had found out. He didn't know what he would do in the future,

either... Ugh, he wouldn't go thinking about a problem so far in the future. The most urgent thing right now was to get out of here quickly.

Since Phainon really had no strength left, he had no choice but to use his previous method of continuously using his healing ability on himself. Yet the bite mark on the back of his neck seemed as though they were out of the scope of his ability. No matter how he tried, he couldn't heal it. Phainon could only pull his collar a little higher, trying to cover up where he had been bitten.

Still, as long as someone paid a little more attention to that spot, they would be able to see the marks.

Just as Phainon finally recovered most of his energy, a hideous giant insect began to approach slowly from a distance.

Shockingly enough, it was the same giant insect as the one from yesterday night. Though in daylight it didn't look as gruesome as it did in the evening, each feature was terrifying. Phainon was so disgusted that he would refuse to even describe the insect in detail.

"I'm surprised this bug hasn't left yet... It even turned back around." Generally speaking, if it had been scared off yesterday it should have ran away, right? It was just a low-grade bug, so what intelligence did it have!

Phainon was even more sure that it was because he had poked the son of fate, the original protagonist Khaslana, a few times with a knife, and therefore caused the world consciousness to set itself against him. That was why there was so much crap happening to him.

If they swapped to another novel, what cannon fodders would be able to take a knife and go at the protagonist without getting a lunchbox?

Luckily, after a night of rest, his spiritual energy was about enough that he could use it again. Phainon gritted his teeth, looking out at the giant insect, calculating silently in his head.

It would be better to use his spiritual energy when the insect got closer. Otherwise it would be ridiculous if he didn't even injure it and he was the one who couldn't last.

But in the next moment, there was a loud noise. Something flew out from behind him suddenly, piercing through the giant insect's body. The insect, unwilling to resign itself to death, thrashed its legs furiously, but it could do nothing. It slowly stopped moving, black fluid pooling on the ground. It was disgusting.

Phainon's first reaction wasn't celebration. Instead, he turned his head vigilantly. "Who's there?"

At a time like this, there was no guarantee a human would be safer than a giant insect.

But he just saw Mydei leap out from behind him, a gun in his hands. When he saw Phainon, he stored the gun into his space button.

"I finally found you." Mydei looked like he hadn't slept all night. He reached out anxiously to hold Phainon up, giving him a once-over. "Thank goodness you're alright."

Mydei had come down the slope himself and found human blood in the ground. He had nearly fallen apart, but because there was no body he clung to his hopes, searching everywhere.

"Didn't they say we couldn't bring firearms?" When he finished speaking, Phainon realized that his attention seemed to be on the wrong thing.

"Oh, this? Don't worry. As long as nobody sees it, it's fine. Who wouldn't bring some things for self defense when coming to a place like this?" Mydei said.

Phainon, who had not brought any good weapons (and even forgetting that he couldn't get his hands on them at all), felt like he had been shot right in the heart.

Still, he had a point. Who would go searching a space button who belonged to someone like Mydeimos, the crown prince's younger cousin, or Caelus, the son of a duke? Even if they knew there was something hidden inside, they probably wouldn't have the nerve.

"Yesterday, I lost my reason because I got too worked up and I was unable to stay by your side. It led to this situation. I truly apologize." Mydei looked like he wished he could throttle his past self.

"It's okay." Phainon thought that yesterday's events had been too much of a mess. "It was all because of me that you... If it wasn't for Khaslana attacking all of a sudden, things wouldn't have gone so far."

"I didn't expect he would do something so inhumane." By now, Mydei loathed Khaslana from the bottom of his heart. He had completely forgotten his initial appreciation for Khaslana's friendship. "How could he move against you? He's truly too ruthless."

If Mydei knew what Phainon had done to Khaslana, would he still say something like this...

"This is still..." Phainon changed the topic hastily. "By the way, what happened to Caelus?" Mydei had brought a fucking gun, so Caelus should be okay, right... Although he didn't care that much about Caelus, for better or worse they had been together for a long time. It was perfectly normal for him to be concerned about whether Caelus had died or not.

Mydei's expression cooled. It was obvious that he didn't want to talk about Caelus, but Phainon was the one who brought it up, so he couldn't not answer. He said, "After I hit that guy, he was injured. He ran away already."

Phainon: "...It's been hard on you." When he thought about it, Mydei could even bring in firearms, so it would be very normal if Caelus brought in some weapons for self-defense.

"Where did this blood come from?" Mydei finally noticed the bloodstains on Phainon's sleeves and clothes. Because it had been some time and

Phainon had also fallen into the dirt, he wasn't able to tell just now. He immediately turned anxious. "Are you hurt somewhere?"

"No, these... these are all from Khaslana's blood." Phainon couldn't avoid the topic any longer. He could only say, "Yesterday when I was fighting with Khaslana, I got worked up, and I was a bit more ruthless... I don't know what happened to Khaslana after that, either."

Though a normal person would certainly have no way to walk off after getting stabbed all over, Pei Shijan was a man with plot armor on his side. No matter what, nothing bad would happen, unless it was something really too ridiculous.

"You truly deserve your renown. You can even fight an alpha down to such a state as an omega." Mydei's eyes sparkled. From the bottom of his heart, he praised, "Having the opportunity to follow at your side is truly the most fortunate occasion of my life."

Of course, even if Phainon wasn't able to beat Khaslana, Mydei would still think that being able to follow at Phainon's side was the most fortunate occasion of his life.

Phainon had a feeling that even if he lost Mydei would find a way to praise him to the skies.

"This isn't the most suitable place to converse. I'll lead you away," Mydei said. Out of the corner of his eye, he noticed the back of Phainon's neck, and he froze.

"Perfect timing. I was just getting hungry." Phainon didn't notice where Mydei's gaze was in the slightest. He was tired, hungry, and ready to sleep. Where would he get the extra attention span to notice what Mydei was looking at?

Besides, after interacting with him for so long, Phainon had confidence in Mydei. At first, he was completely on guard, but after meeting up with Mydei he relaxed. He got sleepy quickly and yawned. He said, "Mm... I still have omega inhibitors at the campsite... I have to go and get them."

"Alright." Mydei turned around, pretending that nothing had happened. He put Phainon on his back, heading back in the direction he came from.

It was clearly what he had been dreaming of for a long time, but his heart sank further and further.

To Phainon, their surroundings were full of forests that all looked the same, but Mydei walked as comfortably as if he was in his own backyard, and his pace through the woods was extremely nimble. He was even able to walk so smoothly that Phainon didn't feel much from his position on Mydei's back.

In those conditions, Phainon quickly fell asleep where he was sprawled out on Mydei's back.

If he hadn't transmigrated and was instead a native who had seen the strength of passerby alphas for himself, he would probably start feeling like Mydei's strength was simply inhuman... But even if Mydei was strong, he wasn't stronger than the strongest villain, Nanook, or Khaslana post-evolution.

When they arrived at the bloody hill, Mydei paid attention to the surroundings. He didn't know where Khaslana was. The blood on the ground had already dried up, but it was still disgusting. It was easy to imagine what had happened here yesterday.

If Mydei was to run into Khaslana now, he would fight him until they took their last breaths.

While Phainon was still asleep, Mydei took the chance to set him down under a tree, clearing up the ground a bit so that nobody could tell what had happened there.

Because Phainon was sleeping too deeply, he had no idea what was happening. When he woke up, they had already arrived at their campsite from yesterday.

It was a complete wreck. When the two of them started fighting yesterday, they fought with control. When Khaslana discovered that Phainon had

evaded him, he pulled out any weapon he could. There wasn't a single space left intact.

Now, the area was a mess. The tent was even more tattered. At a glance, it looked as though some robber had swept their way through, and it was enough to make someone worry whether or not they could find what they needed inside.

Phainon nervously walked to where he had put his things down yesterday. He was pleasantly surprised to find that everything was still in one piece... He didn't expect that he would be so lucky during such an unlucky time.

It was okay not to have anything else, but he couldn't lose his omega inhibitors. Phainon went straight to take a pill out and stuff it in his mouth, and he felt the last shred of omega scent in his body dissipate before he could finally relax.

When Mydei saw him, he felt a bit worried. "I've heard that it can be a serious danger if you take too many of those inhibitors... A typical omega won't take them. Is there really no problem if you take them?"

"Well, there's no other way right now." Phainon shrugged. "Anyways, that's nothing to worry about."

Anyway, Phainon didn't have any intention of staying in this world for a long period of time. Ever since he sneakily healed the original host's mother with his healing ability when he went back to the host's house, he was prepared to leave at any time.

But Mydei's attention wasn't swayed but Phainon's words. His gaze turned even more complicated.

Was he imagining things? Why did he have the feeling that Phainon would leave him at any time and go somewhere that nobody could chase after him...

Phainon put away the rest of the things that were still of use. He remembered how Caelus and Khaslana had ran off somewhere, but the rules

were that two people had to arrive at their destination to succeed. When Phainon reached that point of his train of thought, he gave up on it.

In fact, based on their power as four, they wouldn't have had any problems at all. It was just that within a day they had an unforeseen mishap....

Speaking of the people in the institute, if they knew that Khaslana, the person they had been anticipating would seize first place, couldn't take first because he had forfeited on his own, they would probably scold his ears off.

Mydei looked like he had thought of the same thing. He hastily said, "No, we can't let those ignorant people humiliate you. I will take you to the destination point. You just need to rest well."

Phainon thought for a moment. He felt the same way... So he nodded. He didn't need to worry about what would happen if he stayed at Mydei's side, and he would also get a chance to train his physique a little.

And so they made their way to the destination, dawdling for several days before they finally arrived. Because Khaslana wasn't with them, things progressed especially smoothly. Nothing out of the ordinary happened at all.

It had already been so much time that most of the other top students at other institutes had arrived at the destination already. What Phainon didn't expect was that Caelus would also be waiting at the destination.

Caelus was sitting outside, looking listless. When he caught sight of Phainon, his eyes lit up, then he put up an expression of disdain, striding over like he wanted to say something.

Mydei immediately blocked Phainon behind his own body.

Caelus glared. "What are you doing? Get out of my way."

"No," Mydei said coldly. "Someone who has lost to me doesn't need to keep up the arrogance."

Caelus knew that he wasn't strong enough to compare with Mydei, and he could only grit his teeth, giving up on getting closer to Phainon to talk one-on-one. He turned to Phainon. "I won't forget our deal. When I complete my end of the deal, you need to fulfill your promise too. Or else I won't let you off!" When he finished, he didn't wait for Phainon to reply before turning to flee.

Phainon suddenly felt like catfishing Caelus might have been a mistake.
"..."

Khaslana hadn't arrived yet. Phainon let out a breath of relief. If he saw Khaslana and this shameless system changed Khaslana into his capture target, he really had no idea what he would do.

And Phainon had suddenly thought of something very important. Didn't the system say before that after changing capture targets it would hurt to touch the previous capture target? This effect had never taken place with Caelus.

The system came out to explain, [It's because this world is a bit more unique. It's different from the previous worlds. In order to let the host get accustomed slowly, a safeguard period has been initiated. It will continue for three months, so in these months the host doesn't need to worry about the effect after switching capture targets.]

Phainon: "..." You're saying it oh-so-kindly, but why don't you say something like this earlier! And the three month period was about to pass, too. He felt like it was ending before he could enjoy the special treatment.

All kinds of problems had come up in the previous worlds because of this lousy setting. Couldn't they just get rid of this penalty mechanism completely!

Phainon was just blurting out whatever, not expecting the system to listen to him. As he t thought, the system knew plenty about making excuses, and nothing was unchangeable. What was all that about maintaining the capture target's interest... Phainon actually felt sorry for the capture targets.

But there had been no news about that Zerg teenager. Even when he went to ask around at the institute that he had stayed at before, everyone else was confused. They had no information about him, only that they had seen how powerful he was before, and that was why they had been so flattering of him before.

Phainon: "..." Hey, why is your school so casual about it! They were on track to be finished.

Phainon couldn't do anything about it, and that teenager didn't seem like the kind of person who would go spreading someone's secrets either, so he would leave it alone for the time being.

As time passed, the rest of the students slowly arrived, but Khaslana still didn't appear.

The heads of the institute couldn't hold themselves back from questioning Phainon. Phainon had no choice but to say that they had separate partway through, and he didn't know where exactly Khaslana was.

Other than hiding the part where he gave Khaslana a beating, the rest was all real.

Because he had Mydei and Caelus acting as witness, nobody suspected that Phainon was hiding anything. After all, Phainon didn't look like the kind of person that could fight with Khaslana.

Soon, the competition formally ended. This year, the empire's military institute had ranks in the middle. Khaslana, who they had expected would be able to give a good showing, had disappeared. Everyone was in low spirits. There were even some people that brought up whether or not Khaslana might already be dead.

But Phainon knew very clearly that Khaslana was the central figure in this world. If he died, the world might just collapse. Where would you get the time to keep guessing if he was alive or not...

Khaslana must have encountered some good luck. After all, protagonists would all get their opportunity after a hardship.

Though they left some people behind at the base to search, most of them thought that Khaslana's situation had taken a turn for the worse. Everyone boarded the airship back to the capital planet. They had come in excitement and with high spirits, but now the mood had disappeared.

Because Khaslana was gone, Mydei let Phainon move to his room. Caelus didn't say anything either.

During the few days they spent on the airship, Phainon kept lowkey and typically didn't go out. If he went out and Khaslana's fans came to vent his anger, what would he do?

After he finished his meal, Phainon got in bed and went to sleep. He could relax now that he was staying with Mydei.

But on the side, Mydei gazed at his sleeping face, his eyes gloomy.

He had never asked out loud why exactly Phainon had forced a kiss onto him. Was it the reason that Phainon and Caelus explained? If so, then Mydei knew very clearly that Phainon obviously had no intentions towards him...

Mydei had always thought that it was enough for him to follow after Phainon. As long as he could watch Phainon's shadow from up close, he could be satisfied.

But after that event, Mydei finally understood.

He didn't just want to stay at Phainon's side. He wanted Phainon to have only him at his side, wanted Phainon to only look at him, to talk to him, and to never look at someone else.

"...I really am insatiable." Mydei looked towards Phainon, recalling that day when he had found Phainon and happened to see the bite mark on the back of his neck.

"...Who exactly was the person who marked you then?"

But this wasn't important anymore, because in the future... the alpha who marked Phainon would be *him.*

Chapter End Notes

The Author Has Something To Say:
Yay! New Chapter!

Did you all like the reveal? I was expecting more people to be able to get it because of the golden eyes like molten gold but then again a lot of HSR characters have golden eyes I have come to realize. Also darn you google when my paranoid ass asked you before what Nanook's hair color was you said pale blonde but now your saying its silver or white?! I hate my life. Whatever it was just a disguise so consider it as that but it was supposed to be more obvious. Oh well, this is good for plot.

See you all next week!

Chapter 14: Finals

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

And so they returned to the institute. Because of what happened with Khaslana, everyone in the institute was in low spirits. If it wasn't for the fact that they couldn't be sure if Khaslana was dead or alive, everyone might have arranged a memorial for him.

Phainon naturally didn't have the nerve to go to Caelus's house again... He had a feeling that if he went something bad would happen. Anyway, he didn't have much luggage to pack, so he decided to just move to a dorm rented from the institute.

There were several cheap dorms, but most of them were designed for several people. All the singles were in the high-rise. He felt that if his omega pheromones spread out, he would stir up an entire building of alphas in minutes. The scene was too gory for Phainon to imagine.

After they came back to the institute, Caelus never came back to school. It was rumored that Caelus had especially gone to seek out his father for the sake of the finals. He had his father use his influence to invite a retired general to teach him. He trained from dawn to dusk with no time to spare. He spent his days in incredible hardship.

Phainon had thought that Caelus, someone born in a duke's family just needed to enjoy their comfortable life. After all, the one inheriting the duke's title was Caelus's brother, so Caelus just needed to enjoy himself. In the last dozen years, that was just what he did. Nobody had ever counted on him to do anything.

But now that Caelus was suddenly working so hard, the duke and duchess were given a shock. They were even worried that their son might have been possessed.

Phainon knew that in the original novel Caelus had become very powerful in the later parts of the novel, but they were currently in the middle of the novel at latest. Even if he improved, he probably couldn't make it to the finals of the mecha competition right away...

When Mydei found out that Phainon was thinking of looking for a dorm, he immediately offered to let him move to his own residence.

Phainon didn't really want to think too much to begin with, but when he considered how he didn't know when he would go into heat it would be a hassle, it would save him some trouble to have someone with him... Besides, Mydei's residence was huge. He didn't need to worry about his omega pheromones drawing people over.

Phainon had completely forgotten that Mydei was also an alpha... It was all because his impression of Mydei as a loyal lion had been engraved deep in his heart.

When Mydei found out that Phainon had been using a helmet to login to the virtual world, he was ready to faint in anger.

A helmet couldn't completely send someone's consciousness into the virtual world. Although it didn't feel too different in use, there were subtle aspects that would be affected. All of the contestants participating in the competition were using nutrient cabins.

On the other hand, using a nutrient cabin could greatly reduce the amount of stress on the body. For someone like Phainon, who had an especially weak constitution, he would be able to stay online for a few more hours if he used the nutrient cabin, and he wouldn't be as exhausted as if he had used a helmet after he came out. Instead, he would feel very comfortable.

Mydei immediately purchased the latest model of nutrition cabin for Phainon. In his opinion, it was criminal that Caelus couldn't bring out Phainon's full power. He regretted not hitting Caelus harder when he had the chance.

At first, Phainon thought Mydei was exaggerating, but when he used the nutrient cabin, he was stunned by the speed and smoothness at which he entered the virtual world. His body felt much lighter, and the scenery before his eyes was crisper. It was as though he was a character in a cultivation novel who had had succeeded in building his foundation.

In comparison, Phainon felt like his past self was like a lousy computer that refreshed at a rate of one frame per second... Before switching, he was used to the feeling of the virtual net helmet, but now that he had switched, he discovered that it simply wasn't a way to live.

At the same time, because of what happened with Khaslana, other people were getting more and more worked up. There were even people who cursed Phainon, saying that there was no way Khaslana would have disappeared if it wasn't for the fact that Khaslana was paired with such a weak partner. They got angrier and angrier, even demanding for Phainon to be expelled.

But with Mydei there, their goal had no hope of succeeding.

Mydei didn't want to tell Phainon, but when he thought about how serious the problem was, he decided to tell him after all. He advised Phainon not to go out. If there was anything he needed, he could come looking for Mydei.

Phainon hated being a bother. When he imagined the terrifying scene of himself being surrounded by Khaslana's fans, he immediately gave up on the idea of going outside...

Everyone else thought that Phainon was innocent and that he had only gotten paired up with Khaslana and encountered such an event... But Phainon was very clear that there was a strong correlation between the current situation and how he had poked a few stabs into Khaslana.

Because Phainon couldn't out and he couldn't go to class, Mydei decided he might as well not go to class either. He brought over a textbook, giving Phainon special one-on-one explanations.

Mydei's grades were at the top of the class. When he was explaining, he would pay extra attention to the parts that Phainon didn't understand. Phainon learned even more than when he went to class himself, and he understood mechas even better.

Mydei would also make all kinds of delicious foods to feed Phainon. He was afraid that Phainon would get bored staying inside day after day, so he changed his cooking all the time.

Phainon was originally a homebody who didn't have much desire to go outside anyway. His new lifestyle couldn't be any better. He had pretty much anything he wanted, all kinds of delicious foods, and he could go online to practice mecha maneuvering whenever he wanted. He had even less desire to go outside.

Mydei was different. His emotions were extremely complicated.

This wasn't any good to Phainon, but because Mydei could stay alone with Phainon and without anyone bothering them, he was secretly delighted.

He even wished that they could always live like this. He didn't even care what kind of price he had to pay.

In the blink of an eye, it was time for the final match of the virtual mecha competition.

Recently, the officials had contacted several of the competitors to let everyone advertise themselves and so on. Occasionally, there were a few who were invited to go on a show for publicity. They were pretty much the same as a celebrity... But in a world like this that worshipped the strong, compared to a celebrity, generals and marshals and others like them had the most fans.

Of course, Phainon never appeared. After all, wasn't it too extreme to go promoting himself with a mosaic on his face? Besides, that wasn't even the

important part. It would be an absolute joke if he accidentally revealed his identity!

Anyway, he could market himself as a cool character (Phainon had already chosen to ignore the atrocities he had committed on his mecha to get advertising fees).

He didn't expect that his actions would really make his fans even more frenzied. The idol in their hearts should be as mysterious and aloof as this. He was incredibly cool.

The ad-filled mecha that Phainon usually used was also being praised like crazy. People said the mecha was just like a work of art. Art was something the general populace couldn't understand, so normal people didn't understand Prince Latiao's sense of aesthetic.

Phainon: "..."

During this time, there was no news from Khaslana. Just as the officials were debating if they should withdraw his qualification, Khaslana finally appeared.

Exactly. The protagonist always had to arrive just as the situation was hanging by a thread, except if it was an author that had to abuse their readers and insisted on writing terrifying plotlines about protagonists who could never make it back for the climax and got hurt.

Phainon, who only ever read easy, relaxed novels, firmly rejected those kinds of novels. Maybe those novels had more depth, but he only read for entertainment. Who cared about depth and so on?

But right now, Phainon would rather Khaslana was the protagonist of a novel like that... A protagonist with a cheat on his side had zero friendliness to a cannon fodder like him!!

Especially because Khaslana had definitely got the cheat and leveled up before he came back. Phainon had stabbed him several times, so Khaslana

definitely had a deep hatred for him. If he didn't stab Phainon several dozen times in return, then he wasn't Khaslana.

Still, he didn't need to worry about Khaslana exposing him for those stabs. Khaslana was the kind of person valued his reputation more than anything, and he absolutely wouldn't say that he had been given serious stab wounds by a beta. It was too humiliating. It completely ruined his perfect image.

Phainon only had the guts to go on the school website to take a look. As expected, they were all excited. All of the threads were about Khaslana, saying Khaslana was like the representative of the empire's military institute. It was as though the institute was done for without him.

The indignant people who had been calling for Phainon to be expelled weren't saying anything anymore. They were probably too busy licking Khaslana's boots.

Things had pretty much completely blown over, but now that Khaslana was back, Phainon was even more afraid to go out. He would rather curl up at home and bear it until he reached the ending of the novel. He didn't want to go out so soon and bind to Khaslana so miserably!

Soon, it was the day the finals really began.

Phainon naturally won his first match. With his incredible spiritual energy, he wasn't worried about losing at all. Now, there was nobody at the competition who was a threat besides Khaslana.

But when Phainon thought about the guy who paid two million empire coins to face him one-on-one and the words he said, Phainon felt a faint sense of worry. He kept secretly looking at his surrounding opponents, but he didn't find anyone like that person.

Could it be that the challenger had just wanted to toy with him a bit, and didn't have any treacherous intentions? ... Who would have so much free time.

After returning, Khaslana's strength skyrocketed. During the competition, he was even more incredible. He made all kinds of incredibly difficult moves look easy. Recordings were being spread around the internet at an insane speed. Countless people were drawn in by Khaslana's charm. Soon, people were even beginning to call him the Nation's Mr. Perfect.

If they were following the plot of the original novel, he would definitely be the Nation's Mr. Perfect.

But in the very last match, Khaslana's opponent was Prince Latiao.

Over the course of the competition, the two of them had gathered many fans. Even if they said they would always worship their own idol, in reality, whoever could win would be the victor, and nobody would remember the loser.

Phainon was under high pressure. The main worry was that Khaslana was fate's favorite! Under the protection of his plot armor, it would be hard if Phainon wanted to win. Last time he had been relaxed about winning because it couldn't impact the plot too much. This time, there would be a huge effect.

Although he was relying on his plot armor, even if Khaslana lost he would be able to make a comeback. In this novel, the plot typically moved forward with incredible ease. When Khaslana wasn't being abused, he was truly the author's biological son.

Phainon didn't want to lose. He had already made it so far. Even if he had to risk his life, he had to give it his all.

Mydei was also aware that they were in a dangerous situation. Every day, he would make foods to build up one's health and take care of Phainon in all kinds of ways. Sometimes, he would even feed Phainon... Oddly enough, Phainon had a feeling that he had already settled down and gotten married. Mydei was too much of a perfect wife.

Finally, the day of the final match arrived.

Many people had already been anticipating Prince Latiao's fight.

The match was finally about to begin. When the tickets were made available online a few days ago, they had been snapped up. Even though there were people reselling the tickets at a high price, it was impossible to get one. Not everyone had the chance to watch the finals from such a close distance, even ignoring the fact that the two competitors fighting were both figures that would only appear once in decades.

Before the competition properly started, everyone was discussing eagerly. "Who will win?"

"Although I think both sides are strong, God Time should be the one who will win. After all, he's always been competing with the worst model mecha. His true strength is obvious."

"You guys don't know? Prince Latiao used an old mecha in his first fight too. And back then, he won right away. He can't be any less skilled than Time."

"But all the mechas Prince Latiao use now are new models. I bet he knows he's not skilled enough, and he can't defeat anyone with the old models, right? From this perspective, he's taking the upper hand because of his mecha."

"Too bad. God Time will be at a disadvantage in this sense. The mecha he uses is so far behind the other one. It's very likely that even if he's stronger than his opponent, he'll lose. It'd be good if he didn't stick to it."

It was easy to see Khaslana's scheming from this perspective. Even if he lost the competition, he could blame it on his mecha being low quality. There would probably be a bunch of people who complained on behalf of him and saying that even though he had lost the competition he had won in skills or something like that.

In the next moment, their mechas appeared on both sides of the battlefield. When everyone saw the sight, their eyes widened in shock.

"What the heck? They're both old-fashioned mechas?"

"Prince Latiao picked an old-fashioned mecha too? What is he thinking?"

Precisely. Even if it was a mecha packed with ads, the mecha's model was the cheapest old-fashioned mecha no matter how you looked at it. It was exactly the same as the mecha that his opponent Khaslana was using.

These old-fashioned mechas had fallen out of use in the outside world. They only had the most basic functions. Nowadays, only newbies who were just starting to come in contact with mechas would use them, but they had made their way into the finals.

Even the host was shocked. The host explained, "Surprisingly, Prince Latiao is using the old-fashioned mecha. It seems that he wants to have a just, honorable, and fair match with Time."

Precisely. Phainon had always kept an eye on the news online, and already knew what they were thinking. To avoid being accused for unfairness even if he won, Phainon had immediately chosen the same old-fashioned mecha as Khaslana. He would save himself a lot of trouble.

Across from him, Khaslana was sitting in his seat, completely at ease. He looked at his opponent's old-fashioned mecha, raising an eyebrow. "Not bad. You picked the same old mecha as I did... You're really confident in your strength. But if a newbie like you wants to win against me, you've still got a long way to go."

Khaslana had never faced a setback from anyone other than Phainon, and he didn't believe that anyone would get a win by accident the way Phainon had.

Khaslana looked towards his wrist. On it was a hideous wound. In the real world, the wound had already been healed by the power of the necklace, but he had specially added it back on in the virtual world as a memento.

After he had been stabbed several times by Phainon back on that planet, Khaslana had discovered the secret of the necklace his mother left behind

by chance. In a series of coincidences, he arrived at a cavern and obtained an ore that might have been left behind by an aboriginal of the native land.

The ore could activate someone's innate potential, and stimulated the imperial blood that had been passed onto Khaslana. In moments, his strength rose up a level, and his features were more attractive than they were previously.

At first, Phainon had roasted the novel. Everyone was human, but why was the imperial family's bloodline so incredible... But if the author wanted to give Khaslana a cheat then there was nothing he could do.

Afterward, Khaslana returned to the capital planet. He had pretty much guessed his identity, and he immediately felt even more unwilling to accept his status in life.

He was the emperor's biological child, so why did his mother have to endure strenuous labor in the slums and pass away? And he had grown up in the orphanage, but the other princes and princesses could life such easy lives... If his mother had simply been treated in a good environment, nothing would have happened to her.

Khaslana's heart burst with an impulse to get revenge against society. He had never been someone moral and upright, so turning evil could happen in minutes... In fact, he had always been evil. He had never been good.

Khaslana knew that while his classmates in the institute flattered him, he was nothing to the imperial family. Thus, he needed to seize first place in the virtual mecha competition in order to increase his bargaining chips.

But ever since he came back, he had never even seen Phainon's shadow. He guessed that Phainon was hiding from him, but Khaslana didn't get annoyed. As long as he possessed power in the future, how would it be difficult to keep a beta at his side?

Even if Phainon wanted to hide, the people at his side would present bring him to Khaslana by hook or by crook.

Besides, after Khaslana's strength increased, he was several levels above other people. He didn't face any difficulty in the previous matches. Now that he was facing Prince Latiao, someone who was always placed on par with him online, he still didn't feel any sense of crisis.

Unless this Prince Latiao was Phainon, who had put him in a bad spot time and time again. But how could that be?

"Let's do it. Use your defeated, pained despair to ingratiate yourself to me." Khaslana smiled slightly, maneuvering his mecha to walk into the battlefield.

At the same time, Phainon mirrored him and walked in.

Both of them wanted to get the match over and steamroller their opponent as quickly as possible. Phainon felt that if he was too late, something bad would happen, but Khaslana didn't feel like wasting his time in a fight. Thinking along the same lines, as soon as they entered the battlefield, they quickly engaged in battle.

The crowd couldn't keep up. They couldn't believe that they were looking at a fight between two old-fashioned mechas. They felt that it would have been worth the money even if they had paid ten times the price for their tickets.

The people watching the livestream were ashamed of themselves. Practically everyone had piloted an old-fashioned mecha before, but there had never been anyone who could bring them out to this level. It was obvious how skilled these two pilots were...

Although strong spiritual energy was said to allow anyone to maneuver a mecha however they wished, being able to maneuver however they wished wasn't enough to win. At first, Phainon was nothing impressive. He had only increased his strength after practicing hard for the last few weeks.

What the crowd didn't know was that in actuality both of them were hiding something. Khaslana was waiting for his opponent to show his full strength before he used his spiritual energy to thrash them. On the other hand,

Phainon was afraid Khaslana would discover his true identity, so he didn't dare to use his spiritual energy.

The two of them exchanged fierce blows. Each move was targeted right at their opponent's vitals, but both of them were incredibly quick. The number of times they took a blow could be counted on their fingers.

After all, these were extremely fragile old-fashioned mechas, and the virtual net was faithful to its original construction. If they were hit by a few strong blows, they would fall apart. The victor would be clear as day.

Everyone looked on, holding their breaths, afraid of missing a single detail. A brilliant fight like this might only come once in years.

Phainon originally planned to finish the fight quickly, but he didn't expect that Khaslana would have such strength after leveling up. Just as he was debating if he should use his ability, a familiar heat welled up in his body.

"???!" Phainon was ready to vomit blood. His movements slowed, and he barely managed to stop Khaslana from seizing the chance to defeat him. Luckily, by relying onto his strong spiritual energy, he was able to avoid the blow.

Fuck, he had obviously just used his inhibitors! Why was his heat still... Although he had heard that after inhibitors would lose their efficacy in the long term, it couldn't be so quickly, right! He didn't take that many before either.

As expected, this was the world consciousness preventing him from triumphing over the son of destiny Khaslana. If he kept delaying like this, Phainon felt that there was a very real possibility he would explode lying in the nutrient cabin.

"There's nothing I can do. I can only take this chance..." While his rationale hadn't completely disappeared, he used his spiritual energy in a surprise attack. He couldn't care too much about it now.

In that moment, Khaslana felt a familiar sense of danger. He immediately gritted his teeth, but at that moment, he had no way to dodge the attack. If he avoided it, it would only result in a loss. How could he resign himself to it? He could only block Phainon's attack stiffly.

Thus, in the next moment, Phainon's spiritual energy connected with the spiritual energy stuck to Khaslana's mecha.

It was easy for spiritual energy to taint someone else's emotions. In that moment, Khaslana felt like he was experiencing the same anxiety in his opponent's spiritual energy. It felt like his body was turning hot, but most importantly was that this spiritual energy was so familiar...

If it was the Khaslana of the past, he would probably be terrified by this spiritual energy and faint away, but after leveling up, his spiritual energy had increased significantly. As he struggled to barely resist the spiritual energy, he had some spare energy left to think.

"...So it was you..." In that moment, several things that Khaslana couldn't understand became clear, breaking through the clouds of mystery and into the sun of realization.

No wonder Mydei, who didn't have the slightest interest in Phainon, suddenly chased after him so furiously. No wonder Caelus also treated him differently than he treated others. In fact, the one who had been in the dark was Khaslana.

Khaslana's heart pounded. He got more and more excited. "Phainon, just how many pleasant surprises can you give to me? Let me see your true strength."

To outsiders, the two mechas were both locked in combat, refusing to budge, but those who were familiar with mechas knew that the two pilots were immersed in a fight of spiritual energies.

In normal circumstances, Phainon could drive out Khaslana's spiritual energy, but at that moment he was struggling to focus his attention. His strength was probably equal to just two thirds of his normal strength.

Yet Khaslana's spiritual energy was like a sharp sword, twisting furiously into Phainon's spiritual energy. Both of their emotions were being transmitted almost completely. It was hard for either of them to recognize which ones were their real feelings.

"Dammit..." Phainon gritted his teeth, his body getting hotter and hotter. Although he knew his opponent's situation should be about the same, in the end they still couldn't go on like this. "If things stay like this, I'll definitely lose."

From the other side, Khaslana's spiritual energy probed another level deeper, wanting to come into contact with the core of Phainon's spiritual energy. Normally, only people with the most intimate relationships could do something like this. It was even possible to learn about a portion of the other person's memories. Of course, if one party's spiritual energy was enough to overpower the other person's, they could also do it forcefully.

"No." Phainon jolted awake. Seizing the opportunity, he pulled his consciousness back from Khaslana. Before Khaslana could react, he used his mecha's skewer to impale his opponent's cockpit.

And thus their deadlock ended.

Phainon panted, completely exhausted. He was about to collapse in the mecha's cockpit. "...I...I won..."

He had actually won against Khaslana, someone blessed by the world consciousness. This was something simply impossible... Even if he really exploded in the nutrient cabin, it was fine.

Phainon was about to faint, but because of his heat his mind was overstimulated and his spiritual energy was thusly in an abnormal state. After he left the competition, he was forcibly logged out of the virtual world. It was a function to protect some people from being too stimulated in the virtual world and causing an accident to happen.

In the virtual world, cheers rose up in the arena. Everyone was cheering for Prince Latiao in excitement.

Prince Latiao had managed to use the old-fashioned mecha, the one that Khaslana was most skilled with, to defeat him. It was simply more proof for how powerful his strength was. In the future, Time's fans couldn't mock Prince Latiao anymore.

Only Mydei thought there was something off about the situation. When he thought about how Phainon's situation had been recently, he quickly logged off, leaving his nutrient cabin and rushing to Phainon's room.

As soon as he entered the room, Mydei smelled an incredibly thick omega scent. It was the smell of an omega who had thoroughly gone into heat.

"As I thought.. It's your heat?" Mydei's heartstrings tightened.

If he was a normal alpha, he would have lost control and charged forward a long time ago, but Mydei was extremely calm. He made his way to the nutrient cabin step by step, slowly observing the situation.

Phainon was laying in the nutrient cabin, his pale cheeks thoroughly flushed red and his eyes full of tears. He couldn't keep his breathing steady. It looked like he was in horrible suffering.

Mydei leaned over, reaching out to touch Phainon's body gently. Immediately, Phainon let out a low sob. The place he had been touched turned red rapidly... Because he had always suppressed his heat, his body was now incredibly sensitive.

Mydei's cheeks flushed. He leaned in close to Phainon's ear, his voice low. "...Right now, what do you wish for me to do?"

"I-I'm thirsty..." Phainon mumbled. "Water..."

Mydei grabbed a cup of water from the side, taking a sip and holding it in his mouth. He pressed against Phainon's lips, sending the water slowly into his mouth.

Mydei finished feeding him the water, but Phainon wrapped his arms tightly around the back of Mydei's neck as though he was afraid he would leave, sucking the liquid from his mouth as though it would dispel the heat in his body.

Mydei lifted his head after a long time. He picked Phainon, who had lost much of his sense of reason, up from the nutrient cabin walking towards the bathroom. He had to give Phainon a bath.

Phainon was completely immersed in the agony of his heat. He kept squirming in Mydei's hold, saying quietly, "...Help... Help me..."

In these circumstances, Phainon couldn't really tell exactly what was happening to him. He felt as though he was in a dangerous situation, but wasn't sure. He just had the faint feeling that he could believe in Mydei, and so he unconsciously relied on him.

Mydei's deep yellow eyes darkened completely. He pulled Phainon into his arms, his voice low. "*Then would you mind if I caused you offense now?*"

Chapter End Notes

> The Author Has Something To Say:
> Yay! New Chapter! Sorry for the delay, I've been feeling pretty tired lately. But I hope the wait was worth it. Mydei Finally got that cookie! It's going to be fade to black unfortunately because I've never written smut before but I have read a lot of smut so I might write a bonus chapter once the story ends that fully expands this scene, hehe.
>
> Also we got obsessed Khaslana this chapter! Even going so far as to recreate the wound and wanting to lock him up, Khas I know what you are~

Chapter 15: Mark

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

In his confusion, Phainon couldn't distinguish what exactly Mydei had said. He nodded blankly.

Mydei lowered his head, peeling off Phainon's sweat-soaked clothes like he was unwrapping a meticulously packaged gift.

It was only at these kinds of times that Phainon would only see him.

Mydei picked up Phainon and placed him into a bathtub filled with hot water. He lowered his head to kiss him on the lips. When they were red and swollen, he finally pulled back, kissing down the line of Phainon's neck. His deep green eyes were filled with a manic longing, like the most pious believer prostrating himself before his god.

His heat had made Phainon’s usual caution evaporate and all he could think was that he could trust Mydei to not hurt him. His hands subconsciously gripping his shoulders to hold him close.

Phainon had been completely exhausted. He was too weak to do anything but lean against Mydei obediently. Because of his discomfort from his heat, he kept nuzzling against Mydei's body, as though this way he could fill the void inside him.

"Please forgive my offense."

In his daze, Phainon seemed to hear Mydei say something. Immediately, a wave of pain seared through his body, and he couldn't stop himself from beginning to struggle.

The strength of an omega in heat was completely dismissible. Mydei pressed Phainon down easily, leaning down to kiss his pale nape gently. A

hint of his desire finally shone into his eyes.

"I'll always be yours," he murmured.

...Could you always keep your eyes on me as well?

Finally, he bit down.

When Phainon finally woke up, two days had already passed.

Phainon wasn't aware of what had happened yet. He lay on the bed, feeling like his body had fallen apart. There wasn't a single part of him that wasn't aching. He didn't have an ounce of energy.

But when Phainon felt the strangeness in the part below the neck that couldn't be described, a fragment of his memory welled up in his mind alongside a furious blush.

Phainon: "???" W-wait, what?! He did those kinds of things with Mydeimos just like that?!

How did things reach this stage, huh?!

Phainon felt like his worldview was about to shatter. Even worse, he remembered it!

The door opened. Mydei walked in, holding a plate of food. He looked like he hadn't slept all night. He had dark circles under his eyes and his blonde hair had lost its usual luster.

Phainon had no idea how he would face Mydei in the future. Even after looking at him for a long time, he still couldn't say anything.

Mydei placed the food at the side, but he immediately kneeled down, pulling out a sharp dagger and handing it to Phainon.

Phainon took the dagger, dumbfounded. "Mydei, this is..."

"It was all my fault. I've gone so far as to do such a thing to you." Mydei's voice was low. "If you're unhappy, please vent your anger on me however you like. Even if you want to kill me, I won't say a single word of blame."

"How could I kill you because of something like this..." Phainon said. Besides, he wasn't the kind of person who would go around stabbing people just because he was upset!

He could only remember a few indistinct images. He couldn't remember the details at all and… for some reason he couldn’t bring himself to hate what happened.

"But I've committed an irredeemable offense." Mydei gritted his teeth. He grabbed the dagger, moving to stab it into his heart.

"Wait!" Phainon pulled his hand back hastily, heart pounding. "T-This isn't your fault. After all, in those kinds of circumstances, as long as it's a normal alpha there's no way to hold back."

Except for Khaslana, the guy who had the author's cheat... In fact, when he thought about it, this was all Khaslana's fault, wasn't it! If it wasn't for the sake of debating him, how would Phainon go into heat? Though the system was a big problem too.

Mydei said, "But if I can't gain your forgiveness, I don't know how I could be bold enough to live on."

"It's fine, it's fine, I forgive you," Phainon said quickly. He was afraid that Mydei would try to commit suicide if they disagreed in the slightest.

In any case, Phainon wouldn't die because of this. If he really thought about it, this wasn't actually his first time. Besides, being marked would save him a lot of trouble.

He would just pretend like nothing had happened at all, just like he is pretending to not feel the slight heat on his face as his fingers trail the mark on his neck.

Phainon felt he was someone who came around easily...

After the virtual mecha competition, a video of Prince Latiao and Time using old-fashioned mechas spread widely. Quickly, it sets off a resurgence of popularity for the old mechas.

Many people began to praise old mechas. There were even people who thought that people with real skill should use old-fashioned mechas to prove themselves.

And Prince Latiao became the idol in even more teenagers' hearts.

Caelus, who had invested almost all of his time in training, made some time on the day of the finals. After he finished watching the match, he sank into silence.

He had already worked so hard, but he felt like Phainon was getting farther and farther away from him. No, he had to work even harder... He had to catch up to Phainon's pace.

Caelus dived into his training with renewed fervor, and improved noticeably. The people around him were stunned.

When Anaxa found out that his own little brother was training so hard just because of a beta, he was stunned. But recently he had been looking into that beta. Although there were plenty of strange things about Phainon, when he thought of the brilliant Prince Latiao, and then thought about this beta-

It seemed that beta should indeed have no connection to Prince Latiao. In comparison, it was more important that Khaslana had gone missing from that planet for several days. He should report this to His Highness Nanook...

Now that he thought about it, could his little brother really win against Mydei? When Anaxa thought about it, he couldn't help feeling a bit worried.

In the original novel, when Khaslana took first place, his renown spread far and wide. It was for this reason that one of his mother's past admirers took notice of him.

Because Khaslana's face was seventy to eighty percent similar to his mother's, the admirer recognized him instantly. Later, the admirer contacted Khaslana in secretly, hiding his identity and offering him a lot of aid. He even organized several opportunities for Khaslana and the emperor get to know each other as father and son.

But because the emperor was afraid Khaslana would be assassinated by a member of the clan backing the crown prince, he had never publicized Khaslana's identity. He only struck at Nanook's power from the shadows. What he didn't know was that Nanook had seen his each and every move, and Khaslana's identity was laid bare before Nanook's eyes.

Now, though Khaslana didn't take first place, his fame rose to a status similar to his fame in the original novel because of his and Phainon's battle with the old-fashioned mechas.

In a certain airship, General Wiley, a man with influence, the empire's hero who had battled against and vanquished the Zerg a dozen years ago, was watching a video on the virtual screen in front of him. When he saw the face on the screen, the cup he was holding slipped from his grip and dropped to the ground.

"Amelia?"

His voice was completely shocked.

It was common knowledge that General Wiley had started as an ordinary commoner born into poverty. He had managed to reach where he was today thanks to His Majesty the Emperor's recognition.

But nobody knew that his beloved childhood sweetheart Amelia was the emperor's mistress. It was also because of his guilt towards Amelia that the emperor had promoted Wiley. How else could he have risen up over the officers from noble families with just hard work?

Amelia had already been dead for over a dozen years. Wiley didn't expect that he would see someone who looked so similar to Amelia.

Wiley sent people to investigate almost immediately. When he saw the detailed report about Khaslana, he was practically trembling.

"There's no mistaking it... This is Amelia's child..."

As soon as he thought of how Amelia had died wretchedly in the slums because of the Kremnoan family's persecution, and as soon as he thought of how that damned Kremnoan family was maintaining their power with the help of their relationship with the crown prince, Wiley's emotions settled. He had to get revenge for Amelia.

But before he did that, he should properly foster the single child that Amelia left behind.

After the virtual mecha competition ended, though Khaslana wasn't first place, he was extremely popular in the institute. After all, the only person in the institute who had qualified for the finals was Khaslana.

Everyone consoled Khaslana, saying that Prince Latiao was so skilled that he had to be someone with decades of experience and who had practiced countless times before he had become so powerful. Khaslana was young, and he still had room to grow.

When people were consoling him, Khaslana put on a show of feeling motivated. In fact, he was very clear that Prince Latiao's real identity was the same person these people had mocked again and again... He didn't know what they would think if they discovered that Phainon was actually so strong.

Khaslana didn't expect that he would lose to the same person time and time again.

If he had lost to someone else, Khaslana wouldn't settle. He would want revenge. But after losing to Phainon, his heart filled with another kind of emotion.

Although he didn't take first place at the virtual mecha competition like everyone had expected, he was famous. There were also more strong people getting in contact with him. It looked like he had to get ready to choose his future path.

Before he knew his identity, Khaslana would have chosen the powerful family behind the crown prince, the Kremnoan’s without hesitation. Besides, his good friend Mydei was also on their side. But now that he knew his identity, and with the fact that his ties with Mydei had been split ages ago, Khaslana changed his plans.

"The person standing subtly against the Kremnoan’s is General Wiley. Besides, he was also born as a commoner, so he won't look solely at birth when judging someone. I'll be able to stand out as someone with more strength." Khaslana muttered to himself, "But they've never had someone contact me. Or should I recommend myself to him after I've graduated?"

Khaslana wasn't the kind of person who needed someone else to invite him. As long as he could earn the greatest profit, he didn't care even if he had to abandon his reputation.

Just as he was thinking, a letter sent itself over. Khaslana opened it carelessly. When he saw the contents, he smiled slightly.

"It's come."

Although Khaslana didn't win, the plot still developed in the same way under the prompting of the world consciousness.

But there were a few plot points that diverged significantly from the original plotline. For example, after watching the video, General Wiley was

extremely unhappy with Prince Latiao who won over Khaslana. He thought Prince Latiao was no stronger than Khaslana.

Moreover, General Wiley could easily see how unpracticed several of Prince Latiao's moves were. He had to be a dumb child who hadn't grown up yet. He had probably made use of his spiritual energy to defeat Khaslana.

General Wiley couldn't find Prince Latiao's true identity, but he wasn't afraid of offending anyone in the entire empire. His Majesty the Emperor was the one backing him.

Soon afterwards, while he was being interviewed, a journalist recalled Prince Latiao, who was famous recently, and asked about General Wiley's thoughts about the recent virtual mecha competition.

General Wiley sneered. He openly and frankly expressed that he strongly disapproved of some young people who did anything for money regardless of their morals. Strength wasn't everything; moral character was also extremely important... Moreover, these people weren't necessarily that strong.

If it wasn't for the fact that Prince Latiao had fought in the final match with Khaslana using an old mecha, General Wiley would even have wanted to take the chance to praise Khaslana and put Prince Latiao down in the same breath. He only avoided mentioning Khaslana in order to stay a bit more lowkey.

General Wiley's popularity wasn't something someone from the virtual world could compete with. After all, when the Zerg invaded the borders of the empire, they were able to fight them back because of General Wiley's strength and his subordinates who risked their lives. He was the hero of countless young people. He had left a strong impression on the people of the empire.

Although General Wiley didn't mention any names, anyone could tell who he was talking about. Now that he had been ridiculed by General Wiley himself, Prince Latiao had absolutely no future.

In these circumstances, Prince Latiao's fans quickly reduced a significant amount. Several media channels also avoided the topic. Even officials of the virtual mecha competition were kept low-key, acting as though the competition didn't happen at all.

There were even a lot of people who didn't know what was going on but went the flow and started cursing Prince Latiao. Anyway, even General Wiley had cursed him. It was impossible for them to be in the wrong.

Many of Prince Latiao's fans couldn't stop themselves from refuting those people, but they were beaten back as brainless fanboys and fangirls. There were even many people who said that the fact someone like this still had so many fans was a sign of how low society had fallen and how the empire's future was bleak.

Under these circumstances, many people left the fandom, but the remaining people held steadfast to their belief that Prince Latiao wouldn't disappoint them.

It was lucky that Prince Latiao didn't publicize his real identity, or he would have been cursed horribly.

This was what Phainon, who had rested several days to recover his emotional wounds, was faced with as soon as he logged on.

When he remembered that in the original novel General Wiley was Khaslana's biggest supporter, he pretty much understood what was going on... General Wiley must have secretly started this trouble because he was unhappy that Khaslana lost.

In the original novel, General Wiley was exactly the kind of person who would defend someone even knowing they were in the wrong. He had basically seen Khaslana as his own son. Regardless of whether or not it was Khaslana's fault, as long as it was someone who made Khaslana suffer, they were General Wiley's enemy.

Moreover, other than his strength, General Wiley also had significant influence. Without his help, Khaslana couldn't have risen up the ranks so

easily.

Right now, the most important thing was that Phainon couldn't say anything yet. He couldn't jump out and run to General Wiley to thrown down the gauntlet. He would definitely get mocked.

When Mydei found out, he wanted to use his family's influence to help Phainon, but Phainon stopped him. After all, General Wiley had a special place in many people's hearts. If he came out to cross blades with him so carelessly, defeat would be the only possible ending.

And based on what Phainon knew of General Wiley, his attacks wouldn't cease so easily. If he pulled out his trump card now, he would have a hard time dealing with General Wiley in the future.

Mydei could only have his family log into the virtual world to spread positive propaganda about Prince Latiao. Of course, it didn't make a significant impact. It made Mydei so angry that he had people gather information about the people who were slandering Phainon online.

Just as Phainon thought, General Wiley wasn't satisfied yet. After putting down Prince Latiao's morals, he also wanted to put down Prince Latiao's strength until it was worth nothing.

So General Wiley suddenly said that he wasn't someone who was against the youth of today. He just wanted to temper the other person. After all, if a youth couldn't resist the pressure, how would he succeed in the future?

Immediately, General Wiley said that after seeing the videos of Prince Latiao, he felt that he had some strength, but the strength didn't mean much. If Prince Latiao could win against one of his subordinates, he would retract his previous statements. If he couldn't even do this, then-well, forget about it.

The subordinate that General Wiley dispatched was named Augustine. Although he wasn't famous, and he wasn't well-known among the public, he

was truly strong.

But Augustine had a terrible temper. Once, he had even lost control and killed a teammate. If it wasn't for General Wiley's protection, he would have been sentenced to death a long time ago. For that reason, he was stuck in limbo and couldn't be promoted or demoted, but his loyalty to General Wiley was unquestionable.

Under General Wiley's guidance, many media channels came out to report on it. If Prince Latiao didn't accept the challenge, he would certainly be suppressed until he couldn't stand back up. If he accepted and lost, he would naturally meet the same end result.

There would be no good end unless he won against Augustine, but anyone with a discerning eye knew that this was impossible. Even though Prince Latiao was unopposed in the virtual world, he was still a long way from someone who had tempered themselves on the battlefield for decades.

When Phainon found out, the first thing he did was accept the challenge. The news quickly spread through the virtual world.

People who hadn't been paying attention to the virtual world began to pay attention when they found out that this was something General Wiley had prompted. Soon, there even the strong began to envy that Prince Latiao could have so much attention.

Naturally, General Wiley knew that if Prince Latiao won, he would become even more dazzling. But how could he win? He was just a green newbie. How could he win against his formidable subordinate?

The officials of the virtual mecha competition offered up a free space for the battle. They even provided several kinds of livestream services. The number of people online reached over a billion. The servers were practically about to explode.

Augustine, General Wiley's strongest subordinate, was also piloting an old mecha.

Augustine was obviously using it to show his disdain for Phainon. Phainon was just using an old-fashioned mecha, but he could still be praised to the heavens? Even if there were a dozen virtual mecha competition champions surrounding Augustine at once, they were no match for him.

The MC introduced Augustine's recent military achievements. Each time he finished listing one, the crowd would cheer.

If Augustine's temper and luck were a bit better, he might have achieved success that could compare with General Wiley's.

In comparison, Prince Latiao's brilliance was dim. Other than his single achievement of winning the virtual mecha competition, there was pretty much nothing else to say.

And under General Wiley's suggestion, the media had already shaped Prince Latiao into a figure who was arrogant solely because of his one merit, his strength. All of the onlookers looked at Prince Latiao with stares full of disdain.

Only the fans who were taking up a minority of the stands and being glared at by the rest of the crowd as brainless fans shouted Prince Latiao's nickname continuously, trying to rouse his spirits.

Soon, the match that had drawn the practically entire empire's attention began.

Phainon took a deep breath. This had nothing to do with the original plotline, so the world consciousness wouldn't affect it. He could move forward completely relying on his strength.

Their mechas locked in combat. Each one of Augustine's moves were sinister attacks that were certain to make Phainon's mecha break down in one hit. On the other hand, Phainon dodged continuously, looking as though he was evading with difficulty.

To an outsider, it was as though Augustine didn't want the fight to end quickly, and he was humiliating Prince Latiao unceasingly. Prince Latiao didn't have any power. It was clear that he wasn't strong enough to match his opponent.

As the MC watched, he felt his hair stand on end for Prince Latiao. "It looks like the victor of the match is already clear."

Internally, he couldn't help but sigh. Ever since the beginning, he had been paying attention to Prince Latiao. He was obviously strong and his future path was boundless. Who expected that he would have offended General Wiley? Now, it looked like he was going to be ground into the mud.

It was lucky his identity hadn't been exposed. In the future, he should be able to hold his head up in public if he changed his name and was a bit more low-key. Of course, he wouldn't be able to match up to his current status.

Prince Latiao's fans looked on in worry.

In their hearts, they also knew that Prince Latiao wasn't strong enough to compete with someone who had risked their life enduring the battlefield for decades. They pretty much thought of this match as Prince Latiao's final match, but they still had a faint sense of expectation in their hearts.

They expected that, just like they had countless times before, they would see Prince Latiao win against his opponent.

In fact, Phainon could use his spiritual energy to win easily, but this way he would expose how strong his spiritual energy was. Moreover, he really didn't have the battle experience to compare with his opponent. Why not take the chance to learn a bit?

What an outsider saw as perilous escapes was easy to Phainon. His spiritual energy could even analyze the principles behind Augustine's moves and see what their goal was.

Although Augustine looked down on Phainon, he couldn't help feeling surprised that this Prince Latiao could somehow keep avoiding him time after time.

Soon, Augustine aimed an attack at him, but Prince Latiao faced it directly, not dodging it at all.

The crowd felt like the time had finally come. It looked like Prince Latiao had also become aware of the disparity between his and his opponent's strength. He should have finally decided to admit defeat.

But things didn't turn out as they expected. Instead, Prince Latiao used a cunning move to grab Augustine's weapon. While Augustine was stunned, Prince Latiao rapidly counterattacked with one of the moves Augustine had used previously.

If Augustine didn't react quickly, Phainon would have hit him right on the mark.

When Prince Latiao's fans saw the scene, their eyes lit up. In his first match, when nobody had known who he was, Prince Latiao had copied his opponent's move. Could it be that he was preparing to use the same tactic this time?

"Hmph." Augustine sneered, his face full of mocking. "If you want to copy me, you're still decades behind in skills."

His moves were all tempered in numerous occasions when his life hung in the balance. A greenhorn like this simply had no way to copy him. Even if he managed the form, how would he understand the principle? Unless he was someone with strong spiritual energy who could pass judgement depending on the situation... But if there really was someone with such strong spiritual energy, then how could General Wiley bring him so far down?

Those with experience shook their heads at the sight. At such a time, Prince Latiao didn't use a move he was familiar with, but instead copied his

opponents? How could he defeat Augustine, who knew the move as well as the back of his hand? As they thought, Prince Latiao was still too young.

The MC also sighed silently. Out loud, he said, "It looks like Prince Latiao wants to copy Augustine's attacks to make it through the danger, but can he really do things so smoothly... Wait, his movements aren't quite the same as what Augustine just did..."

Augustine was full of disdain. He sneered. "As I thought, he can't even copy it. I think the competition should be coming to an end..."

But in the next second, Prince Latiao's attack was different from what he expected. It scraped across the front of his mecha.

Augustine was stunned. "How could it be? He managed to touched me? This move isn't performed like this... No, he modified it?"

Prince Latiao's attacks came one after another. Each move had a subtle difference from the attacks that Augustine had shown earlier, but it was clear that they were sharper than the old moves. Even someone who didn't know much about mechas could tell the difference.

And Augustine, who was intimately familiar with these moves, sank into a predicament precisely because of his familiarity. Prince Latiao had made changes to several of the most important points. It was impossible to defend.

All of the onlookers were shocked. "What!?"

"Could it be that Prince Latiao has made improvements to these moves?" The MC was stunned. Unconsciously, he blurted out what he was thinking in his head.

"How could it be? Improving a move, and it's improving someone as strong as Augustine's... He saw every one of the weaknesses in his opponent's moves. Only a mecha piloting expert can manage this."

"Could it be that he really is strong? That's impossible, right?"

"How could someone as strong as this be unknown in reality? He must be someone as famous as General Wiley."

"Impossible... It has to be a coincidence."

Everyone immediately sank into confusion, but Prince Latiao's fans were cheering. It looked like this opponent wasn't as strong as they had thought. As expected, they had thought too much. How could someone as strong as Prince Latiao lose?

"Shit." Augustine gritted his teeth hard, his expression taking on an edge of savagery. "How could I lose do a brat like this."

But his opponent's each and every move was impossible to predict. Even Augustine was having a hard time fending him off. On top of that, because he was confident he could overpower his opponent with his strength, he hadn't chosen a mecha that he was used to. It was even more difficult for him to get into his best condition.

"I'll have to use my spiritual energy." Just like Phainon's previous opponents, Augustine wanted to use a spiritual attack.

But before Augustine could draw out his spiritual energy, Prince Latiao seized his opportunity, His weapon slashed at the weak point of Augustine's mecha.

Old-fashioned mechas like this were fragile. In moments, it fell apart, and the cockpit dropped to the ground.

Victory had, without question, been decided.

The crowd was absolutely flabbergasted. In the time that Prince Latiao went from his disadvantageous position to taking the upper hand to finally being victorious, only a few minutes had elapsed.

He was even able to win against Augustine. It was clear exactly how strong he was... And the moves that he had improved weren't coincidences. It was

all because he was much stronger than Augustine that he could reach such a level.

Who exactly was this Prince Latiao?

But Prince Latiao's mecha didn't retreat after his victory. the cockpit opened, and someone jumped down, landing gracefully on the ground.

Even at a time like this, his face was mosaiced. Nobody could tell who he was.

Everyone was stunned. They looked down. At that moment, almost half of the empire was watching.

Phainon only felt a heat in his chest. He was filled with a strength like he had never felt before. Even with all of these people staring at him, he didn't feel timid at all.

After his fight with Augustine, he was suddenly filled with a fierce desire to become strong. He didn't want to rely on his spiritual energy to defeat his opponents, but to learn to use his own strength to learn how to attack. But most people didn't have the strength to satisfy him anymore. Now, he just so happened to have someone he could pick...

"General Wiley, since you won't recognize my strength, then I'll extend a challenge to you right here."

Though Phainon's voice wasn't loud, it resounded throughout the arena. It was so quiet you could have heard a pin drop.

"General Wiley, do you accept my challenge?"

Chapter End Notes

The Author has Something To Say:
Yay! A new chapter! Phainon baby just admit your in love! DW Mydei baby he's just in denial, you'll conquer him soon ;) Also the fight was very fun to write, one of my favourites. Phainon! Your finally acting

cool! That challenge scene was lit! I think I'm a fan now too! *Insert lightsticks being waved*

Also I haven't played HI3 so I'm not sure if Khaslana has any parents in that game that I could have used but since I gave Phainon's parents to Phainon. Khaslana gets...Amelia and the nameless emperor XD.

Happy Reading! See You Next Week!

Chapter 16: Cousins Fighting Over A Man (Pt.1)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

It took everyone a long time to react. Immediately, they sucked in a breath of cold air, almost suspecting that they had developed hearing problems.

General Wiley was one of, if not the most, renowned and powerful people in the modern empire, yet Prince Latiao, a newbie who appeared on the internet, wanted to try and challenge him? Even if he had successfully won against Augustine, he was being too arrogant by making this kind of declaration, wasn't he?

General Wiley, who was watching the screen from the lounge, nearly crushed his teacup in his hand. He had never received such humiliation since he had become famous.

A mere greenhorn of a brat wanted to challenge him? Where did his courage come from? They were already at this point, so he couldn't be at fault for being too ruthless. General Wiley snorted.

In the next moment, General Wiley's stern face appeared on the screen in the competition arena. His expression was filled with disdain. He spoke as though he was giving alms. "I accept your challenge."

The crowd rose up in an uproar. The people in the outside world were also given a huge shock.

Even if Prince Latiao had never lost ever since he appeared and even if he had successfully defeated Augustine this time, the distance between him and General Wiley wasn't something that could be closed in an instant.

As soon as he got General Wiley's response, Prince Latiao set a time to battle next week and immediately logged off.

Afterwards, all kinds of social media featuring these news exploded. It trended significantly more than when Prince Latiao and Time were about to battle.

Countless people were shocked by Prince Latiao's arrogance, and also by his courage. Many people knew that if they were in that position, they would never be able to say the same words.

At first, the people who had been mocking Prince Latiao were ashamed after the match finished. Now that they saw he was challenging General Wiley, many of them scolded him online, saying that Prince Latiao didn't understand how to respect his elders and he was just too arrogant.

After all, General Wiley was so strong that he was right no matter what he did. Even when he had said that Prince Latiao was no good he was simply giving guidance to a newbie. But Prince Latiao going so far as to challenge General Wiley was just showing that he couldn't tell good from bad. There were even people who said Prince Latiao wanted to use General Wiley for hype.

But there were also some people who were inspired by Prince Latiao's spirit and became his fans. There were also some die-hard fans online who said, "Who doesn't know Prince Latiao will win?" He had won so many battles that everyone thought he would lose. It wasn't necessarily hopeless this time.

Of course, people like that were being mocked and called brainless fanboys and fangirls, but after the previous fight, even though everyone knew clearly that it was impossible, they couldn't help from considering the possibility. If Prince Latiao really won, what would happen?

Meanwhile, General Wiley's subordinates didn't understand why he had accepted Prince Latiao's challenge.

"Sir, why did you accept?"

"Regardless of whether you win or not, that brat will be famous."

"Besides, isn't it fine for us to deal with trash like that?"

General Wiley frowned. "Even Augustine lost. Are you all sure you yourselves can win?"

Immediately, they went quiet. Although they were confident in their strength, Augustine was in no way an easy opponent. It was clear that Prince Latiao wasn't so simple.

When Augustine remembered how he had lost to that Prince Latiao guy, he spat, "If it wasn't for that brat being so underhanded and making it so that I didn't get the chance to use my spiritual energy, how would I have lost so easily?" As he spoke, he hammered a fist into the wall, sinking a depression in the sturdy wall.

Augustine remembered something. He quickly said, "Sir, as long as you use your spiritual energy to attack that Prince Latiao, his spirit energy will immediately collapse."

After a spiritual energy collapse, a person would typically become disabled.

"You're correct," General Wiley said calmly. "I was thinking of the same thing. I knew Prince Latiao had potential when I saw him. If I keep letting him develop on his own, it will most certainly bring us disaster. I might as well act now."

At his words, they all saw the light. One after the other, they began to praise General Wiley's resourcefulness.

In the meantime, Phainon practiced mecha maneuvers on the virtual net every day. He pretty much understood the movements and principles behind mechas now. What he was missing was practice with spiritual energy.

Although his spiritual energy was strong, it didn't have enough offensive power. As soon as Phainon remembered how Khaslana's spiritual energy had nearly peered into his heart, he shivered again.

But there were few books about spiritual attacks, and even fewer about how to fight with spiritual energy. Phainon just kept trying different ways of using his spiritual energy as practice, recalling what Khaslana had done that day and slowly fumbling his way through the principles.

Soon, the day of the match arrived.

This match had caused a bigger commotion than the previous ones. Many people, and even members of the imperial family, were paying attention. Even if the winner was already clear, they still wanted to see the legendary General Wiley's grace on the battlefield.

The government officials were especially shameless and adopted an auction format to sell tickets. In the end, the prices were sky-high.

Many of Prince Latiao's die-hard fans were young. Naturally, they couldn't get their hands on these tickets, but Mydei bought several tickets in one swoop and gave them away to his fans.

When Phainon entered the arena, he spotted the high-grade mecha that General Wiley was using on the other side of the battlefield. His heart rate spiked.

Although General Wiley had shielded his people to the point it was unreasonable, he was truly powerful. Even though he had strong spiritual energy, Phainon still wasn't confident.

Thus, Phainon wasn't using an old-fashioned mecha today. Instead, he had used the strongest modern mecha. These kinds of mechas could at least last a bit longer and wouldn't get one-hit KO'ed as soon as he entered the battlefield.

After the match started, General Wiley burst into the offensive, testing Prince Latiao's strength. But he was met with the same circumstances as Augustine, and discovered that Prince Latiao had been able to copy his moves at an astonishing pace.

Just as I expected, General Wiley thought. Prince Latiao is a genius. If he was left to grow on his own, in the future he would certainly have a boundless future... He might even be able to surpass me.

If he had brought a genius like this under his wing from the beginning, it would be fine. It was a pity that he hadn't thought anything of Prince Latiao at the start. Now, they had no relationship. He couldn't let Prince Latiao continue to grow.

"It's just a pity that plenty of geniuses have faced defeat at my hand. I'll make you into a complete cripple right here and now."

General Wiley sneered, directing his spiritual energy at Prince Latiao across the battlefield. His spiritual energy was SS-grade, and it had incredible offensive power. Even many of the people who had decades of battle experience couldn't match up to him, much less a young newbie like Prince Latiao.

Even though Phainon had incredibly strong spiritual energy, he just barely dodged General Wiley's attacks.

After all, there was a chasm between their fighting abilities.

Many of General Wiley's guesses were accurate, but he was mistaken about exactly how strong Prince Latiao's spiritual energy was.

"This is the most crucial moment." Phainon took a deep breath. Imitating what Khaslana had done, he concentrated his spiritual energy, forming it into a razor-sharp knife. Ruthlessly, he stabbed at the body of General Wiley's mecha.

In the split second their spiritual energies connected, General Wiley was stunned.

How strong was this? It was a terrifying spiritual energy just like an endless sea.

If he continued, he would die. General Wiley barely thought for another second. He retracted his spiritual energy with the help of his years of experience. Despite his quick reaction, a sharp pain stabbed through his head like an explosion.

In that moment, General Wiley even recalled the terror he felt when he encountered the Zerg Queen in the Zerg nest years ago.

He had never said it, but in fact he didn't kill the Zerg queen. Instead, under the crushing pressure of her spiritual energy, he had fled in panic.

Back then, General Wiley thought that it was over, but unexpectedly the Zerg withdrew, and everyone called him a hero. Naturally, General Wiley didn't explain the truth. But now Prince Latiao's spiritual energy was as strong as the Zerg Queen's. He had lost all of his fighting spirit and sank into terror. He didn't have the courage to move a single inch. The Zerg Queen was a slightly different from what the data had said, but he didn't have the extra energy to take notice either.

With these circumstances, Phainon's weapon easily stabbed through General Wiley's cockpit.

The arena went silent. Even the MC couldn't say a word. They all wondered if they were dreaming.

When the system announced the winner, everyone finally woke up from their daze. Prince Latiao's fans erupted in shocked cheers, almost afraid to believe their eyes. They began to cry, hugging each other in tears and in laughter. But this time there was nobody giving them any stares.

Nobody else could believe it. When Prince Latiao defeated Augustine, they could say that he had more talent, but he had won against General Wiley? Who was he? How old was he? He could do something like this?

"The winner of this match..." The MC's voice was trembling. "The winner is Prince Latiao. He managed to be victorious... He managed to win against General Wiley. Perhaps I had always underestimated his strength."

The MC suddenly felt that he seemed to be witnessing the meteoric rise of the genius of a new age.

The people in the stands were quiet for a moment, as though they were processing the results. One by one, they began to cheer, and the name that they were shouting loud enough to deafen the heavens was Prince Latiao. No matter how they had thought of Prince Latiao before the match, they had been completely persuaded by his strength and turned thoroughly into his fans.

In the empire, the strong were respected. Even though General Wiley had so many honors, his brilliance had dimmed significantly the moment he lost to Prince Latiao.

In some sense, Prince Latiao had stepped on General Wiley to succeed. Moreover, something like this was something only he alone could do. Many people had attempted it before, but they didn't have the same strength.

Nearly the moment after the match ended, the number of views on articles about Prince Latiao skyrocketed crazily, causing many sites to go down. All the news sites were changing their tunes, hurrying to make their apologies one by one and praising Prince Latiao madly.

Similarly, the people who had mocked Prince Latiao quickly deleted their old messages. Some people were slow to delete their messages and discovered that there were already several hundred thousand comments cursing them. They apologized speedily, saying that they had also become Prince Latiao's fan.

Nobody expected that a newbie who had begun to show their skills in the virtual mecha competition a few months ago would defeat General Wiley today.

Now, the people who thought Prince Latiao had remained undefeated through luck were stunned by the discovery that in fact it had nothing to do

with luck. It was all because Prince Latiao had enough strength to crush everyone.

And the people who lost to Prince Latiao in the beginning were no longer upset. Instead, they felt honored from the bottom of their hearts. They even pulled up videos of their fights with Prince Latiao to flaunt to the people around them.

Everyone was guessing Prince Latiao's identity. As long as he revealed himself, even if he was the ugliest coal miner who lived on the most remote planet, there would be plenty of people worshipping his face and throwing money at him.

Sadly, Prince Latiao was extremely low-key. Even if they racked their brains, they had no way to figure out exactly who he was.

It was fine if they couldn't figure out his identity. It was all the same online, anyway. The night the match ended, there were millions of people online showering their love on Prince Latiao. There were even all kinds of attractive, highly-ranked nobles who were willing to spend their entire family fortune to arrange a single meeting with Prince Latiao. It didn't matter even if the meeting was just ten minutes long.

Everyone had heard that Prince Latiao had once agreed to fight one-on-one with someone for a million empire coins. Immediately, many people sent letters saying that they were willing to give ten million empire coins or a hundred million empire coins; they just wanted Prince Latiao to fight one match with them.

The companies that had gotten Prince Latíao to advertise for them saw their sales jump up by several times and celebrated their foresight, while the companies that didn't think of Prince Latiao regretted everything.

Overnight, Prince Latiao became the entire empire's favorite celebrity. If he had any social media accounts, he might gain hundreds of millions of fans in the blink of an eye.

But Caelus, who knew Phainon's identity, gritted his teeth and cut down on his daily rest time. Even if he couldn't catch up, he had to try his hardest.

Because of his exhaustion, after the competition Phainon rested the entire night. When he logged into the virtual net the next day, he was given a huge shock by the volume of mail in his inbox. Because there were such a crazy amount of emails, Phainon was frozen and booted offline.

"...I just won't look at my mail this time." Phainon logged into the virtual net again with lingering fear.

But why was there so much mail? Was Phainon being cursed out by General Wiley's fans?

Then Phainon glanced casually at the forum and was stupefied.

Although he knew he was pretty strong to be able to defeat General Wiley, this should be too much of an exaggeration... He didn't expect that he would go from being cursed out to this kind of treatment.

Especially the people who were willing to spend a hundred million empire coins as long as they could get a thrashing from him. Phainon even had the urge to agree. In the beginning, he had agreed to fight with Caelus for a mere million empire coins. Why wouldn't he agree for this many coins now? Besides, it wasn't for a match. It was just to give a beating.

Then Phainon received a message from Mydei. He arrived at Mydei's virtual home... Although he obviously lived in a house, he still had to do something like this for a chat.

"You mustn't agree to their requests." Mydei spoke almost without waiting for Phainon to sit down. "If you need money, I'll provide you as much as you need. I just ask that you don't agree to fight."

"Why?" Phainon didn't really understand.

Although Mydei was ecstatic that Prince Latiao had achieved such accomplishments, hundreds of thousands love rivals had appeared. Mydei

couldn't help worrying that Phainon would get stolen away.

"At the moment, everyone has a strong desire to discover your true identity," Mydei said. "I myself have received several inquiries. Even my elders have come to ask me."

After all, Mydei was the president of Prince Latiao's fan club. If someone couldn't reach Prince Latiao directly, they would naturally wonder if Mydei knew what was going on.

Phainon: "!"

"Of course, I would never say anything about you," Mydei said quickly. "This will slowly calm down as well. These people will give up as soon as they realize it's impossible. But if you agree to someone, whoever can bring out a hundred million empire coins can't be ordinary. They'll certainly go in a frenzy to discover your identity."

Phainon: "!"

He was right. Although the system had been able to maintain secrecy so far, who knew when something would happen.

"Alright then." Phainon had no choice but to give up unwillingly.

After General Wiley was defeated, he was completely dumbfounded. He was almost unable to accept that he had somehow lost to a greenhorn brat. But he was very clear how strong Prince Latiao's spiritual energy was.

If he had stubbornly fought against it, he would have been left off with a spiritual energy collapse. He was doomed to lose, but it was still hard to take the jeers from his enemies the Kremnoan family.

General Wiley's subordinates were afraid to say a word for fear of making General Wiley angry.

"Who in the world is that person?" General Wiley gritted his teeth. "How can it be that he's so strong, but there's not a shred of information about him?"

At first, he thought things would pass, but soon something nobody had expected happened.

Several people began to speak up on behalf of Prince Latiao, snidely taunting certain people for trying to crush a newbie without being aware of their own power. They were practically pointing their fingers right at General Wiley.

Someone who had the mind to investigate a bit further would discover that these people were all backed by the Kremnoan family. It looked like Prince Latiao was relying on the Kremnoan family. Still, that made sense. The Kremnoan family was the strongest clan in the empire.

But when all was said and done, General Wiley still had some influence. There were only a few people who mocked him quietly. There was nobody who had the courage to say it boldly in the open.

Later, there were people who suddenly posted threads digging up information about how Augustine, Prince Latiao's previous opponent, had gone so far as to kill someone from his own troops in the past. His personality was also disgusting. He would even force omegas from other families to serve him and then throw them aside.

But all of these offenses had been hidden away by General Wiley. He even had his subordinates beat the people who reported the crime until they were bruised and bloody, and silenced the witnesses.

Normally, General Wiley would be able to use his influence to delete the discussion in an instant, but the other person had the Kremnoan family supporting them from behind. The topic grew increasingly intense. Moreover, Augustine had made a name for himself throughout the empire when he fought with Prince Latiao last time.

But this wasn't the end. Perhaps because they gained courage after the first thread, more and more threads that exposed General Wiley's subordinates' sins began to appear.

Quickly, everyone's image of General Wiley crumbled. They began to doubt the way they thought in the past.

After all, everyone was in a panic when the Zerg made their surprise attack. The empire needed a hero to stabilize the populace. Because General Wiley had real strength, and because he was close with the emperor, he was the natural choice to be promoted. But he was the kind of person who would shield another's shortcomings unconditionally. In these few years, he had completely covered up the messes his subordinates had caused. He had absolute confidence in his own strength and never thought there would be one day that someone caught hold of his weak point.

More and more people began to curse out General Wiley online. Soon, it was so bad his influence took a hit. He even received a message from the emperor.

If it wasn't for the fact that General Wiley's strength was universally acknowledged, he might be drowning in the people's disdain.

When Augustine found out about the news, he was furious. He smashed a fist into the wall. "Isn't the reason we worked long and hard to protect those useless peasants just to get some omegas? Besides, it's the honor of a lifetime for omegas as ugly as that to service me. Do they need to make such a big fuss?"

"That's not the problem right now." General Wiley's brows were deeply furrowed. "It's the Kremnoan family that wants to take the chance to take us down. It's not something we can deal with easily."

"In the end, it's all because of that damn Prince Latiao. If he wasn't so arrogance, how would he have pushed us to this point?" Augustine was furious.

But Augustine didn't have the guts to fight another round with Prince Latiao. Even General Wiley had lost; what else could he do?

His other subordinates began to swear up a storm at the Kremnoan family.

General Wiley sighed. He knew things couldn't be dealt with so easily. "You guys go out first."

When the people in the room were pretty much gone, there was still one other person who remained.

The person was someone who had just been added in: Khaslana.

"Is there something you want to say?" When General Wiley saw the youth, someone who looked incredibly similar to his first love, his heart softened. It was as though the person in front of him was his own child with Amelia.

"Sir, I have some thoughts about this situation." Khaslana had a harmless smile on his face. He said softly, "I think that we can turn Augustine in."

Since Khaslana joined them, he discovered that his treatment was significantly better than the other newbies. He was also promoted rapidly.

There were people who could barely see General Wiley after trying with all their might, but he would meet him by chance again and again. General Wiley also looked at him with incredible affection.

Khaslana was too suspicious to let this go without notice. He investigated himself, and because nobody had thought to hide it, he quickly discovered the relationship between General Wiley and his mother. He pretty much understood what had happened in the past.

Khaslana could make use of anything regardless of what it was. He pretended that he didn't know anything, and when he ran into General Wiley, he put on an act of an obedient younger junior. He even made several useful suggestions. Naturally, his position rose quickly.

Later, Khaslana pretended to happen upon the relationship between General Wiley and his mother by coincidence. He hurried to ask the general, even

asking if he was the general's child.

At first, General Wiley, who was well aware of Khaslana's identity, had no way to explain the truth, and he shook his head. Finally, he sighed, saying that he would treat Khaslana as his own child.

General Wiley didn't dare to tell Khaslana his true identity. He was afraid that if the Kremnoan family discovered it, then Khaslana's life would be in danger.

Khaslana similarly hid the fact that he knew about his identity long ago. Now, he took advantage of their relationship to speak about turning Augustine in without any restraints.

"What did you say?" General Wiley looked at Khaslana in shock before flying into a rage. "This isn't something you should be saying. Augustine is a brother who has been by my side for so many years. How could I turn him in just because you say so?!"

But Khaslana spoke with complete sincerity. "I'm truly saying this for you, sir, from the bottom of my heart."

In truth, Augustine had blocked Khaslana from moving forward. Besides, Augustine had humiliated Prince Latiao several times in the past. Khaslana didn't have a high opinion of him.

"Sir, look, out of all of your subordinates only Augustine is so arrogant. He doesn't have any merits other than his strength. Moreover, he's brought you so much trouble..." Khaslana looked like he was thinking whole-heartedly of General Wiley. "We can say that what happened this time is what he's caused. Now, the situation is so serious, but he still doesn't know his problem. If you keep someone like this, he'll definitely cause another problem."

If this was coming from someone else, General Wiley would have them dragged out and beaten to death, but this was coming from Khaslana. It was crystal clear who out of Khaslana or Augustine was closer to him.

How could a subordinate like Augustine compare to the child of the woman he had loved deeply for years?

"And you're just like my father. Would I lie to you?" Khaslana's words made General Wiley's entire body stiffen in shock.

"Yes... You're right." General Wiley immediately remembered all of the annoyances that Augustine had caused and all of the time and energy he had spent to help cover things up. But Augustine had never been regretful. His last shred of attachment disappeared into thin air.

When Khaslana saw General Wiley's expression, he let out a profound smile.

As such, General Wiley turned Augustine straight in. What everyone else had done could be forgiven, but Augustine's crimes had already incurred the public's wrath.

Immediately, General Wiley told his subordinates that he had absolutely no idea of what he had done. Although nobody believed him, the situation was settled as such, and General Wiley's renown declined. He never felt the same glory again.

Mydei was always afraid of Caelus. After all, the love rivals who had a few dozen billion coins were completely unaware of Phainon's identity. Even if they were bigger threats, they weren't strong enough to make a difference. But the only person besides himself who knew Phainon's identity was Caelus. Although Caelus spent all day either in training or in practice, he and Caelus weren't far at all. If Mydei wanted to meet, he could arrange it in minutes.

The semester just happened to be about to end. After considering it from all kinds of angles, Mydei invited Phainon to stay at his home. On the surface, he said he wanted Phainon to relax, but in fact he wanted to take Phainon to meet his parents...

Since he had already marked Phainon, Mydei felt that if they got a fake marriage to hide Phainon's identity, Phainon probably wouldn't reject him... Step by step, sooner or later, he would achieve his goal.

Phainon had nothing else to do, so he agreed. Besides, he had become extremely reliant on Mydei recently. If there was nobody to wake him up in the mornings, and nobody to make him breakfast... After experiencing such a happy life, who would want to return to their bitter days!

If Phainon were to stay in this world forever, Mydei would probably be proposed to by him in a few years.

In the palace, Nanook watched the battle video before him, slowly sipping wine from the cup he was holding. A smile crept up into his blue eyes.

"Truly worthy of being the person I've taken a fancy to..."

Soon, his personal terminal suddenly buzzed. Nanook looked down at it, and his eyes immediately filled with an indecipherable emotion. He said in a low voice, "Oh? I see... It looks like I have to pay a visit to the Kremnoan family."

Chapter End Notes

> The Author Has Something To Say:
> Yay! New Chapter! And I'm actually on time this week! But we set up a lot of things in the end of this part and I'm very excited for next part as we will see Mydei and Nanook clash. This chapter was too big so it will be split into 2 parts. Also love that General Wiley got his due karma as well as Khaslana being annoyed that Augustine insulted Phainon? AHHH! Really selling the whole 'Only I can bully him' vibes Khas XD.

Chapter 17: Cousins Fighting Over A Man (Pt.2)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

On the flight back, Mydei gave Phainon a rundown of his family and a few key points he should take notice of.

The Kremnoan family was the greatest family in the empire. There were several famous people who came from his family, and even more families that were connected to them by marriage. Their influence covered practically the entire empire. Mydei's mother, a female alpha named Gorgo, was the leader of the current generation in the Kremnoan family. Her younger sister was the deceased empress.

Chief Gorgo was a person with incredible influence, and she had several lovers, but her first husband had been tossed aside. After all, they had only arranged to marry to benefit their families, and they had no feelings for each other.

It was for this same reason that Mydei and his mother only had a cordial relationship. Instead, he was closer to the empress. When he was young, he often stayed in the imperial palace. After the empress passed away, he still had a good relationship with the crown prince.

Mydei was fortunate that when he had stayed there, he never saw the times empress and Nanook went crazy...

Of course, after Mydei became Khaslana's subordinate in the original novel, their close relationship also went away... This time, without Khaslana, the cousins shouldn't break off relations in such a dramatic way.

Phainon was slightly worried that his interference would make it so that Khaslana couldn't attain a high position. Khaslana and he were obviously at odds, but if Khaslana couldn't reach the height of achievement then Phainon wouldn't be able to leave the world. His feelings were complicated.

Still, Khaslana was fate's favorite. Even if he was missing a few subordinates, with the world consciousness on his side, he would certainly be able to prosper, and succeed on the path to the finale.

Mydei deeply respected the crown prince. He kept telling Phainon about all kinds of the crown prince's achievements, including how excellent his grades were when he was in school and how powerful he was piloting a mecha.

Once again, Phainon felt that Khaslana was a terrifying man to be able to make Mydei betray the crown prince.

When he finished, Mydei sighed again. "His Highness has a great character. Although he has power and influence, he isn't happy."

After all, his biological mother didn't care for the emperor in the slightest, so where would she have the time to bother with Nanook? Later, she did something so terrifying and died spectacularly. The emperor was even more disinclined to take another glance at Nanook.

At the same time, because Mydei was feeling blessed, he felt Nanook was even more tragic.

Phainon decided it was better for Mydei not to know about the truth after all. After all, in fact the crown prince was a huge villain who was pure on the surface and completely evil once you cut him open. Whatever Mydei thought about his great character was all pretend. He was someone who was extremely cold.

Perhaps he didn't feel anything towards Mydei at all, and it was all an act... After all, this fit his villainous setting better.

When he saw Phainon's upset expression, Mydei thought Phainon was angry by what he said. He said quickly, "Of course, you are still the most outstanding to me. Even His Highness can't compare to you."

"Alright, I know what you mean." Phainon felt like Mydei was like a proud lion begging for praise. He couldn't stop himself from reaching out to pat

his head. Mydei's face immediately flushed.

Since it was a private airship, there was no need to make detours or stop at any planets along the way. They soon arrived at the planet where the Kremnoan family's main residence was located.

In the past, this planet was famous for its wellness resort. It had a hot spring that was especially well-known. Supposedly, because it contained all kinds of microelements, besides being able to eliminate fatigue, it was especially effective to train after soaking in the hot spring.

Later, the Kremnoan family spent a huge some of money to buy the planet. Now, only the Kremnoan family and their guests were on the planet, as well as the servants who waited on them. Anyone else who came had to undergo a strict investigation.

As the heir of the next generation, any classmates that Mydei brought were naturally allowed enter straightaway. As soon as the security staff saw Mydeimos, they bowed respectfully.

Phainon guessed that the only person here who was stronger than Mydei was the family chief. He would be able to test whether the system would let a girl be a capture target. He might even be able to rescue his sexuality... Though a female alpha still had a peepee. No matter how often he said it, he still felt the world was too terrifying.

The airship stopped at the entrance of the estate. The sky had already turned dark, and it was impossible to see what the mansion looked like other than the fact that it was incredibly large.

Phainon looked in. It seemed as though there was some banquet being held. The mansion was brightly lit, and there were all kinds of magnificent decorations around the courtyard.

"Mother loves holding banquets. It's probably the same now." And she would always invite many of her lovers. Every time there was a banquet, the lovers would start a fight for favor. It was because of this same reason that Mydei normally didn't want to come home.

"Have we come at the wrong time..." Phainon said. They had managed to run into someone else throwing a banquet.

Mydei was a little worried. He said, "If she sees you, she'll certainly ask some unnecessary questions... But that's fine. If she asks any rude questions, you can just ignore them."

The main reason he had come back was just to let Phainon meet his mother and father and tell them that he had already decided on the person he would spend the rest of his life with. If his mother went as far as to blurt out some things, she couldn't control him even if she opposed more fiercely.

"Is there really no problem with this..." Phainon had a bad feeling. He felt like something bad would happen as soon as he walked in.

But they were already here. It would be too much for him to say that they should leave. Of course, Mydei would agree, but Phainon would feel rude.

Thus, he braced himself and went inside with Mydei.

He saw several people assembled in the middle of a magnificent hall. When they saw Mydei, they were stunned. They gathered around Mydei with excitement.

"Young Master Mydeimos, I didn't expect you would come back this year."

"Madam Chief will be ecstatic."

"Do you still remember me, sir? I actually met you once a few years ago."

"By the way, Young Master, you and my child were sweet on each other when you were younger, do you still remember?"

Immediately, the two of them were surrounded by the crowd. Every single one of them was enthusiastic, so enthusiastic that it was terrifying. If it wasn't for Mydei's always cold expression, they could even squeeze their way in front of him.

Mydei's attitude was already very cold, so aloof it was like he wanted to keep everyone a thousand miles away from him, but they continued to fight with their all to get closer.

After all, Mydeimos was the heir of the Kremnoan family. Although Gorgo had plenty of paramours, she didn't have a single illegitimate child.

Moreover, Mydei didn't have a partner yet. The families who had omega children, and even the families who only had alpha children, were all excited. If it wasn't for the fact that Mydei didn't give them a second look, they would push their children onto him.

Phainon, on the sidelines, was completely ignored. After all, he just looked like an unthreatening beta. He was probably just a classmate who was friendly with Young Master Mydeimos.

"Young Master Mydeimos, could it be that you also heard the news that His Highness is coming, so you hurried back?"

Mydei suddenly heard those words from the midst of noise. He turned to look at the person who had spoken. "You said His Highness?"

The person Mydei replied to was stunned, feeling a sense of honor at being called on. He said quickly, "Yes, exactly. His Highness the Crown Prince. As it turns out, you were unaware of this?"

Mydei frowned slightly. His Highness Nanook would never come over unless it was his mother's birthday. Why in the world was he here this time? Could it be that something had happened?

When Phainon heard their conversation, his face turned pale. "!"

Why did Nanook, the ultimate villain in the original novel, run over at this time? He had a feeling that something bad was going to happen. Besides Nanook's strength was clearly higher than Mydei's...

Did he still have time to leave?

Phainon looked at the people crowded at his side. Despairingly, he discovered that there was no chance he could squeeze his way out.

At that exact moment, the hostess of the banquet, Chief Gorgo, appeared from the second floor. The crowd immediately stopped making conversation so they wouldn't make Gorgo fed up with them.

Chief Gorgo was in her fifties. In the future, where the life expectancy was two hundred years old, she was extremely young. She had blonde hair, yellow eyes, and devastatingly gorgeous features. She was an enchanting woman.

But at that moment, compared to the person at her side, Gorgo looked much much more dull.

The young man at her side had silver hair and molten gold eyes. He was smiling slightly, but his forehead creased slightly as though he had some faint worry. He was beautiful in a way that was impossible to describe in words. No matter what kind of beauty was at his side, they would feel a keen sense of inferiority.

After all, this was the face that came from the most envied beauty in the empire.

When they saw Nanook, the crowd froze. Even though most of them had seen His Highness in photos online, he was a hundred times better looking in person than in pictures. For a moment, they couldn't think of anything to say.

Normally, a face like this should make people fall in love, but everyone had a keen feeling that they couldn't match up to His Highness the Crown Prince. They admired him the same way they admired a work of art. Forget about wooing him; there weren't even many people who would confess to him.

But Nanook didn't have any intentions to other people either. He had always kept out of trouble, living an honest life. He didn't have a single sex scandal.

Gorgo was already used to the assault Nanook's beauty caused on people, so she didn't care. Compared to what was happening with Nanook, there was something even more important.

She knew that her son was coming back a long time ago. She looked towards Mydei, a slight smile immediately revealing itself on her face, and walked over. Everyone else immediately took the initiative to draw back, giving her space to move.

When Mydei saw his older cousin, who he hadn't seen in a long time, his expression warmed greatly.

"This is your classmate?" Gorgo looked towards Phainon with curiosity. It was the first time Mydei had brought back a classmate. It truly was a rare occurrence.

Unlike Mydei, who was in a high spirits, Phainon was in a bad mood. Even his face was ashen.

No….Please No….He was perfectly fine with Mydeimos so-

[Beep beep beep... Detected a more powerful character... Beginning to change capture targets in accordance with the system's regulations... Change complete. The current capture target is Nanook.]

It really fucking went there. What the heck was he supposed to do so he could get close to his capture target, huh? Nanook's difficulty level was definitely no lower than Khaslana's.

The only way he was better than Khaslana was the fact that Phainon hadn't made an enemy out of him yet...

"This is my..." Mydei was halfway through his introduction when he suddenly stopped. For a moment, he had no idea how to describe his relationship with Phainon. 'Classmates' made them sound too unfamiliar, but they were obviously closer than that now.

As Mydei hesitated, a slight smile appeared on Nanook's face. He looked towards Phainon. "You finally came."

Phainon couldn't register his words until Nanook picked up his hand.

In front of everyone, Nanook lifted Phainon's hand up to his lips, lowering his head to press a kiss to the back of his hand. "I've already waited for you for a long time."

A thousand fucks steamrollered across Phainon's brain. "!?" Wait, what the heck was happening?!

The surrounding crowd reacted about the same as Phainon. If it wasn't for the fact that they had to do their utmost to maintain proper bearing in front of Nanook, their jaws might have fallen right off.

What did they just see?! Why did His Highness the Crown Prince look like he had such a good relationship with this beta who looked like a normal passerby? This was completely illogical. Or did this mean that this passerby beta was actually someone with incredible talent?

Gorgo was also stunned. Facing Mydei, she said, "So you brought back His Highness's friend? Why didn't you mention it before? How rude have we been!"

But Mydei was completely frozen. He didn't hear what his mother said, just looking at the scene in front of him in astonishment. Why would his cousin know Phainon? This wasn't right... And how could he be so intimate with Phainon?

Phainon finally came back to his senses, asking the same question that everyone around them wanted to know. "Your Highness, d-do we... know each other?"

Nanook leaned in to speak into Phainon's ear. "We've already known each other for a long time... Think about it some more. You'll certainly remember." He grabbed Phainon's hand and turning to the crowd and Gorgo. "Allow me to introduce my fiancé, Phainon."

Nanook's voice was quiet, but it struck through the crowd like a bolt of lightning.

Fiancé?? Wait, what did they just hear?!

Phainon was stupefied. He looked at Nanook with astonishment, but suddenly he felt that his voice was familiar.

...He remembered now. Wasn't this the person who spent two million empire coins to fight with him on the virtual net? The nouveau riche who said a single terrifying sentence and then ran off?!

No wonder Nanook said he found him... Although he didn't know how exactly Nanook had recognized his true identity from the virtual net, he pretty much knew the reason. There was no use in worrying about things like that.

Phainon felt uncomfortable all over. He thought he had kept his sockpuppet account quiet, but it turned out that practically all of the main characters knew! What was the difference between having a sockpuppet and not having one then!

Everyone else finally processed Nanook's words.

"What? What did I just hear?"

"His Highness has a fiancé??"

"W-when did this happen?! How come I never heard of it at all?"

"I'm actually dreaming, right?"

Everyone was wondering if they had missed some important news in the last few days. Why had the future emperor, the incredibly outstanding alpha His Highness the Crown Prince, chosen a beta as his companion? This just couldn't be justified, okay?!

And they had never heard of the name Phainon before. There were no families with this surname in the great clans and nobles of the empire.

But with their statuses, they had no way to question His Highness the Crown Prince's decisions. They could only hide away their shock, putting their uncertainty in their hearts, and turn to giving out their blessings.

Gorgo was also shocked. She frowned. "Your Highness, are you being serious? Have you consulted His Majesty? An event as important as a wedding isn't child's play."

Nanook glanced towards her indifferently. "It's enough for me to decide myself."

Nanook's attitude was mild, but Gorgo's heart iced over. In that moment, it was as though she was seeing her beautiful but obstinate younger sister.

The gentle beauty who became famous was a mere frail omega, but she had done something nobody dared to believe.

That year, her younger sister could even do something like that. If they opposed His Highness the Crown Prince's decision, who knew what the crown prince would do?

Gorgo immediately compromised. "If Your Highness likes him, then I won't say anything else."

"Your Highness, this is a joke, right?" Mydei stared at Nanook, doing his best to maintain his calm, but he couldn't stop his voice from trembling. "Might you have made this decision too quickly..."

Mydei simply couldn't imagine that his older cousin he looked up to the most had done something like this.

"I'm very serious this time?" Nanook smiled slightly. "Besides, now that I have someone I like, you must also be quite happy, right?"

Mydei's expression turned ugly. He looked towards Phainon with a prayer in his eyes, as though he was hoping he would say everything was false.

But Phainon had bound to Nanook. Although he didn't know what exactly Nanook was going to do, at this time it was clear that he couldn't say the

truth! So, reluctantly Phainon gritted out, "It really is true."

Mydei wanted to put on a reluctant smile, but no matter how he tried, he couldn't do it.

Gorgo immediately noticed there was something wrong with her son. Could it be that Mydeimos also liked this beta?

If this was the past, Gorgo would probably advise him to marry an omega from an illustrious family, then take his true love as his lover or something. After all, Gorgo had done the same thing.

But the fact that he had fallen in love with the same person as His Highness Nanook was too terrifying. Gorgo quickly said, "Mydei, you just came back, you haven't said hello to your father yet, have you? He's been waiting for you for a long time. You should find him quickly."

"Yes, you're right." Mydei was in a trance. "I truly apologize. I'll leave first."

The way he left made people wonder if he would be okay.

But Gorgo was the hostess of the party, and she couldn't leave any time she wanted. She was left to say, "Alright, everyone has arrived, so we'll begin the dance proper."

Nobody had enough of the love triangle. They felt a bit sorry.

The music began. Gorgo hurried away.

And Nanook, who had started the entire series of events, acted just like nothing had happened. He looked down at Phainon, smiling slightly. In that moment, it was as though the radiance around him had turned dark.

"Come, dance with me."

"...!" Phainon's heart tightened into a knot. Before he figured out what exactly Nanook was trying to do, how would he be in the mood to dance? He said, "But I don't know how to dance..."

"It's fine, I'll lead you." Nanook had a gentle attitude, but Phainon felt his heart go cold. He had the feeling that if he rejected Nanook, something bad would happen.

Thus Phainon braced himself and walked with Nanook to the center of the dancefloor.

The rest of the people slowly digested the stunning news, swaying on the dancefloor as if nothing had happened, but in their minds they wished the dance was already over and they could run over to discuss the gossip they learned today.

When the first song ended, Phainon, who had absolutely no idea how to dance, had already stepped on Nanook many times. He had a feeling that if they kept going he would get beaten to death, and finally he couldn't stand it anymore. He said, "I feel a bit tired. Can I go rest first?"

"Of course you can." Nanook didn't have any intentions of forcing Phainon.

After shaking off Nanook, Phainon practically flew to the flower garden outside. He found an isolated area to sit down before he was able to let out a breath of relief.

There were only two possibilities to explain why Nanook had said what he said. First, he could be one of Prince Latiao's fervent fans, and when he met Phainon he was seized with the sudden impulse to confess.

But anyone who read the original novel would know that Nanook wasn't a naive sweetheart like Mydei or Caelus. He had enough strength on his own, and he had no particular thoughts about anyone else who was strong. Even the most outstanding people were just chess pieces in the palm of his hand.

If it wasn't for Khaslana's plot armor, he absolutely wouldn't be defeated so easily.

Then Nanook was probably trying to draw Phainon over to side?

But he didn't have to do something like this. He could just draw over a few subordinates. There was no need to force him in front of a crowd and say some stuff about a fiancé...

The dignified crown prince didn't have to go so far as to use these method to keep an expert, right?

Besides, in reality, Phainon was still such a useless potato.

Phainon felt his head ache. He heaved a sigh. He had no idea how he would live his days in the future. His heart ached when he thought about Mydei's reaction but he didn't understand why...He was just another supporting character so why… It was probably that he wouldn't be able to eat the tasty foods that Mydei made anymore….yeah, that must be it.

Just then, someone walked over. It was a pale-faced Mydei.

"I have something to ask you."

It was obvious that Mydei didn't go to his room earlier. Instead, he was waiting in this remote are the whole time. He looked like a mess, but when he looked at Phainon, he was trying his best to maintain calm. "Was everything you said genuine?"

Just as Phainon was about to explain, Mydei carefully reached out, wanting to hold Phainon's hand.

And Phainon, who wasn't paying much attention, felt the terrifying electric shock, one he hadn't felt for a long time, from touching a previous capture target.

The shock was several times stronger than the previous electric shocks.

In a split second, Phainon drew back his hand rapidly. Because his movement was too intense, he nearly fell to the ground. Mydei wanted to pull him up, but Phainon flung him away.

Phainon vowed with the utmost integrity that it wasn't on purpose. It was all the system's fault! The shock was obviously several more times painful than

it was in the previous world!

[It's to prevent some masochistic hosts from purposefully violating the rules to attain pleasure.]

Phainon: "!" Damn it, of course masochists would feel excited when they get a shock, okay! Only innocents like him would be even more miserable.

Mydei was already as pale as a piece of paper. He bit his lip, taking several steps back. "It was my mistake. I shouldn't have touched you. I shouldn't ask you a question like this... B-but why... why..."

He must have been too confident in himself. Although he had always been together with Phainon, it didn't necessarily mean that Phainon had to tell him about everything he did and everyone he met.

It wasn't that he couldn't understand what he didn't know about Phainon. Maybe Phainon and Nanook got to know each other some time he didn't know about... And Nanook really was a good match for Phainon, who he had always yearned after. He should be congratulating them.

But... He should be congratulating them, but why couldn't he be happy? Instead, he even had some terrifyingly extreme thoughts.

"Wait, it's not what you think. I can explain." When Phainon saw Mydei’s expression he felt an inexplicable panic rise up. He immediately wanted to explain.

"Explain what?" Nanook's voice suddenly resounded.

Phainon turned and spotted Nanook walking over slowly. He looked at the two of them with a slight smile. "Can I listen in on what you two are talking about? I also really want to know what you guys are chatting about."

Phainon had no choice but to swallow his words back down. "It's nothing, I wasn't going to say anything."

"Mydeimos, thank you for taking care of My Deliverer these days." Nanook turned to look at Mydei. "I've noted it all down. If there's anything you have

trouble dealing with, you can come look for me."

Mydei turned his eyes to the person he used to worship so fervently. Suddenly, he found Nanook's smile incredibly ugly. The dark feelings in his heart suddenly exploded. He opened his mouth to speak reluctantly. "...I will."

When he finished speaking, Mydei staggered away as though he didn't want to see the scene again.

Phainon decided to explain to him when he went online again. This wasn't the right time. There was something more important waiting for him to deal with.

"What's wrong?" Nanook said. "You're looking at me like that all of a sudden. Is there something you want to say to me?"

"Your Highness, what exactly do you want to do?" Phainon said with narrowed eyes. "Even if you know my online identity, you didn't have to say something like that in front of everyone. This has no benefit to you... Besides, you see it too, I'm just a beta. My strength isn't as outstanding as it is on the virtual net."

He ought to make it clear first so that Nanook wouldn't get mad when he discovered he was a potato in the future → →

"I know. I know much more than you think," Nanook said. "I already noticed a long time ago... After all, someone with enough power to prevent me from finding their identity would make me very curious about their true identity."

Phainon: "..." Hey, so it turned out that the source of all of the trouble was actually right here?

"I was always looking for exactly who that person was. After what you did, I was finally certain." Nanook smiled slightly. "Besides, after I found out that Prince Latiao was you, I investigated thoroughly. It's true that you currently don't have the same strength as you do in the virtual net."

"Then why do you have to do this..." Phainon just couldn't understand what Nanook was thinking. Then again, if he could figure it out, then Nanook would just be a normal villain...

"If someone is powerful in the virtual world, but is just a common beta in real world, how interesting is that?" Nanook said. "I'm truly interested."

Phainon: "..." I'm begging you not to be so interested in this.

"Besides... I really do like you a lot." Nanook leaned in, extending a hand to cup Phainon's cheek. He whispered into his ear, "Do you remember the time when you were on that planet attending the training and suddenly went into heat?"

"!!!" Phainon's body went stiff. He retreated unconsciously, but Nanook pulled him into his arms firmly. He could do nothing but ask, "H-how do you know about that?!"

The only person who knew about that should be the Zerg youth, right?!

"I don't just know. Back then, I was there." Nanook looked at the nape of Phainon's neck. "Your scent in heat is delicious..."

Phainon: "You!?" Fuck, what the heck was happening! Don't tell him that the Zerg was Nanook's disguise?! Wait, if he remembered correctly that Zerg youth also had pale hair with gold eyes... Although he looked completely different, who knew whether or not Nanook used some high-tech technology to disguise himself.

The fact that the crown prince of the empire was a Zerg completely overturned a ton of the plotlines in the original novel, didn't it?! No, when he thought about it, he could make a subtle connection. But it was still crazy.

Before Phainon could completely digest the new information, Nanook's gaze darkened slightly. "Why is there the scent of someone else's pheromones on you?"

Phainon: "..." Fuck. T-this... He nearly forgot about the intimate things that couldn't be described that he did with Mydei during his heat.

"Could it be that somebody marked you?"

Chapter End Notes

The Author Has Something To Say:
Yay! New Chapter! And our Phainon got stolen!! (T^T) No Mydei~! But Nanook was quite swoonworthy with his forceful lines. I'm excited to see your reaction to this chapter. I have some fun things planned for Nanook and Phainon for the next few chapters. Sorry Mydei, I promise to make it up to you one day QAQ. This is one of favourite chapters and I'm excited for Nanook's possessiveness XD.

See you next week!

Chapter 18: Meeting The Parents

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Fuck, why did he feel like he got caught cheating?

Still, he could take advantage of this change. In this omegaverse setting, wasn't it that an omega couldn't sleep with someone else after they were marked by an alpha? With this kind of reason, Nanook should give up on those improper thoughts!

Phainon's mood cheered up. He said in a low voice, "Your Highness, you can tell too... You're right. I'm someone who doesn't think ahead. I'm not faithful, and I'm weak to handsome faces. I'll fall in love at first sight. I even like omegas."

In order to make Nanook change his improper thoughts, Phainon already started putting himself down. It didn't matter even if he put himself down even more.

Anyways, what he said about liking an omega was the truth. Even if Phainon hadn't even seen a single omega before.

"Your words," Nanook said, "instead make me think that we're quite well-matched."

Phainon: "?!"

"I'm fed up with this plain, ordinary life. You always bring me new surprises," Nanook said. "You can't change my mind with these words..."

"...l-it's fine even if I mess around all the time?!"

"Of course not." Although Nanook had a slight smile, his eyes were cold. "No matter who you like, from beginning to end, you can only stay by my side... And you can only keep your eyes on me."

"...Then what if someone else gets close to me?" Phainon said.

Nanook said, "Isn't it fine if I just kill the people who get close to you?"

Phainon: "...." Hey! With these kinds of thoughts, you really are worthy of being a villain, aren't you?! Then what if that person's your younger cousin!

When he thought about it, Phainon had the feeling that Nanook really could do something like killing off his younger cousin.

"Still, I won't force you."

Phainon knew that villains like this would begin to threaten people right after saying something like this. He immediately braced himself.

"I know everything about your parents," Nanook said. "The reason they had you pretend to be a beta should also be to protect their noble title. As long as you marry me, they'll be able to continue their clan, and they'll also be able to rise up to high society."

Phainon: "!" Fuck, he even brought out the parents! He already said he wouldn't use force, but as expected...

"But if you turn me down, things will probably take a turn for the worse," Nanook said. "You need to make your decision carefully."

With a heavy heart, Phainon thought about how the other party was his capture target. Finally, he made his decision. He grabbed Nanook's hand, looking up at his face earnestly. "I've thought it over."

"Oh?"

"Actually, I admire Your Highness a lot," Phainon said. "Please let me stay at your side."

Morals? Just let them die in the wind.

And he wouldn't bother with how an omega would be together with another alpha after being marked!

Mydei didn't even know how he got back to his room. When he returned to his senses, his things were already strewn everywhere. Even the photo album in his cabinets where scattered.

When he lowered his head, Mydei could still see the press photos of his older cousin's graduation that he had specially collected in the photo album.

The Nanook in the pictures was gentle, but even so, because of his face, he was still dazzling.

...He was so dazzling that he was instead harsh and blinding.

No matter what, Mydei had never expected that he would encounter such a situation when he came home.

Of course, Mydei would never blame Phainon no matter what.

Besides, Phainon had always seemed completely willing... But why did he fling him aside like that later? Was he led astray by that face?

Yes, it was all Nanook's fault. If he hadn't suddenly appeared, things wouldn't become like this...

As long as he could die, everything would be just like it was in the beginning.

Mydei was shocked to discover that when he thought about killing his own cousin, the one he had always worshipped, his emotions were calm.

It was already late. After straightening out his feelings, he walked to the shower.

But under the illumination of the moonlight, a photo album was laid bare on the ground. A sparkling silver dagger was stabbed through the face of the charming young man in the photo.

After going back, Phainon found out that Gorgo had arranged for him and Nanook to share a room... After all, Gorgo thought of the them as an engaged couple. It was a perfectly normal arrangement.

Even if he wanted to explain, he had no idea how he would explain it. Phainon could only brace himself to sleep in the same room as Nanook.

He didn't even have time to carry out his original plan to go online and explain what happened to Mydei.

And Phainon didn't know how he should explain. Things had already gotten to this point. Why not just let Mydei think it was real then?

Luckily, the bed in the room was big enough. After he finished bathing, Phainon went straight to lay down on the furthest edge, still struggling to accept what he found out earlier... How exactly was Nanook related to the Zerg!

"You're thinking about why I appeared on the planet back then?" Nanook asked. He suddenly leaned in, looking into Phainon's eyes.

Phainon was so shocked he nearly fell off the bed. He nodded. "That's really important to me."

"I can tell you. Because I like you a lot, you know." Nanook pressed himself closer to Phainon lazily. He said, "Those were actually bodies cloned from my genes. Of course, those bodies don't have my will. When I want to go somewhere, I can use them whenever I like. They're quite convenient."

"Modern technology can already do something like that?" Phainon was a bit shocked. "It can even let someone's mind get moved to someone else's

body?"

He already thought that sending his consciousness to the spiritual world was incredible.

"... Of course not," Nanook said, his tone careless. "The reason I can do something is naturally because... I'm not human."

Phainon: "!" The fuck, why'd you say something like this so out of the blue? He had the feeling he was going to be silenced, okay!!

"It's a joke." Nanook reached out to poke Phainon's cheek, smiling slightly. "You actually believed it? You really are naive. It's easy for people to cheat someone like you."

Phainon: "..."

No, with his experience from years of reading novels, this was absolutely real... But if it was true, how exactly was Nanook a Zerg?

It was impossible that he inherited from the emperor. After all, Khaslana was also the emperor's son. In that case, this novel would also become a record of a Zerg's counterattack.

But if it was from the empress, then didn't that mean the Kremnoan family was all... and Mydeimos was also...

No, that shouldn't be right. Maybe it was just that Zerg genes had been introduced to the cloned body for some need. This sounded a bit more reasonable.

Phainon immediately sighed a breath of relief. He felt like he could finally explain everything.

Just at that moment, the time hit midnight. The system sounded right on schedule. [Daily task refreshed. The current task is [Kiss the capture target once]. Host, please do your best.]

Phainon: "..." There was actually a difference between a forced kiss and a kiss? The kiss didn't need to be lip-to-lip now?

[Correct.]

He really never thought that the system would release a task with so much kindness. Phainon felt unexpectedly moved.

If the system released a healing task, he would be able to test whether or not Nanook was a Zerg... Wait, even if the system didn't release a task, he could still try it out.

Phainon turned his head. Nanook had already fallen asleep next to him at some point. This was a golden opportunity to test out his theory.

Nothing bad happens nine times out of ten, Phainon reasoned. He lowered his head towards Nanook, slowly leaning in.

Just as his hand touched Nanook's shoulder, the other person's eyes suddenly opened. His yellow eyes were closer in color to liquid gold, as though he was completely emotionless. He said, "What are you trying to do?"

"It's a... good night kiss... Yes, a good night kiss!" Phainon was nearly scared out of skin, but he gathered his wits and blurted out an excuse before leaning down and pressing a kiss on Nanook's cheek.

He could even finish off his daily task while fooling him. He really was a genius.

Nanook grabbed his hand, pressing Phainon into the bed and raising one eyebrow. "Ever since earlier, I've been controlling myself, but you're still seducing me."

"I just- I just couldn't control myself because you're too good-looking," Phainon said quickly.

"Oh?" Nanook bent over, whispering into his ear, "Do you know what happens to omegas who have been marked by an alpha but can't get married

to them?"

"No."

Phainon thought this setting was a pain in the ass. After an omega was marked by an alpha, they couldn't be marked by anyone else. Wouldn't it be a bother if the alpha didn't take responsibility?

Although the empire's laws dictated that alphas had to take responsibility in these circumstances, there was nothing they could do if a powerful and influential scumbag alpha didn't want to take responsibility.

And it was also illegal if an omega reached a certain age and hadn't gotten married yet. They had to pay an incredible sum in fines, and their families could even force the omega to get married or something like that... This was just a feudal society, dammit.

Although the status of an omega had risen quite a bit in the last few years, and it wasn't like in the past when they had no rights at all and they were considered solely a part of an alpha's riches, they still had to stay at home and couldn't leave.

"Those omegas will be forced to marry someone else. Even if they were already marked, they'll be forcibly possessed by that other person... You know, don't you? It's incredibly painful for an omega to couple with someone who didn't mark them," Nanook remarked. "And their spouse would detest them. When their child is born, they're worthless. There would be no one asking after their life or death."

Phainon's face turned white in terror. "!!" Fuck, system, hurry up and think of a solution!

[There's no need to worry. To prevent a situation like this, when the host transmigrated into this body, the system already transformed the body. Still, an accident occured because of a lack of familiarity with this world's world consciousness.]

"What accident..." Phainon had a bad feeling.

[Although the host himself can let anyone mark him without minding, the alphas who marked the host will never be able to mark another person again... Still, this doesn't matter to the host. Host, you can mess around without worries."]

Phainon: "..." What kind of roast was this?! And he didn't even mess around.

When he saw Phainon's ugly expression, Nanook thought he was scared. He said, "Don't worry, I won't do anything... Recently, the research institute has begun to investigate an alteration medicine. It's almost become successful. In the future, it can resolve this problem."

Phainon sighed a breath of relief. Science truly benefited mankind, though there was no way for the people who slept with him to benefit.

No, actually he didn't want to go sleeping around with other people, okay! Even if it was someone as attractive as Nanook!

"Then what if there's no medicine?" Phainon asked. "What will happen?"

"What do you think?" Nanook smiled slightly, patting Phainon's cheek.

Phainon felt uncomfortable all over. "..." He didn't want to think about something like that!!

And even though he didn't show much on his face, in reality Phainon was still afraid of Nanook. After all, he was the villain, and he had that crazy mother. In front of him, Phainon felt like his life was at risk.

Despite that, when Phainon immediately spotted Nanook's beautiful face in the rays of early morning light the next day, he felt he had nearly turned gay.

"He really is too terrifying." Phainon twisted his head away quickly, feeling some lingering fear. It was just a waste for this face to be on a man!!

If he had transmigrated around fifteen years ago, he would probably have been able to see the number one beauty, the empress.

Phainon simply couldn't understand the emperor's sense of aesthetic. He didn't like someone as beautiful as the empress, but instead liked a pretty face with a vicious heart... Well, that could just be his taste.

After they got out of bed, Nanook brought Phainon to a restaurant to eat.

Mydei was already waiting for them. His expression looked exactly the same as normal, and his eyes also looked normal when he looked at Phainon. He didn't like someone who had been cheated on yesterday night.

Gorgo felt a bit worried after she hadn't been able to find Mydei when she went looking for him yesterday, but when she saw her son's current attitude she relaxed.

When Mydei saw the two of them approaching, he stood up to speak. "Yesterday, I was too shocked to process the circumstances. I truly apologize for leaving the way I did."

Nanook smiled slightly, as though he had absolutely no idea what his cousin was thinking. "That's great."

Phainon sighed in relief. It would be for the best if Mydei could think things through. But how would he tell Mydei about what the system said yesterday?

The system had dug a deep hole for Mydei. The bootlicking system was so good to the capture target that it even made the host a little jealous, but its attitude to the previous capture target was terrifyingly indifferent.

The system certainly wouldn't bother with a capture target like Mydei who had a modification trap set up for them... In other words, Mydei had been bound to Phainon.

Still, the circumstances were a little better than in the original novel. After all, in the original novel, the person Mydei liked was even more scary and

even more scummy.

"It's enough if you're happy." Mydei looked at Phainon, looking incredibly genuine.

"Of course I'll bring him happiness," Nanook said, smiling slightly.

His attitude made it seem like he had some hidden intention. Still, looking at his warm smile, there was probably no one would think he was doing it on purpose...

Phainon: "..." Hey, this guy was simply insane! No wonder Mydei was betrayed in the original novel. He probably felt really happy making his little cousin despair...

They began to eat breakfast. Of course, everyone was immersed in their own thoughts. Other than Phainon, not a single person could enjoy the flavor of the delicious food.

After they finished eating, Nanook said, "I'm planning to bring My Deliverer home today."

"So soon?" Gorgo was a bit shocked. "Your Highness, won't you stay here a little long?"

In reality, Gorgo wanted to send His Highness the Crown Prince away as soon as possible. When His Highness the Crown Prince first came, it was something to be proud of, but who knew it would cause something like this to happen... Even if Mydei was perfectly normal right now, who knew if he would do something irrational?

"No... The purpose for my visit was to pick up My Deliverer and leave." Nanook smiled slightly. "Now this purpose has been accomplished, we can leave." As he spoke, he even turned to look at Phainon.

Phainon had no choice but to speak up. "Yeah, I think we can leave now too."

In fact, Phainon really wanted to try out the hot springs, but how could he say it now?

If it was the past Mydei, he might have been so disgusted that he lost his appetite. Now, though, he still looked calm, as though he didn't care about what was happening at all.

After finishing his food, Phainon was taken out the door and straight onto Nanook's private airship.

Phainon was very nervous. He didn't know where he would be taken.

Nanook said, "Mm, it's time to meet Mother-in-Law and Father-in-Law."

Phainon: "Huh!?"

So when Nanook said they were getting married, he was actually being serious?! Would others really have no objections... Still, when he thought about it, with the emperor's attitude of turning a blind eye towards Nanook, the emperor would probably be ecstatic if he heard that Nanook was randomly getting married to someone from an impoverished noble family.

As for other people, even the chief of the Kremnoan family Gorgo couldn't control Nanook. What could anyone else do?

At that moment, the airship sailed towards the planet that Phainon thought he would never visit again.

Phainon felt a bit disturbed. After all, last time he even brought Mydei home. Besides, Audata and Hieronymus really liked Mydei. They practically thought of Mydei as his future partner. Wouldn't it cause any problems if he brought another person?

After they got out of the airship, they should have taken an aircar straight to their destination. However, Nanook suddenly had the strange idea to take a look around Phainon's hometown. No matter how Phainon tried to persuade him, nothing worked. He took Phainon straight out from the port.

In moments, the two of them drew the surrounding crowd's attention.

Nanook was incredibly attractive. Even if he wasn't the crown prince, he would still be someone that people paid attention to. Although he was currently wearing a pair of sunglasses to conceal his identity, in reality there wasn't much of a different compared to if he wasn't wearing them.

After everyone got over their shocked, they became incredibly excited. "It's His Highness the Crown Prince?!"

"Why would His Highness the Crown Prince be here!"

"Ahhhh am I dreaming?"

Immediately, the port became a mass of chaos. Huge numbers of people squeezed closer. Still, nobody dared to come close to the two of them, and there were still two hundred meters around Nanook left empty. Outside of those two hundred meters, a sea of people had already gathered.

Phainon was intimidated. The spectacle made him feel like he was going to be trampled in the next second. At his side, Nanook looked like he was already used to it and didn't have the slightest bit of anxiety. Instead, he waved at the people around them with a slight smile, making everyone begin to shriek.

Because they were right outside the port, what happened completely affected the port's normal operations. People around them who didn't know what happened even thought there might be some kind of riot.

Finally, the governor of the planet hurried over. At first, he just wanted to find out who was causing the disturbance, but when he realized the person who had come was His Highness the Crown Prince, he was so excited his hands began to tremble. He immediately invited Nanook onto his aircar.

When Nanook was gone, the crowd dispersed quickly, but they couldn't calm down. They quickly posted the pictures they took onto the virtual net.

And the person next to His Highness the Crown Prince in the photos drew the other people's attention.

On the aircar.

Phainon remembered from the original owner's memories that the governor was high and mighty. He had never been polite. Unexpectedly, now that he was in front of Nanook, he changed completely.

"Could I ask what Your Highness is doing here?" Along with his excitement, the governor felt completely off-balance. He was afraid that the things he had done in the past had been exposed. "I-Is there something we've done poorly here?"

One of his subordinates, who was pouring tea on the side, was extremely nervous. Several times, he nearly poured tea outside of the cup. Even when he tried his best to maintain his calm, he couldn't stop his trembling hands.

"No, I just wanted to come see my future in-laws... But things turned out like this." Nanook sighed. "I also feel very troubled."

Phainon: "..." Actually, this guy should be really happy. He was as happy as however much of a mess he made. He wouldn't care what other people were thinking.

When the governor heard him, he was stunned.

The Crown Prince's in-laws?! How could someone with such a high status be on this planet? He knew very clearly that although the planet was relatively closer to the capital planet, it wasn't some kind of tourist planet. Other than a few nouveau riche who wanted to be a bit closer to the noble circles, there was only a few downtrodden nobles who resided on the planet.

The person next to the governor saw Phainon's face clearly. Immediately, he froze. "This young man is Hieronymus’s..."

The governor suddenly recalled that he hadn't thought about the young man at all, though he thought Phainon looked familiar. After all, his family was

such an impoverished noble family. How could they know someone as awe-inspiring as His Highness the Crown Prince? Now that his subordinate reminded him, he suddenly remembered.

"It's been a while since we last met," Phainon greeted, although he didn't really want to explain his identity.

The governor thought that Phainon was just one of the crown prince's followers, but that position alone was enough to stun him. He didn't expect that a mere beta from a rundown noble family would be able to lick the crown prince's boots. If he had known earlier, he would have had his own child get on friendly terms with him.

In the next moment, Nanook pulled Phainon right into his arms, announcing their relationship openly. "Actually, Deliverer here is my fiancé. In the last few years, he's received your care."

The governor was stupefied. He wished he could go back in time. He completely regretted that he hadn't gone to cozy up with his family.

But the subordinate at his side was as white as paper. He tugged at the governor's clothing cautiously.

This was their signal. Immediately, the governor smiled apologetically, saying that he had something to care of, and walked out to the hallway.

The governor looked at his subordinate with worry. "What in the world is it? Quick, spit it out." He was in a rush to seize the opportunity to show his kindness to His Highness the Crown Princess. If he wasted this change, he wouldn't have such a precious opportunity again.

"Sir... You must have forgotten." His subordinate's face was pale. "Recently, sir, you agreed to some of the that family's requests... Now, they might already have..."

The governor went stiff. He suddenly remembered.

Some people in the family's side branches had gotten him some benefits. They seemed to have plans to do something to the main branch, so he pretended that he didn't see them and allowed them to mess around on the main family's territory. Anyway, a family as downtrodden as this one could't cause any ruckus.

He didn't expect that now the supposedly downtrodden family's Phainon had managed to cling onto such a powerful person. He had no idea how Phainon had managed to become the crown prince's fiancé. Was he done for?!

The governor nearly fainted. His subordinate quickly caught him. The governor took a long time before he came back to his senses, and he hoarsely rasped, "Hurry and stop those people quickly. We can't let His Highness find out..."

If he got found out, there was no need to mention his future. He might not even be able to keep his current position!

Meanwhile, Audata and Hieronymus was gloomy.

Recently, a side branch of the family produced an extremely outstanding alpha named Herklas. He was a few years older than Phainon, and he was measured to be a genius when he was born. After Audata had her accident, she had thought about adopting Herklas, but it had been left unsettled for a variety of reasons.

Recently, Herklas had succeeded in becoming subordinate to a patriarch of one of the Kremnoan's branch families. Although it was just a branch family, they suddenly had unprecedented influence and power. Afterwards, they began to make moves towards the main family's title.

At first, Audata and Hieronymus put out a huge price for the people who were coveting their position. But even though the family was in dire straits, their only child Phainon was still an omega pretending to be a beta. They

had no way to resist Herklas, someone under the Kremnoan family's protection.

Although Mydei had visited the other time, Hieronymus and Audata were completely in the dark about his identity. They had even less of an idea about the heir of the distant Kremnoan family coming to pay a visit

that day. They still went to the kitchen and cooked, thinking that it was just one of Phainon's average classmates.

"What exactly is the best way to go forward?" Audata couldn't stop her tears. Her health had finally recovered, and Phainon was doing much better in school. She thought that they could finally shake off their difficulties. She had never expected that something like this would happen.

"When you think about it, it's all this title's fault." Hieronymus sighed. "We might as well just turn it over. Herklas shouldn't treat us poorly in the future... This way, Phainon will be able to be a normal omega."

"You're right..." Audata said.

They were about to continue discussing when the front door was flung open. It was haughty young man with a forehead full of sweat and a huge group of people. He walked in, swollen with pride. When the people behind him were inside, they began to pound on the walls around the room.

"What are you doing?" Hieronymus hastily shielded Audata, looking at Herklas with fury.

"Gosh, Uncle Hieronymus, didn't I say that the decorations in this house were too awful?" Herklas sat right down on the sofa, his attitude lazy. He raised an eyebrow, looking at Audata and Hieronymus. "Anyway, this house is going to be mine in the end. Why don't I start putting things in order now? It'll make it easy for me to move in quickly.

"You...! I haven't agreed yet. Hurry up and stop!" Hieronymus gritted his teeth. Although he was an alpha, his natural talents were mediocre, and he

still wasn't very strong today. Otherwise, he wouldn't have let his family fall to such straits.

"Oh?" Herklas looked indifferent. "Does it matter whether you agree or not?"

"We're all relatives. Why go to such extremes?" Hieronymus said furiously. "Don't think that you can do this just by taking advantage of the Kremnoan name."

"Gosh, Uncle, you're already so old, don't get too angry. It'll be bad if your health is affected," Herklas sneered. "Still, Uncle, what you mean is that you want to go against the Kremnoan family with your strength alone? You really make people shocked by your courage... I admire you."

"You..." Hieronymus had no choice but to admit it. Forget about fighting back; the Kremnoan family could flatten them with the strength in their little finger.

"If you kiss up to me quickly, I can still look after you until you're old," Herklas said coolly. "At first, I didn't value this stupid title too much."

"We don't need you to look after us until we're old..." It was obvious that even if Audata was planning to hand over their title on a silver platter, the other party wouldn't treat them well. She gritted her teeth. "We have an heir ourselves."

"Oh? An heir?" Herklas had naturally investigated before coming, but he only knew that the dukedom had servants.

Herklas didn't dare to offend the duke, but a duke's servant had the courage to resist the Kremnoan family? He said with disdain, "That Phainon guy... Isn't he just a beta? He's just useless trash."

Suddenly, a voice came from the door. *"Who did you call useless trash?"*

Chapter End Notes

The Author Has Something To Say:
Yay! New Chapter! I hope you enjoy spending time with Nanook because we'll be seeing a lot more of him from now on. Haha i love Phainon questioning Mydei's previous crush on Khas calling Khas a scummy crazy person XD. This chapter was kinda boring but we're heading towards the ending soon!

See you next week!

Chapter 19: He's My Fiancé

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Herklas was unhappy to be interrupted halfway through his sentence. He had already given the governor plenty of benefits, but he had still been disturbed by someone else.

He turned his head in annoyance. Immediately, he spotted Phainon and the governor standing at the door.

Although Herklas hadn't seen Phainon in many years, for better or worse he had looked up his information before coming and had an idea of what Phainon looked like. He snorted at once. "And here I thought it was someone important. So it's just Phainon. Do you think there's a problem with something I said? Do you think you're so amazing?"

"What's going on here?" Phainon immediately turned to look at the governor. "You'd better explain this clearly."

Despite his words, Phainon could pretty much guess what was happening... Just now when they were on the airship, he had a feeling the governor's attitude was off.

The governor's face was ashen. He blurted, "Actually, this is all a mistake. It was just that a member of the branch family wanted to come and take a look around. I don't know where the miscommunication was..." Simultaneously, he gave Herklas several meaningful glances, hoping he would play along.

He had barely managed to calm down on the airship just now and resourcefully said that they ought to bring gifts when visiting the in-laws. He had successfully managed to delay the crown prince.

But Phainon had noticed something, and insisted on hurrying back. The governor had no choice but to come along, thinking he would still be able to salvage the situation. He didn't expect that he would spot this kind of situation at once. He immediately felt his head begin to spin.

Even if you wanted to snatch someone else's noble title, there should be no need to act like this! Herklas was too arrogant. He had even begun to plunder the house.

As the governor thought, he also forgot what he had guaranteed Herklas when he first accepted his bribes.

It was a pity that Herklas completely missed the governor's signals. He snorted. "I came this time for the family's noble title. There's no mistake at all. It seems to me, sir, that you've forgotten something."

Audata and Hieronymus looked at the governor next to Phainon in shock. They knew that Herklas had bought over the governor a long time ago, so they thought the governor had come to pressure them. Their hearts sank.

They just didn't expect that Phainon would also come. If he impulsively began to argue with the governor, it would be terrible. Audata quickly stepped forward, tugging at Phainon. With worry, she said, "Phainon, why are you here? You don't need to worry about this... We can deal with it."

But Hieronymus stared coldly at the governor. "We've stayed on this planet for several years. We paid plenty of fees every year. Sir, if you've become biased towards someone else for this trifling benefits, my heart has truly gone cold."

When the governor heard his words, he was ready to faint away. He hurried to say, "You've made a mistake, my lord. I haven't come because of that."

Hieronymus was shocked by his address. It was the first time the governor used the words "my lord" in all these years.

Although the governor was unwilling to let go of Herklas's benefits at first, Phainon was right next to him. This was the crown prince's fiancé! How

could he offend him? Were those bribes as important as his position?! Did he even need to think about it?

The governor made a prompt decision. He said to Herklas, "I have no idea what is happening here. The way you barged into Phainon’s family's house truly has no regard for me as governor. As for the family's noble title, you're just a member of the branch family. Unless the heir of the family dies, it's impossible for you to inherit the family."

Phainon: "..." Hey, your attitude changed too fast, didn't it? Besides, he should be the one saying these cheesy lines... The governor was making it seem like he was the heir of the family.

Audata and Hieronymus were stunned by the governor's rapid change of heart. They had absolutely no idea the governor would speak up for them like this. They had already known each other for decades, but he had never faced them with a smile. If the governor, who only recognized wealth and not personality, turned into such a fair and honest person, the world didn't feel quite real.

Herklas couldn't help but laugh in his anger. He sneered, "I've already given you the money. You don't want to recognize it anymore, sir? The Kremnoan family is supporting me. You should think it over one more time."

Should the governor choose Herklas, who had the Kremnoan family supporting him, or three people who had nothing but their noble title?

The governor chose almost without hesitation. Damn it, compared to the crown prince, Herklas's Kremnoan family meant jack shit. The crown prince could kill them all without even lifting his pinky finger.

"So what if you have the Kremnoan family? I won't subdue because of something like that." The governor looked firm and just. "Even if the chief of the Kremnoan family came personally, I would still stand by my word!"

Audata and Hieronymus were dumbfounded. They wondered if the governor had been possessed.

It was the first time Herklas met someone who would remain unmoved after hearing the Kremnoan name. He frowned, wondering how much money Phainon had bribed the governor with to make him speak up on his behalf.

Although he was close to the Kremnoan family, he had no way to keep rising up if he didn't blow his money. After all, there were many strong people around. If it wasn't for this, he wouldn't insist on seizing the family's title.

Herklas said, "According to clan laws, only the strongest alpha of the next generation can inherit a title. Phainon is just a useless beta. He has no right to inherit. Even if I'm a branch member, I'm the strongest alpha in this generation. I'm clearly more qualified than he is."

The governor's head ached. This was rule from hundreds of years ago. It had been abolished ages ago.

Although there were some people who held nostalgia for the past and still practiced the tradition, in reality there weren't many families who followed it. He didn't expect that Herklas would bring it up. He was truly shameless! It was obvious how many times his parents had said it to him.

Just as the governor was going to sneer something at Herklas, Phainon suddenly spoke up.

"What you mean is that you're sure you're the strongest in our generation?"

"Of course." Herklas curled his lip, looking at Phainon. "I'm different from a beta like you who could only get into the empire's military institute through a back door. I was admitted into a military institute by recommendation, and I graduated in the top ten."

However, he attended one of the lower-ranked schools in the five major military institutes and not the empire's military institute. This had always made Herklas unhappy. Regardless of whether it was natural gift or ability, he was several times stronger than Phainon. Why could Phainon get into the empire's military institute with the help of his parents' connections? On the

other hand, he had struggled long and hard and was only able to make it into a lesser military institute.

If he was in Phainon's position, he would certainly have even greater achievements. He would be on par with Khaslana of the empire's military institute.

"Then I'll fight a match with you. If you win, then I'll give you the position of heir. What do you think?" Phainon said suddenly.

He had completely given up on the idea of hiding his strength. In any case, he was already sucking up to the crown prince. He could just leave everything to Nanook to deal with.

Audata and Hieronymus were stunned. They were very clear about Phainon's abilities. He would certainly lose. They nearly grabbed onto Phainon's clothes to stop him on the spot.

Again, the governor felt like he was going to faint. If he kept getting shock after shock like this, he wouldn't be able to take it.

Things had been going perfectly smoothly. Why did Phainon say something like this? If he couldn't keep the title with Phainon’s family, the crown prince would cut him into bits!

"You guys don't need to say anything. I've already thought it over," Phainon said to his parents.

Hieronymus sighed. Secretly, he thought that Phainon must want to hand over the position of heir in a more respectable way. That was fine. Anyway, he had earned a good amount of money in the last few years. Even if they didn't have their title, they wouldn't be in complete poverty with no way forward.

Herklas laughed in delight. "Phainon, do you really think you're so amazing just because you attend the empire's military institute? Let me beat you into the ground, and I'll let you know what strength really is."

"And if you lose?" Phainon said.

"If I lose," Herklas sneered, "then I'll go straight to a rural planet and mine. I'll never come back to the heart of the empire." He didn't consider Phainon to be his match in the slightest. He threw out a promise casually.

After both parties signed a contract, they got ready to fight. However, the family didn't have a mecha or a fighting arena, so the group of people went to a mecha training site in the heart of the city.

Mecha training sites like these allowed people who couldn't afford mechas to practice. Normally, there were occasional fights, but there weren't many spectators. After all, the competitors were all quite amateur.

But this time, after hearing it was a fight for a noble title, and the governor was acting as guarantor, the manager of the training site sensed a financial opportunity. He immediately allowed to let them use the arena for free. Simultaneously, he began to spread the word.

The tickets sold out in seconds. All of the spots were packed. There were even some of Herklas's fans who became incredibly excited after hearing that he had come to fight.

Herklas had never participated in a virtual mecha competition, but he would occasionally participate in a few small-scale competitions. That, combined with his decently handsome appearance, meant he had some popularity.

"Is that Herklas? I've seen his mecha fights on the virtual net before. With his skill, if he participates in the virtual mecha competition, he'll certainly be in the top hundred."

"My god, why is someone so amazing fighting here?"

"I heard that he's here to win his family's title."

"The heir of the main branch of the family... I think his name is Phainon. He's just a beta, right? I saw him in a mecha fight before. He has absolutely no skill. It made me wonder if he even knew how to pilot a mecha."

"Then the winner of this fight is obvious."

"Sure enough, it's better to give the title to someone with real strength like Herklas."

"It's too bad. It would be nice if they were evenly matched. I wanted to watch an exciting match... Still, it'll be pretty cool to see an expert like Herklas crush his opponent."

No matter how you thought about it, it was Herklas who was in the wrong for coming to take someone else's title, but this was an empire that respected the powerful, so everyone was on Herklas's side. Only a small portion of people would take pity on the original heir, Phainon.

The governor couldn't stop Phainon. His forehead was full of sweat, but he could do nothing. He could only buy the best seats and invite Audata and Hieronymus to sit. He fawned over them, hoping to give himself a few more brownie points in the crown prince's in-laws' hearts.

He didn't have any dreams of being promoted up to the peak of achievement. He would be happy as long as he was able to avoid being banished to a remote planet.

Two mechas walked into the center of the arena. Both of them were provided by the training site, and they were both exactly the same. It was quite fair.

Immediately, many people in the stands began to shout Herklas's name. There were even several people who were confessing directly.

Herklas felt incredibly proud. He opened his mouth to speak.

The model of mecha he was using had a special function that allowed the contestants to amplify their voices for everyone to here.

"Thank you for your support, everyone. If there's anyone in the audience who is interested, after the competition ends, I'll perform for a few minutes

for everyone. If there's anyone feeling uncertain about mechas, you can also come and ask me directly."

He spoke as if he had already won, and he could defeat Phainon in minutes.

But nobody in the audience felt that there was anything wrong with his attitude. In fact, they felt like they had lucked out. Even Audata and Hieronymus felt the same. They watched the arena nervously, afraid to even breathe.

On the other hand, Phainon was perfectly calm. He didn't say a word even until the match began. Whispers erupted in the stands, discussing whether or not he was so scared he couldn't say anything.

When the match started, Herklas opened with an incredibly difficult move. It was the kind of move that drew the most attention from young people. Although it was magnificent, it was in fact a flashy trick without much use.

The crowd immediately burst out in applause, as though they were watching a mecha exhibition show.

Herklas charged at Phainon, who still had no reaction. He was moving as though with great difficulty, just like a beginner piloting a mecha.

Herklas smirked. To maintain his outside reputation, he faked a gentle attitude. "Phainon, I really apologize. Although I don't want to see you lose the position of heir... Well, we need a strong person to inherit the position to lead the family back to glory." As he spoke, his weapon thrust right at Phainon's cockpit.

The weapons in competitions like these were specially made. In reality, they didn't have much capacity to harm; when they stabbed through the opponent's cockpit, they would simply make the other person's mecha stop operating.

Audata was already covering her eyes, afraid to look. Hieronymus forced himself to keep watching, but he knew what the result would be.

The governor watched on, feeling like his world had already collapsed, but he had to endure. If anything happened, he had to have people immediately bring Phainon to the hospital... Today, his health felt especially fragile.

But Phainon's mecha moved. It was just a gentle, minute movement, and he caught Herklas's blow as if by accident.

Herklas was stunned. He gritted his teeth. "A good-for-nothing caught my attack? How utterly humiliating."

He immediately maneuvered his mecha to pull back, spouting out fakely wise words. "Phainon, I'll give you this one as courtesy for all the years we've known each other."

The crowd, who had felt uncertain after the earlier situation, suddenly saw the light. So Herklas was going easy on him. No wonder his attack would be caught.

After he spoke, Herklas got ready to use an even more flashy move to defeat Phainon. He immediately prepared his position.

"Isn't Herklas using the move that's talked about in the textbook?!"

"Oh my god, this move is incredibly difficult. I used to be a mecha teacher, and I can't even do it!"

Everyone was worked up. Many people had their terminals out to record, wanting to catch the legendary move on camera.

But what they couldn't have imagined was that when the magnificent, amazing move was used against Phainon, it was caught again. It made the magnificence dim into nothing.

"Shit, what's with this Phainon guy?!" Herklas was going crazy. He braced himself. "This time, I'm giving courtesy to your mother and father. I'll give it to you one more time. Next time, I'll fight for real."

Now, Herklas didn't dare to act cool. He grabbed his weapon, aiming at the weakest point of Phainon's mecha, and attacked.

But Phainon didn't stand in place obediently waiting for his beating anymore. He maneuvered his mecha to dodge the attack and then took the offensive.

Phainon didn't use any flashy moves, but his speed and ease was astonishing. It was obvious at a glance that he was skilled with mechas.

The crowd couldn't help but feel like they had been thinking along the wrong lines. It looked like Phainon had been practicing properly at the empire's military institute. The people who hadn't spared a glance for him now had a change of heart.

When Herklas was suddenly attacked, he was given a shock. He counterattacked furiously and successfully blocked Phainon's attack, but he still felt a wave of lingering fear. Luckily, his combat experience allowed him to react and counterattack by relying on his instincts.

Herklas felt another wave of humiliation. He wanted to fight back in his fury, but he was shocked to find that he had no opportunity.

It was as though Phainon had an eye on every part of the battlefield. He attacked Herklas continuously so that he could block one spot but not the other. His limbs moved in a flurry, but his mind could barely keep up.

At some point, the crowd began to hold their breaths. They watched the competition seriously, feeling that the match they were watching wasn't the one-sided beating they had expected. Instead, they felt an unforeseen excitement.

Not even a minute had elapsed, but Herklas was already feeling exhausted. His panting, heavy from nerves, was broadcast to the entire arena, making everyone feel a sense of panic.

"...How could he be so strong? He's just a beta... How could he..."

Unexpectedly, Herklas felt the same feeling he had when he first entered the Kremnoan family and he had been easily defeated by the bodyguard of a

branch family head. He had never known until then that he wasn't the most outstanding. There were countless people even more impressive than him.

"I-it's impossible. No matter how impressive he is, he's just a beta. He can't win over me at all!"

In the next moment, Phainon pulled back his offensive.

But Herklas didn't dare to advance. The attacks just now had shaken his morale. He felt as though no matter where he attacked, Phainon would be able to counter easily.

"The warm up should end here," Phainon suddenly said.

The stands rose up in an uproar. Could it be that all of Phainon's moves just now were warmups? That was too ridiculous!

Before the match, they would have jeered at Phainon. Now that the match had started, there was nobody who would say anything, because they all had a feeling that Phainon was probably the real deal.

"What did you say?! A mere beta has the guts to be so arrogant!" Herklas was enraged. He rushed up, planning to attack Phainon.

Because of his agitation, Herklas completely forgot to guard. His mind was a ball of fire that wanted to teach Phainon not to give him cheek.

But he discovered that he couldn't operate at all. The mecha wouldn't move at all.

"What?" Herklas was breathless in his shock. "Did this mecha break?"

The crowd was silent. Everyone had an unusual expression on their face.

Herklas realized something had happened. He looked up and realized that Phainon's weapon was pressed against his mecha's cockpit... It was for this same reason that his mecha had stopped moving.

"You lost," Phainon said.

Herklas was stunned. He wanted to resist, unwilling to accept his defeat, but he discovered that his body was weak. At some point, it had filled with cold sweat, and almost felt like he couldn't even stand.

The people in the stands were also shocked. It had only been minutes since the start of the match to now, but victory had been reversed easily. Phainon, who they thought had no strength at all, had won so easily, and Herklas, who they all expected to win, had lost so badly.

The crowd began to applaud fiercely. No matter who won, the person they worshipped would always be the one with strength.

When Audata heard the applause around her, she moved away her hands, looking at the arena with sorrow, but she discovered that Hieronymus was incredibly worked up. She blurted, "What happened? Phainon is fine, isn't he?"

"He's fine, he's fine." Hieronymus almost couldn't calm himself down. Although he was an alpha, he didn't have the slightest bit of talent with a mecha. After he grew up, he had no choice but to admit it, and he was forced to give up on his dreams and choose to become a businessman.

In the past, Hieronymus had once hoped that his child could carry on his dreams, but he only had an omega child, and because of the difficult birth, his wife was left with an illness and could never bear a child again.

Since then, Hieronymus had never held onto his hopes. Although he had always raised Phainon as a beta, when all was said and done, he wasn't a real beta and he was completely ignorant about mechas. They couldn't force him to learn.

But now, looking at the sight of Phainon fighting in the arena, Hieronymus remembered his dreams from the past. He couldn't help tearing up.

Audata finally realized that Phainon had won. When she thought about how Phainon was actually an omega, she was both excited and distressed. She even began to cry. "Our Phainon, he... he's really worked himself too hard."

After the governor let out a sigh of relief, he felt that it was only natural. Phainon was the person His Highness the Crown Prince selected as his fiancé! Of course he was talented. Although he was a beta, he wasn't any worse than an alpha. It was no wonder that he was able to cling onto the crown prince's side.

After the match ended, the two people got off from their mechas.

After bitter training, Phainon was able to extend the time he could pilot a mecha using spiritual energy up to five minutes... Moreover, he wouldn't be so weak after he disconnected.

Now that he had finished the fight, Phainon felt like all his training was completely worth it. It was too bad that omegas have too many physical limitations. If he had transmigrated into an alpha, he would even be able to become as OP as Long Aotian.

Herklas stayed in his mecha in a daze. He couldn't accept that he had lost right in front of everyone. He rushed to grab Phainon, but the sharp-eyed governor hurriedly called people over to stop him.

"Phainon, how could you win against me?" Herklas was being held back by several people. He glared at Phainon, besides himself in his rage. "You must have cheated!"

"If you're saying I cheated, then bring out the evidence." Phainon looked back at him calmly.

The governor's attitude similarly cooled. "Everyone saw how you did during the match. Everything was inspected before the match, and you signed the contract. Even if you don't want to honor the contract, you can't wrong someone and say they cheated for no reason."

"I'm someone that the Kremnoan family has recognized! How could I lose to a beta?!" Herklas refused to admit it, but he couldn't bring out any evidence that Phainon cheated. He could only say, "It's because I didn't bring out my all just now. I demand another round! If Phainon wins again, then I'll believe that he didn't cheat!"

The crowd's disdainful expressions changed when they heard the name "Kremnoan". If Herklas was telling the truth, then he might really have lost because he didn't bring out his all. After all, the Kremnoan family was the number one family in the empire.

As for what Herklas said about Phainon cheating, there weren't many people who believed it. Mecha training sites had high-level examination machinery. It was as hard to cheat as it was to climb up to the sky. If it was really cheating, it was absolutely expose several scandals. Even the governor wouldn't be able to assume responsibility.

"Who cheated?" A voice came from the door.

Everyone froze. They turned their heads. In the next second, the crowd erupted in screams.

"Ahhhh I was able to see His Highness here?"

"I didn't believe it when someone said they saw him before..."

"Oh no, I'm going to faint..."

Nanook walked over, wearing black sunglasses. He had a slight smile on his face and looked incredibly gentle. The people following after him were holding several bags, both large and small.

"Your Highness?" Herklas naturally recognized the crown prince. He got up, feeling excited.

If he could seize this opportunity, why would he pledge his loyalty to whatever Kremnoan family? If he could go to the crown prince for shelter, he would have an even better future. Besides, he was so strong. The crown prince would certainly be happy to take him into his troops.

The governor broke out in cold sweat. He didn't know what he could this time and if he could make His Highness the Crown Prince let him go for his hard work.

The more Herklas thought, the harder he struggled free of the people holding him back. He rushed up to Nanook, half kneeling, his voice serious. "Your Highness, there's a contestant in this match who may have cheated. Sir, you must investigate clearly."

Herklas began to explain his fair competition with Phainon over the position of heir. He didn't expect that Phainon, a beta without any fighting power, would cheat and make him lose. He took the chance while he was in front of Nanook to introduce some of his glorious achievements, thinking himself to be quick-witted and sure that he would leave a deep impression on the crown prince.

"Why do you think Phainon cheated?" Nanook said.

Herklas was bold and confident. "He's just a beta. How could he win against me?" He looked at the crown prince.

"Oh?" Nanook looked at him with a smile that wasn't a smile.

Herklas thought that the crown prince believed him. He turned his head proudly and spotted the governor's ugly expression. He even thought that the governor was afraid that he would be exposed for taking bribes, and he quickly said, "This governor actually accepted that family's money. He shamelessly covered up Phainon's cheating. Someone like this doesn't match up to his position."

Now that the crown prince was involved, the governor ought to forget about shielding Phainon... Besides, the family's noble title was naturally Herklas's.

But, he suddenly wondered, *why in the world did someone like the crown prince come to this planet?* Still, it wasn't anything important. The important thing was that the crown prince had come, and he could go a step further.

The governor's face turned even more colorful. He was looking at Herklas almost with pity. He was certain now; with Herklas drawing all the hatred, no matter what he said, he wouldn't be left too miserable.

But Audata and Hieronymus was panicked. They looked hastily towards Nanook. "Phainon certainly didn't cheat."

"Your Highness, you can't believe his one-sided statement."

Immediately, Nanook looked down at Herklas. "Do you think I'll believe you?"

"Why not?" Herklas thought the crown prince was testing him. He immediately said, "No matter what happens, as someone the Kremnoan family chose, I would never lose to Phainon. The truth of this matter is already very clear."

The audience couldn't bear to look. After all, Herklas only knew how to say again and again that he couldn't lose, but he couldn't bring out any evidence that the other party cheated. Still, the Kremnoan family was behind Herklas, and the crown prince's mother was also from the Kremnoan family. Would he believe Herklas because of this?"

"Then do you know Phainon's identity?" Nanook smiled slightly.

"He's nothing but a student at the empire's military institute. He doesn't matter at all," Herklas said without hesitation. "I know everything. He got into the institute through bribery, and he's always messing around at school."

"Then do you know," Nanook said softly, "*that he's my fiancé?*"

Chapter End Notes

The Author Has Something To Say:
Yay! A new chapter!! We get some more face slapping done by Phainon! Can you tell that's my favourite genre of Phainon? Putting people in their place. I hope these recent chapters aren't too boring haha but there's only about three chapters left of this fic so bare with me. And gotta love Nanook stirring the pot and staking his claim XD.

See You Next Week!

Chapter 20: Nanook

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Herklas was frozen on the ground. For a long time, he was speechless. His mind was blank. He knew every word the crown prince was saying, but why couldn't he understand what he meant?

The surrounding crowd was thoroughly stupefied. Were their ears malfunctioning? They seemed to have heard the crown prince say something about a fiancé?

"So you're saying that even if my fiancé cheats, he has to lose against you?" Nanook looked at Herklas with a slight smile.

By now, Herklas didn't feel that His Highness the Crown Prince was smiling at him because of his value. In his terror, his legs went weak, and he fell to the floor.

Why was it like this? That Phainon was clearly just trash without a single redeeming feature. Why did His Highness the Crown Prince like him? What was wrong with this world...

"N-No, it was an accident..." In reality, Herklas knew perfectly well that Phainon couldn't have cheated, but he wasn't willing to believe it. He could only mumble over and over, "I couldn't fight at full strength just for a moment earlier..."

But Nanook ignored him. He turned and walked towards Phainon.

Audata and Hieronymus were completely dumbfounded. Next to them, the governor stood close to them as though he was a good friend. He stepped forward enthusiastically and said to Nanook, "Your Highness, I didn't expect that a branch member of the family would be so shameless. If I

hadn't come so promptly, I don't know how things would have turned out." He spoke as though he hadn't accepted any bribes from Herklas.

When Herklas heard the governor, he whipped his head up furiously. He didn't have the courage to put his hatred on Phainon, the crown prince's fiancé, so he diverted all of his anger onto the governor.

It looked like the governor had known about this already. Why else would his attitude change so quickly? The worst part was that the governor exposed him completely. It was obvious that he had already decided to push all the blame onto Herklas!

Herklas completely forgot how he responded when the governor was signaling him when things started.

"Mother-in-law, Father-in-law, hello." Nanook looked towards Audata and Hieronymus with a slight smile, motioning for his subordinates to bring the gifts over. "I was a little delayed because I was buying gifts earlier. It's great that nothing happened."

Audata and Hieronymus were more frightened than they were pleasantly surprised. They had never expected that the crown prince would start liking their own son. They worried about whether or not the crown prince knew Phainon was actually an omega.

The governor began to explain again. Of course, he hid the truth about how he accepted bribes and told them about everything Herklas and his lackeys had done.

It made everyone sigh in wonder. They had never thought that Herklas, a handsome man with outstanding bearing, could do something so shameless. The people who used to be his fans felt humiliated and left stealthily. On their way home, they unfollowed him, wishing they could erase all traces of their worship as if it had never happened.

"You've done quite well." Nanook looked towards the governor. Naturally, he had already investigated the situation thoroughly, but he was quite

satisfied with the governor's attitude. Although the governor's previous actions weren't very sensible, his change was pretty good.

After Nanook's praise, the governor was as energized as if he had been shot with a dose of adrenaline. He said quickly, "I'd be the first one to stop someone like this from running rampant. They can't do whatever they want just because they think they're so strong and amazing." Though he didn't mention any names, it was obvious he was talking about Herklas.

After being pointed out, Herklas jolted back to his senses. He knew that if he didn't retract his words, he would have no chance at redemption. He threw himself at Phainon, hugging him around the leg. "Phainon-ge, I was wrong. I shouldn't have done something like this... I know I can't say anything to make up for it, but we grew up together. Why don't you have His Highness the Crown Prince spare me this time?"

Phainon, who had been thinking of himself as a bystander, was given a shock. He wasn't able to shake off Herklas even if he tried. Besides, what was with that Phainon-ge! Anyways, Herklas was several years older than him... He was so shameless.

But Nanook's gaze turned cold. What he hated the most was when outsiders touched the people he cared about. He immediately had his subordinates pull Herklas aside. He looked at him coldly. "I don't know who in the Kremnoan family accepted scum like you as their subordinate. It looks like their judgement is lacking."

It was easy to imagine how the person who accepted Herklas would react when they found out what the His Highness the Crown Prince had said.

Herklas's body was trembling as he was dragged away. He was filled with regret. He hated himself for his lack of foresight. Why didn't he think ahead?

Phainon, who used to be so lacking, had shockingly become amazing. His Highness the Crown Prince had suddenly come to this planet and even came to the training site personally... If he could have found out earlier,

using his familial relation to Phainon, why would he fight for a noble title? When Phainon got married to the crown prince, what would he still need?

He could only hope that His Highness the Crown Prince would let him off because of his relation to Phainon.

"Still, someone like this isn't worth taking up my personal time to deal with." Nanook said calmly to one of his subordinates, "Send him back to wherever he came from. Just have the Kremnoan family decide how to deal with him."

When the onlooking crowd saw his actions, they immediately sighed over how kind the crown prince's attitude was. He even treated someone like this so well.

In fact, only Herklas knew that he would naturally have no good ending if he returned to the Kremnoan family after offending the crown prince. His face turned deathly pale.

After things were worked out, Nanook left with Phainon, Audata, and Hieronymus.

But that wasn't the end of it. In the next few days, the mecha training site was packed. Countless people came over specially to see the place that His Highness the Crown Prince had been to, feeling as though they had also been there with him.

And the people who were there immediately uploaded everything online after they calmed down.

At first, many people didn't take it seriously. What was all that about the crown prince liking a beta from a downtrodden noble family? Was this a fairy tale?

But more and more pictures appeared, and when the pictures of the crown prince and that beta acting intimately surfaced online, everyone was

stunned. They finally realized that this probably wasn't something that someone fabricated out of nothing.

Soon, someone found out the identity of the other person in the photos. Shockingly enough, it was a student at the empire's military institute. He was a beta, and his grades were awful. It was obvious that he had gotten in through connections.

Most people were even more certain that the person was just leeching off of the crown prince after finding out. The pictures were just a bit suggestive. As for the videos... they were all blurry. Who knew if the person in the videos really was the crown prince?

Forget about being a couple or something. It was already unlikely that the crown prince and this beta were friends. Being his fiancé was just preposterous.

Moreover, the crown prince hadn't publicized anything yet. This Phainon guy was probably spreading things online to cause a sensation.

Everyone was confident in their belief.

Meanwhile, Nanook brought Audata and Hieronymus straight onto the airship, and they arrived at the capital planet.

Phainon remembered how he had just left the capital planet a few days ago... He was still a layabout lazing around in his room, eating, and waiting for death. Who would have expected that in just a few days so many things would happen?

This simply solidified Phainon's determination to squat at home in the future.

The airship arrived at the district in the capital planet that noble families resided in. Caelus's residence was also nearby. Phainon felt a bit nostalgic.

Soon, Nanook ushered them into a villa. He said to Audata and Hieronymus, "This house is a present for you, Mother and Father. Please accept it without being courteous."

Audata and Hieronymus turned uneasy and wanted to decline. It was terrifying for someone to be gifting them a house in the capital planet for no reason.

But Nanook smiled. "This is all to thank you for caring for and loving Phainon these last few years. You don't need to refuse... Besides, your previous residence has been ruined. Can you still live there? Somebody has cleaned this place up, and you can move in right away. You can have people move your other things over as well."

Phainon: "..." A house like this absolutely wasn't something someone could buy immediately. Nanook must have gotten it ready long ago. Besides, it looked like the things he was saying weren't things he thought of casually. It looked like he was incredibly sincere.

Hieronymus hesitated for a moment. Finally, he couldn't stop himself from saying, "Your Highness, could I ask what you like about our family's Phainon?"

Compared to his status, Phainon's happiness was actually the most important.

And His Highness the Crown Prince, high above the masses, had a sudden interest in him. In comparison, that Mydeimos fellow who came to visit last time felt more reliable. Besides, Mydei was so kind and he knew how to cook. He looked like a good kid.

Phainon had to admit that the methods Mydei made use of were good at getting people to like him.

If Hieronymus and Audata knew that Mydei was actually the heir of the Kremnoan family, they would probably be even more worked up.

Phainon was given a shock. He had a feeling that the upcoming topic wouldn't be great, so he said that he would go to the kitchen to pour everyone a cup of water, then took the opportunity to leave. Of course, he was actually hiding at the side and eavesdropping.

With Nanook's personality, he would certainly say things that made people feel ashamed without a care for whether Phainon was there or not, but Phainon himself was embarrassed...

Nanook said, "Sir, you want to know what I like about him?" He lowered his head, as though he was considering carefully, then looked up with a slight smile. "My Deliverer looks very cute, and on the surface he seems obedient, but he's always secretly planning something. It feels as though he's about to do something overboard at any time... I really like it."

Phainon, hiding at the side: "!" Hey, is this something a normal person would think was good?!

Audata and Hieronymus were also stunned. For a moment, they couldn't tell if Nanook was praising Phainon or complaining about him. He was indeed worthy of the name of His Highness the Crown Prince; his taste was so unique.

"In the past, I never thought of getting married, but after I met my Deliverer, my thoughts changed," Nanook said. "I want him to stay at my side."

He also wanted Phainon to only look at him, to only think of him.

Nanook's eyes darkened slightly.

When Hieronymus finally processed what Nanook was saying, he kept opening and closing his mouth again, as though he wanted to say something but didn't have the courage to speak.

Nanook immediately understood. He said, "Sir, you don't need to worry. I know about how Phainon is actually an omega. In fact, when he had his last heat, I was the one who helped him deal with it."

Phainon nearly charged forward. "!" Fuck, what the hell are you saying, huh!

Audata and Hieronymus were stupefied.

Although Nanook hadn't done a single thing, anyone would begin to imagine all the lively things that he and Phainon had done together after hearing his words. At the same time, Phainon couldn't come out to refute him.

This reason was more believable than any of the many other things that Nanook had said, because it could be something like helping someone deal with his heat and thus marking him by accident, so then they could only be together...

After those words, Audata and Hieronymus could only accept it. After all, an omega would typically have no way to remove a mark, unless the alpha that marked them died.

In fact, Nanook had planned for this. He just hadn't said it to Phainon before.

Audata and Hieronymus had never gotten the chance to be picky. After all, they had always thought that their son would always be alone, but he had found a partner who knew his true identity, and his partner was someone with such an honorable position.

And they could only sigh and say that they had no natural affinity with Mydei, who they had originally set their sights on.

Soon, Nanook and Phainon went to the same room to rest. After all, to an outsider, they had already done some intimate things together, and it was perfectly normal for them to stay together and prevent something like an omega going into heat in the middle of the night.

Even though Phainon really didn't want to, he was afraid Audata and Hieronymus would worry, so he had no choice but to brace himself to continue to sleep in the same room as Nanook.

When Phainon went downstairs to get a glass of water at night, Audata came looking for him. They found a corner out of sight to talk privately.

"Phainon, you have to tell Mom the truth." Audata looked at Phainon sternly. She said, "What exactly happened? How did you meet His Highness the Crown Prince?"

Phainon had no choice but to make something up. He said that he had run into His Highness the Crown Prince on the airship in a twist of fate. Later, when he went into heat, he got help from the crown prince.

After Audata heard his explanation, she sighed again. "It looks like that Mydei child really doesn't have an affinity with you. He really took a liking to you."

When Phainon thought about Mydei and their last interaction his heart felt uncomfortable again so he just pushed the thought away. What's done was done, he was stuck with Nanook now.

Phainon: "Mydei... He'll be fine even without me." Although he got trapped by the system and was already bound to Phainon _(:3」∠)_

When Phainon got back to his room, he spotted Nanook sitting like an interrogator waiting for his turn to ask questions. Nanook raised an eyebrow and said, "...Is there anything else I don't know between you and Mydeimos?"

"Were you eavesdropping just now?" Phainon was given a fright.

Nanook said casually, "I was just worried for your safety, so I decided to move... I don't think you care about little things like this, right?"

Who didn't care!!

Phainon just knew Nanook was a pervert. Based on the settings in the original novel, it wouldn't even be strange for someone like Nanook to bug

him with listening devices. Dammit... He had miscalculated.

"Well, it's nothing much." Phainon resigned himself to his fate. "I think what happened between me and Mydei is perfectly clear, isn't it... Is there anything else to add?"

"Of course there's something I'm still not clear about. For example, what did he do after he came to your house?" Nanook sighed. "The fact that Mother-in-law and Father-in-law both like him so much makes me feel hurt."

"He didn't do anything much," Phainon said. "It's just that when he came last time, he happened to cook at home. After all, Mydei's cooking skills are really good..."

"I see." Nanook smiled slightly. "You don't need to be scared. Isn't it fine now that you've told me? I won't do anything to you. I just wanted to know how you were doing. I like you, so I want to know everything that has to do with you."

A normal person wouldn't insist on knowing everything about someone just because they liked them.

Phainon said, "But I don't know anything about you."

"Then why don't I tell you now?" Nanook looked like he was in high spirits. "Want to listen?"

Phainon quickly shook his head. "No, I don't want to." He had a feeling he was going to hear something that would make him feel like the world had turned on its head!

Soon, it was time for bed. The two of them laid down side-by-side as before. Although Nanook seemed crazy, most of the time he would let Phainon do whatever he wanted. If Phainon wasn't willing to do it, he usually wouldn't force him.

In his daze, Phainon suddenly heard the system's alert. After hearing that the daily mission was to heal the capture target, he was startled into wakefulness.

"I can't believe it's this mission." Phainon opened his eyes. "It looks like what today I can do what I didn't do yesterday."

He turned and saw that Nanook was already sleeping. Phainon thought to himself, Today shouldn't be like yesterday, and cautiously leaned in. After reaching out to touch Nanook's wrist, he carefully sent his ability in.

If he sent his healing ability into a normal human's body, there would be absolutely no problem, but if they weren't a human it was very likely something would happen, especially Zergs who would go into heat.

In the next moment, Nanook, who should have been asleep, furrowed his brows. His cheeks quickly flushed red.

Phainon froze. His heart skipped a beat. "Huh?!"

This meant that Nanook wasn't actually a human?!

Nanook opened his eyes gently. He grabbed Phainon's hand, pulling him down to his side.

Phainon quickly began to struggle, but it was completely useless. To Nanook, it probably hurt as much as a kitten's scratches.

Nanook was like a different person. His face was flushed red and his gold eyes were as deep as the sun. He cupped Phainon's face, dipping his head to give him a furious kiss.

He followed the line of Phainon's neck, nipping gently. When he reached his shirt, he finally reached up to take it off.

To be honest, his actions didn't seem like someone in heat, but Phainon knew very clearly that after a Zerg went into heat they would suppress their reason. If he didn't seize the opportunity to escape, he would be done for.

Just as the third button of Phainon's shirt was unbuttoned, he finally broke away. He dove off the bed, but Nanook hugged him around the waist. Because of his movements, his clothes were completely ripped open.

They rolled across the ground. Luckily, there was a rug spread across the floor, and Phainon wasn't hurt when he fell.

But what was terrible was that Nanook was still hugging him. It was like he was drunk; his movements were sluggish, and his breathing was hot against Phainon's waist. His hands reached straight into Phainon's pants.

Phainon blurted, "C-calm down, this isn't the time to be doing something like that."

"Oh?" Nanook looked up. His voice was low. "Then you're saying that this is the time for...?"

Phainon was pressed against the carpet and fucked the entire night. At some point, he fainted away. When he woke up the next day, it was already noon.

Phainon was sitting on Nanook's lap. His torso was prim and proper, but his lower body was completely bare, and his legs were both exposed.

He bit his lip harshly, afraid to move an inch. If he moved at all, a strong pleasure would jolt through his body, and he would most definitely let out a humiliating noise.

It seemed like nothing had happened to Nanook at all. He pressed a spoonful of congee to Phainon's lips. "Here, this is congee that I made myself... It looks like Mother-in-law and Father-in-law are quite happy."

Phainon opened his mouth with difficulty, swallowing the congee. In these circumstances, he didn't have any extra energy to think about whether the congee tasted good or not.

Who knew if someone as dignified as His Highness the Crown Prince had exploded the kitchen the first time he went to cook...

"I'm no worse than Mydeimos." Nanook looked very confident about his cooking skills. He leaned in and said, "It's delicious, isn't it?"

Phainon didn't even know what Nanook was talking about. He hurriedly nodded. After what happened yesterday, he felt weak all over, and he could only lay weakly against Nanook.

He had dug his own grave. Phainon regretted it as soon as he thought about it.

After eating a whole bowl of congee, Phainon was ready to collapse. He tugged Nanook's clothes. "Hurry up... and put me down..."

"It's not time yet." Nanook hugged Phainon like he was hugging a child and leaned in close to his ear. "You've discovered it, haven't you? In fact, I'm not a normal human."

Phainon: "...!" When you're talking about business, can you not do something like that!

"You know, right? My mother was the empire's greatest beauty, born from the Kremnoan family," Nanook said. "But what nobody knows is that she actually liked someone else. Right when they eloped, her lover betrayed her and sent her to the imperial palace. On the road there, she killed herself to retaliate against her family and her lover."

Phainon focused his attention with great difficulty. "Huh...?" Wasn't this exciting? The original novel clearly said that the empress focused on the emperor single mindedly, so focused that she was crazy.

"Back then, there was a Zerg on the airship." Nanook smiled slightly. "It's funny, thinking about it. Everyone thought that the Zerg had been chased away ages ago... In fact, long ago, the Zerg had already slipped into the empire."

Everyone had thought that General Wiley chased the Zerg queen off. In truth, their flight was an act. In their first year at war with the humans, they had already taken on human appearances and infiltrated into the empire.

Many humans had always looked down on Zerg for their appearances. In reality, their intelligence was no lesser than humanity's.

And General Wiley never said that he failed to kill the Zerg Queen, so nobody suspected a thing.

"At that time, the Zerg sensed their chance, so the Zerg Queen took on the appearance of the Kremnoan family's daughter and entered the imperial palace, arriving at the emperor's side." Nanook spoke the thrilling news as though he was telling an ordinary story.

Phainon: "?!"

Wait, this info dump is kind of big! Are you fucking saying that the empress has actually always been the Zerg Queen, and for all these years she's been... with the emperor... He suddenly felt a wave of sympathy for the emperor.

...Then Phainon remembered what the empress's son had done to him, and suddenly felt that he was even more miserable.

"At first, the Zerg's goal was to kill the emperor, then turn into him and take advantage of the opportunity to occupy the empire," Nanook said. "But the Zerg Queen fell in love with my father. After all, despite the fact that he's pretty useless, he has a good-looking shell."

Out of the emperor's two sons, one looked like the empress and one looked like a delicate, beautiful flower, but neither of them looked like the emperor.

Phainon was a bit shocked. "..." Hey, isn't this plot too overdramatic? The horror movie exposition suddenly turned into a palace drama with a love triangle.

"After that, I was born..." Nanook said. "I knew ever since I was young that I actually wasn't human, even if part of the blood running through my veins was human."

Phainon: "...." He didn't want to think about how a Zerg and a human could have children so casually.

"The funny thing is, the emperor doesn't like my mother. Although he didn't marry a concubine, he has a lover," Nanook said. "I don't know how that woman is doing now. If she has a child, he must be around the same age as you now..."

Phainon's heart stopped for a moment. He suddenly thought of Khaslana, and it affected how lower body. He couldn't stop his breathing from quickening.

"Deliverer, do you know who it is?" Nanook leaned to ask. He naturally wouldn't pass up this opportunity.

If he could say it, Phainon would certainly spit it out, but this had to do with the plot, and he couldn't say a thing. He just shook his head. "I... I don't know..."

"You really don't listen... I just told you everything about me, but you're hiding something from me." Nanook's eyes narrowed, and he lowered his head to nip Phainon's neck. "As punishment, I'm going to mark you now."

"...Wait... C-calm down..."

Though the person who suffered after the mark wouldn't be him anyways.

Because there was never anyone from the imperial family who stepped out to clarify, the pictures from before spread even further. Public interest boiled over, and a huge number of people were shocked.

Most people didn't believe that there was anything between the crown prince and Phainon. They would rather believe that Phainon was sucking up to the crown prince.

The people who were the most shocked were the people in empire's military institute. The fact that Phainon had somehow managed to return to school

after being expelled by latching onto Caelus was shocking enough. Later, he somehow managed to grab onto the heir of the Kremnoan family, Mydeimos. If it wasn't for the sake of keeping up their reputations, plenty of people would have gone up to Phainon to ask how he did it.

But now Phainon had managed to suck up to His Highness the Crown Prince! This guy's bootlicking skills were expert!

Some people had a vague understanding that if the news hadn't been deleted after so long that it couldn't be simple.

Later, the crown prince finally announced his engagement. He said that he would host an engagement banquet in a few days, and his fiancé was, of course, Phainon.

Everyone was flabbergasted. They had no idea what part of Phainon drew the crown prince's attention. Whether it was strength or personality, they didn't think he was good in any aspect. He couldn't match up to His Highness the Crown Prince at all.

But the emperor didn't bother with it at all. He was happy to have Nanook marry a beta from a downtrodden noble family. As soon as he thought about how furious the Kremnoan family would be, he was delighted.

Besides, the emperor had heard of Amelia's whereabouts recently. After hearing news about his true love, he had no time left to consider things to do with Nanook.

Soon, the internet filled with people beginning to shame Phainon. They cursed him for using some kind of despicable methods to seduce the crown prince. There were also people suspecting that he had relied on some sinister tricks to sleep with the crown prince, then forced him to marry him to take responsibility.

After all, the crown prince had such noble character. How could he mess around with someone randomly!?

These people also thought ordinary nobles weren't worthy of the crown prince. The only people who were worthy of the crown prince couldn't be someone ordinary; even if they came from an influential clan, they weren't worthy of him.

In the end, someone suddenly remembered Prince Latiao who had risen to fame a while back. They said that only someone as amazing as Prince Latiao was worthy of the crown prince.

Although Prince Latiao should be an alpha, technology was so advanced anyways. Two alphas could have their own descendants with the aid of technology.

At first, these words were only brought up as a joke. In the end, most people approved. In moments, the people online began to say that compared Phainon, who was as good as a couch potato, they could only accept an expert like Prince Latiao being together with His Highness the Crown Prince.

Chapter End Notes

> The Author Has Something To Say:
> Yay! New Chapter! Lmao Nanook really said whatever Mydei did I'm gonna do too. It took Mydei so long to get that cookie and Nanook just went for it. Haha am I the only one who loves his possessiveness. Its jus the right brand of gentlemanly and forceful <3
>
> See You Next Week!

Chapter 21: The Transition Into The Finale

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Phainon's balls ached as soon as he got online. A forced marriage could even happen like this... What would these people think if they knew he was the same person as Prince Latiao? Still, they probably wouldn't ever know in their lifetime.

Besides, Phainon thought that the bigger pain in his ass was the problem of Nanook's identity. In fact, he didn't want to know it at all.

Speaking of which, the fact that Nanook was a Zerg-human mix was several times more shocking than the fact that Phainon was actually an omega pretending to be a beta. How was Nanook able to say it so casually, completely without fear that Phainon would spread it around?

Still, when he thought about it, Nanook probably wasn't afraid of him talking about it at all. Even if he did say it, nobody would believe him. They would probably think he had gone crazy.

After all, people still thought of Zerg as monsters with savage appearances. Who would imagine that Zerg were hiding right at their sides? Who would believe that His Highness the Crown Prince was actually not human?

If it wasn't for the protagonist Khaslana, the empire would simply be on its way to destruction. Still, these people were busy worrying that His Highness the Crown Prince was going to marry an ordinary beta.

No matter how other people protested, everything proceeded as normal. The engagement banquet was held at the same time they spoke about how a fresh flower was being stuck in a pile of cow dung.

Although outsiders were cursing up a storm, the people who attended the banquet had decent attitudes.

The people who were aware of Nanook's personality just thought that Phainon was someone with courage.

The people who weren't aware felt that someone as lowly as Phainon must have had plenty of tricks to be able to get successfully engage to the crown prince. They couldn't get on his bad side too easily.

Mydeimos arrived with Gorgo, smiling slightly as he gave his congratulations. Nobody could tell anything was wrong with him.

But only Anaxagoras came from the duke's family. He could do nothing but express that his younger brother couldn't attend because he had been ill recently.

In fact, Caelus had faced an incredible shock after hearing the news. He went to an extremely dangerous area to train alone. Anaxa couldn't stop him, and he could only send a few bodyguards look after him.

Phainon wasn't used to banquets like this at all. He found an excuse to go to the lounge to take a break and happened to run into Mydei sitting inside.

Mydei stood up hurriedly. He said to Phainon, "You're fine, right?"

After he leaned in, he smelled the thick alpha scent on Phainon. His gaze immediately darkened.

"I'm perfectly fine." Phainon sat down immediately. He thought of what the system had said, and he said, "About that... If you have someone you start to fall in love with, how about you let me know..."

That way, he could avoid the tragedy when Mydei couldn't mark the other person, though Phainon couldn't do anything at all.

"How could I fall in love with another person?" Mydei grabbed Phainon's hands, but after a thought he pulled them back. He dropped to the ground, half kneeling in front of Phainon. "The most important person in my heart is you alone. There's no one who can take your place."

Phainon was emotionless. "But you're the heir of the Kremnoan family. Soon or later, you'll have to face it, won't you?"

"Those matters are of no importance," Mydei said. "I have never wanted to bother with the Kremnoan family's matters."

In any case, his mother had so many lovers. When the time came, couldn't she just birth another one? Why did he have to do something he didn't want to do?

When he thought of how his mother had brought up forming an alliance through marriage, Mydei made up his mind.

"I may leave for a period of time." Mydei looked at Phainon. "You must wait for me to come back. By then, I'll certainly be even stronger... And I'll be able to protect you even better."

And with those words, Mydei gave Phainon a profound glance and left the lounge.

A few days after the engagement banquet, the Zerg who had disappeared for years suddenly crawled back from their defeat, trying to invade the planets at the empire's frontier.

But the news didn't make the common people of the empire panic. After all, the Zerg had already been beaten away once, and the hero who beat them away, General Wiley, was still as healthy as a horse.

The frontiers were too distant from the capital. It was several days away even traveling by airship. Nobody felt a sense of crisis at all.

But Phainon, who was staying at Nanook's side, knew perfectly well that the Zerg at the frontier were merely the weakest and dumbest low-level Zerg. If these people knew that the Zerg had actually occupied over half of the empire's territory, what would they think... After all, high-level Zerg could transform into human shape.

If it wasn't for the fact that in the original novel, the Zerg were all connected to the Zerg Queen and their strength would plummet after she died, the Zerg in the original novel would probably already have succeeded in seizing control of the empire.

Yet now Nanook was actually a Zerg, and he was the child of the Zerg Queen. He really was worthy of being the villain boss...

When he thought about how Nanook's identity hadn't been exposed by the finale of the novel, and how he had been exiled instead... Who knew if he had an opportunity to do something else in the future? Suddenly, he felt that the finale wasn't very probable.

Meanwhile, the emperor was searching for news about Amelia. Later, with the help of General Wiley, he successfully met Khaslana and they mutually acknowledged their relationship as father and son.

After all, it was the child the woman he loved the most left behind. With the addition of his memories of his unattainable first love, tears nearly fell from his eyes when the emperor first set eyes on Khaslana.

The emperor simply had no feelings towards the empress or the children of the concubines he had married before.

In front of the emperor, Khaslana put on an act of a clever, adorable child. Time and time again, he let slip how miserable he had lived for the last few years. The emperor immediately felt even more regretful, and he poured almost all of his paternal love into Khaslana. The only reason he didn't publicize Khaslana's identity was because he was obstructed by the Kremnoan family.

The emperor didn't have any plans of passing on the throne to Khaslana yet. He just wanted to give the child he had failed the power and wealth that he deserved, but if he gave it too casually, he was afraid he would draw the Kremnoan family's notice.

It was right at that time that the empire ran into the problem with the Zerg, and the emperor immediately sent out General Wiley. In fact, he was

planning to have General Wiley and his people fight on the frontlines, then promote Khaslana, who was mixed in, so he wouldn't draw the Kremnoan family's attention.

Of course, in the emperor's expectations, other people would be in charge of fighting; Khaslana only needed to stay safe under others' protection.

But things weren't so smooth. Although General Wiley was said to be strong, the biggest reason he had fought the Zerg back in the past was because of the other side's scheming.

Besides, someone the Kremnoan family placed at the emperor's side had already discovered Khaslana's true identity.

Even if Nanook didn't act, the people behind him in the Kremnoan family wouldn't let things go. They would set up all kinds of obstacles for Khaslana, trying to make it difficult for Khaslana to survive. After all, it was incredibly easy to off someone in somewhere as chaotic as the frontiers of the empire.

Phainon wasn't worried for Khaslana at all. This was the plot from the original novel anyways. Next, as all kinds of people chased after him with the intent to kill, Khaslana would grow stronger and stronger, then at the frontier he would gather several teammates who were strong but had no status. Not long after coming back, he would approach the finale.

Phainon felt emotional when he thought about how he was finally going to be able to leave the world. He had only stayed a few months in this world, but so many things had happened. It made him feel like he had been here for ages. But a strange part of him also felt melancholic about those moments but he pushed that thought to the back of his brain.

Ever since the engagement banquet, Phainon was forced to live with Nanook. He even had to learn palace etiquette and such during the day.

He was just about to leave, but he still couldn't scrape by... Because every night, Nanook insisted on inspecting what Phainon studied. If Phainon couldn't answer, he would ‘punish’ Phainon.

Phainon seriously suspected that Nanook was just finding an excuse, but he couldn't do anything about it. He could only use the passion he had for learning about mechas to learn palace etiquette.

Phainon ate listlessly after tiring himself out with his studies. Maybe Nanook was insisting on competing with Mydei, because he was always cooking personally. It made Phainon, who had thought he would be able to eat palace delicacies, extremely disappointed.

"Did you know? The child that Father truly loves is that Khaslana guy." Nanook looked at Phainon, propping up his head with hand. He said slowly, "He must be happy."

Under the candlelight, his face was stunningly beautiful. Phainon still felt that getting engaged with Nanook was too much of a fantasy. It took him a long moment to react to what was being said.

"Of course I didn't know," Phainon said quickly. "Still, Khaslana really is pretty awesome."

Was it possible for fate's favorite in a novel not to be awesome? Though Khaslana tragically lost to Phainon several times and even got stabbed by Phainon several times.

Nanook continued, "Also, Mydeimos went to the frontier with those people as well."

"Huh?" Phainon was a bit shocked. He suddenly remembered what Mydei said to him the day of the engagement banquet.

In the original novel, Mydei worshipped Khaslana, so he couldn't feel at ease letting him go alone, and followed along... This time, he had probably decided to leave and go out to improve himself after being provoked by Nanook.

This world's consciousness was amazing... It could even make the plot develop the same way as the original novel_(:3」∠)_

"As the heir of the Kremnoan family's next generation, he clearly doesn't have to worry about his future. Why would he take a risk and go to the frontier?" Nanook asked. "Is it to train himself, or is it for something else?"

Phainon hurriedly said, "Of course it's to train himself. After all, Mydei is someone who seeks strength."

"You're right, but... Don't you think you understand things related to him too well?" Nanook smiled slightly. "Didn't I tell you before? You need to forget everything about him."

This kind of thing isn't something you can forget just by saying you'd forget!

Phainon quickly changed the topic. He asked, "But, Your Highness, what exactly is your goal in having those low-level Zerg do these kinds of things..."

"Of course it's for my amusement," Nanook said. "Isn't it fun? You can see what the lofty nobles would look like when they're afraid. It's enjoyable just thinking about it."

Phainon: "..." *Was there really nothing wrong with people like Nanook who thought like this!!*

As expected, things progressed pretty much as they did in the original novel. In just a few months, the Zerg looked like they were going to retreat.

Though the generals fighting at the frontiers didn't get lavish praise for being heroes who saved the empire like last time, they received plenty of flattery, especially Khaslana. He was young and handsome, and he had made plenty of contributions. For a moment, he was the most dazzling person in the empire. Several people suddenly realized that Khaslana was someone who had fought his way into the finals of the mecha competition when they found the videos of him online.

After all, only the first place winner would be remembered by the people, and the first place winner Prince Latiao was so flashy that it made Khaslana's brilliance significantly dimmer.

But now there had been no news of Prince Latiao for a long time. In contrast, Khaslana was on the way to taking his place.

Many people wondered why someone as strong as Prince Latiao wouldn't publicize his identity... And General Wiley, who had kept his grudges the entire time, took the chance to get a group of people to guide public opinion online.

For a moment, several people began to say that although Prince Latiao was strong, he had no courage. At such a critical moment, he didn't have the guts to come out. He couldn't hold a candle to Khaslana.

Mydei had achieved plenty himself, and because he went personally to the frontlines to kill the Zerg despite being the heir of the Kremnoan family, he won a good amount of the common populace's heart.

But this was all to pave the way for Khaslana, and similarly all the propaganda focused on him. Most of the time, Mydei was overlooked.

The emperor was put at ease. He moved directly to confer a title on Khaslana, giving him a position with real power and promoting him rapidly. The others were also awarded generously, but they didn't get anything close to Khaslana. Many people immediately thought about how to get close to Khaslana.

General Wiley suffered serious injuries in the expedition. When he recovered, he was still far from his past strength. He immediately thought of resting, and he passed on all of his influence and subordinates to Khaslana.

In that span of time, Khaslana's power and influence faintly became greater than what General Wiley's had been. Although he couldn't compare to the Kremnoan family, he was already enough to give them a sense of danger.

There had also been several scandals from the Kremnoan family recently. After all, there was no way that they had reached such greatness cleanly. It was obvious just by looking at how Herklas had tried to use the Kremnoan family's name the other time. It was just that nobody had ever dared to oppose them or speak up in the past.

But this time, the person behind the people spreading the news was the emperor. Of course, they were assured with him as their support. At the same time, the Kremnoan family had never expected that the trick they used against General Wiley could be used against them. Soon, they were in a bad spot.

Nobody would expect Khaslana and his subordinates that the place normally met to discuss was an extremely ordinary residence on a remote outer planet.

Wearing a disguise, Mydei walked in after getting off the aircar. "What did you call me here for?"

"I want to show you something very interesting." Khaslana pushed open an interior door, smiling slightly, and a Zerg corpse appeared in front of them. Although it looked slightly different from an ordinary Zerg, there wasn't anything special about it.

Mydei had seen plenty of them on the frontier. He said coolly, "It's just a Zerg corpse. What am I supposed to be looking at?"

"It's different from other Zergs," Khaslana said. "When it was alive, it looked like a human."

"What?" Mydei felt a sense of alarm. He looked carefully at the Zerg's corpse, but no matter how he studied it, he couldn't see anything unusual.

"It happened a few days ago. I caught someone who wanted to assassinate me and brought him here to interrogate," Khaslana said. "I didn't expect that after he died, this fellow would turn into a Zerg... It really is interesting."

Mydei knew perfectly well that most of the people who came to assassinate Khaslana were sent by the Kremnoan family, and his expression turned grave.

After what happened in the past, he understood that, although he was the heir of the most powerful Kremnoan family, in reality the power was out of his hands. The family had never even taken him seriously.

He wanted to make his way up and get revenge on Nanook, who had snatched away his everything, so he had come to the frontier, making peace with the person who had the same goal as him, Khaslana. Of course, they each had their own plans.

But on the road, all kinds of things kept happening. All kinds of people came on assassination missions. There was someone who wanted to kill Khaslana in every situation. But Khaslana was truly lucky; he was able to push through each and every assassination. Mydei had the feeling that he was someone favored by the heavens.

"What is going on here..." Mydei frowned slightly. "How could there be a Zerg who took the shape of a human?"

"I thought it was strange before. These Zerg were just like ordinary beasts... But suddenly, they could show high intelligence. Thus, it made people suspect that they were separated into different categories," Khaslana said. "I had people study this corpse. Although it looks no different from a normal Zerg on the outside, it's actually several times stronger than a normal Zerg... If it wasn't for the fact that it died when it was returning to its normal form, even I would have trouble dealing with it.

"I looked into it more after that, and I discovered some very interesting things."

Khaslana pulled out a sheaf of papers. They were filled with information about people who had been awarded recognition of their service in the war years ago. Today, they had all climbed to lofty positions in the empire. The one thing that matched between all of them was that they were on the crown prince's side.

"These people," Mydei said, "are all childless?"

"Exactly. All of these people have been married for several years, but they don't have any children. Why is that?" Khaslana said. "I think we'll certainly make a big discovery if we investigate them."

Mydei said, "What you're saying is that they're all Zerg?"

"I didn't say that," Khaslana said. "But if that's true... then our plans aren't far from success. His Highness the Crown Prince, that high and lofty fellow, has finally given the game away."

"I truly never expected it," Mydei said quietly. "His Highness has actually been colluding with the Zerg."

This was something that could deal a serious blow to the Kremnoan family, but Mydei didn't feel sorrowful at all. Instead, he had a faint sense of excitement.

The Kremnoan family was too strong. They should have stopped existing a long time ago. As long as the family existed, he would be unable to do the things he wanted to do.

And if Nanook fell from power, then wouldn't Phainon also come to his side?

Mydei suddenly found his own thoughts terrifying, but he couldn't completely stop himself.

As long as he could have Phainon return to his side, he didn't care about anything. Nothing could make him hesitate for even a split second.

It wasn't just Khaslana and his side who discovered some clues. Problems were also beginning to rise within the empire.

At some point, several people announced with terror that they had seen people turn into Zerg with their own eyes.

At first, everyone thought of those words as utter nonsense. Even the people who said it themselves suspected that they might have gone crazy. Zerg were Zerg and humans were humans. How could a human suddenly turn into a Zerg?

But soon after, pictures unexpectedly surfaced time and time again. In the pictures, the Zerg were very real. Even an expert couldn't tell where the pictures were edited when they examined them.

The major planets began to impose a curfew, and they required several rounds of questioning to leave. Many people who just arrived on the planet were isolated and examined.

General Wiley, who had already retired, took a stand, saying that he had indeed seen some high-level Zerg turning into humans when he went out to war this time, and they were extremely intelligent. He told everyone not to hold everything back and to speak up about anyone who they felt was suspicious.

In moments, everyone was alarmed. Many people stayed home, afraid to go out. They would feel suspicious even when they saw their long-time friends.

But in that moment, Khaslana took a stand. He said that his subordinates had discovered a way to find out if someone was a Zerg pretending to be a human.

As someone who discovered how to deal with the situation, Khaslana was just like how General Wiley had been in the past. He was quickly put up on a pedestal and hailed by everyone as a hero.

And Khaslana worked swiftly and fiercely. As long as someone was suspicious, he would take them in for an examination. He arrested several of the higher-ups in the Kremnoan family, and finally discovered that they really were Zerg.

In moments, the Kremnoan family became public enemy number one. In contrast, the heir of the Kremnoan family Mydei unhesitatingly announced

that he was on Khaslana's side.

It was only then that everyone remembered that those people in the Kremnoan family were only replaced because the Zerg killed them. They quickly felt a wave of sympathy for Mydei.

Things happened in rapid succession. Many of the higher-ups in the Kremnoan family died, but it was obvious that they didn't have the same strength they used to have. Naturally, they couldn't compare with Khaslana, who was at the peak of his power.

Soon afterwards, the emperor took the chance to send out an announcement: Khaslana was actually the beloved son he had been separated from for many years.

In the midst of the chaos, Nanook said nothing. He didn't even take a side. Several of his subordinates had been exposed as Zerg, and their strength had been pretty much destroyed. His greatest support, the Kremnoan family, no longer had their old glory.

Soon, many bystanders who valued strength sought refuge with Khaslana. There were people who spoke out to say His Highness the Crown Prince's personality was unsuited to being the heir of the throne, and Khaslana's personality was the most suitable. They demanded that Khaslana was made the crown prince.

Things progressed smoothly. It was going so smoothly that even if Khaslana was fate's favorite it seemed too convenient.

While the outer world was in a hubbub, Nanook was calm. He even had the spare time to help Phainon wash his hair.

"Aren't you worried?" Phainon couldn't help but ask.

Although nobody was saying that Nanook was a Zerg, there were many people that guessed Nanook had some connection to the Zerg... It looked like Nanook's identity would be found out sooner or later.

"Why do I need to worry?" Nanook said, smiling slightly. "Right now, everything is going just as I want it to..."

Phainon: "!?"

Wait! Actually, based on what happened in the original novel, Nanook would be able to achieve his goal of controlling the whole empire if he inherited the throne. Why would he still do so much? Could it be that he really just thought it was fun?

"You must be wondering why I did so many unnecessary things." Nanook could tell what Phainon was thinking at a glance. "To be honest, my goal isn't to rule the empire."

Phainon often felt that Nanook might have the power to read minds. His guesses were simply too accurate.

"In fact, I want to destroy the empire," Nanook said. "Don't you think these people are boring? No matter if they're people or Zerg, it's most interesting when they're facing destruction."

Phainon: "!" *Hey, Nanook was totally a chaotic evil villain!*

"Actually, the fact that all those people are Zerg... I revealed it to the public. What fun is a chess board where you always have the upper hand?" Nanook said slowly. "Being backed into a corner all by yourself is the only way to have the most fun."

Phainon: "...!" *I already stopped understanding what exactly you're having fun with!*

But it looked like now... the finale should be coming soon.

No matter what Nanook wanted to do, he just had to endure until the finale and everything would be fine! He could do everything again in the next world.

In the next few days, Khaslana's influence grew more and more. In contrast, Nanook declined all visitors, seeming as though he had lost all hope. His subordinates also did nothing.

Just as though it seemed like everything had already been decided, an unforeseen event occurred. On a perfectly normal morning, countless people discovered that their friends or family members had become Zerg.

The entire country flew into a panic.

Everyone had thought that the Zerg had already been captured. But all of the Zerg who had been caught were people that purposely revealed their identities under Nanook's suggestion.

The imperial palace was also in chaos. In the grand hall, the emperor looked at Nanook, his face filled with terror. "What are you trying to do?"

After being on the throne for so many years, the emperor had enjoyed all kinds of pleasures. He said that he missed his true love, but in fact he doted on a number of new lovers. He had never trained; his strength didn't even match up to a twelve-year-old alpha.

"Father, I just want you to pass on with Mother." Nanook smiled slightly. "You don't need to be scared. It will all end quickly."

"I know I can't make it up to your mother..." the emperor said. "But you don't need to go so far either. How have I ever treated you unfairly in these years?"

The emperor took a step back in his terror, but he bumped into Khaslana who was just coming into the door. He immediately stood at Khaslana's side, feeling much more at ease.

"Father, you don't need to worry anymore. Nothing will happen now that I'm here." As Khaslana spoke, he smiled slightly. He skewered a sharp knife through the emperor's chest.

He gazed at the emperor's astounded expression, and he let out the laugh he had been holding back.

"My deepest apologies. I've always hated you."

Even if the emperor was biased towards him, Khaslana's hostility had never changed. Although the Kremnoan family had pushed him towards the slums, it had a lot to do with the emperor... If it wasn't for the fact that he couldn't even protect the woman he loved, how would things go so far?

Khaslana looked at Nanook. "Your Highness the Crown Prince, I didn't expect that you would collude with the Zerg. For the sake of the empire's future, it looks like I have no choice but to make a move against you."

"Oh? If you have the strength, then don't hesitate to come at me." Nanook laughed.

Dozens of Zerg rushed in from outside, gathering up by Nanook.

The Zerg were hideous. Their carapace was as hard as an alloy, and their blood could corrode a mecha. Coupled with their speed, it was difficult for an ordinary person to face them without a mecha.

"It looks like I've underestimated." Khaslana's gaze turned cold. He had no choice but to temporarily withdraw.

Phainon didn't realize that the world had turned on its head until he woke up.

Fuck, he just got up a little late! Why did it seem like he missed a lot? Nanook didn't even wake him up at such a critical moment.

Phainon was given a shock. He shot to his feet, making to exit.

But there was a bodyguard that Nanook left at the door. Although he treated Phainon with great respect, he had absolutely no intention to give way.

Phainon knew that all of these bodyguards were originally Zerg. It would be impossible for him to break through by himself, so he had no choice but to return to his room.

He had to find a way to get out, then he would probably be able to leave the world after he found Khaslana. Otherwise, if he stayed here... After the finale, the new emperor Khaslana would probably find someone to kill him off.

Phainon could still remember how he stabbed Khaslana a few times back then. The person that Khaslana hated the most was, without a doubt, him.

Unexpectedly, Phainon heard the sound of fighting from outside. He hid in a place with cover, shocked. He was afraid it was someone Khaslana sent. If he was caught, he would be done for.

The fight ended quickly. The sound of footsteps came over, and at the same time, Mydei's voice sounded.

"I'm here to pick you up."

Chapter End Notes

The Author Has Something To Say:
Yay! New Chapter! We will be wrapping things up next week. But don't worry I'll be back after my exams with lots of fun side stories that will be announced next week. Ahh! I'm nervous. Endings are really not as fun to write as beginnings. Personally, the best parts are the middle where emotions are already high or are being established. I feel like the dialogues aren't as heavy hitting this chapter as I would like but I cant think of much else. If there's any extra content that you would like to see being made, comment it down in this chapter or the next one and I'll look into it. I've already taken a lot of good Inspo from some of you who suggested stuff hehe.

Also since we are at the second last chapter today. I want to ask you cuties what your rankings of the ML's are? Mine are:
1. Mydei/Khaslana

2. Nanook
3. Caelus

See You Next Week!

Chapter 22: The Winner Takes It All

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Phainon immediately let out a breath of relief. He came out. "Why are you here?"

Mydei felt emotional seeing Phainon again. "You're in danger. Of course I must come."

When Phainon thought about how Mydei was working with Khaslana, he knew the time had almost come. He asked, "How are things outside right now?"

Mydei said, "Right now, it's a mess outside. The common people are all staying in shelters. Many Zerg are out on the streets. I feared something would happen to you, so I rushed over.... How about I take you to the shelter now."

Phainon followed Mydei down the stairs. He spotted a Zerg corpse lying on the ground and a mecha before him; his heart suddenly skipped a beat.

"Let me borrow your mecha for a moment."

Mydei was stunned. "What did you say?"

Phainon just placed a kiss on Mydei’s cheek, steeling his heart and whispering “I’m sorry Mydeimos.”

Everything happened too quickly. Before Mydei could react, Phainon leaped into the cockpit of the mecha, whisking it away so quickly it was as though the mecha hadn't even touched the ground.

Although a normal mecha had authentication systems that made it so others couldn't use them at random, Phainon's strong spiritual energy was enough

to obliterate the mecha's security and allow him to immediately pilot the mecha.

Phainon rushed towards the main hall. The road was left extremely open. There were barely even any Zerg.

It was a good thing that Nanook lived in the imperial palace, or it might have been a hassle.

While he was on the road, Phainon's personal terminal suddenly lit up. Unexpectedly, a holographic screen appeared without his prompting and began to transmit the scene by the imperial palace.

Phainon immediately froze. The rest of the empire was probably watching the same broadcast. He didn't expect that Nanook would get someone to control the mainframe.
On the screen, Nanook sat up straight on the throne. He was wearing a crown on his head, and he looked over with a slight smile. He said, "I think everyone must be very confused, hmm? Don't worry, and don't be scared.... There's already no hope for you."

Phainon: "!" Hey, these lines were exactly like a villain's! It was easy for him to imagine how shocked the public would be at His Highness the Crown Prince's words. Still, this was the effect Nanook wanted....

"I truly apologize for hiding this from you in the past." Nanook sighed. "In truth, I'm a Zerg and human hybrid. And the beautiful empress you remember was actually the transformed Zerg Queen."

Everyone in the shelters was stunned silly when they saw the broadcast. They couldn't believe what they were hearing at all.

"It's really such a pity that Father died too soon; otherwise, if he learnt about this, he would probably be pleasantly surprised," Nanook said. "After all, he lived with the Zerg Queen for such a long time. How difficult for an ordinary human."

Phainon: "..." There was obviously nobody who would be excited about something like this!

Phainon finally hurried his way to the imperial palace. He quickly spotted ten Zerg fighting against Khaslana.

Phainon couldn't actually recognize Khaslana's mecha, but as soon as he spotted it, Phainon heard the system's voice.

[Beep beep beep... Detected an even more powerful character.... Beginning to select capture targets in accordance with the system's regulations.... Selection complete. The current capture target is Khaslana.]

That was so hard! He finally succeeded in binding to the original male lead now!

It was Phainon's first time feeling emotional over binding to someone.

"Then I can leave now, right?" Phainon said. "After all, it's pretty much the finale now."

[The villain boss is not dead yet and the original protagonist has not reached his peak, so the host can't leave yet.]

"Huh?!" But in the original novel Nanook didn't get his lunchbox either!

[Currently, due to his exposed identity, he turned from a villain who could be saved into a villain who must be killed.]

"..." *Even this was okay?*

Because he thought he'd be able to leave immediately, Phainon had relaxed. He didn't bother paying attention to how long he had been maneuvering the mecha at all.
After the shock, Phainon suddenly felt his body go stiff. Blood began to flow out of his mouth.

"Fuck!" It had already been more than five minutes! Hey, his body was about to collapse!

On the other side, Khaslana made a mistake and was accidentally splashed with the Zerg's corrosive body fluids. Instantly, his movements slowed. It was obvious that for the time being there was no way he would be able to charge over to Nanook and begin a life-or-death battle.

Phainon: "!?" Fuck, something would actually happen at such a critical moment? He wasn't going to get his lunchbox at such a critical moment, right?

No, he still had hope.

Phainon gritted his teeth. There was still one person who could kill Nanook, and that person was him.

Phainon maneuvered the mecha with gritted teeth, passing Khaslana and charging at Nanook.

He had never wanted to be a hero. He had never wanted any of this—not the system, not the endless transmigration, not the cruel joke of falling for people he could never keep.

Especially not him.

The thought of Mydei flashed through his mind unbidden: those sunset eyes, the way he would kneel with such fierce devotion, the gentle hands that had learned to cook just to make Phainon happy. The way he had looked when Phainon kissed him goodbye just moments ago.

"I'm sorry, Mydeimos."

The words felt like glass in his throat.

His silhouette of course appeared on the screen. Everyone could recognize Mydeimos's mecha, and they immediately roused themselves with excitement, telling themselves that the empire still had hope.

"Oh?" Nanook looked at the mecha in front of him. "It's someone familiar. Still, even if it's someone familiar, I won't show any mercy."

Immediately, numerous Zerg swarmed in from the sidelines, blitzing at the mecha.

Phainon used his spiritual energy to feel all around him, as though he had temporarily forgotten how his body was about to collapse. With natural, easy movements, he cut down the Zerg who flung themselves at him. Every attack was precisely on his enemy's weak points, cutting the Zerg right in two.

But he wouldn't be able to stand up against the increasingly serious condition of his body even if he was more skilled, and it was like he would never kill enough of the surrounding Zerg.

Moreover, when the Zerg died, the corrosive fluids from their bodies would splash onto the mecha. At first, it wasn't a problem, but with the buildup of more fluids, significant amounts of the mecha eroded.

Phainon coughed up another mouthful of blood. The scene in front of him turned blurry.

"!" Fuck! Even if Khaslana came personally to flaunt his protagonist halo he might not be able to kill Nanook!

This same scene was broadcasted to the entire empire. Everyone saw it as clear as day.

"Amazing..."

"But is Lord Mydeimos so strong?"

Anyone who was more in the know about mechas could tell that though the mecha before their eyes belonged to Mydei, its movements were completely different from Mydei's.
Even if Mydei had purposely concealed his strength in the past, it was impossible that it could be to this extent.

"Maybe it's some expert in his mecha. These movements look so familiar!"

"I remember now! Didn't Prince Latiao use these kinds of moves before?!"

"Yes, exactly! They really are the same... Could it be that the person inside is Prince Latiao?"

Everyone began to feel excited. After all, Prince Latiao was someone so powerful that he could even overthrow General Wiley with ease, so the people in front of him would be a piece of cake.

Phainon gritted his teeth, pulling his spiritual energy back in.

Immediately, the mecha stopped. Just as everyone began to grow doubtful, the door of the cockpit opened. Phainon, his brow dripping in cold sweat and his mouth still gushing with blood, poked out his head.

At that moment, everyone was stupefied.

They all knew this person.... Wasn't this Phainon who everyone had cursed out? How did he get in the mecha?!

Could it be that he was the legendary Prince Latiao? Prince Latiao was a freaking beta?

Nanook immediately stood from his throne.

The Zerg below made to attack, but they felt something, and one by one they stepped back.

Phainon crawled out of the cockpit with difficulty, falling weakly to the ground, but Nanook propped him up.

Nanook looked at Phainon and could immediately see that there was something off. "Your body can't stand it anymore. Why?"

"I...." Phainon didn't finish his sentence even after a long time. He coughed up a mouthful of blood.

He gritted his teeth. He knew that he was about to die. He threw himself into Nanook's chest, pulling out a knife he had hidden on his body for self-defense, and stabbed forward.

Even if Nanook was a Zerg-human hybrid, when he was in his human form, his weakness was his heart.

Before the knife could touch his skin, Nanook caught Phainon by the wrist.

"You want to kill me?" Nanook asked.

Phainon bit his lip. He felt like he was about to be done for. His voice was low. "Exactly...."

Shockingly, Nanook revealed a slight smile. "Of course you can." It was as though he had heard Phainon bring up an ordinary wish. He reached out to grasp Phainon's wrist, thrusting down towards his own chest.

Phainon looked up in astonishment. "Why?"

"Because I like you. I would agree to any of your requests...." Nanook pulled Phainon into his arms. "And... I'm feeling a little tired too. Wouldn't it be the most joyful thing to die with you?"

Although Nanook thought a bit differently from an ordinary person, Phainon had a strange feeling. In the next moment, he completely lost consciousness in Nanook's arms.

[Beep beep beep…. Mission Complete…. Initiating Transfer….]

Phainon’s spirit which was slowly fading away, looked at the corpse of the body he occupied below and felt a strange sensation in his chest. It was good that he was finally able to leave this crazy world but just then a certain blonde haired male came into his mind but he pushed that thought down. He always knew he was going to leave; it was better not to get attached. Mydeimos would be better off without him….. Just as he was thinking this he caught a glimpse of that very person.

When Khaslana came in and saw what happened, he was stunned.

And Mydei, who hurried over, charged over furiously and embraced Phainon's corpse.

He didn't remember crossing the threshold. He didn't remember pushing past the Zerg that had gone suddenly still, their connection to their queen severed. He didn't remember Khaslana shouting something behind him.

All he remembered was the body.

Phainon lay crumpled against Nanook's chest, the crown prince's blood pooling around them both. His eyes were closed, lashes dark against too-pale cheeks.

"Phainon?"

Mydei's voice didn't sound like his own. It was too small, too broken, too human.

He fell to his knees beside the body, hands reaching out to touch—to hold—to somehow undo what had been done.

"Wake up."

His fingers brushed Phainon's cheek. It was still warm.

"Please."

Nothing. No flutter of eyelids, no teasing smile, no exasperated sigh.

"You can't leave me here all alone."

The words tore from his throat, raw and desperate. Mydei gathered Phainon into his arms, pressing him against his chest as if he could force life back into that broken body through sheer will alone.

"I love you."

He had never said it before. He had been too afraid, too reverent, too certain that Phainon would disappear if he spoke the words aloud.

"I love you, I love you, I love you—"

The mantra became a sob. Mydei buried his face in Phainon's hair, breathing in the fading scent of him—that impossible mix of omega sweetness and something uniquely Phainon.

"*You idiot.*" Mydei's tears fell onto Phainon's face, tracing paths through the blood and dirt. "*You absolute idiot. Did you think I would want to live in a world without you*?"

Mydei pressed his head against Phainon’s chest as if willing his heart to beat once more through sheer force of will. He felt his heart growing colder and colder by the second as he clutched Phainon’s body to his chest.

Just then, his gaze landed on the knife still clutched in Phainon's hand.

Phainon saw this scene and his eyes widened as his heart pounded in his ear drums.

“Mydeimos! Wait- System, what is he doing!? Why isn’t somebody stopping him!”

Phainon had wanted to bury his feelings and leave this world behind but he didn’t want Mydei to be hurt, he wanted him to be healthy and well, to maybe even fall in love with someone else and be happy. But Mydei couldn’t hear him and he was fading fast.

Mydei stared at the knife and then at his dear Deliverer and his heart had made its decision. He grabbed the knife and thrust it towards his own chest.

“Mydei-!” Phainon called out, his hand reaching out.

[Beep beep beep…. Transfer Complete]

That was the last sound Phainon heard as his world went dark and his outstretched hand faded into particles.

Khaslana quickly had his subordinates stop Mydei, knocking him out, then had some people tidy up the main hall. Phainon's corpse was left in the inner hall.

When everyone finally left, Khaslana walked slowly over to the corpse.

Even now he couldn't believe that Phainon, the person who had always opposed him, the person who had won several times against him, had actually died.

His chest felt empty. He couldn't say a single word.

After Nanook died, the strength of all the Zerg decreased significantly to the point that even an ordinary human could stand up to them. As such, the crisis that the original novel thought would send the empire into destruction was resolved.

Naturally, Khaslana became the emperor, and he promoted the people who had followed him from the beginning. Only Mydei left without saying goodbye; nobody knew where he went.

Unlike Mydei, Caelus spent several days at Phainon's tombstone, then invested all of his energy into mecha training.

Nobody had expected that in the end, the person who would rescue the empire would be the person that everyone hated, Phainon.

And the truth that Phainon was actually an omega hiding his identity only came out after his death.

It was only then that everyone understood why Prince Latiao only appeared online while staying so lowkey in the real world. After all, he was just an omega.

But though he was just an omega, he stepped out bravely at such a time. He didn't hesitate to sacrifice himself to save the empire. He was completely worthy of being called a hero.

When Phainon's initial engagement with Mydei was brought out, everyone's imaginations ran wild. They even thought that Phainon had known

Nanook's identity ages ago, so he laid down his life to hide at Nanook's side.

It was also after this that the empire developed a new medication to remove a mark on an omega, as well as other relatively harmless suppressants.

Their status also rose significantly. They could even attend the same schools as alphas and betas. Soon, there were many more omegas who came to participate in the virtual mecha competitions.

And several hundred years later, the story of Phainon was recorded in the empire's textbooks, and what he did had been shot as several movies.

Epilogue:

The apartment was too quiet.

Phainon sat down near his front door, tying his shoes and tried to remember what normal felt like. The morning light slanted through half-open blinds, catching dust motes that drifted lazily through the air. Somewhere outside, a car honked. A bird sang. The world went on, utterly indifferent to the fact that he had lived—and died—in places this world would never know.

He ran a hand through his hair and sighed.

Multiple worlds. Multiple lifetimes of memories. And for what?

The System had been silent since he woke up in his original body three weeks ago. No daily tasks. No electric shocks. No cheerful announcements about capture targets or powerful characters. Just... nothing. Like it had never existed at all.

Good riddance.

But it had still been hard to assimilate back into his modern life when he to the people here he had only been gone a day while he had lived hundreds of years with the system.

Stop it, he told himself. *It's over. You're home. Move on.*

He'd been telling himself that for three weeks.

It wasn't working.

The coffee shop was two blocks away, a small corner place he'd walked past a hundred times before the System snatched him away. It was familiar in the way old shoes were familiar—nothing special, but comfortable. The kind of place where the barista knew your order and the same old man sat in the same corner booth every morning, reading the same newspaper.

Phainon pushed open the door, bell jingling overhead, and stepped inside.

The warmth hit him first—the smell of roasted beans, the hiss of the espresso machine, the low murmur of conversation. It was aggressively, mundanely *normal*. Exactly what he needed.

He was halfway to the counter when the door swung open behind him.

He didn't think anything of it. Just another customer, here for their morning caffeine fix. He took another step—

And someone crashed into him from the side.

Coffee spilled. The world tilted. Phainon's feet tangled with someone else's, and suddenly he was falling, his shoulder hitting the floor hard, a curse already forming on his lips.

"I'm so sorry—"

The voice stopped him cold.

He knew that voice. He had heard it whisper his name in the dark, had heard it praise him without any scruples, had heard it beg him to wake up when everything was already over.

Phainon looked up.

Blonde hair, a shade lighter than he remembered. Amber eyes, warm as sunset, wide with genuine embarrassment. A face that was all sharp angles and quiet strength, softened now by faint concern spreading across his features.

Mydeimos.

But not *his* Mydei.

This Mydei wore a simple grey sweater, sleeves pushed up to his elbows. A messenger bag hung across his chest. His hair was shorter, neater, without the warrior's wildness. And his eyes—those eyes that had once blazed with fanatical devotion—were looking at Phainon with nothing but stranger's concern.

"I didn't see you—are you alright?" He crouched down, extending a hand. "Here, let me help you up."

Phainon stared at that hand.

He had watched this man kneel before him in a dozen different ways. Had felt those fingers trace his skin, had held that hand in the dark, had memorized every line and callus. He had watched him fall apart over a body that wasn't even really his.

And now—

Now Mydei was just a stranger in a coffee shop, offering a hand because it was the polite thing to do.

Phainon didn't move.

"Hey?" Mydei's brow furrowed. His hand stayed outstretched, patient but starting to look uncertain. "You okay? Did you hit your head?"

Say something, Phainon screamed at himself. *Move. Breathe. Do something normal. This is not him.*

Instead, he just kept staring.

Phainon, immersed in his own thought didn’t notice that behind Mydei's polite concern, beneath the unfamiliar sweater and the stranger's confusion, there was something else. A flicker. A pull. A tension in his shoulders that said he felt something, even if he didn't understand it.

Slowly—almost trembling—he reached up and took Mydei's hand.

The grip was warm. Solid. Real.

Mydei pulled him to his feet with easy strength, and for a moment they stood face to face, closer than strangers should stand. Phainon could smell him—coffee and something clean, like soap or rain. Nothing like the battlefield. Nothing like the crown prince's palace.

But the hand holding his didn't let go.

Their eyes met.

And Mydei hesitated.

His lips parted, then closed. His head tilted, just a fraction, as if he was trying to solve a puzzle he didn't have the pieces for.

"Sorry," he said again, but this time his voice was quieter. "Do I... know you?"

"You seem..." Mydei trailed off, searching for a word that didn't seem to exist. "*Familiar.*"

Chapter End Notes

> The Author Has Something To Say:
> Hello Everyone! Sorry for the long unexpected hiatus between this chapter and the last but I'm a bit of a perfectionist so I started obsessing over the ending and nothing felt right and I ended up being filled with anxiety plus my exams were nearing so I pushed it aside.

My exams are currently underway but me procrastinating studying has led to me finally just doing it. I hope the ending was satisfactory.

Thank you to everyone who read this silly little project of mine and left comments. This was my first fanfic and I had a lot of fun thanks to you guys! I appreciate all of you for spending time with me and this story and my little rambles at the end of each chapter when you could be doing anything else, especially the ones who were here from chapter 1. Lmao I even lowkey memorized your usernames haha XD.

I also have a question to ask you all. If you forget the epilogue and Phainon seeing what Mydei was about to do for a moment, Who do you think fits the description of ML? Nanook who died with Phainon at the end of the story or Mydei who was the only person to move Phainon's heart but was left behind?

This is a question I have thought about a lot so please do answer to this.

I will probably come back with side stories in about three months but no promises though haha. The tentative list so far is:
1. Khaslana Ending
2. Mydei x Khaslana Jealousy Scene
3. Phaidei extended smut scene
4. NanookPhai extended smut scene(?)
5. True Harem Ending (?)
6. PhaiKhasDei Poly Ending(?)
7. Nanook Ending

The ones with (?) are maybe's but the others are definitely will write.

Thanks for reading this large ramble and bye!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!